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## Introduction

When I got introduced to D&D, my favorite books were the Monster Manuals. Pretty pictures and evocative descriptions excited my imagination, made me think about how the world would treat these creatures, how they would coexist with one another, and what kind of adventures and quests they could be used for. I did not treat them as enemies, but as parts of the world. This is why the “Ecology of [monster]” articles from Dragon Magazine were (and still are) my favorites.

When I started playing GURPS, I immediately began converting the various races and monsters from D&D, even if I did not need them for the game I was running. I thought that they might come in handy later, and that this is a good practice.

At first, when I was still having a “D&D mindset,” I tried to make them as close to the original statblock as possible. You know, with a myriad of spell-like abilities that do not even make sense in the context of GURPS. Later, I understood that that was a big mistake, that many D&D monster abilities are only there due to the level-based nature of the system, not because they are thematically appropriate for the monster in question. For example, many monsters past a certain CR have *dispel magic*, *remove curse*, *see invisibility*, and similar abilities just to be able to deal with player characters that are excessively buffed up and have access to abilities or spells that simply cannot be countered without these spell-like abilities. The same applies to incredibly high stats some of the monsters have just because they need these stats to be of that CR. In that sense, D&D is very gamified, but GURPS is not. This is the blessing of being a classless, levelless system – you get to have a believable world instead of being a simple game. Some see it as a curse; I certainly do not.

So, after having this mindset broken, I reworked everything. *Many* abilities got cut, and many got completely reworked. I tried to preserve the essence of the monster while making it a GURPS monster, not a D&D monster, if that makes any sense. This is why there are so many discrepancies that observant and knowledgeable readers may notice – they are intentional.

All GURPS games are different. I may run a D&D-style game in GURPS my way, and others may do so using a different set of optional rules. We would be using the same system, be inspired by the same source (D&D, in this case), but we would get different experiences. This is why I think that a “GURPS Bestiary” that people wish for would not make much sense – a bestiary would have to be made for a *specific* GURPS game. This is why you have monster books for Dungeon Fantasy, DFRPG, and Monster Hunters, but not much for “generic GURPS,” because

generic GURPS isn’t a thing. This particular document is a bestiary for D&D-style games *the way I run them*. This doesn’t mean that this is the only true way, but it may give you a baseline to adapt to the way *you* run the game. For example, I include damage values for [Reduced Swing](#) damage, because this rule provides the experience I want.

I’m not a big fan of the GURPS monster statblock. Thus, in this document you will see a different format from what you’ve seen in the official publications. I took inspiration from D&D and ACKS II, and added some stuff of my own. The goal was to have a statblock that is easier to use for the GM. GURPS has a large library of books, and looking stuff up may take a while, so I tried to present all the information you need and provide page references for certain rules that may come up. In addition, I included information that is not related to combat. A monster is not just a potential adversary, but a part of a living world. I believe that the ecology of a monster is very important if you want to make believable environments and dungeons. Sometimes, it makes adventure design easier, as interesting situations and interactions between different monsters may be a good inspiration. Also, since fighting a monster is not the only thing you can do, I included information on whether you can catch and tame it, and all the valuable parts and other spoils. Crafting is fun!

D&D lore and statistics are inconsistent between editions and even books within the same edition. Sometimes, they directly contradict one another. For this document, my goal was to not to provide a one-to-one “canon” version, but a version of the creature that I would use in my games. Usually, I take the D&D 3.5 version as the base, and then look through other books and editions to see what else I can add without any contradictions and inconsistencies. Sometimes, if I find something that I like more than what’s spelled out in the D&D 3.5 version, I replace it with that. For example, *Lords of Madness* for D&D 3.5 describes the reproductive system of the beholders, but D&D 5e retcons it to be something completely different (and stupid, but that’s just my opinion), so that newer stuff isn’t taken into account here. On the other hand, the D&D 3.5 ankheg is a six-legged insect that has no forearms, but all pre-and-post-3.5 versions are more mantis-like in shape with four legs and two forearms that can be used as weapons. I like that more, so that’s how the ankheg works here.

This document is a work in progress. You may see some placeholder information, and I may change things up as new ideas come up. I hope you have as much fun with it, as I had writing it!

- Enraged Eggplant

## How to Use

This document may seem very different from the standard GURPS monster statblocks, so let me clarify what some of these things are.

First, monsters are listed alphabetically, and if a particular monster belongs to a particular category, the category is listed first. Thus, we have “Lizard, Monitor” instead of “Monitor Lizard” to have all lizards in the same place.

When necessary, the category itself has an entry that describes common traits and features of its creatures. For example, “Demon” has its own entry and “Demon, Evistro” assumes that everything under “Demon” applies too. Category entries try to avoid listing mechanical concepts to decrease the amount of scrolling and page flipping.

Sometimes monsters have minor variations (such as shadow and greater shadow) or entries that use a racial template from the main entry and add non-racial traits (such as aboleth and aboleth mage). In this case, only the mechanical parts are duplicated to avoid page flipping but all the flavor information is omitted.

**Physical characteristics** include physical attributes, body plan, weight, length or height, effective height (as per p. 4 of *Pyramid #3-77*, it depends on SM and traits such as Horizontal), and, if appropriate, Appearance and Social Stigma. A short physical description of the creature is given here.

**Treasure type** is given for an average number of creatures encountered. See the [linked post](#) for details.

**Movement** lists the common modes of movement with their Move rates and exploration rates in miles per hour. The exploration rates are derived as per *GURPS Dungeon Fantasy 16: Wilderness Adventures* and are equal to Top Speed/2 in miles per hour. They assume normal travel conditions; the actual speed can be lower due to terrain, weather, etc. This section also may list certain movement-related traits and features. Finally, an encumbrance table is given.

**Defenses and vulnerabilities** lists DR values, active defenses, and special notes for new, altered hit locations, especially if the creature has a nonstandard body plan. Then, it lists immunities, resistances, weaknesses, and vulnerabilities of the monster.

**Hex footprint** is given only if the monster differs from the typical creature that takes up a single hex.

**Combat** may talk about the typical combat tactics, and then lists the most commonly used attacks with their effective skills. Grapples list control damage as per *Fantastic Dungeon Grappling* – if you’re not using it, just use the normal grappling rules. For the same system, Control Thresholds are listed in a table. They already include any bonuses from Lifting ST and high grappling skills. Sometimes,

combat-related traits, such as Extra Attack are listed and highlighted in bold here too.

Effective unarmed attack and effective slam weights are important for weapon breakage. They are calculated as per *Quadratic Natural Attacks (Pyramid #3-77, p. 9)*.

**Special abilities** lists both innate special abilities that deserve an explanation and do not fit anywhere else, and abilities that are not part of the racial template but are added beyond it, such as spells.

**Useful combat rules** gives you references for some combat rules that may be useful.

**Senses** lists all sensory information in one place.

**Mentality** lists mental traits and explains some of them in more detail in addition to providing some insight into the monster’s mental outlook.

**Skills** lists the typical skills and skill levels that the creature has. Note that more often than not, these skills are not part of the racial template. Psionic and spellcasting skills also are listed in this section.

**Other traits** lists “leftover” traits that are not expanded upon anywhere else in the monster entry.

**Ecology** may take a lot of space in some entries. For the most part, this describes the inner workings of the creature – where it lives, what it eats, how it reproduces, etc. This section *may* contain mechanical information, but if it is something important, it will be highlighted in bold letters.

**Society** talks about how these creatures interact with one another, what societies they form and how they work. For the most part, this section is present only for some sapient beings.

**Spoils** describes what kind of treasure the monster may possess, and what kind of crafting and enchanting value do the monster’s parts have.

**Capturing and training** talks about how a captured monster can be used, and whether or not it can be tamed and trained. It also lists the typical monetary value of such creature that is combat-trained or untrained and, if appropriate, the price of an egg. In addition, it lists supply costs – how much does it cost to feed the creature if you happen to tame and train one. The daily food weight is calculated as per *GURPS Bio-Tech*, pp. 63-64. Carnivores and other creatures with a restricted diet have their costs of supply increased arbitrarily (quadrupled for carnivores, for example – meat is more expensive!).

**Mass Combat Statistics** are based on Battle Rating from *ACKS II*, but they can be used in *GURPS Mass Combat* in place of Troop Strength. See the [linked post](#) for more details.

**Racial template** provides you a racial template that you can use in any way you want. After all, point costs matter when it comes to buying an Ally or Alternate Form.

# Aboleth

Type: Aberration (Aboleth)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |          |
|----|----|----|----|--------|----------|
| ST | 30 | HP | 37 | SM     | +3       |
| DX | 11 | BS | 6  | thr/sw | 3d/5d+2  |
| HT | 13 | FP | 18 | BL     | 180 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 3d/3d+2

**Body Plan:** Special (see below).

**Weight:** 6,500 lbs.

**Length:** 20 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary, brood (2–4), or slaver brood (1d3+1 plus 7–12 skum). 20% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** J (solitary), J x 2, F x 2 (brood).

The aboleth is a repulsive aquatic creature resembling a fish that can be found mainly in underground lakes and rivers. It harbors a strong dislike for nonaquatic beings and will try to eliminate them as soon as it sees them. Despite its fishlike appearance, the aboleth is a unique creature that combines elements of fish, squid, and boneless deep-sea predators.

On average, an aboleth is around 20 feet long and weighs 6,500 pounds, but some can grow much larger. The largest recorded aboleth encountered by reputable adventurers measured over 40 feet long, indicating that there are potentially even larger specimens lurking in the depths of unseen realms.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 1; exploration 0.5 miles per hour. Aboleths move using their four tentacles to drag themselves across surfaces when out of the water.

**Water:** Move 6/9; exploration 4.5 miles per hour. When swimming, an aboleth uses its tail to propel itself forward, with its tentacles and fins assisting in stabilizing its movement. The creature's serpentine

swimming style resembles that of a snake more than a fish. Aboleths are adept at swimming and do not face any skill penalties for being underwater.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 180 | 360   | 540    | 1,080 | 1,800       |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 3\* (tough skin). The aboleth's skin is actually a thick layer of multiple membranes that are tough and difficult to pierce. This membrane can stretch out and return to its original shape, providing the creature with excellent natural armor. The skin appears dark green to the naked eye, but upon closer inspection, a rainbow of faint colors can be seen shimmering under the surface. These colors are actually the latent energies the aboleth uses to unleash its impressive psionic powers.

**Eyes (-8):** The eyes are protected with DR 2 and get +2 to any HT rolls concerned with eye damage. Unlike most creatures, the aboleth has three eyes.

**Dodge:** 9.

**Parry:** 8 (unarmed).

**Body Plan:** The aboleth has a nonstandard body morphology. Its fishlike body has a torso, face, skull, tail, vitals, but no neck. Its four tentacles can be targeted at -2.

**Immunities:** pressure.

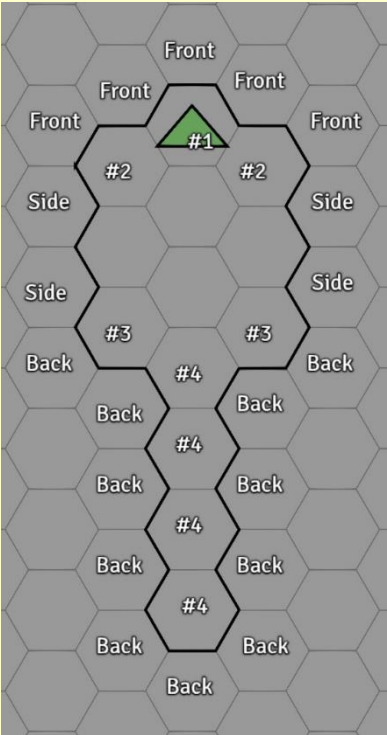
**Weaknesses:** immersion in saline water (1d HP per 30 minutes).

**Notes:** A character can target an aboleth's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Aboleths) roll that defaults to Physiology (Fish)-1.

## Combat

An aboleth attacks by flailing with its long, slimy tentacles, though it prefers to fight from a distance using its psionic powers. Keep in mind that the aboleth has **Extra Attack 1** and hence can attack with two body parts in a single turn.

**Sharp Teeth (11):** thrust 1d cutting. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the aboleth may elect



to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d control against SM+0 and smaller victims or 1d-2 control against larger ones.

**Tentacle (11):** thrust 3d-1 crushing. Reach C-3 from hexes #2-3. No off-hand penalty. Tentacles are extra-flexible – they are not limited to working only on one side of the body.

**Tail (11):** thrust 4d-1 crushing. Reach C-2 from hexes #4. Side hexes are attacked at -2. Cannot parry.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 3d control. Reach C-3 from hexes #2-3. If the aboleth is holding anything in even one of its tentacles, it becomes unable to move on land.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 9 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 90 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 15                   | 30        | 45                   | 60                 |

## Special Abilities

**Mucus Cloud:** When underwater, the aboleth exudes a mucus cloud. Any creature in the same hex as the aboleth that breathes in the mucus must make a successful HT roll or lose the ability to breathe air and gain that ability to breathe water for 30 minutes times the margin of failure.

**Psionics:** Aboleths possess an array of innate telepathic abilities and Telepathy Talent 2. Like all telepathic abilities, these can only affect sapient beings. An aboleth has innate access to the following abilities:

*Mental Blow 4 (15)* – p. PP65;

*Mental Surgery 2 (15)* – p. PP61;

*Mind Shield 5 (15)* – p. PP66;

*Suggestion 3 (15)* – p. PP63;

*Telecontrol 2 (15)* – p. PP64;

*Telereceive 4 (15)* – p. PP58;

*Telesend 5 (15)* – p. PP60.

Many aboleths acquire other psionic abilities or improve the innate ones further.

**Slime:** Before rolling to hit with a tentacle attack, the aboleth can spend 1 FP to coat it in slime. If this attack hits, then it deals 1d follow-up toxic damage with an onset of one minute, unless the victim resists with HT-3. Then every minute for ten more cycles, the damage repeats. Being moistened with cool, fresh water negates cyclic damage, and each cycle can be resisted with HT-3. The skin of the victim gradually becoming a clear, slimy membrane, and after losing 1/3 HP to this toxic damage, the victim's natural DR with Tough Skin becomes reduced by 2, to the minimum of 0, until he heals above this threshold.

**Slipperiness:** The aboleth has +3 on all ST, DX, and Escape rolls to slip restraints, break free in close combat, or squeeze through narrow openings. If using FDG, this gives Control DR 3 and +3 to DX when attacking to break free of an existing grapple.

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Evading (p. B368).

- Evading (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Incidental Collisions (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Slam and Overrun (p. B392).

- Defense vs. Slams (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 9).

Teeth (p. MA115).

Trampling (p. B404).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid* #3-26, pp. 7-8).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

An aboleth's senses are akin to a human's, except for its eyesight which grants it **Infravision** (p. B60) in darkness. Its three eyes are red ovals without iris or pupil, while it detects scents through ventral orifices and sound through skin vibrations. Aboleths lack tongues but have a keen sense of taste. The most sensitive parts are their tentacles and tail.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 15 | 15   |

Those who connect with an aboleth's mind describe a vast and terrifying intellect. Aboleths possess a deep racial memory passed down through generations. This memory predates all other races and while vast, retrieving specific information takes time. Scholars debate the origins of these memories, with some suggesting they are exaggerated or misunderstood. Regardless, the age and complexity of aboleths as a race are undeniable.

An aboleth may Concentrate and make an IQ (15) roll to replay its ancestors' memories at will.

**Mentality Traits:** Callous; Intolerance (Land dwellers); No Sense of Humor.

## Skills

Brainwashing/TL3-16; Expert Skill (Psionics)-16; Interrogation-16; Intimidation-16; Research/TL3-16; Thaumatology-16.

**Psionic Skills:** Mental Blow-15; Mental Surgery-15; Mind Shield-15; Suggestion-15; Telecontrol-15; Telereceive-15; Telesend-15.

## Other Traits

Double-Jointed; Horizontal.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Central Nervous System:** The most advanced organ in an aboleth's body is its central nervous system, particularly its brain. The brain, which makes up nearly one-fifth of the creature's body mass, is a large structure of various shades of purple, resembling an aboleth without its tail. It is divided into five main sections, each with specific functions.



**Frontal Lobe (1):** Located at the front of the brain, this pale purple cone-shaped lobe generates the aboleth's powerful telepathic attacks and serves as a core for telepathic communication with enslaved minions.

**Primary Lobe (2):** Positioned behind the frontal lobe and above the ventral lobe, this section controls the creature's primary brain functions such as thought, logic, and intelligence.

**Ventral Lobe (3):** A single lobe underneath the brain, consisting of four tentacle-shaped arms that store memories and extend as the aboleth ages.

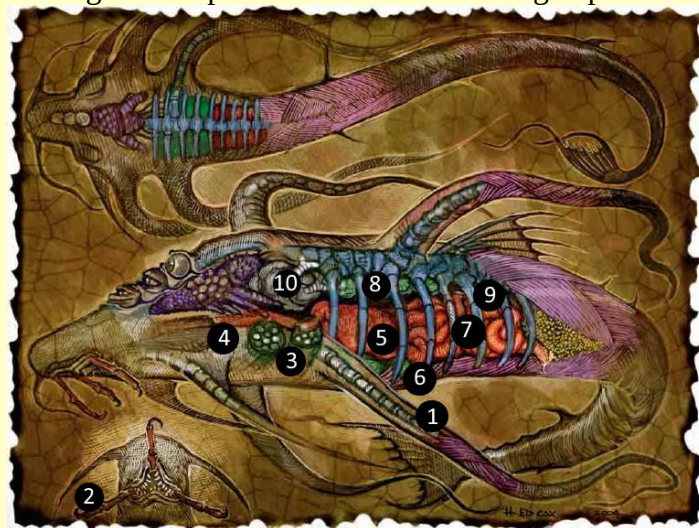
**Dorsal Lobe (4):** Located behind the primary lobe, this visually striking section is a mass of purple tendrils that contain psionic and magical energy for creating illusions.

**Rear Lobe (5):** The smallest section, responsible for the body's automatic functions like breathing and digestion.

**Circulatory System:** The aboleth's circulatory system is notable for having two hearts. The primary heart (9) pumps blood throughout the body, while the secondary heart (10) provides blood specifically to the brain. The blood in an aboleth's body is bright red, while the blood flowing to the brain is deep purple or almost black. If an Affliction causes a heart attack, the aboleth can survive as it has a backup heart.

**Diet:** While aboleths can survive by filtering microscopic organisms from the water around them, they consider this method a last resort. Aboleths are carnivorous creatures that enjoy consuming various types of flesh, including fish, squid, octopus, whale, and jellyfish. Their favorite foods, however, come from land-dwelling creatures, with humanoids - especially humans and gnomes - being considered delicacies. Aboleths prefer the flesh of beings transformed by their tentacle slime, finding it most delicious and easy to digest. Despite their large size, aboleths do not require much food to sustain themselves due to their efficient digestive system, which can sustain them for three months with just 27 pounds of meat.

Aboleths may mark their slaves by consuming nonessential parts of their bodies or selecting their least efficient slave as a meal when necessary. Interestingly, during the process of consuming a creature, an aboleth gains snippets of memories and emotions. These flashes occur randomly and are seen as a significant part of the aboleth's dining experience.



**Digestive System:** The aboleth's digestive system is relatively simple, comprising a mouth, esophagus (4), a sizable stomach (5), and intestines. The creature has numerous small teeth lining its esophagus down to the stomach, where food is further broken down into a slurry. A portion of the food is then diverted to a respiratory organ known as the milasthast (6) situated between the stomach and the ribcage for processing. The actual extraction of nutrients from food takes place in the intestines (7), where the aboleth can easily digest flesh, bone, and plant matter. Other materials are either not consumed or cause significant

discomfort as they pass through the intestinal tract.

**External Anatomy:** One of the most notable features of an aboleth is its four tentacles. These tentacles are primarily used for capturing, subduing, and transforming prey and slaves, and also aid in the creature's movement when it is out of the water. Each tentacle consists of strong muscles wrapped in a mucus membrane. Running down the length of each tentacle is a primary slime duct (1) along with numerous capillary ducts that carry a specialized slime created in the milathast organ to the surface of the tentacle. This toxic slime is used by the aboleth to change its captured victims into creatures better suited for life in its watery abode.

The creature's mouth is a unique structure that, when closed, appears as a small pale pucker. However, when feeding, it opens rapidly to form an equilateral triangle about 2 feet wide on each side. Extended from each corner of the mouth are long, thin stalks tipped with bony spikes (2). The interior of the mouth is lined with thousands of tiny serrated teeth. Although the aboleth has a large number of teeth, it rarely uses them in combat, as its biting capabilities are not very strong.

Running along the creature's sides are twin sets of large orifices (3), which can open as wide as 2 feet. These orifices serve as breathing, scenting, speaking (both in air and underwater), and mucus expulsion outlets for the aboleth. The mucus produced by the creature allows it to move more easily on land by creating a slippery surface and in water, creates a cloud of slime. Breathing the mucus is essential for the aboleth's survival, and losing the ability to create the slime could lead to suffocation, even when underwater.

**Habitat:** Underground freshwater lakes and rivers. The temperature comfort zone of an aboleth falls between -4° and 90°. It can survive under any pressure, even in the deepest underwater trenches.

**Lairs:** Aboleth cities are mainly found in deep underground lakes and waterways, though some live closer to the surface. Surface-dwelling aboleths fall into three categories:

1. **Slavers:** These aboleths inhabit small lakes or rivers near underground trade routes to capture slaves. Once they gather enough slaves, they return to their home city and then come back for more.

2. **Exiles:** Driven out due to religious or philosophical differences, these aboleths form small, like-minded communities near the surface.

3. **Nomads:** Disillusioned with their sunken cities or curious about the surface world, these aboleths establish cults, positioning themselves as leaders or deities. They lack interest in their race's legacy and prefer to explore or influence the surface world.

Aboleths' lairs, whether deep or near the surface, usually feature an underground waterway connected to a vast underground lake. Those without such connections use magical means like teleportation for travel. These lairs are typically in natural caverns or partially flooded ruins, wholly underwater with a small accessible ledge. The lair's pathways are maze-like, populated by enslaved minions who regularly visit the aboleth to renew their fealty. Lairs are mostly trap-free, relying instead on illusions for defense.

**Lifecycle:** Aboleth eggs typically hatch around five years after being deposited. Upon hatching, aboleths are born fully aware and mature, instantly absorbing the knowledge and memories of their parent. While they do not experience a traditional childhood phase, they are physically fragile and dependent for several years after emerging from the egg. During the initial stages of their growth, young aboleths stay close to their parent for approximately a decade, obediently following their instructions without question. Once they reach the age of ten, a mature aboleth acquires all its psionic abilities and is ready to venture out independently.

Aboleths continue to increase in size gradually as they age. This growth persists until they reach a length of around 40 feet. While they technically keep growing beyond this point, the pace becomes so slow that it can only be discerned over immense spans of time.

Aside from succumbing to illness or violence, aboleths are essentially immortal. Their mental and physical capacities remain unchanged from the age of ten throughout their existence, whether they live for a mere thousand years or far beyond.

**Reproductive System:** Aboleths possess both male and female reproductive organs. Reproduction for an aboleth is a private process that occurs in solitude. Every five years, an aboleth is driven by the urge to lay eggs and seeks out a secluded area to do so. After laying 1d/2 eggs, they quickly cover them in mucus and fertilize the surrounding water with fluid emitted from their tail. This fluid fertilizes the eggs within the mucus, forming a cohesive and solid mass. The aboleth typically attaches the egg mass to a stone surface, but if unavailable, allows it to float freely in the water.

**Respiratory System:** Contrary to common belief, aboleths do not breathe water. They lack lungs and gills, yet require a substance to sustain their blood and bodies. The vital element that aboleths take in for energy is only found in the clear, runny mucus they continuously produce.

This mucus is produced in the aboleth's milathast, which is the closest organ the creature has to a lung. The milathast draws in water through the numerous ventral orifices on the aboleth's body, mixes it with

material from the creature's stomach, and expels the resulting mixture outside the body. This mucus interacts with the surrounding water to create a thick cloud that the aboleth then breathes in.

Similar to the milathast, an organ known as the nilthast (8) is situated above the creature's stomach, nestled between its two hearts. The nilthast converts liquid mucus into a foul-smelling gas, which is used by the aboleth to control buoyancy and navigate vertical movements while swimming. The gases produced in this organ are also used to aid respiration when the creature is not in water.

**Skeletal System:** The internal skeletal structure of an aboleth is relatively straightforward. A significant portion of its skeleton is occupied by its massive skull, which extends from the front where its three jawbones meet, down to the midpoint of its back. The spinal cord extends from the skull, consisting of interlocking bones that provide flexibility for the aboleth to coil up like a snake if desired. From either side of the spinal cord, numerous long ribs descend, each independently articulated and connected to a large, flat bone protecting the creature's stomach and internal organs. The ribs disappear as the tail begins, which is supported by a continuation of the spinal cord. The fins of the aboleth lack bones and are instead supported by sturdy cartilaginous spines.

**Water Dependency:** The survival of an aboleth is reliant on the mucous membrane it generates around itself. This mucus production requires water and quickly dries up when the creature is on land. An aboleth loses 1 HP per minute when outside of water and must immerse itself in water for at least a minute to prevent this damage. If it loses 1xHP due to water deprivation, it enters a state of hibernation, maintaining awareness of its surroundings but losing tactical and olfactory senses. The mucous membrane hardens, providing the aboleth with DR 6 but completely paralyzing it. This prolonged state of unconsciousness is considered a fate worse than death, as the aboleth experiences continuous pain, is unable to breathe, eat, or drink, and will swiftly perish if the membrane is breached.

## Society

**Cities:** Aboleth cities are alien and terrifying, offensive to those accustomed to structured order. Built entirely underwater, their massive towers and spires are supported by water currents flowing through numerous tunnels and openings. These cities can float or drift at the rulers' will, often using powerful spells or magical devices.

Constructed of stone with the aid of magic and slave labor, aboleth buildings look melted or cancerous, or sport towering spires with twisted

crenellations and spikes. These structures resemble discarded prehistoric shellfish shells and are adorned with flourishes honoring the Elder Evils, adding to their eerie and disturbing feel.

Their architectural style originates from memories of the primal empire, with the largest, most isolated cities incorporating surviving ancient structures. Aboleths consider damage to these buildings a grave offense. Each aboleth occupies an oversized building, reserving the lower levels for slaves.

The city's leaders are always savant aboleths, with small cities having one leader and larger cities governed by a council of savant aboleths.

**Language:** Aboleths communicate using a highly intricate language through vents on their flanks, making the pronunciation challenging for creatures with just one mouth. Scholarly aboleths have more mouths than others, needing multiple orifices to articulate complex words.

Lesser beings with a single mouth struggle to speak Aboleth fluently and often sound dull-witted. Even with the help of tools (such as flutes, bagpipes, or large brass horns like tubas or trombones), such creatures can speak Aboleth only at Broken.

Aboleth written language consists of intricate glyphs carved using crystal devices dipped in acids. Aboleth names vary from complex to simple, sometimes shared with the city they founded. Common aboleth names are Dupapn, Mavad'Nidhuned, Nevek'Dithasig, Sochsna, Torop'Jethixur, and Urdol.

**Minions:** Aboleths, with their enslavement abilities, always have minions for guarding their lairs, entertainment, and other needs. The type of minions depends on the local ecosystem:

- Near svirfneblin cities: Svirfneblin and earth elementals.
- Ruined city pools: Bullywugs, tasloi, or yuan-ti.
- Lakes in human nations: Humans, halflings, dwarves, elves, and gnomes.

Minions are assigned roles such as assassins, entertainers, procurers, and guardians based on their abilities. Specific notable minions include:

- Adventurers: Equipped with powerful gear and effective tactics.
- Baatezu: Summoned demons providing strong defenses and stimulating conversation.
- Constructs: Loyal and uncharmable; often custom-made from aboleth mucus or ancient relics like elder eidolons.
- Derro: Voluntary servants, used as shock troops but not trusted with critical tasks.
- Oozes: Used for waste disposal and perimeter defense, except for the dangerous teratomorph, which can prompt aboleth evacuations.

- **Skum:** Amphibious humanoids created from humans, prized for their combat prowess and indicating an aboleth's societal status, similar to warhorse breeding in human culture.

**Relations with Other Creatures:** Despite seeing themselves as rulers of creation, aboleths are practical and acknowledge the crowded nature of modern times. They generally ally with other aquatic races, as their submerged lairs put terrestrial and airborne races at a disadvantage. These alliances help aboleths defend against surface threats, with the plan to later address their aquatic neighbors.

Dwellers of the flooded underground, aboleths have limited interactions. Other races are viewed primarily as slaves or food unless specifically mentioned.

**Drow:** Frequently clashing with aboleths, the drow sometimes form alliances due to shared worship of Ghaunadaur, creating formidable underwater cities.

**Illithids:** The most common allies, owing to their similar logical, emotionless nature and shared view of other races as fodder. Aboleths find mind flayers unsettling due to their mysterious origins from the future.

**Kuo-toas:** Ideal allies and subordinates due to their weaker, amphibious nature. Aboleths use their enslavement power to control kuo-toas, rewarding loyal leaders with autonomy while keeping the rest enslaved to prevent rebellion.

**Religion:** Aboleths are agnostic and acknowledge the existence of lesser races' deities, evident through divine healing. However, they do not see these deities as infallible, questioning why they coexist with the aboleths. Aboleths recognize the power of gods, but they revere the Elder Evils, beings predating the current deities and beyond eternity. Aboleths pay respect to Elder Evils through statues and architecture, viewing them as the closest thing to a religious devotion.

Aboleths focus admiration on five select Elder Evils, entities often in contact with the Material Plane and considered formidable opponents.

**Bolothamogg (*Him Who Watches from Beyond the Stars*):** Revered as the darkness between stars and a primal force, honored in aboleth architecture with open spaces and structures without roofs.

**Holashner (*The Hunger Below*):** An Elder Evil existing fully in the physical world, appearing as a mix of squid and centipede, consuming materials and leaving behind volatile substances. Honored in aboleth architecture with spindly protrusions and bilestone inlays.

**Piscaethces (*The Blood Queen*):** Depicted as a vast aboleth without tentacles, believed to travel between realities. Honored in aboleth architecture with large domed windows of red crystal.

**Shothotugg (*Eater of Worlds*):** Another Elder Evil in the Material Plane, a seething mass traveling between worlds, altering the multiverse. Honored in aboleth structures with pools of colored liquids or swirling patterns.

**Y'chak (*The Violet Flame*):** Acts as a muse for destruction and encourages worship of evil deities. Honored in aboleth cities with massive pillars of violet flame, used as markers of time and communication.

**Adopted Deities:** As the aboleth empire evolves, more of their kind are introduced to divine magic and the power of faith. Not all aboleths dismiss the benefits of worshiping a powerful entity, with some realizing the advantages of forging a divine alliance. Aboleths becoming clerics, druids, and other divine spellcasters are slowly increasing in number, drawn to deities like Ghaunadaur, the Patient One, and Tharizdun.

While there may be cities of devout, deity-worshiping aboleths, they are an exception rather than the norm. Traditional aboleths see those who worship gods of lesser races as traitors and enemies of the aboleth race.

## Spoils

An aboleth may accumulate a lot of treasure during its lifespan, but its lair is well protected. Additionally, if an aboleth is killed, its slime can be refined in various ways. As a rule of thumb, it is possible to gather HP/12 pounds of slime from an aboleth carcass with a successful Surgery roll.

Each 0.5 lb of slime can cover the entire ingredient cost of aboleth oil (poison) or aboleth mucus (alchemical grenade). Moreover, an alchemical process requiring a week per pound, \$100 in ingredients, and a successful Alchemy-3 roll can refine the slime into aboleth cloth, which provides DR 2 against psionic attacks. Aboleth cloth weighs 0.5 lb per square yard.

Aboleth meat is inedible to anyone but those with Universal Digestion. Anyone else must make a HT-4 roll to avoid taking 1d toxic damage and retching for a number of minutes equal to the margin of failure.

An aboleth's brain can be refined into a distilled essence that can substitute for 10 EP when enchanting psionic items that grant ER (Psionic) or telepathic abilities.

The dried mucous membrane of a dead aboleth may be harvested and used to produce armor. Typically, an aboleth provides 3% of its weight in dried mucous membrane this way. When designing such armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid #3-52*, use the following statistics: WM 0.6; Cost \$60, DR/inch 60, Max DR 9, Construction: scale, solid.

## Capturing and Training

Aboleths tend to avoid direct military confrontations, preferring to rely on slaves to do the dirty work. Nonetheless, the stats are given. There is no such things as an “untrained” aboleth due to their racial memories.

**Egg Value:** \$10,800.

**Untrained Value:** \$54,000.

**Trained Value:** \$540,200.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.007 and 0.03 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.563

**Wage (Monthly):** \$16,200.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 5 Aboleths

*Battle Rating:* 3

*Classes:* C3I, Nav.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 36/144 (water) or 4/16 (land).

*Supply (Weekly):* \$20.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$80,710.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$81,030.

## Racial Template

760 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+20 (Size Modifier, -30%) [140]; DX+1 [20]; IQ+5 [100]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+3; HP+7 (Size Modifier, -30%) [10]; FP+5 [15]; Per-5 [-25].

**Advantages:** Ambidexterity [5]; Amphibious (Accessibility, Only skill penalties, -50%) [5]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; DR 3 (Tough Skin, -40%) [9]; Double-Jointed [15]; Enhanced Move 0.5 (Water) [10]; Extra Attack 1 [25]; Extra Legs (Four Legs; Cannot Kick, -50%; Extra-Flexible, +50%; Long 1, +100%) [10]; Extra-Flexible Long (+1 SM) Arms [30]; Extra-Flexible Long (+1 SM) Foot Manipulators 2 [24]; Infravision [10]; Injury Tolerance (No Neck) [5]; Nictitating Membrane 2 [2]; Pressure Support 3 [15]; Racial Memory (Active; Immersive, +50%) [60]; Reduced Consumption 4 (Food Only, -50%) [4]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Slippery 3 [6]; Speak Underwater [5]; Striker (Tail; Crushing; Cannot Parry, -40%; Limited Arc, Rear, -40%; Reversed Arc, +0%) [1]; Telepathy Talent 2 [10]; Temperature Tolerance 3 (Cold) [3]; Unaging [15].

**Mucus Cloud:** Affliction 1 (HT; Accessibility, Underwater only, -30%; Aura, +80%; Advantage, Alternate Form (same template, but with Doesn't Breathe (Gills; underwater only)); +150%; Area Effect, 1 yard, +25%; Biological, Passive, -5%; Extended Duration, 30x, +60%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; Respiratory Agent, +50%) [40].

**Slime:** Toxic Attack 1d (Biological, -10%; Follow-Up, Tentacles, +0%; Cyclic, 1 minute, 10 cycles, being moistened with cool, fresh water negates damage, Resistible, +200%; Onset, 1 minute, -10%; Resistible, HT-3, -15%; Symptoms, 1/3 HP, Negated Advantage, DR 2 with Tough Skin, +18%) [12].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Callous [-5]; Dependency (Water; Constantly; Enters hibernation after losing 1xHP, -50%) [-12]; Horizontal [-10]; Intolerance (Land dwellers) [-10]; No Sense of Humor [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Weak Bite [-2]; Weakness (Immersion in saline water, 1d per 30 minutes) [-5].

**Perks:** Two Hearts [1].

**Quirks:** Likes eating victims transformed by slime [-1].

**Features:** No Legs (Semi-Aquatic); Plankton Strainer; Three Eyes.

**Racial Psionic Abilities:** Mental Blow 4 (Accessibility, Only on sapient beings, -10%) [27]; Mental Surgery 2 (Accessibility, Only on sapient beings, -10%) [20]; Mind Shield 5 [20]; Suggestion 3 (Accessibility, Only on sapient beings, -10%) [25]; Telecontrol 2 (Replace Specialized, Humans, -40% with Accessibility, Only sapient beings, -10%) [75]; Telereceive 4 (Accessibility, Only on sapient beings, -10%) [40]; Telesend 5 (Accessibility, Only on sapient beings, -10%) [24].

**Racial Psionic Skills:** Mental Blow (H) Will [1]; Mental Surgery (H) IQ [1]; Mind Shield (H) Will [1]; Suggestion (H) IQ [1]; Telecontrol (H) IQ [1]; Telereceive (H) IQ [1]; Telesend (H) IQ [1].

## Aboleth Mage

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |          |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 30 | <b>HP</b> | 37 | <b>SM</b>     | +3       |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 3d/5d+2  |
| <b>HT</b> | 13 | <b>FP</b> | 18 | <b>BL</b>     | 180 lbs. |

*Reduced Swing:* 3d/3d+2

**Body Plan:** Special (see below).

**Weight:** 6,500 lbs.

**Length:** 20 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft. (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 4).

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 20% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** J.

Amidst the submerged tombs and dungeons they call home, the aboleth lords concentrate their efforts on mastering wizardry to achieve dominion. Their

immense power establishes them as rulers among all subterranean beings. Despite this, these solitary creatures, dedicated to their arcane pursuits, spend the majority of their lengthy lives in isolation.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 1; exploration 0.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** Move 6/9; exploration 4.5 miles per hour.

Aboleths are adept at swimming and do not face any skill penalties for being underwater.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 180 | 360   | 540    | 1,080 | 1,800       |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 3\* (tough skin).

**Eyes (-8):** The eyes are protected with DR 2 and get +2 to any HT rolls concerned with eye damage. Unlike most creatures, the aboleth has three eyes.

**Dodge:** 9.

**Parry:** 8 (unarmed).

**Body Plan:** The aboleth has a nonstandard body morphology. Its fishlike body has a torso, face, skull, tail, vitals, but no neck. Its four tentacles can be targeted at -2.

**Immunities:** pressure.

**Weaknesses:** immersion in saline water (1d HP per 30 minutes).

**Notes:** A character can target an aboleth's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Aboleths) roll that defaults to Physiology (Fish)-1.

## Combat

An aboleth attacks by flailing with its long, slimy tentacles, though it prefers to fight from a distance using its psionic powers. Keep in mind that the aboleth has **Extra Attack 1** and hence can attack with two body parts in a single turn.

**Sharp Teeth (11):** thrust 1d cutting. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the aboleth may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d control against SM+0 and smaller victims or 1d-2 control against larger ones.

**Tentacle (11):** thrust 3d-1 crushing. Reach C-3 from hexes #2-3. No off-hand penalty. Tentacles are extra-flexible – they are not limited to working only on one side of the body.

**Tail (11):** thrust 4d-1 crushing. Reach C-2 from hexes #4. Side hexes are attacked at -2. Cannot parry.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 3d control. Reach C-3 from hexes #2-3. If the aboleth is holding anything in even one of its tentacles, it becomes unable to move on land.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 9 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 90 lbs.

### Control Thresholds

| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| 3                           | 15                          | 30               | 45                          | 60                        |

## Special Abilities

**Mucus Cloud:** When underwater, the aboleth exudes a mucus cloud. Any creature in the same hex as the aboleth that breathes in the mucus must make a successful HT roll or lose the ability to breathe air and gain that ability to breathe water for 30 minutes times the margin of failure.

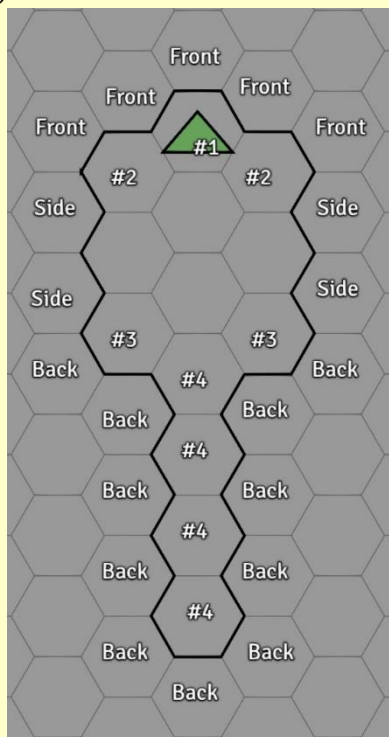
**Psionics:** Aboleths possess an array of innate telepathic abilities and Telepathy Talent 2. Like all telepathic abilities, these can only affect sapient beings. An aboleth has innate access to the following abilities:

*Mental Blow 4 (15) – p. PP65;*  
*Mental Surgery 2 (15) – p. PP61;*  
*Mind Shield 5 (15) – p. PP66;*  
*Suggestion 3 (15) – p. PP63;*  
*Telecontrol 2 (15) – p. PP64;*  
*Telereceive 4 (15) – p. PP58;*  
*Telesend 5 (15) – p. PP60.*

Many aboleths acquire other psionic abilities or improve the innate ones further.

**Slime:** Before rolling to hit with a tentacle attack, the aboleth can spend 1 FP to coat it in slime. If this attack hits, then it deals 1d follow-up toxic damage with an onset of one minute, unless the victim resists with HT-3. Then every minute for ten more cycles, the damage repeats. Being moistened with cool, fresh water negates cyclic damage, and each cycle can be resisted with HT-3. The skin of the victim gradually becoming a clear, slimy membrane, and after losing 1/3 HP to this toxic damage, the victim's natural DR with Tough Skin becomes reduced by 2, to the minimum of 0, until he heals above this threshold.

**Slipperiness:** The aboleth has +3 on all ST, DX, and Escape rolls to slip restraints, break free in close combat, or squeeze through narrow openings. If using FDG, this gives Control DR 3 and +3 to DX when attacking to break free of an existing grapple.



**Spells:** The aboleth mage is a powerful wizard with [Wizardly Study 12](#). This allows it to improvise spells from its spellbook that cost up to 12 points or use hardcore improvisation to cast spells that cost up to 74 points.

Typical known spells, taken as alternative abilities:

[Alarm 4](#) (16);  
[Daze](#) (16);  
[Detect Magic](#) (16);  
[Dispel Magic](#) (16);  
[Lightning Bolt 2](#) (16);  
[Mage Armor 2](#) (Touch) (16);  
[Permanent Image 2](#) (16).

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Evading (p. B368).

- Evading (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Incidental Collisions (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Slam and Overrun (p. B392).

- Defense vs. Slams (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 9).

Teeth (p. MA115).

Trampling (p. B404).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid* #3-26, pp. 7-8).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

An aboleth's senses are akin to a human's, except for its eyesight which grants it **Infravision** (p. B60) in darkness.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 15 | 15   |

Those who connect with an aboleth's mind describe a vast and terrifying intellect. Aboleths possess a deep racial memory passed down through generations. This memory predates all other races and while vast, retrieving specific information takes time. Scholars debate the origins of these memories, with some suggesting they are exaggerated or misunderstood. Regardless, the age and complexity of aboleths as a race are undeniable.

An aboleth may Concentrate and make an IQ (15) roll to replay its ancestors' memories at will.

**Mentality Traits:** Callous; Intolerance (Land dwellers); No Sense of Humor.

## Skills

Brainwashing/TL3-16; Expert Skill (Psionics)-16; Innate Attack (Beam)-16; Interrogation-16; Intimidation-16; Research/TL3-16; Thaumatology-16.

**Psionic Skills:** Mental Blow-15; Mental Surgery-15; Mind Shield-15; Suggestion-15; Telecontrol-15; Telereceive-15; Telesend-15.

**Spells:** College of Illusion and Creation-16; College of Lightning-16; College of Meta-Spells-16; College of Mind Control-16; College of Protection and Warning-16.

## Other Traits

Double-Jointed; Horizontal.

## Capturing and Training

An aboleth mage is a valuable asset for any army. Despite that, it is unlikely to be seen on the battlefield.

**Trained Value:** \$960,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.007 and 0.03 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 1.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$28,800.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 5 Aboleth Mages

**Battle Rating:** 5

**Classes:** C3I, Nav, (Recon).

**Features:** Night.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 36/144 (water) or 4/16 (land).

**Supply (Weekly):** \$20.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$143,700.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$144,020.

## Achaierai

Type: Outsider (Evil, Lawful)



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |         |
|----|----|----|----|--------|---------|
| ST | 21 | HP | 18 | SM     | +2      |
| DX | 11 | BS | 6  | thr/sw | 2d/4d-1 |
| HT | 12 | FP | 12 | BL     | 88 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 2d/2d+1

**Body Plan:** Quadruped (no neck) (p. B553).

**Weight:** 750 lbs.

**Height:** 15 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-8. 5% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E x 2, C.

Achaierais are flightless, quadruped birds resembling plump quails. They have stilt-like legs, 8–9 ft. long, ending in sharp talons. Their pony-sized bodies feature withered wings and spherical heads. Their bright red crests can vary in color, and their feather hues range from dim teal to shadowed gold to burnt russet. Their metallic blue-gray legs, claws, and beak shine like polished metal.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 9; exploration 4.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 88 | 176   | 264    | 528   | 880         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** Torso, face, groin, and skull of the achaierai are protected by thick plumage that provides DR 2\*. Feathers also help shed water, eliminating up to -2 in penalties for being wet – notably for *Cold* (p. B430). Legs and feet have a metallic covering that provides DR 6.

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against attacks from the sides or rear).

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Neck).

**Resistances:** Magic Resistance 2 (Improved); +3 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Immunities:** achaierai black cloud, sunburn.

**Vulnerabilities:** Anarchic weapons (x2); holy weapons (x2); magnetism.

**Notes:** A character can target an achaierai's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Achaierai) roll.

### Combat

Achaierai attack with two legs and their powerful beak in close combat.

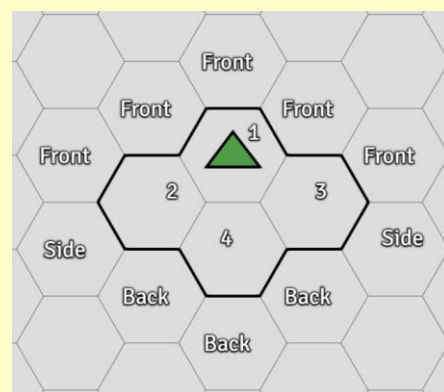
**Beak (14):** thrust 2d+1 large piercing. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the achaierai may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d control against SM-1 and smaller victims or 1d+2 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 2d+1 cutting. Reach C-1 from all hexes.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 2d control. Reach C-1 from all hexes.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 4.4 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 44 lbs.



| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 11                   | 21        | 32                   | 42                 |

### Special Abilities

**Black Cloud:** By spending 2 FP and performing a Ready maneuver, an achaierai can release a choking, toxic black cloud. It spreads in a 2-yard radius area around the achaierai (centered on hex #1), lasts 10 seconds, and drifts with the wind. The cloud imposes a -3 penalty on all vision- and Infravision-based rolls within the area. Additionally, every creature that inhales the cloud must make an HT roll. If it fails, it takes 1d toxic damage, ignoring DR, and begins to hallucinate for margin of failure minutes. After that,

the subject is stunned (p. B420) and may roll vs. HT once per second to recover. Achaierais are immune to this ability.

**Metallic Legs:** Achaierais' four metallic legs and feet have DR 6 and regenerate 1 HP per 12 hours but are susceptible to magnetism. The achaierai may use one of its feet to manipulate objects (or grapple prey), but due to its horizontal posture it must remain stationary to do so. In addition, the foot manipulators have **Ham-Fisted 1** (p. B138).

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Evading (p. B368).

- Evading (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Incidental Collisions (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Slam and Overrun (p. B392).

- Defense vs. Slams (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 9).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** The achaierai possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

Aside from normal vision, the achaierai can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

These cunning predators have a complex sense of justice and tribal organization. They seek vengeance for wrongs against their kin and devise inventive tortures, but will abandon or attack their brethren when necessary.

**Mentality Traits:** Sadism (12).

## Skills

Brawling-14; Running-14; Stealth-14; Survival (Acheron)-12.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** They feast on flesh—fresh, fetid, scavenged, hunted, or cannibalized. They require a large meat intake and iron to maintain their metallic legs.

**Habitat:** Achaierai thrive in Acheron, preferring temperatures between 35° and 90°. They are mostly found in Avalas or Thuldanin and occasionally in Material Plane caverns, nesting in multi-chambered underground lairs.

**Lifecycle:** Achaierais mate for life, producing two eggs annually, but cannot reproduce on the Material Plane. Young reach maturity at three years and can learn multiple languages. Their lifespan is about 200 years.

## Society

Social creatures, achaierai form flocks, lacking true society and often cannibalizing weak members. Leaders are simply more powerful individuals. Flocks migrate with rust dragons, who share a dog-human-like bond with them, transporting them to new locations.

In the Material Plane, achaierai and races like the drow or svirfneblin mutually exterminate each other. Achaierai devour underground village populations and livestock, invoking fear and disgust in natives.

## Spoils

The only valuable part of an achaierai is its colorful plumage.

**Feathers:** 14 feathers, \$980, 4.2 lbs.

## Capturing and Training

A captured achaierai may be trained for combat.

**Egg Value:** \$2,600.

**Untrained Value:** \$12,880.

**Trained Value:** \$128,800.

**Supply Cost:** \$1.6 and 12 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Achaierai).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.134

**Wage (Monthly):** \$3,900.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 20 Achaierai

**Battle Rating:** 2.5

**Classes:** None.

**Features:** Night.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 36/144.

**Supply (Weekly):** \$480.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$75,440.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$77,400.

## Racial Template

213 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+11 (Size Modifier, -20%) [88]; DX+1 [20]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+2; HP-3 [-6]; Basic Speed +0.25 [5]; Basic Move +3 [15].

**Advantages:** DR 2 (Flexible, -20%; Partial, Does not protect legs and feet, -10%) [7]; DR 6 (Partial, Legs and feet, -15%) [26]; Extended Lifespan 1 [2]; Extra Arms 2 (Foot Manipulators, -30%) [14]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Infravision [10]; Injury Tolerance (No Neck) [5]; Magic Resistance 2 (Improved, +150%) [10]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [3]; Regeneration (Slow; Accessibility, Only legs and feet, -15%) [9]; Sharp Beak [1]; Sharp Claws [5].

*Black Cloud* [48]: Toxic Attack 1d (Area Effect, 2 yards, +50%; Drifting, +20%; Emanation, -20%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Persistent, +40%; Respiratory Agent, +50%; Resistible, HT, -30%) [9] + Obscure 3 (Vision; Drifting, +20%; Extended, Infravision, +20%; Persistent, +40%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%) [11] + Affliction 1 (HT; Area Effect, 2 yards, +50%; Costs Fatigue, 2 FP, -10%; Drifting, +20%; Emanation, -20%; Hallucinating, +50%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Persistent, +40%; Respiratory Agent, +50%) [28].

**Disadvantages:** Ham-Fisted 1 [-5]; Horizontal [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Anarchic Weapons, x2) [-10]; Vulnerability (Holy Weapons, x2) [-10].

**Perks:** Feathers [1]; Immunity to Achaierai Black Cloud [1].

**Quirks:** Affected by Magnetism [-1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 3.

## Ankheg

Type: Animal (Arthropod)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |         |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|---------|
| <b>ST</b> | 18 | <b>HP</b> | 20   | <b>SM</b>     | +2      |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.75 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+2/3d |
| <b>HT</b> | 13 | <b>FP</b> | 13   | <b>BL</b>     | 65 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d+2/2d

**Body Plan:** Hexapod (p. B553).

**Weight:** 800 lbs.

**Length:** 10 ft.

**Effective Height:** 15 ft.

**Organization:** Solitary or cluster (2-4). 15% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** C.

The ankheg features a huge, segmented form with elongated limbs, each terminating in a pointed talon, visually akin to an oversized praying mantis. With two pairs of legs and an additional pair of forelimbs utilized for burrowing and combat, the ankheg uses its frontal limbs to grasp smaller prey while employing its mandibles for the attack.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 8; exploration 4 miles per hour.

**Tunneling:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 65 | 130   | 195    | 390   | 650         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** Sporting a robust exoskeletal layer that shields its back, this gargantuan bug presents a contrast with its more vulnerable underside. The limbs are distinctly more delicate compared to the torso. The exoskeleton's hue varies across a spectrum from yellows to browns to grays, while the soft underbelly displays tones ranging from reds to pinks.

**Antennae (-7):** DR 0. Located in hex #1. 1 HP of injury cripples an antenna; any excess injury is lost.

**Face, skull, neck:** DR 4.

**Torso:** DR 4 (soft underside is protected with DR 1; it can be targeted at -1 from the front, sides, and back, or at +0 from below).

**Legs, feet:** DR 2.

Halve DR values during the molting period, rounding down. See *Molting* for details.

**Dodge:** 9.

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed, foreleg).

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against damage caused by high or low body temperature; +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Notes:** A character can target an ankheg's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Insects) roll.

### Combat

An ankheg usually lies 1 to 3 yards below the surface until its antennae detect the approach of prey. It then burrows up to attack with a bite as an All-Out Attack (Determined) or Move and Attack. Clusters of ankhegs share the same territory but do not cooperate. If several attack, each tries to grab a different foe. If there aren't enough targets, two might grab the same creature in a tug-of-war.



**Acidic Bite (12):** thrust 1d+2 cutting + follow-up 1d-1 corrosion. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the ankheg may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+2 control against SM-1 and smaller victims or 1d control against larger ones.

The follow-up corrosion damage is not applied if the ankheg's Spit Acid ability is recharging.

If the ankheg is injured after grabbing its prey, it retreats backward down its tunnel, dragging the victim with it. Roll a Quick Contest of ST against the prey's ST+4 (each side penalized as per DX if they have CP inflicted on them). If the ankheg wins, it may move up to 8 yards if the prey's ST is 9 or lower, up to 4 yards if its ST is 18 or lower, or a step if it is 27 or lower. This counts as a Move and Attack, but the ankheg may elect to perform this as an All-Out Attack (Determined) to roll at +4.

**Claw (12):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C-1 from hex #1. No off-hand penalty.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d+2 control. Reach C-1 from hex #1.

**Spit Acid (14):** 2d corrosion. Ranged attack (Acc 3, Range 20 from hex #1). Double the actual distance

to the target when calculating the range modifier due to the ankheg being nearsighted. Costs 1 FP, takes 1 hour to recharge between two consecutive uses. Can be blocked and dodged, but not parried. While this ability is recharging, the ankheg does not deal follow-up corrosion damage with its bite attack. An ankheg does not use this ability unless it is desperate or frustrated. It most often spits acid when reduced to fewer than half its HP or when it has not successfully grabbed an opponent.

**Trample (12):** thrust 2d-1 crushing. Can only be dodged. The ankheg can trample SM+1 creatures lying prone or smaller creatures in any posture. Against SM-1 or smaller creatures, this counts as large-area injury (p. B400). If the ankheg knocks down a foe in a collision or slam and keeps on moving, it tramples automatically for half damage (rounded down).

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 3.25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 32.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 9                    | 18        | 27                   | 36                 |

### Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Evading (p. B368).

- Evading (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Incidental Collisions (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Surprise Attacks and Initiative (p. B393).

Slam and Overrun (p. B392).

- Defense vs. Slams (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 9).

Teeth (p. MA115).

Trampling (p. B404).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 11          | 11    |

**Hearing:** While the ankheg can detect vibrations via Tremorsense and Vibration Sense, it is otherwise deaf.

**Tremorsense (11):** The ankheg can feel faint movements in the surface it is standing on with a Sense roll, including earth tremors, distant explosions, and footsteps. Modify the roll for loudness and distance as for sound (p. B358). If lying full length (burrowing without building a tunnel counts automatically), roll at +2!

This sense relies on the ankheg's antennae. The antennae have no DR and are located in the creature's head hex (hex #1). A male ankheg's antennae are

straight, but a female ankheg's antennae are forked. They can be targeted at -7, and have 1 HP each; any excess injury is lost. Losing one antenna imposes a -4 penalty on Sense rolls to use this ability, and losing both disables this sense.

**Vibration Sense (11):** Vibration Sense lets the ankheg make a Sense roll subject to *separate* bonuses for the target's size, speed (invert the penalty), and a penalty for range to the target based on the *Size and Speed/Range Table* (p. B550) to detect something by sensing vibrations that propagate through the air. Success allows ignoring visibility penalties in combat that second. Wind will generate "noise" that imposes penalties, and the same penalties are applied to attacks that rely on this ability.

Just like Tremorsense, this sense relies on the ankheg's antennae.

**Vision:** The ankheg has superior eyesight due to its compound eye structure – though such vision is quite nearsighted. Thus, the ankheg has **-6 to Vision rolls to spot items more than one yard away**. It makes **melee attacks at -2** and **doubles the actual distance to the target** when calculating the range modifier for ranged attacks (this is taken into account in the combat statistics).

The hundreds of small, black lenses in the ankheg's eye allow the creature to see with great clarity in gloom or at night with Ultravision (p. B94). Above ground, the ankheg gets a **+2 to Vision rolls** and **ignores -2 in darkness penalties**.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 2  | 9    |

**Mentality Traits:** Wild Animal (with Mute).

### Skills

Brawling-14; Innate Attack (Breath)-14.

### Other Traits

Ambidexterity; Extra Legs (Four Legs); No Fine Manipulators.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** The ankheg navigates subterranean realms, favoring dirt that is affluent in minerals and organic content. Primarily, its nourishment comes from ingesting minerals and plant matter, yet the creature occasionally indulges in flesh (predominantly livestock, with humans and similar beings when convenient). Although its mandibles are unsuited for rending flesh, the ankheg liquefies its catch using a potent digestive secretion that doubles as a weapon in combat. Despite the potential threat it poses, the

ankheg inadvertently benefits agricultural territories. Its burrowing activity introduces air and water channels into the earth and enriches the soil with nutrient-dense waste, enhancing crop yields by as much as 15%, assuming control over the ankheg population.

Given that ankhegs partially absorb nourishment from the earth while tunneling, spending upwards of half a day within mineral and organic-rich soil reduces its requirements for food and water by two-thirds for that duration.

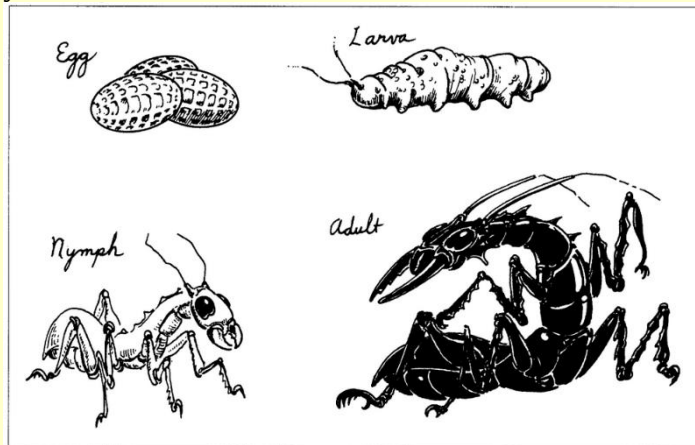
**Habitat:** Warm and temperate plains and forests. The temperature comfort zone of an ankheg falls between 35° and 90°, but see *Temperature Regulation* below.

**Hibernation:** In regions battered by harsh winters, the ankheg retreats into hibernation to weather the frigid season. About a month following the initial snowfall, it takes refuge in its burrow for the winter. Throughout this dormant period, it survives on the reserves of proteins and nutrients accumulated during the fall—a time when it ramps up its hunting activities in anticipation of the lean months ahead. Thus ensconced, the ankheg can remain hidden beneath the surface all winter, reemerging with the advent of spring. In milder climates, where winter poses little threat, ankhegs stay active year-round. Should an ankheg attempt to stave off hibernation for any reason, it must succeed on a Will (9) roll to resist succumbing to slumber.

To the untrained eye, a hibernating ankheg might be mistaken for deceased. Only those with knowledge of its unique metabolic dormancy can accurately assess its condition through a Quick Contest of Diagnosis against the ankheg's HT (13).

Should it sustain injury, the ankheg awakens immediately.

**Lifecycle:** Typically, ankhegs have a lifespan ranging from 10 to 12 years. These colossal insects undergo rapid growth, leading to their relatively short existence. They achieve full maturity within two years.



An ankheg's size is indicative of its age and health, steadily growing from 3' immediately after

birth to 6' in the following six months. With each subsequent year, it elongates by another 3' until it reaches its maximum length of 20', beyond which it ceases to grow.

Fall not only signals preparation for hibernation but also marks the ankheg's breeding season. Male ankhegs, lured by a pheromonal scent released by females, enter a trance-like state during which the eggs are fertilized but at the cost of the male's life. The female then entombs her mate in a specially prepared chamber, using her ovipositor to lay her eggs within his body.

The female deposits up to 2d eggs per mating, with a 75% chance of fertility. Each egg, grey and roughly 2' in diameter, hatches within a month, typically before the mother enters hibernation. Damaged eggs release a toxic green vapor, posing a risk to those nearby. Over the winter, the hatchlings, or "nymphs," nourish themselves on their father's remains, growing as previously described.

**Molting:** Annually, as the ankheg matures, it must shed its exoskeleton for a new, larger one—a process that leaves it at its most vulnerable, particularly in the fall. This shedding occurs over a couple of days, with the new shell taking 1-2 weeks to fully harden. In the initial week, the ankheg's defensive resilience is significantly reduced, and its mobility is halved as it adjusts to its new armor. After this period, the shell regains its customary durability, and the ankheg recovers its typical agility. Similarly, the ankheg experiences a reduction of -4 to ST and -2 to DX. It is also incapacitated from utilizing its acidic spit during this time. Engaged in the renewal of its exoskeleton, the creature refrains from burrowing activities to prevent compromising the nascent armor. This abstention includes forgoing its tunneling capabilities. To safeguard itself against potential threats, including predatory attacks or displacement by fellow ankhegs in its vulnerable state, it emits a deterring scent. This odor, a byproduct of the shell-hardening enzyme, is reminiscent of decaying fruit to human senses and effectively repels most would-be predators during this phase, resulting in a -2 to their reaction.

**Relationships:** Ankhegs find themselves in territorial contention with giant ants. Should these ants be eliminated or expelled from their nest, any surviving offspring are coerced into serving the giant ant colony.

**Temperature Regulation:** The ankheg is a cold-blooded creature. While it has +2 HT to resist damage from high or low body temperature, it tends to stiffen up in cold weather. After 30 minutes in cold conditions, the ankheg gets -1 to Basic Speed and DX per 10° below 50°F. The ankheg regains lost Basic Speed and DX at the rate of one point of each per

hour once it returns to a warm climate. Double this rate in an exceptionally warm environment. At temperatures below 32°, the ankheg must roll vs. HT (13) or take 1 HP of damage.

**Tunnels:** The ankheg employs its mandibles for excavation, utilizing its digestive enzymes to disintegrate large minerals and relying on its forelegs to manipulate the soil. As it tunnels, the ankheg ingests the minerals, effectively processing them. Predominantly, the ankheg engages in ceaseless burrowing, seldom pausing except for periods of hibernation, nesting, or in anticipation of prey. During its active phases, the ankheg methodically explores an area through a network of tunnels at varying depths and trajectories, often temporarily inhabiting nutrient-rich zones like agricultural fields or forest floors until depleted. Rarely does an ankheg delve deeper than 40 feet, as it encounters compacted soil and a challenging water table that impede and displease it.

Owing to its wandering tendencies, the ankheg's dwelling is typically a complex network of tunnels, with portions that may have caved in and others still functional. Unlike certain creatures that settle in specific environments, the ankheg's choice of lair is versatile, fixed only during nesting or hibernation. At such times, it adapts a dead-end tunnel into a suitable lair by expanding the passageway. Nesting chambers are notably spacious, stretching 10-12 feet in height, 20-25 feet in width, and 60-80 feet in length, providing ample space for the family unit. In contrast, a hibernation burrow is significantly more compact, essentially conforming to the ankheg's dimensions to leverage the soil's insulating properties against the cold.

Ankheg tunnels, inherently maze-like due to their erratic layout, typically feature straight pathways that vary in depth, intersect, or terminate suddenly. Entrances to these tunnels are generally scarce, with additional openings occurring when an ankheg emerges suddenly to ambush its prey. The dimensions of these passageways mirror the size of the ankheg, averaging 3-6 feet in width and 4-10 feet in height. Given the terrain, these structures are prone to collapse, posing a hazard to those exploring them. Adventurers delving into these passages are advised to proceed with caution to avoid untimely entombment.

## Spoils

Any treasure found within an ankheg's lair is accidental, left behind by its victims and overlooked by the ankheg, which lacks any inclination or need for such possessions. Consequently, the concept of an ankheg amassing a "hoard" is non-existent. Valuables and magical items accompanying the victims' remains are usually preserved, barring their susceptibility to

the ankheg's digestive enzymes. Should the GM consider it necessary, they may determine the fate of these items based on a roll against HT-4. Items that withstand the ankheg's acidic secretions remain; others are consumed. Any items spared by the ankheg are discarded within its tunnels, often found at the scene of consumption.

Because of its unique composition, the ankheg's body provides a number of "natural treasures." For example, the hard, chitinous shell of the creature makes extremely good armor.

Butchering an ankheg provides 15% of its body weight in chitin +1% per point of success on the Professional Skill (Butcher) roll, up to the maximum of 22%. For a typical 800 lbs. ankheg, this is 120 lbs. + 8 lbs. per point of success. When designing ankheg chitin armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid #3-52*, use the following statistics: WM 0.74; Cost \$25, DR/inch 8, Max DR 5, Construction: scale, solid.

Ankheg meat is edible, but sour, bitter, and mildly toxic. Those without at least one level of Reduced Consumption (Cast-Iron Stomach) must roll against HT+2 after eating ankheg meat to become nauseated for margin of failure hours (p. B428) and take 1 point of toxic damage. A molting ankheg's meat reeks of rotten fruit. *Anyone* eating a molting ankheg's meat must roll against HT or become nauseated for margin of failure hours and take 2 points of toxic damage.

The ankheg's eyes (and the fluid therein) are useful to alchemists and arcanists in the creation of sight-related magic elixirs and items. Each eye counts as \$100 of material components for such elixirs, and each four eyes count as 1 EP for enchanted items. Extracting an eye intact requires a Surgery roll and 1 minute. Likewise, the ankheg's digestive acid can be salvaged and utilized as a regular acid. This chemical maintains its properties for up to six months after the ankheg's death. A successful Surgery roll that takes 10 minutes extracts one dose of acid plus one per full two points of margin of success, up to the maximum of four doses. There is a secondary enzyme sac located in the creature's head, very similar to a small, acid-resistant bladder that yields only one dose of acid. Recovering this fluid from the ankheg requires very adept hands, as it is very easy to break this sac accidentally. Failure to successfully remove the sac without breakage results in 1d-3 corrosion damage to the handler's hands. Use stats from page 28 of *GURPS Dungeon Fantasy 1: Adventurers*.

Aside from this, the ankheg's mandibles make reasonably good axe-heads, and its legs (if cured and preserved) may be used as improvised knobbed clubs. By removing out the meat inside and replacing it with some substance to provide weight (sand, metal, etc.),

these appendages can be formed into weapons delivering the same damage as their counterparts.

Legs and sinew of an ankheg can be used to produce bows.

### Capturing and Training

While an ankheg is not a bright animal, it still can be trained to perform guarding or hunting tasks, or even as a war beast or mount.

**Egg Value:** \$1,300.

**Untrained Value:** \$6,670.

**Trained Value:** \$66,700.

**Supply Cost:** \$3.5 and 4 lbs./day. If the ankheg is allowed to burrow freely, supply cost is \$0.8 and 1.3 lb./day. If it also is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Training Skill:** Animal Handling (Flightless Insects).

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Flightless Insects).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.07

**Wage (Monthly):** \$2,000.

### Mass Combat Statistics

#### 20 Ankhegs

*Battle Rating:* 1.5

*Classes:* Eng.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 32/128 (land) or 16/64 (burrowing).

*Supply (Weekly):* \$1,100.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$35,700.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$40,100.

### Racial Template

-24 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+8 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%, Size Modifier, -20%) [32]; IQ-8 [-160]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+2; HP+2 (Size Modifier, -20%) [4]; Will+7 [35]; Per+9 [45]; Basic Move +3 [15].

**Advantages:** Ambidexterity [5]; DR 4 (Legs, feet, arms, and hands have halved DR, -20%; Nuisance Effect, Weak underside, -15%) [13]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Metabolism Control 3 (Winter; Hibernation, -60%) [6]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Accessibility, Must spend at least half a day in soil, -30%) [3]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Subsonic Hearing (Biological (Passive), -5%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4]; Tunneling (Move 4) [50]; Ultravision [10]; Vibration Sense (Air; Biological (Passive), -5%) [10].

*Acid Enzymes (Alternative Abilities) [12]:*

*Acidic Bite:* Corrosion Attack 1d-1 (Biological (Passive), -5%; Follow-Up, Bite, +0%; Nuisance Effect, Can be depleted, -10%) [6/5=2].

*Spit Acid:* Corrosion Attack 2d (Biological, -10%; Blockable, -5%; Increased 1/2D, 10x, +15%; Reduced Range, 1/5, -20%; Takes Recharge, 1 hour, -30%) [10].

**Disadvantages:** Bad Sight (Nearsighted) [-25]; Cold-Blooded (50°) [-5]; Deafness [-20]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; Short Lifespan 3 [-30]; Wild Animal (with Mute) [-40].

**Quirks:** Likes meat [-1].

## Beholder

Type: Aberration (Beholder)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 25 | <b>HP</b> | 31 | <b>SM</b>     | +3        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 2d+2/5d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 13 | <b>FP</b> | 13 | <b>BL</b>     | 125 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 2d+2/3d-1

**Body Plan:** Only torso, eyes, and vitals.

**Weight:** 4,000 lbs.

**Diameter:** 8 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 80% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** J.

Beholders rank among the most formidable of the aberrations, standing out not only for their lethal nature but also for their unique and striking appearance.

The body of a beholder is deceptively simple to the naked eye, being a lone sphere roughly 8 feet in diameter, though variations that are somewhat smaller or considerably larger are not uncommon. Thanks to its inherent buoyancy, a beholder's mass is somewhat mitigated, yet its form remains densely packed.

The sphere is chiefly characterized by a large, central eye and a gaping mouth filled with teeth. From the top of this spherical form, ten smaller eyes on slender tendrils emerge.

In terms of functionality, a beholder's mouth is comparable to that of a human, complete with a tongue, soft palates on both the upper and lower sides, and sets of upper and lower teeth. The teeth of a beholder are designed to slice and dice, being long, thin, and exceedingly sharp.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Air:** Move 2; exploration 1 mile per hour.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 125 | 250   | 375    | 750   | 1,250       |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** The hide of a beholder is as durable as steel. Excluding the more supple skin found on the eyelids and around the mouth, the skin of a beholder is notably rigid. The color and texture of their hide can vary dramatically among individuals, ranging from a single, dull shade with a smooth, almost glossy finish to a vibrant, patterned covering that resembles thick, interlocked plates.

A beholder's central eyeball is remarkably hard and solid, about as strong as a similarly sized ball of stone.

**Central Eye (-8):** DR 3 when open, DR 6 when closed.

**Eyestalks (-6 or -9):** DR 3. Each eyestalk has HP 2; any excess injury is lost. Can be attacked with cutting and swung non-impaling attacks at -6, or any other attacks at -9. Since these eyes are on stalks, there is no x4 injury multiplier as for a normal eye hit.

**Tongue (-6):** DR 0. The tongue can only be targeted when the beholder is feeling an object with it. HP 3, any excess injury is lost. Located in hex #1.

**Torso:** DR 5.

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against attacks from the sides or rear).

**Resistances:** +3 to all HT rolls concerned with eye damage.

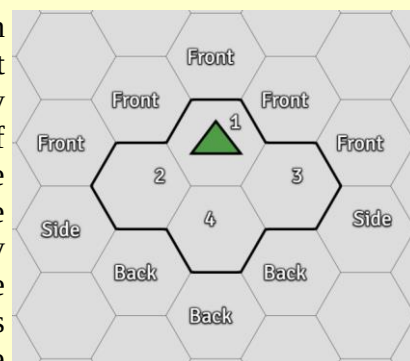
**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Head (still has a brain), No Neck).

**Notes:** A character can target a beholder's vitals or brain intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Beholders) roll. The brain is not protected by extra DR.

### Combat

Beholders often attack without provocation. They try to stay in the midst of their enemies to be able to use their eye rays on as many victims as possible while pointing its antimagic cone at the enemy spellcasters.

If a beholder feels that it won't be able to overpower a foe physically, then it stays in the air outside of the enemy's reach and uses its eye rays. Due to being fliers, beholders enjoy an additional +1 when performing a vertical retreating dodge.



**Bite (12):** thrust 3d-1 cutting. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the beholder may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d+2 control against SM+0 and smaller victims or 2d control against larger ones.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 6.25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 62.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 13                   | 25        | 38                   | 50                 |

## Special Abilities

Beholders are innately magical creatures that possess many special abilities. All of the abilities are magical in nature and hence depend on the ambient mana.

**Antimagic Cone:** The central eye emanates a cone of antimagic that suppresses all magical effects and abilities, including the beholder's own eye rays in all its front hexes within 16 yards. Temporary magical effects (like buffs) are automatically dispelled, while truly permanent magical effects and abilities are suspended.

As a free action once during its turn, the beholder may close its central eye. This disables this ability until the beholder opens the eye again, allowing it to use its own eye rays against targets within its frontal arc. In addition, when the central eye is closed, it is protected by the rigid eyelid – its DR becomes 6.

**Energy Reserve:** A beholder has ER 10 (Magic) that it spends to use its eye rays before it uses FP.

**Eye Rays:** Each eyestalk can produce a spell-like effect in the form of a visible ray. Rays are ranged attacks with Acc 3, Max 100, and no 1/2D range. They use Innate Attack (Gaze) to hit. They can be used against any target within range, not only against targets in the front arc. Each ray costs 1 FP to use (except for the Telekinesis ray which is free), can be dodged, but not parried or blocked. Note that the eye rays are *not* alternative abilities!

Obviously, the beholder uses its eye rays on those outside its antimagic cone, and tries to avoid turning to the affected victims with its central eye open, as that would dispel all effects that have a duration.

Each ray is tied to a separate eyestalk. Eyestalks can be attacked at -6 with cutting attacks or at -9 with any other attacks. Eyestalks have HP 2 and DR 3, and crippling an eyestalk disables the associated eye ray. If a beholder uses one of its rays in combat and an opponent observes it, the opponent may make a Vision roll to notice and track the eyestalk used. Otherwise, if an eyestalk is attacked and crippled, disable a random eye ray.

Note that while the beholder may only fire one eye ray per second, it can aim at three targets at once.

**Eye Ray: Charm (17):** Beholders use this ray to confuse the opposition, usually employing it early in a fight. The beholder generally instructs a charmed target to either restrain a comrade or stand aside.

**Eye Ray: Death (17):** Beholders use this ray on weak-looking opponents to remove them from the fight. Tough opponents are likely to have high HT and hence are resistant to this effect.

**Eye Ray: Disintegrate (17):** Beholders never use this on magical objects. Instead, they prefer to disintegrate heavy mundane weapons that are likely to penetrate its natural armor or heavy armor to soften the target up for Eye Ray: Inflict Wounds.

**Eye Ray: Fear (17):** While it is easy to get bonuses to resist fear, the beholder uses this ray on the most formidable opponents due to the Rule of 14 (p. B360) capping the effective Will for the purpose of Fright Checks. An opponent stunned (or worse) by a Fright Check is an easy target for other rays.

**Eye Ray: Flesh to Stone (17):** This ray is used by the beholder to take opponents out of the fight if they may prove useful to the beholder later. Even though a petrified victim cannot be returned to normal with Dispel Magic, the beholder's antimagic cone *will* dispel this effect, letting the monster interrogate, charm, and/or eat the victim.

**Eye Ray: Inflict Wounds 4 (17):** This is the main damage-dealing ability of the beholder. Since there is no roll to resist, the beholder employs this ray when attacking tough targets that are likely to shrug off the effects of resistible rays. However, since the ray's damage is reduced by DR, the beholder may want to use Eye Ray: Disintegrate to remove armor first.

**Eye Ray: Sleep (17):** This ray is often used when fighting a lone opponent that may prove useful to the beholder. If used when fighting multiple opponents, even if this ability succeeds, the sleeping opponent is likely to wake up immediately due to the combat noise.

**Eye Ray: Slow (17):** Beholders are very slow fliers, so they use this ray to slow down fleeing foes (who are likely to have their backs turned to the beholder and hence have no active defense against the ray), following up with a bite or Eye Ray: Sleep.

**Eye Ray: Telekinesis 15 (17):** In combat, beholders use this ray to grapple or even wield weapons. Outside of combat, this is a utility ray that is used to move objects, such as corpses, loot, rocks, etc. Keep in mind that this ray requires constant concentration, so a beholder cannot grapple an enemy with it and fire other rays at the grappled enemy.

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Evading (p. B368).

- Evading (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

Incidental Collisions (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Not Just Stunned (*GURPS Horror*, p. 141).

Slam and Overrun (p. B392).

- Defense vs. Slams (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 9).

Striking at Weapons (p. B400).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 15     | 10      | -/10        | 10    |

**Vision:** The myriad eyes of the beholder stand as its most distinguished (and feared) physical characteristic. These eyes afford the creature an unparalleled field of vision (**negating penalties for defending against side or rear attacks**, and offering a +5 bonus to detecting Shadowing attempts), as well as the capability to focus, guide, and unleash formidable magical powers. With just one Aim action, a beholder can target up to three adversaries. Beyond these functionalities, a beholder's eye remains an intricate and marvelous structure, captivating numerous scholars and magicians for ages.



The substance of a beholder's eyestalks is resilient and stringy, yet in contrast to its body's skin, this material is notably supple. The surface of each eyestalk on the majority of beholders is sleek and

elastic, reminiscent of a tentacle. Variability exists, with some beholders displaying segmented eyestalks akin to a worm's physique, and others featuring jointed stalks that resemble an insect's limbs, capable of twisting and bending in every conceivable direction.

In a dormant state, the eyes present a vividly colored, spherical iris (1). This iris appears to be a translucent crystal made up of myriad interlinking layers, each capable of moving separately. This design grants a beholder incredible control over its iris's form and the intensity of light entering the eye. A beholder can reshape its iris into virtually any form and can enlarge it to the eye socket's edge, creating the illusion of an absent iris.

Interestingly, a beholder's eye doesn't contain a sole lens. Instead, it may contain up to twelve lenses of varying sizes and shapes (2), all moving independently and in coordination with the iris's movements. Through manipulating these lenses along with the iris, a beholder can precisely target with its eye beams. The multiple lenses also enhance the creature's already superior sight. Every beholder comes equipped with **Infravision** (p. B60).

A beholder's eye's interior is cluttered with transparent, almost invisible nerve fibers named evocularies (3). Each evoculary directly connects to one of the three retinas and secures an iris layer (4) or a lens, or sometimes both. These evocularies facilitate the movement of the eye's components and also channel light and magical energy between the retinas and lenses. The configuration of the evocularies varies from eye to eye, affecting the concentration of the raw magical energy that a beholder produces in its brain to generate its iconic eye ray effects.

Each eye possesses three retinas (5) that intertwine into a complex, braided formation extending down the stalk or behind the central eye towards the creature's deep internals and cerebrum. This braided path transmits the raw magical energy essential for the beholder's eye beams from the brain's dweomerlobes.

**Hearing:** Among its four non-visual senses, a beholder's hearing is the most comparable to a human's. Typically, a beholder has a dozen tiny tympanic membranes scattered haphazardly over its body. Each membrane is about an inch in diameter and detectable only under meticulous examination.

**Touch:** A beholder's tactile sense has diminished almost to nonexistence, with the exception of its tongue's surface. Beholders are effectively **Numb** (p. B146), save when employing their tongues to sense objects, given the heightened sensitivity of this muscular organ. The tongue is neither armored nor capable of manipulation. When a beholder uses its

tongue to explore an object externally, it is unable to speak or bite.

**Smell/Taste:** Paradoxically, despite having a sensitive tongue, beholders lack any taste sensation entirely. This absence of gustatory ability could be the reason they consume virtually anything they overpower. Beholders possess the ability to detect odors through countless tiny pores (referred to as spiracles) scattered across their skin, which simultaneously serve as their means of respiration.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 13 | 15   |

Beholders are characterized by their malevolence, aggression, and greed, often engaging in conflict with or enslaving different races, including their own kind and various beholder relatives. This hostility stems from a deep-seated xenophobic intolerance, driving their disdain for all beings dissimilar to themselves.

Each beholder regards itself as the epitome of perfection, believing it to be directly descended from the primeval entity known as the Great Mother. They view any deviations in other beholders as evidence of inferiority.

A beholder's consciousness, as alien as its physique, is bifurcated into two distinct, autonomous intellects. These are identified as the rational mind and the intuitive mind.

The rational mind operates with a detached logic, organizing information into understandable patterns for the beholder. It houses strategies, arcane knowledge, justifications, memories, and ambitions.

Conversely, the intuitive mind encompasses the realm of perception. It filters observed information, deciding what should be conveyed to the rational mind. This is where a beholder stores repressed memories and knowledge, including reminders of past failures and hypotheses that could destabilize its logical counterpart.

Within the chasm separating these dual minds lies the root of a beholder's paranoia and xenophobia. Generally perceived as deranged, not every beholder is plagued by the drawbacks of dual consciousness. In some individuals, the rational and intuitive faculties collaborate seamlessly, harmonizing thoughts and plans without concealing truths. Such beholders are deemed sane and are capable of interacting with other entities in a less destructive fashion, though they retain the potential for brutality and cruelty characteristic of their species.

Having two minds does not give a beholder any sort of additional actions in combat (even if they cooperate like the two minds of a "sane" beholder), but they are affected by magic, psionics, and the like

*separately* (e.g., one compartment could be hypnotized without affecting any of the others).

If one compartment is under external influence, roll a Quick Contest of Will to see whether it gains control of the body. The compartment currently in control of the body rolls at +1. Battling compartments may attempt to use mental powers on each other. Treat them as completely separate minds for this purpose, each with the beholder's IQ, Will, and mental abilities.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (9); Callous; Gluttony (12); Greed (12); Intolerance (Total); Loner (6); Paranoia; Sadism (9).

### Skills

Brawling-12; Innate Attack (Gaze)-17; Interrogation-15; Intimidation-15; Thaumatology-15.

### Other Traits

No Legs (Aerial); No Manipulators; Temperature Tolerance 2 (Cold).

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Central Nervous System:** The formidable magical prowess of a beholder is concentrated and managed within its neural network and brain (7). Some posit that beholders amass magical energy by consuming the carcasses of spellcasting entities, while others speculate that they passively soak up the ambient magic in their surroundings.



Indeed, the copious reserves of magical power within a beholder are intricately linked to its visual organs. Similar to how its intertwined optic nerves channel light towards the brain to facilitate vision, the eyes also funnel magic to the brain, where it's stored and intensified. Beholders are capable of assimilating magical energy through various means: observing active spell effects, watching magical beings like constructs or mages, looking at ancient artifacts and small magical trinkets, and even perusing spellbooks. They can also reclaim magic from their own eye beams, effectively recycling the energy back into their brains as they deploy them.

The amount of magical energy assimilated through the eyes is negligible; a beholder might peruse the same spell scroll dedicated to magic missiles incessantly for several months before the scroll becomes depleted. The absorption process lengthens with the potency and permanence of the magic involved. Additionally, beholders develop resistances to repeatedly encountered types of magic. For example, a week spent studying a sole pair of winged boots would yield significantly less magical energy for a beholder than delving into a vast library of arcane literature. A beholder deprived of a consistent influx of novel magic to study becomes irritable and distrustful. Driven more by this need than mere avarice, beholders accumulate magic artifacts as treasures or venture into ancient ruins and labyrinths in search of potent magic.

The brain of a beholder is notably voluminous, predominantly comprising two horn-like lobes descending on either side, termed *dweomerlobes*. It is here that magical energy is stockpiled and strengthened.

**Diet:** Despite its intimidating prowess and magical dominance, at its essence, a beholder is a corporeal entity necessitating sustenance. Consumption of food and beverages, aside from the intellectual acquisition of magical lore or subjugation of inferior species, serve as its sole indulgences.

Being omnivorous, a beholder can derive nourishment from any organic matter (affording it **Universal Digestion**). A typical beholder requires roughly 9 pounds of food and at least 2 gallons of water daily. For beholders, consumption engenders their utmost physiological satisfaction, prompting them to ingest more than their actual needs (manifesting as **Gluttony (12)**). For instance, a beholder might devour a sizeable defeated adversary, amounting to about 200 pounds of flesh and several pints of blood, in one session. Although such intake surpasses its daily necessity, it remains open to additional offerings of sustenance.

Given their diminished taste capability, beholders derive pleasure from the textural and visual aspects of their food. Foods exhibiting intriguing textures (such as the blend of tender meat and crunchy bones found in live prey) or captivating shapes and hues, viewed with its frontal eyestalks while eating, are particularly appealing to beholders, who favor vividly colored foods.

Furthermore, beholders exhibit a particular fondness for wine, one of the scant flavors they can discern. This preference, coupled with wine's chromatic varieties, renders it an exemplary beverage choice for beholders. Their bodies process alcohol with remarkable efficiency, meaning the volume of wine needed to intoxicate a standard beholder often

surpasses what is readily consumable. Beholders receive a +2 bonus on all HT rolls pertaining to alcohol consumption.

Given their propensity for overindulgence, beholders are adept at managing considerable volumes of food. The digestive tract of a beholder can accommodate an immense quantity of sustenance (over 600 pounds) within its stomach's numerous creases. This creature can metabolize the stored fare at about 18 pounds daily, obviating the need to eat in this period, though it must continue to hydrate as usual. Any attempt to ingest food beyond this capacity is futile.

Even when satiated, a beholder may continue to masticate food, savoring the texture and the act of eating itself, but will let the food fall from its mouth once its textural essence has been exhausted.

A beholder's palate favors a variety of foods, including small live mammals, distinct mushrooms and fungi, gnomes, beef, pork, vividly colored vegetables, leaves, flower petals, insects, and birds. It displays no reluctance in consuming sentient beings, whether they are humans or fellow beholders.

**Digestive and Vascular System:** The external appearance of a beholder might suggest a creature of logical design. However, delving into its internal architecture reveals an array of organs so bizarre and vividly hued, so entangled and inexplicable, they bear little resemblance to human anatomy. Scholars have deduced the functions of some organs through elimination or location relative to the beholder's mouth, confidently identifying the digestive, circulatory, and respiratory systems, as well as reproductive organs and the brain.

Despite their seemingly simplistic exterior, beholders are intrinsically complex and foreign in their essence. Their organs may share superficial similarities in shape and function with those of other beings, yet numerous aspects are uniquely monstrous.

The beholder's digestive system is among its most apparent internal structures. Its mouth leads to a robust muscle resembling a sphincter (1), opening into a brief esophagus (2) and then a sprawling, flat stomach (3) occupying most of the space within its lower jaw. From here, numerous intestine-like tubes (4) fork off, winding upwards along the creature's back. These tubes, which grow progressively thinner, eventually encircle and permeate a large, fan-shaped organ (5) filled with myriad tiny, air-filled cavities. This organ serves as the beholder's lung, where air is continuously blended with the liquefied remnants of meals to create a frothy, pink concoction.

Encased in muscular walls, the lung rhythmically inflates and deflates, drawing air through the creature's skin spiracles. From the lung, countless slender arteries fan out to distribute this nutrient-rich

mixture throughout the body. The nutrient and oxygen delivery via this fluid is facilitated by the lung's pulsations, with waste fluid returning to the beholder's vast mouth to be expelled or often dribbling continuously as pungently odorous drool, which solidifies to a rock-like substance within two days. A food-deprived beholder becomes noticeably sluggish as its body starts to desiccate.

Materials resistant to digestion are either expelled through vomiting or gradually assimilated into the stomach lining, eventually becoming part of the beholder's "skeletal" interior surface.

Beholder blood exhibits a distinctive green hue. Instead of a heart continuously circulating blood, beholders possess a central "blood sac" that, aided by a muscular diaphragm, propels blood through their vessels, subsequently drawing it back into the sac.

**Flight:** A peculiar feature among a beholder's internal makeup is its uncanny ability to float. This odd buoyancy persists even in organs detached from the main body, which intriguingly float akin to balloons without harboring significant amounts of air or gas, apart from the lungs. An organ, once severed, maintains this flotation for a maximum of 12 hours, extendable through preservation spells like gentle repose. This inherent lightness grants a beholder its ability to soar, steering itself with air jets from myriad spiracles.

**Habitat:** Cold hills and underground. The temperature comfort zone of a beholder falls between 9° and 90°.

**Lairs:** The lair of a typical beholder is a labyrinthine network of passages burrowed into solid stone, often with the aid of bewitched creatures. These tunnels are known for their smooth, rounded contours, each spanning a radius of 10 feet. Recognizing the strategic superiority afforded by their flight, beholders design their lairs with numerous vertical shafts to confound invaders and prevent the easy escape of captives.

Within these fortresses lie three to five chambers beyond the main entrance. The most secluded serves as the beholder's private sanctum, where it rests and examines accrued magical treasures. Due to their haughty nature, beholders shun the inclusion of escape routes in their quarters, viewing them as invitations for assault from multiple angles. Between this sanctum and the entrance lie chambers designated for guardians, with additional rooms set aside for waste disposal or detention of captives. A beholder may provide a separate chamber for a valued underling, such as a representative, with further accommodations erected as necessary. Fond of ensnaring the unwary, beholders frequently incorporate traps, like pressure-activated plates

effortlessly evaded by their levitation, including pitfalls among their defensive measures.

**Lifecycle:** While beholders have the potential for a lifespan exceeding a century, few navigate past their initial ten years, with their youth predominately spent in search of a suitable stronghold.

From birth, a beholder is imbued with deep-seated racial memories, quickly mastering its native tongue and exhibiting entrenched xenophobia and intolerance, predisposing it towards malevolence.

Rapid growth characterizes the early stages of a beholder's life, though it remains vulnerable while its ocular beams mature. Observational learning of magic over several months is essential for the development of these rays. Beholders situated in magically rich environments typically see their abilities flourish within two to three months, during which they sustain themselves on smaller fauna. In less enchanted settings, this maturation could extend to a year.

Reaching full size by two years, a beholder's growth subsequently decelerates. Theoretically aging leads to fragility past ninety years, with eyestalks diminishing in power towards the century mark. While surpassing one hundred and twenty years is rare, those beholders that adeptly navigate threats through cunning or magic can achieve prolonged lifespans, gradually enlarging. Legends tell of ancient beholders, centuries old and spanning nearly 20 feet across.

**Origin:** It is believed that the first beholders were brought into existence in one of the Outer Planes by a primeval being as mighty as any god, known to its offspring without the need for a name. To the rest of the world, this entity is referred to as the Great Mother, a title attributed more to its role in birthing the entire beholder species from its own essence than to any true indication of its gender. The beholder race, along with its varied relatives, has since spread across different realms, thriving largely unchallenged due to their formidable nature.

**Reproductive System:** Beholders are genderless, experiencing fertility only once during their existence. This phase occurs within the initial forty years of a beholder's life, during which it exhibits heightened erratic and paranoid tendencies. Beneath the back of its tongue, an egg-shaped organ (6)—its womb—becomes noticeably enlarged and distended. In this womb, a beholder may carry up to twelve offspring for nearly six months, becoming increasingly irritable and active. For the first four months of gestation, a pregnant beholder's consumption of food quadruples, as it stores nutrients across its stomach, intestines, and lungs. In the gestation's latter half, the womb expands to a point where the beholder can no longer eat, its tongue conspicuously protruding from its mouth. At

its most distrustful, the beholder secludes itself until it delivers.

The birth of beholder offspring is a rare and ghastly event; the beholder's jaw dislocates, expelling its swollen womb through the mouth. The creature then severs the womb, which hovers in midair. The newborns forcefully gnaw their way out, capable of flight but with underdeveloped eye abilities. Often, out of a dozen born, only a few survive as the parent decides which resemble it the most. The less-favored are consumed by the voracious parent, along with the spent womb. The survivors are expelled from the lair within an hour to survive independently.

## Society and Organization

Despite their might and perilous nature, one critical aspect has limited beholders from achieving widespread domination—their inherent insanity. Deriving from a deity of madness, beholders live in a perpetual state of malice and fury, with minds as disjointed as any sentient being could possess. Yet, this madness evokes a rigid order in them, compelling a view of all other life forms as inferior and despicable.

Consequently, beholders exhibit hostility and aggression towards all other beings. Paradoxically, this animosity is most intense towards their own kind, particularly other beholders and related species. Beholders regard non-beholders as merely utilitarian - resources to be utilized in their relentless pursuit to annihilate other beholders and their variants. While their endeavors are methodically logical, the objectives they pursue are unequivocally deranged.

**Religion:** It's a rare sight to see a beholder taking up the mantle of a cleric. Their disposition lacks the inclination towards dedicating themselves to higher beings, and frankly, their mindset is not wired to grasp such devotion. However, it would be incorrect to label beholders as atheistic; they are in a perpetual state of worship towards an eternal figure known as the Great Mother. Additionally, a number of beholders show reverence towards Gzemnid, also dubbed the Gas Giant.

From the moment of their creation, beholders recognize their origin not as the work of their direct progenitor—who rejects and becomes hostile towards them—but from the timeless entity, the Great Mother. For a beholder, the Great Mother is the embodiment of truth. Anything less is deemed flawed, pushing each beholder to aspire towards the perfection in intellect and form exhibited by the Great Mother. A beholder's memory of its own birth is not of the actual event but is perceived as a personal creation by the Great Mother. Each one firmly believes it is the epitome of the Great Mother's grandeur in flesh, seeing all other beholders as rivals to be eliminated,

for their mere existence is considered an affront to the Great Mother. In the eyes of a beholder, devotion is best expressed through the eradication of others.

**Language:** Beholders are fluent in the dominant language of their habitat, primarily to interrogate and threaten any captives. Yet, they regard speaking in any non-beholder tongue as base and demeaning, almost as an acknowledgment of another race's ingenuity and intellect. Therefore, beholders favor communicating in their inherent language.

The beholder language, while challenging, is not beyond the comprehension or speech of humanoids. Characterized by guttural sounds, mixed with smacking, gurgling, and drooling, a conversation between two non-hostile beholders can quickly become a messy affair.

Interestingly, the beholder lexicon lacks a term for their own species. The label "beholder" is an external designation from those they consider inferior. Identifying with a collective "race" is repugnant to a beholder, each viewing itself as a unique manifestation of the Great Mother. On the rare occasions of camaraderie, beholders refer to each other by their individual names, a sign of profound respect.

Beholder names tend to be elaborate, complex, and unwieldy; self-naming occurs in the early stages of life. Names such as Blorghathus, Gazriktak, and Xanathar are examples. In unique cases, a beholder leading others may adopt a simpler name more palatable to its followers, like Orbius or Slatherjaw.

**Relations with Other Creatures:** When it comes to relations with non-beholder species, a beholder (whether sane or not) typically categorizes them into five groups.

**Powerful:** This category is reserved for beings the beholder acknowledges as equal or superior in might. It is the most sparsely populated category, as beholders prefer avoidance over confrontation with such formidable entities. This group may include storm giants, highly powerful outsiders or undead like liches or vampires, the majority of dragons, and gods.

**Dangerous:** This classification is for those beings a beholder recognizes could inflict severe harm or disrupt its meticulous schemes. These entities either possess knowledge vital to the beholder or have access to coveted items, compelling the beholder to ensnare, dominate, and ultimately eliminate them as methodically as possible. This group includes, but is not limited to, intelligent humanoids, sentient undead, mind flayers, aboleths, and potent outsiders.

**Usable:** Beings falling into this category are seen as minimally threatening by the beholder, yet they hold abilities that could prove advantageous if coerced into service. Such entities range from goblinoids and giants to grell, neogi, and lesser outsiders.

*Inferior:* These entities, viewed as inconsequential by the beholder, contribute nothing of value and are merely vexatious. While beholders may enslave or annihilate them, it's not a task they pursue with zeal. Typical examples include elementals, mindless undead, fey creatures, various vermin, and sentient flora.

*Inconsequential:* In this case, these beings serve as nothing more than an easy food source for the beholder. Animals and magical beasts are primary examples.

**Relations with Other Beholders:** Beholders are innately malevolent, with their deepest disdain reserved for their own kind. While a beholder might temporarily tolerate another of its species that appears somewhat similar, inevitable perceptions of minor flaws in the other promptly incite fury. No beholder ever sees another as its equal, merely as competition or, at most, a potential meal.

Variations among beholders, even in physical form, are considered insignificant. Yet, distinct beholder types like elder orbs and hive mothers exhibit remarkably different capabilities from standard beholders. Furthermore, a range of beholderkin, including gauths, overseers, and eyes of the deep, are viewed with outright hostility for being egregious distortions of beholder identity.

Encountering another beholder typically triggers immediate aggression. If feasible, a beholder will command its minions to assault and dispatch the rival. When this approach is impractical, the beholder has no choice but to engage directly.

Beholders boast a unique defense against their own kind, thanks to their antimagic cone. Combat between two beholders is ferocious and unrelenting, particularly when neither can gain a terrain advantage. An ambushing beholder might swiftly conclude the conflict.

On equal footing, each beholder spins to keep its adversary within its antimagic cone, reducing the clash to a brutal exchange of savage bites and swift retreats. They employ tactics of moving and attacking or launching full-on assaults to bite and then withdraw, making it difficult for the opponent to break free from the antimagic field without retreating further or attempting a similar countermove.

On the rare occasions where multiple beholders engage, the violence escalates exponentially. In such tumultuous brawls, beholders band together against the most distinctive-looking among them, forming temporary alliances based on physical similarity to overpower the rest. As each beholder is defeated, these alliances dynamically shift, isolating the next most unique beholder as the primary target.

**Sane Beholders:** Not every beholder exists as a deranged, lonely entity with an inclination towards

carnage. Much like other races include individuals who defy societal norms, beholders too have their outcasts. From the perspective of humanoids, these outliers are regarded as the relatively sane beholders. Their animosity towards fellow beholders stems more from fear than from sheer intolerance. A rational beholder is aware that its kin perceive it as the ultimate menace, leading it to seek refuge in places forsaken by its own kind. Hence, such beholders often dwell within the civilizations and urban environments of various races.

Though considered sane, most of these beholders are inherently evil. They are conscious of the dread they incite in other species and therefore, they discreetly establish their dens in concealed subterranean vaults beneath cities. By leveraging their charm abilities on inhabitants, they craft a loyal cadre of followers and swiftly ascend to become the clandestine architects of new power structures. Commonly, they spearhead thieves' guilds from the shadows or via a meticulously chosen surrogate. Some beholders venture further, catalyzing the formation of religious sects, bardic circles, magical academies, or even take the reins of a municipality's government.

Predominantly, these entities spawn beholder cults. Each cult revolves around a singular beholder captivating numerous followers into revering it as a divine figure. Such adulation serves as a potent means towards self-gratification for beholders, who in turn, promote this practice among their adherents. Often, only a handful of zealous cult leaders remain under the beholder's spell, guiding the broader congregation. This setup ensures the cult members' voluntary devotion, a scenario beholders deem immensely satisfying.

Extreme cult followers undergo a grim ritual to enshrine a beholder's eye within their own foreheads, venerating the Great Mother. Dubbed ocular adepts, these individuals, despite not being beholders, embody the cult's utmost dedication and pose a significant threat. Typically, an ocular adept helms the cult, possibly in allegiance with a remotely residing beholder. Occasionally, a network of ocular adepts spanning multiple cities might pledge allegiance to a singular beholder. The beholder then selects the most influential cult as its stronghold, governing the lesser offshoots indirectly.

In extraordinary cases, sane beholders collaborate, pooling their capabilities towards a unified aim. This consortium, known as a beholder cluster, ranges from two to six members. Given that beholders do not seek physical companionship, these coalitions primarily aim at dominating lesser species or accruing new magical knowledge for scrutiny. A beholder cluster rapidly emerges as a dominant

regional power and, if unopposed, poses a potential threat to national sovereignties.

Yet, the pinnacle of menace within beholder society is not found in these clusters but within the fearsome beholder hives.

**Hives and Hive Cities:** The beholder hive stands as one of the most daunting phenomena within their culture. It's not rare for beholders of similar form to cohabit, banding together to erect bizarre, foreign metropolises in the world's secluded extremities.

The capability of beholder hive mothers and overseers to orchestrate these congregations is crucial. These entities, fortunately uncommon, wield extraordinary powers to lead and govern their beholder kin. Hive mothers, esteemed beholders believed to emerge directly from the tremulous embrace of the Great Mother herself, alongside overseers—deformities bearing only a cursory resemblance to their beholder origins—can marshal extensive collectives of beholders towards a unified endeavor.

The scale of a beholder hive is largely dictated by its leadership. Overseers, capable of managing only a modest ensemble of beholders, preside over hives constituting roughly twenty beholders and their kin, nestled within subterranean labyrinths.

Conversely, hives under the dominion of a hive mother know no bounds in scale, occasionally even encompassing overseers (all beneath the hive mother's sway, naturally). These expansive hives parallel urban dimensions and, though predominantly underground, a seldom few grace remote surface locales. The principal ambition of a hive mother overseeing such a city invariably centers around the amassment of more beholders and their kin. Holding a conviction of being the Great Mother's elect, these hive mothers strive for racial unity and discipline. Other cities governed by opposing hive mothers stand as their arch adversaries, embodying the entirety of the beholder race's corruption and downfall. The ultimate goal post-rival eradication or assimilation is deploying their immense assemblage to purify other races, paving the way for the Great Mother's resurgence.

A standard hive city hosts a populace characterized somewhat like this:

- 1 hive mother
- 2 to 4 overseer
- 6 to 12 director, each bonded with a monstrous vermin, typically huge monstrous centipedes
- 11 to 30 beholders
- 5 to 15 gauths
- 3 to 8 guardians (such as death kisses or gougers)
- 12 to 24 gas spores, strategically placed like sentinels at the city's outskirts

- 30 to 120 bewitched underlings (spanning any dominant regional races)

These figures merely sketch an average; exceptionally vast hive cities are believed to dwell in the world's nethermost depths or its most removed confines.

For a beholder within a hive city, existence poses a unique conundrum. A hive mother constantly monitors its subordinates, and, should this oversight falter (for instance, through another beholder's antimagic gaze), the beholders endeavor to preserve a semblance of decorum, lest they provoke their sovereign's formidable ire. Yet, even a hive mother's oversight does not extend over the entire hive. It designates trusted beholders or overseers to manage the city as a quasi-council, directing urban operations while the hive mother itself more passively observes rather than micromanages.

Given the endless expanse of the multiverse, it stands that beholder hive cities scattered across the planes may adhere to diverse regulations.

**Minions:** Despite their profound xenophobia, beholders occasionally suppress their disdain and prejudice for a potentially utilitarian being, destined for elimination once it serves its purpose. A beholder holds no faith in alliances while "enlisting" a minion, instead resorting to its charm abilities to exert control. It diligently refreshes any charms on its minions as necessary, allocating its days to this endeavor.

Beholders enlist minions for various motives, the most prevalent outlined herein. Typically eschewing the use of beholderkin as minions—preferring their destruction—exceptions occur among those considered rational or under directives from an overseer or hive mother to do so.

**Assassins:** Beholders craft intricate plots and designs, which can be disrupted by the interference of outside entities. When the machinations of a beholder are thwarted, it employs its network of informants to discern the cause. Upon identifying a particular individual or group as the source of the disruption, it dispatches its cadre of assassins to rectify the predicament. Only when these assassins prove unsuccessful does the beholder intervene directly. In such instances, it prefers to entice the disruptors to its stronghold with the aid of spies or collectors, where it holds the strategic upper hand, deploying every tool at its disposal to eradicate them. Notable examples of such assassins include chokers, derro, doppelgangers, driders, and rogues.

**Entertainment:** Despite their preoccupations with arcane research, scheming, and the intimidation of subordinate entities, beholders typically maintain a selection of minions exclusively for diversions. The form of amusement a beholder seeks varies considerably based on individual whims, ranging

from the malevolent pleasure in observing terrified goblins forced into combat under the threat of annihilation to the refined appreciation of magical exhibitions by charmed spell-weavers. Beholders are particularly fond of illusion magic, yet any spellcasting performance by an entertaining underling also serves to energize the creature's spell lobes. Among all minion types, those kept for entertainment are most susceptible to being consumed impulsively. Examples include bards, goblinoids, sorcerers, and mages.

**Gatherers:** Beholders, preferring the confines of their sanctums amidst their protectors and safeguards, occasionally require objects attainable only from beyond their lairs. In such circumstances, beholders task charmed procurers—entities adept at covering vast distances swiftly and infiltrating fortified locales—to retrieve these items. Prior to dispatching a procurer, a beholder sends out a spy to pinpoint the likely whereabouts of the desired object or individual, thereafter commissioning a procurer to secure it. These procurers are also in charge of ensnaring new captives, though for especially perilous assignments, a beholder may deploy a joint contingent of assassins and acquirers. Representative examples include ethereal filchers, mephits, rangers, and spellcasters.

**Guardians:** The lion's share of a beholder's minions serve as protectors, appointed to defend its lair. Less sentient protectors are relegated to the lair's remote dead-ends, while their more astute counterparts patrol the premises for interlopers.

Gas spores warrant a specific acknowledgment. This distinctive form of airborne fungus was initially cultivated and refined by an ancient beholder sorcerer, now long forgotten. In the gas spore, the beholder succeeded in fashioning a lethal yet unthinking protector that doubles as a living monument extolling the quintessential beholder shape, is fertile and self-perpetuating, and demands minimal external care. Gas spores never revolt against their creators, inadvertently harm a beholder, nor can be persuaded or beguiled by adversaries. Since their inception, gas spores have proliferated across the globe like a contagion, with dungeons once dominated by a beholder sovereign, now vanished or deceased, continuing to serve as breeding grounds for these formidable fungi. Examples of protectors include athachs, barbarians, bulettes, carrion crawlers, dire animals, warriors, gas spores, giants, hydras, minotaurs, ogres, purple worms, and ropers.

**Representatives:** On the infrequent occasions when a beholder must engage with other societies or civilizations through peaceful means, it falls back on the use of a charmed emissary, selected notably for their high Charisma. Unlike the treatment of their typical minions, beholders ensure their emissaries

receive far superior consideration, providing them with the finest accommodations available within their dominion and allowing them to accumulate considerable personal wealth and luxuries. This practice stems from the recognition that, among all their underlings, emissaries stand the highest risk of being identified and "liberated" by outsiders capable of dispelling the charm effect. Remarkably, even after such an intervention, many emissaries continue to demonstrate loyalty to their beholder, a lasting effect of their favorable circumstances. Beholders limit themselves to a singular emissary, as the notion of regarding another being as nearly an equal proved to be an arduous concept. Representative emissaries encompass bards, ogre mages, sorcerers, and wizards.

**Spies:** Performing a role distinct yet parallel to that of collectors, surveillants are not dispatched to retrieve individuals or items but exclusively to monitor the vicinity surrounding the beholder's stronghold. Typically, a surveillant completes their reconnaissance mission within a week, ensuring their return to the lair occurs promptly before the effects of the charm monster ability dissipate, thereby enabling them to report their observations. Examples of surveillants include cloakers, kobolds, mephits, rangers, rogues, and water nagas.

## Spoils

While beholders are endoskeletal creatures, their skeletal structure essentially comprises a substantial skull, the composition of which diverges significantly from conventional bone. Rather, this material exhibits such a close resemblance to the creature's hide that the transition between skin and skull is indiscernible. Characterized by its hardness, rigidity, and extraordinary lightness, the material is highly porous—capable of absorbing a cup of water within seconds—yet maintains a rigidity and strength comparable to that of iron. However, upon the beholder's demise, this material rapidly becomes fragile. Some alchemists have successfully formulated processes to preserve the structural integrity of the bone postmortem. Nonetheless, given its relative strength to iron and the peril associated with its procurement, artifacts fashioned from beholder bone are regarded more as oddities than practical armaments or armors.

When designing untreated beholder bone armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid #3-52*, use the following statistics: WM 0.9; Cost \$30, DR/inch 8, Max DR 4, Semi-Ablative, Construction: scale, solid. Untreated beholder bone weapons are treated as normal bone weapons (p. LT71) but have full cost.

For alchemically treated beholder bone armor, use the following statistics: WM 0.6; Cost \$120, DR/inch

50, Max DR 12, Construction: plate, scale, solid. Alchemically treated beholder bone weapons are treated as cheap steel weapons but have +3 CF. The alchemical treatment process takes 3 days per pound of beholder bone, requires an Alchemy-2 roll and \$7 in alchemical ingredients.

When designing beholder leather armor, use the following statistics: WM 0.6; Cost \$80, DR/inch 65, Max DR 12, Construction: plate, scale, solid.

The central eye of the beholder can be used as 5 EP when enchanting *rods of cancellation*.

Each eyestalk eye counts as \$50 of ingredients for *potions of flight*.

Beholder meat is inedible to anyone without Universal Digestion. Anyone else who dares eat beholder flesh must make a roll against HT-3 or suffer 1d-1 toxic damage with an onset of 1 minute.

## Capturing and Training

A captured beholder will not serve any master regardless of the circumstances, and hence is not useful as a slave. The values below are given just in case you still need to figure out the cost for a magically-controlled beholder.

**Untrained Value:** \$175,000.

**Trained Value:** \$1,750,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$2 and 3 lbs./day. Alternatively, the beholder may subsist on any nontoxic organic matter it may find for free.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 1.823.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$52,500.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 20 Beholders

*Battle Rating:* 36.5

*Classes:* Air, (Arm), Eng.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 4/16 (air).

*Supply (Weekly):* \$2,400.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$1,050,200.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$1,059,800.

## Racial Template

528 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+15 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%; Size Modifier, -30%) [45]; IQ+3 [60]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+3; HP+6 (Size Modifier, -30%) [9]; Will+2 [10]; Per-3 [-15]; Basic Speed +0.25 [5]; Basic Move -4 [-20].

**Advantages:** 360° Vision (Easy to Hit, -20%) [20]; Acute Vision 5 [10]; DR 5 [25]; Compartmentalized Mind 1 (Mental Separation Only, -80%) [10]; Enhanced Tracking 2 [10]; ER 10 (Magic) [30]; Extended Lifespan 0.5 [1]; Flight (Slow, -25%) [30];

Infravision [10]; Injury Tolerance (No Head (still has a brain), No Neck) [7]; Nictitating Membrane 3 [3]; Nictitating Membrane 3 (No bonus to HT against eye damage or vision underwater, -50%) [2]; Reduced Consumption 2 [4]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Temperature Tolerance 2 (Cold) [2]; Universal Digestion [5].

*Antimagic Cone* [136]: Static (Magic; Area of Effect, 16 yards, +250%; Directional, Front, -20%; Temporary Disadvantage, No Limited Nictitating Membrane 3, -2%; Reduced Time 1, +20%; Switchable, +100%) [135] + Rules Exemption (Anti-magic Static can coexist with magical abilities) [1].

*Tongue:* Not Numb (Biological (Passive), -5%; Tongue Only, -60%) [7].

*Eye Rays* [316]:

[Eye Ray: Charm](#) (Nuisance Effect, Eyestalk-based, -5%) [53];

[Eye Ray: Death](#) (Nuisance Effect, Eyestalk-based, -5%) [26];

[Eye Ray: Disintegrate](#) (Nuisance Effect, Eyestalk-based, -5%) [40];

[Eye Ray: Fear](#) (Nuisance Effect, Eyestalk-based, -5%) [27];

[Eye Ray: Flesh to Stone](#) (Nuisance Effect, Eyestalk-based, -5%) [45];

[Eye Ray: Inflict Wounds 4](#) (Nuisance Effect, Eyestalk-based, -5%) [16];

[Eye Ray: Sleep](#) (Nuisance Effect, Eyestalk-based, -5%) [36];

[Eye Ray: Slow](#) (Nuisance Effect, Eyestalk-based, -5%) [27];

[Eye Ray: Telekinesis 15](#) (No FP Cost, +5%; Nuisance Effect, Eyestalk-based, -5%) [46].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous) [-20]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (9) [-15]; Callous [-5]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Greed (12) [-15]; Intolerance (Total) [-10]; Loner (6) [-10]; No Manipulators [-50]; No Sense of Smell/Taste (Taste Only, -50%) [-2]; Numb [-20]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Paranoia [-10]; Sadism (9) [-22]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15].

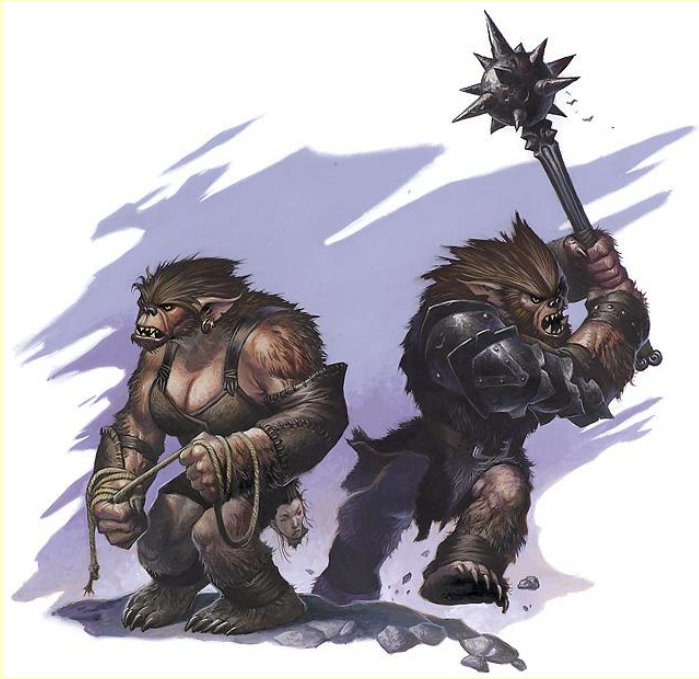
**Perks:** Alcohol Tolerance [1].

**Quirks:** Likes alcohol [-1]; Likes colorful food [-1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 3.5; No Legs (Aerial).

# Bugbear

*Type: Humanoid (Bugbear, Goblinoid)*



**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 300 lbs.

**Height:** 7 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary, rout (2-4), or cete (5-36); a quarter is hunters, rest is warriors. 25% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E, C (cete).

Bugbears, the largest and most aggressive goblinoids, hunt creatures weaker than themselves. Their appearances feature yellowish hides and coarse hair, with green-white eyes and wedge-shaped ears. Their resemblance to bears in their noses and claws earns them their name, although their claws are not weaponized. Instead, they use makeshift, often poorly maintained armor and weapons.

## Mentality

Known for being dim-witted and brutish, bugbears have tempers easily provoked into rages. They primarily seek food and treasure, regarding intruders as sources for both. Greed drives them to collect anything shiny through theft and ambush, negotiating rarely due to their impatience.

**Typical Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Greed (12).

## Ecology

**Diet:** Carnivorous, bugbears eat whatever meat they can hunt or raid, even resorting to consuming their own kind or other monsters.

**Habitat:** Bugbears adapt well to diverse environments, thriving in both wilderness and urban areas as long as they have a steady food supply and a subterranean lair. They may inhabit buildings temporarily but prefer underground locations where temperatures range between 35° and 90°. In the wild, bugbears seek unprotected areas with abundant fauna and opportunities for looting, favoring isolated caravan trails for ambushes. They frequently relocate to avoid enemies and maintain resources, guided by scouts looking for new lair sites. Migrating bugbears are hazardous, often attacking nearby threats. Sometimes, goblins trail behind to scavenge leftover plunder, although bugbears may return for it.

In cities, bugbears often establish lairs in caves or abandoned sewer systems, balancing the risk of discovery with access to food and burglary opportunities. They use their strength to dig tunnels for secret city access or exploit natural stealth to move unnoticed. If tunneling is not an option, they may enter through sewers or reside in unused sewers under the city.

Bugbears prefer secure, subterranean homes such as cavern complexes, underground ruins, or sewers, rarely settling above ground. While they can create prosperous but dangerous warrens within cities, they are usually discovered and dealt with by local authorities before growing too large.

**Lifespan:** Bugbears can live up to 80 years, but most find a violent end of their life much earlier.

## Society

Bugbears typically form small groups called routs, consisting of two to four members seeking food or loot. These groups prefer combat over negotiation and attack when confident of victory. If outnumbered, they maintain a cautious distance. Larger communities, known as cetes, consist of up to twenty males, thirty females, and a similar number of children. Females and children typically avoid combat and use escape routes when threatened.

Driven by hunger and greed, young males frequently patrol their territory at night. These routs are often aggressive but can sometimes be bribed for safe passage. Adventurers are viewed as valuable but risky targets. Some routs, known as colonial routs, form when bugbears leave overcrowded cetes to establish new lairs. These groups may initially negotiate with adventurers but will flee if attacked and remember their foes.

Adventurers encountering routs should act swiftly to prevent any survivors from alerting nearby cetes. Bugbears are adept at ambushes, often catching targets by surprise and ending confrontations swiftly.

**Cetes:** Unlike the mobile routs, a cete of bugbears remains in one area until local resources are depleted.

or they are forced to move by enemies. They are most dangerous in their lairs. A typical cete includes up to twenty mature males led by a khan, with females often in smaller numbers due to their higher mortality rate during invasions. Each adult usually corresponds to one bugbear child cared for communally, as there are no family units and children are raised by the closest available female.

Bugbears lack genuine bonds, with loyalty driven by survival needs, making the cete their sole "family." Khans monitor male rivals closely to protect their leadership, sometimes sending potential threats away to form colonial routs. These splinter groups are expected to establish new cetes far from their original territory to avoid deadly conflicts with their former community.

**Lairs:** Bugbears quickly modify any secure area they choose as a lair. Their first task is to dig extensive escape tunnels for survival, making it hard to besiege them. These escape routes interconnect rooms, providing bugbears with mobility and confusing intruders. Small, crawl-sized tunnels allow them to maneuver around foes.

Traps are a key part of their defense, using primitive tech. Escape tunnels may have deadfalls, and passages often include pit traps. Surface traps are only set in isolated areas to avoid exposing their warren near civilized zones.

Bugbears often keep dire rats as pets and guards. These rats, fed well by the bugbears, roam the lair and alert them by causing a commotion upon sensing intruders, though the bugbear females try to keep the rats away from infants.

**Dark Rangers:** Dark rangers play a crucial role in bugbear society, being the only ones focused on the future. Unlike their kin who stay near the warren, these stealthy individuals venture far to find new homes and hunting grounds. Gifted by Hruggek, they serve as both scouts and assassins, tasked with locating new warrens and eliminating threats to the cete. Their devotion to Hruggek helps them endure solitude and remain fanatically loyal to their race.

Dark rangers see adventurers and armed forces as threats and will either drive them away or kill them. They are adept at ambushes and using poison, making them formidable opponents.

**Religion:** The bugbear pantheon includes Hruggek, the chief god of ambush and combat; Grankhul, the god of hunting and swift death; and Skiggaret, their fearsome bogeyman deity. Stalker, even though not fully part of the bugbear pantheon, is venerated by these creatures.

**Relations with Other Races:** Bugbears have little patience for outsiders, feeling contempt for weaker races and fearful resentment towards stronger ones. They bluntly exploit the weak and are

straightforward with strangers, though stealthy enough to ambush. They might temporarily ally with those showing strength but prefer short, violent tasks as mercenaries.

Bugbears swiftly avoid confrontations they can't win, considering it survival strategy rather than cowardice. They may later plan ambushes, so adventurers should be wary of their retreats.

## Spoils

Bugbear hide is tough enough to be used as material for leather armor.

## Racial Template

5 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+6 (Size Modifier, -10%) [54]; IQ-1 [-20]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM+1; HP-1 [-2]; Per+3 [15]; Basic Move +1 [5].

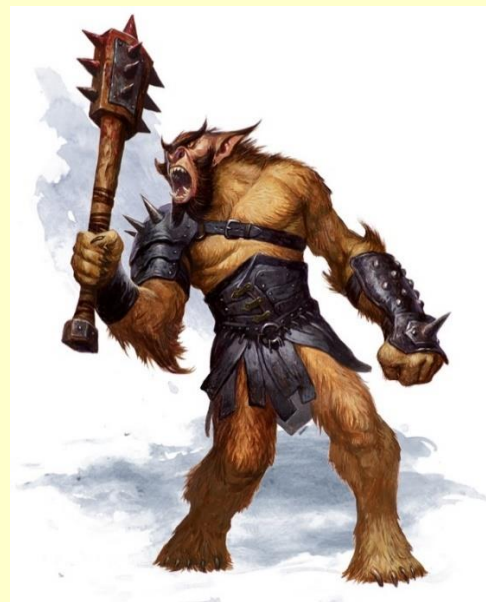
**Advantages:** DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Fangs [2]; Infravision [10]; Silence 1 [5].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Ugly) [-8]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (12) [-10]; Greed (12) [-15]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10].

**Perks:** Fur [1].

## Bugbear Warrior

Type: Humanoid (Bugbear, Goblinoid)



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 16 | <b>HP</b> | 15   | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+1/2d+2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | 11   | <b>BL</b>     | 51 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+1/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 300 lb.

**Height:** 7 ft.**Effective Height:** 9 ft.**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).**Treasure Type:** -.

Bugbear warriors receive only the most basic weapon training.

**Movement and Encumbrance****Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 51 | 102   | 153    | 306   | 510         |

**Defenses and Vulnerabilities****DR:** 1\* (tough skin).**Dodge:** 9.**Parry:** 9U (small mace); 9 (javelin); 9 (brawling); 10 (wrestling).**Immunities:** Sunburn.**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.**Combat**

Bugbears prefer to attack from an ambush, if possible. Hunting parties usually send scouts ahead of the main group. Bugbear attacks are coordinated, and their tactics are sound.

**SM+1 Small Mace (10):** swing 3d+1 crushing (RS: 2d+2), Reach 1, unbalanced, 6.75 lbs.**SM+1 Javelin throw (10):** thrust 2d-1 impaling, Acc 3, x1.5/x2.5 (24/40), 4.5 lbs., Bulk -4.**SM+1 Javelin thrust (10):** thrust 2d-1 impaling, Reach 1, 4.5 lbs.**Punch (10):** thrust 1d crushing, Reach C-1.**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d+2 control, Reach C-1.**Fangs (10):** thrust 1d impaling, Reach C. If the attack hits, the bugbear may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+1 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d-1 control against larger ones.**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.55 lbs.**Effective Slam Weight:** 25.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 2                           | 9                           | 18               | 27                          | 36                        |

**Senses**

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 12  | 12     | 12      | 12          | 12    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the bugbear can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).**Mentality**

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 9    |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Greed (12).**Other Traits**

Silence 1.

**Skills**

Axe/Mace-10; Brawling-10; Spear-10; Stealth-13\*; Throwing Weapon (Spear)-10; Wrestling-12.

\* Includes a +1 from Silence. Add an extra +1 if staying still.

**Capturing and Training**

Bugbears often work in hunting parties and may even serve as soldiers in armies of hobgoblins and other goblinoids.

**Young Value:** \$340.**Untrained Value:** \$1,690.**Trained Value:** \$16,900.**Supply Cost:** \$18 and 6.8 lbs./day.**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.018**Wage (Monthly):** \$500**Mass Combat Statistics****60 Bugbear Warriors***Battle Rating:* 1*Classes:* Recon.*Features:* Night.*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96*Supply (Weekly):* \$9,600.*Wage (Monthly):* \$30,500.*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$68,900.

## Bugbear Hunter

Type: Humanoid (Bugbear, Goblinoid)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 16 | <b>HP</b> | 15 | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+1/2d+2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | 11 | <b>BL</b>     | 51 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+1/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 300 lb.

**Height:** 7 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Treasure Type:** -.

Bugbear hunters are adept ranged combatants and ambushers.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 51 | 102   | 153    | 306   | 510         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin). A typical bugbear hunter wears layered light leather armor that provides DR 2\* to the torso (\$270, 33.75 lbs., Don 20, Holdout -1).

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 9U (small mace); 10 (javelin); 9 (brawling); 10 (wrestling).

**Immunities:** Sunburn.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

### Combat

Bugbears prefer to attack from an ambush, if possible. Hunters also set traps to catch unwary prey or defend their lair. A bugbear hunter usually carries two

javelins to remain unencumbered (total encumbrance 49.5 lbs.).

**SM+1 Small Mace (10):** swing 3d+1 crushing (RS: 2d+2), Reach 1, unbalanced, 6.75 lbs.

**SM+1 Javelin throw (14):** thrust 2d-1 impaling, Acc 3, x1.5/x2.5 (24/40), 4.5 lbs., Bulk -4.

**SM+1 Javelin thrust (12):** thrust 2d-1 impaling, Reach 1, 4.5 lbs.

**Punch (10):** thrust 1d crushing, Reach C-1.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d+2 control, Reach C-1.

**Fangs (10):** thrust 1d impaling, Reach C. If the attack hits, the bugbear may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+1 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d-1 control against larger ones.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.55 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 25.5 lbs.

### Control Thresholds

| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| 2                           | 9                           | 18               | 27                          | 36                        |

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 13  | 13     | 13      | 13          | 13    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the bugbear can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Greed (12).

### Other Traits

Silence 1.

### Skills

Axe/Mace-10; Brawling-10; Camouflage-14; Spear-12; Stealth-14\*; Survival (Mountains)-13; Throwing Weapon (Spear)-14; Traps-14; Wrestling-12.

\* Includes a +1 from Silence. Add an extra +1 if staying still.

### Capturing and Training

Bugbears often work in hunting parties and may even serve as soldiers in armies of hobgoblins and other goblinoids.

**Trained Value:** \$19,250.

**Supply Cost:** \$18 and 6.8 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.02

**Wage (Monthly):** \$580

## **Mass Combat Statistics**

### **60 Bugbear Hunters**

*Battle Rating:* 1

*Classes:* Recon.

*Features:* Night, Terrain (Mountains).

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$9,600.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$34,600.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$73,000.

# Choker, Cavern

Type: Aberration (Choker)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |           |
|----|----|----|----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 7  | HP | 7  | SM     | -1        |
| DX | 11 | BS | 9  | thr/sw | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| HT | 12 | FP | 12 | BL     | 9.8 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-3/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 35 lbs.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 3 ft. when horizontal and 4.5 ft. when upright.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 10% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A.

Countless creatures inhabit the Underdark, including the drow, duergar, and illithids, who establish impressive cities in the subterranean realm. However, the majority are mindless beasts or barely sentient savages lurking in the darkness for their next meal.

Among them is the vicious choker, a small aberration known for how it kills its prey. This elusive predator is a dangerous part of the Underdark ecosystem, striking suddenly from the shadows. Though not particularly strong, its stealth makes it challenging to detect when it hides.

Chokers resemble halflings with spotted gray or brown, rubbery skin. They have a humanoid torso, but their arms and legs are long and thin, resembling tentacles. Their arms can extend up to 5 feet, and if fully stretched, they can stand about 6 feet tall. Their hands, starfish-shaped with a spiny surface, allow them to grip walls and ceilings while inflicting injuries.

There is debate regarding the choker's skeleton—some claim it is bony, while others argue it is cartilaginous. Nonetheless, scholars agree that their limbs are multi-jointed and move fluidly.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 8; exploration 4 miles per hour.

Typically, the choker moves on all four limbs, but it is able to awkwardly walk upright with Move 4. While upright, the choker can use both forearms to attack and parry. Its effective height for the purpose of combat modifiers becomes 4.5 ft. Chokers with DX 12 or more can carry a small object or two while walking.

The choker can **move and fight unimpeded on uneven surfaces**.

**Clinging:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour. The choker can walk on walls and ceilings as per Clinging (p. B43).

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 9.8 | 19.6  | 29.4   | 58.8  | 98          |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 13.

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

## Combat

As stealthy, solitary hunters, chokers feed on kills and carrion left by larger predators. They strangle prey by ambushing from concealment, bravely attacking creatures up to four times their size. Preferring to target solitary victims, they may also pick off stragglers from groups when desperate.

**Claws (14):** thrust 1d-3 cutting. Reach C or C-1 when the arms are fully stretched out.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C or C-1 when the arms are fully stretched out. The choker can actively constrict grappled victims, attacking them each turn with a Constriction Attack (p. B43). Effective ST 9 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.49 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 4.9 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 5                    | 9         | 14                   | 18                 |

## Special Abilities

**Double-Jointed:** Notably flexible, chokers get +5 on Climbing, Erotic Art, and Escape rolls, and can ignore up to -5 penalties for working in close quarters.

**Flexible Arms:** The choker's arms are extra-flexible. They can always reach and work with other limbs, regardless of body positioning, general layout, or "right" and "left." In addition, the choker may stretch them out, increasing their effective SM by 1 per second, up to the maximum of SM+1. Decreasing the length of arms back to their natural state also takes 1 second per SM. When fully stretched, the arms of the choker's let it attack and grapple at Reach 1, but are attacked at +2. This does *not* increase the general SM of the choker.

**Good Grip:** The cartilaginous protrusions on the choker's palms are excellent gripping surfaces. The choker has +4 with tasks that require a firm grip, including climbing and grappling.

**Slipperiness:** The choker has +1 on all ST, DX, and Escape rolls to slip restraints, break free in close combat, or squeeze through narrow openings. If using FDG, this gives Control DR 1 and +1 to DX when attacking to break free of an existing grapple.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the choker can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 7  | 10   |

Chokers are attracted to bright objects like coins, gems, and jewelry. While generally lacking diplomacy and intelligence, they may engage in basic trade if approached cautiously, offering services as guides in exchange for valuables. If initial negotiations fail, they retreat and refuse further communication.

Chokers live and hunt alone, considering other creatures, even their kind, as prey.

**Mentality Traits:** Callous; Cowardice (12); Gluttony (12); Greed (12); Loner (12).

## Skills

Brawling-14; Stealth-15; Survival (Underdark)-14; Wrestling-14.

## Techniques

Choke Hold-14.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Night.

**Diet:** Lacking empathy, they use their strong hands to tenderize their prey before consumption. Although they endure hunger, surviving up to a month without meat, they grow irritable and take risks to find food. They subsist on lichens, moss, and fungi in desperate times, requiring minimal water (about 6 ounces per day), mainly hydrated by their victims' blood.

**Habitat:** Cavern chokers dwell underground, thriving in temperatures between 35° and 90°F.

**Lairs:** Chokers inhabit twisting caves that are hard for others to navigate, leaving bones and pulp remnants behind. They are wise enough to hide their food stash to avoid attracting predators, often lurking near settlements to scavenge and ambush. Treasures are hidden among debris and bones, with shiny objects occasionally brought out to admire. Their lairs are ideally located near prey sources and designed with discreet entrances and multiple escape routes.

**Lifecycle:** Chokers are solitary creatures, intolerant of others, even their own kind, in their territory. Every two years, females release a pungent scent that attracts males, leading to brief and violent mating contests. After a gestation of about six months, females give birth to 2 to 4 young, which they raise for a year before abandoning them in a warren at the edge of their territory. These aggressive juveniles strive to carve out their own turf, fighting others in the darkness. Chokers mature at 2 years and typically live for about 20 years, though some in captivity can reach 40.

**Origins:** Chokers are a relatively recent addition to the Underdark. Their population appears to be growing each year, though the reason remains unclear. One theory suggests that they evolved from gnomes who descended into the darkness, mutating possibly due to cannibalism and Underdark magic, a claim gnomes vehemently deny. Some speculate a similar origin involving halflings, which is also widely rejected. A more plausible explanation is that chokers resulted from failed experimentation, possibly linked to the drow, though drow insist these creatures now pose as much of a threat to them as to others. Chokers often gather near drow settlements, hinting at a

possible connection to their past. Despite their origins, chokers show little interest in their history; they are primarily focused on finding food and collecting shiny objects.

### Spoils

Chokers themselves do not offer valuable parts, but their lairs may contain gems, coins, and trinkets looted from their prey.

### Capturing and Training

Most Underdark inhabitants view chokers as nuisances, with races like drow, duergar, and illithids actively hunting them. While some attempt to capture and train chokers as guardians or trackers, these efforts often fail. Successful training can yield loyal servants, provided they receive enough live meat, but their elastic bodies require solid-walled enclosures for imprisonment, complicating the process and increasing costs.

**Young Value:** \$35.

**Untrained Value:** \$175.

**Trained Value:** \$1,750.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.0006 and 0.003 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.002

**Wage (Monthly):** \$50

### Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Cavern Chokers**

*Battle Rating:* 0.2

*Classes:* Recon.

*Features:* Night, Terrain (Underground).

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 32/128

*Supply (Weekly):* \$30.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$6,320.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$6,440.

### Racial Template

73 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-3 [-30]; DX+1 [20]; IQ-3 [-60]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-1; Basic Speed +3.25 [65]; Basic Move -1 [-5]; Will+3 [15]; Per+3 [15].

**Advantages:** Clinging [20]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Constriction Attack [15]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Double-Jointed [15]; Extra-Flexible Arms [10]; Good Grip 2 [10]; Infravision [10]; Reduced Consumption 3 [6]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Claws [5]; Slippery 1 [2]; Stretching 2 (Limited, Arms Only, -20%) [10]; Terrain Adaptation (Uneven) [5].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Ugly) [-8]; Callous [-5]; Cowardice (12) [-10]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Greed (12)

[-15]; Loner (12) [-5]; Odious Personal Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Semi-Upright [-5]; Short Lifespan 1 [-10]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15].

**Quirks:** Likes shiny things [-1]; Prefers meat to other food [-1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 2.

## Choker, Feygrove

*Type:* Aberration (Choker)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 12 | <b>HP</b> | 10 | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 9  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-1/1d+2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12 | <b>BL</b>     | 29 lbs.   |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-1/1d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 130 lbs.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft. when horizontal and 6 ft. when upright.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 10% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A.

Feygrove chokers are a larger subspecies of chokers native to the Feywild where they menace noble eladrin cities and the sprawling tunnels of fomorian domains in the Feydark.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 9; exploration 4.5 miles per hour.

Typically, the choker moves on all four limbs, but it is able to awkwardly walk upright with Move 5. While upright, the choker can use both forearms to attack and parry. Its effective height for the purpose of combat modifiers becomes 6 ft. Chokers with DX 12 or more can carry a small object or two while walking.

The choker can **move and fight unimpeded on uneven surfaces**.

**Clinging:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

The choker can walk on walls and ceilings as per Clinging (p. B43).

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 29 | 58    | 87     | 174   | 290         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 13.

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

## Combat

Feygrove chokers are much more dangerous than cavern chokers due to their increased strength, size, and camouflage ability.

**Claws (14):** thrust 1d-1 cutting. Reach C or C-1 when the arms are fully stretched out.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d+1 control. Reach C or C-1 when the arms are fully stretched out. The choker can actively constrict grappled victims, attacking them each turn with a Constriction Attack (p. B43). Effective ST 14 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.45 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 14.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 2                           | 7                           | 14               | 21                          | 28                        |

## Special Abilities

**Camouflage:** A feygrove choker's mottled skin can change color and texture to resemble its surroundings. In any situation where being seen is a factor, the feygrove choker gets +6 to Stealth skill when perfectly still, or +3 if moving. If for some reason the choker is wearing clothes, this bonus is reduced to +3 when the choker is motionless, with no bonus if it is moving. This ability only affects normal vision.

**Double-Jointed:** Notably flexible, chokers get +5 on Climbing, Erotic Art, and Escape rolls, and can ignore up to -5 penalties for working in close quarters.

**Flexible Arms:** The choker's arms are extra-flexible. They can always reach and work with other limbs, regardless of body positioning, general layout, or "right" and "left." In addition, the choker may stretch them out, increasing their effective SM by 1. Decreasing the length of arms back to their natural state also takes 1 second. When fully stretched, the arms of the choker's let it attack and grapple at Reach 1, but are attacked at +1. This does *not* increase the general SM of the choker.

**Good Grip:** The cartilaginous protrusions on the choker's palms are excellent gripping surfaces. The choker has +4 with tasks that require a firm grip, including climbing and grappling.

**Slipperiness:** The choker has +1 on all ST, DX, and Escape rolls to slip restraints, break free in close combat, or squeeze through narrow openings. If using FDG, this gives Control DR 1 and +1 to DX when attacking to break free of an existing grapple.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the feygrove choker can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infra-vision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 7  | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Callous; Cowardice (12); Gluttony (12); Greed (12); Loner (12).

## Skills

Brawling-14; Stealth-15; Survival (Woodlands or Underdark)-14; Wrestling-14.

## Techniques

Choke Hold-14.

## Ecology

**Diet:** A feygrove choker requires only 9 ounces of water per day.

**Habitat:** Feygrove chokers dwell in the forests of the Plane of Faerie and in the Feydark, thriving in temperatures between 35° and 90°F. Feygrove chokers make their homes in the boughs of giant trees, whether in a natural crevice or an arboreal hut built from fallen branches. Like all Feywild creatures, feygrove chokers' native gravity is 0.5G.

## Capturing and Training

Most Feywild denizens consider feygrove chokers a menace to be eradicated, but some fomorians capture and train them as guardians and trackers.

**Young Value:** \$130.

**Untrained Value:** \$660.

**Trained Value:** \$6,600.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.033 and 0.15 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.007

**Wage (Monthly):** \$200

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Feygrove Chokers**

*Battle Rating:* 0.8

*Classes:* Recon.

*Features:* Night, Terrain (Underground).

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 36/144

*Supply (Weekly):* \$30.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$23,700.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$23,820.

## Racial Template

134 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+2 [20]; DX+1 [20]; IQ-3 [-60]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** HP-2 [-4]; Basic Speed +3.25 [65]; Will+3 [15]; Per+3 [15].

**Advantages:** Chameleon 3 [15]; Clinging [20]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Constriction Attack [15]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Double-Jointed [15]; Extra-Flexible Arms [10]; Good Grip 2 [10]; Infravision [10]; Reduced Consumption 3 [6]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Claws [5]; Slippery 1 [2]; Stretching 1 (Limited, Arms Only, -20%) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Uneven) [5].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Ugly) [-8]; Callous [-5]; Cowardice (12) [-10]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Greed (12) [-15]; Loner (12) [-5]; Odious Personal Habit (Eats

sapient beings) [-15]; Semi-Upright [-5]; Short Lifespan 1 [-10]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15].

**Quirks:** Likes shiny things [-1]; Prefers meat to other food [-1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 2; Native gravity 0.5G.

## Demon

Demons originate from the Abyss, an expanse synonymous with perpetual evil and chaos. They embody aggression and often engage in attacks purely for amusement, including against their own kind. This love for eliciting fear in their victims prior to their demise, and typically consuming those they kill, is notable among these beings. Furthermore, many demons revel not only in their own vile behaviors but also in corrupting humans to mirror their depravity.

Despite the vast diversity within these creatures, experts have identified several distinct subgroups among them:

**Elemental Demons:** The substance of the Abyss is in a state of perpetual flux and alteration, a characteristic fitting for a domain ruled by agents of chaos. Occasionally, the intrinsic fabric of this plane spontaneously gives rise to living entities, each possessing a soul that is a composite of remnants from tanar'ri and baatezu souls, fragmented during countless conflicts between these groups. These demons are akin to wild animals found in other realms. Each one manifests the essence of the natural material from which it emerged, whether it be fire from a molten lava pool or ice from a boundless glacier.

**Loumara:** These are the most recently formed type of demons, ethereal entities that come to life by inhabiting living beings or objects, thereby spreading malignancy. It is believed that they emerged from the dreams of gods annihilated by the Abyss.

**Obyriths:** As the most ancient demons, obyriths are primeval beings of chaos and madness, originating from a realm wholly separate from our known universe. They once governed the Abyss for countless ages and are credited with the creation of the tanar'ri. However, their dominance waned following a disastrous conflict and a subsequent uprising by their enslaved subjects, which forced many into seclusion or wiped them out entirely.

**Tanar'ri:** Currently the predominant and most populous demonic faction ruling the Abyss, the tanar'ri materialize directly from the Abyss itself, with some exhibiting modifications attributed to the sibriexes or similar entities. These demons typically arise when evil mortal souls make their way into the Abyss.

### Ecology

**Aging and Death:** Demons are ageless and immune to natural death. When a demon dies outside the Abyss, its body dissolves, and its essence returns and potentially reforms into a new, though possibly lesser, demon. When this happens, roll 3d; on a 18, the demon reforms as a shadow demon. This reincarnation usually results in a demotion within the

demonic hierarchy, seen as punishment for their failure. Conversely, if a demon is killed on its home turf within the Abyss, it is permanently destroyed.

Magical summoning provides an exception; demons summoned to another plane and killed return unharmed to the Abyss once the spell concludes, effectively escaping any consequences.

**Diet:** While demons don't need sustenance, they can consume infinite amounts of food, often indulging in the act to enjoy sacrifices or simply engage in destructive behavior. Unlike biological beings, the consumed food either disappears or is expelled for amusement, supporting their penchant for environmental corruption. The disposition of this food remains a mystery, with theories suggesting a mystical transfer to the Abyss, though unproven.

**Formation and Promotion:** Many religious beliefs suggest that evil souls are sent to the Abyss, the Nine Hells, or similar planes after death to suffer perpetually under dark powers, and some may even transform into demons or devils. The sources vary on these processes: the *Black Scrolls of Ahm* indicate that demonic reincarnations from human souls are rare, reserved for those making pacts with entities like Demogorgon or Orcus. In contrast, the *Demonomicon of Iggwilv* lists historical villains who allegedly became demons.

Scholarly texts generally agree that demons originate from the chaos of the Abyss, starting as lower fiends and potentially ascending in the demonic hierarchy, which is described as more cyclic than linear according to Ahm, rather than a strict progression. Demonspawn exist in a state of fear and desperation, serving higher demons and demon princes, with the potential risk of demotion for failing or being too threatening.

Ultimately, the structure of demonic ranks is believed to be chaotic and power-based, reflecting the inherent nature of the Abyss itself.

**Reproduction:** While some demons can engage in sexual activities—primarily to produce half-fiends—it is not essential for their reproduction. Demons generally manifest directly from the Abyssal chaos, bypassing traditional forms of procreation.

**Sleep:** Demons do not need sleep but can be forced into a sleeplike state or rendered unconscious. Some may feign sleep for deceptive reasons, although it offers them no benefit.

### Mentality

Demons epitomize cruelty and savagery, devoid of compassion, empathy, and driven by malice. Their nature is to propagate chaos and evil, always striving to escape the Abyss to unleash havoc across the cosmos. Although rooted in destruction, their motivations can be complex; they prefer extending

suffering before achieving the final act of destruction. Their urge to destroy is occasionally tempered when it serves their interest in gaining power. Demons are solitary and self-centered, respecting only power and displaying erratic behavior, often betraying or consuming their own allies unpredictably. Despite this, they might reward loyalty disproportionately if it serves their purpose.

Demons view themselves as supreme beings, destined to dominate or even reshape reality. Their sense of supremacy and goals vary with their power and intelligence, ranging from causing simple havoc to orchestrating grand schemes of despair and destruction across the multiverse.

Demons inherently harbor an impulse to destroy, an urge intensified by the Abyss's semi-sentient influence, which seduces them with promises of power and dominion. These instincts translate into their behavior, which is generally unstrategic, impulsive, and poorly aligned with long-term goals. Less capable of subtlety and restraint, demons often prioritize immediate gratification – opting for swift chaos over calculated manipulation. While they can execute manipulative strategies effectively, their plans are frequently marred by their impulsiveness and inclination towards wanton violence.

Demons, though primarily selfish and chaotic, can exhibit varying degrees of intelligence and social skills. They are not inherently foolish; many demonstrate considerable mental competence, especially those adept at manipulation. Some may even collaborate with others, including non-demons, driven by overlapping interests or sheer amusement. Their unpredictability and willingness to withdraw from conflicts not out of cowardice but for strategic deception or entertainment, embody their most menacing trait. Despite their apparent narcissism and aggression, demons can occasionally display insecurities, cleverly masked by their outward rage.

## **Society**

**Language:** Demons of all kinds speak Abyssal among themselves and other inhabitants of the Abyss, but many of them possess telepathic abilities that let them communicate with others mentally.

## Demon, Evistro

Type: Outsider (Chaotic, Demon, Evil)



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |     |        |         |
|----|----|----|-----|--------|---------|
| ST | 18 | HP | 18  | SM     | +0      |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5.5 | thr/sw | 1d+2/3d |
| HT | 12 | FP | 12  | BL     | 65 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d+2/2d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 300 lbs.

**Height:** 5 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-16. 5% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** H.

Evistros, or carnage demons, epitomize destruction, taking pleasure in chaos and devastation. These demons, appearing humanoid yet apelike with their long arms and tree trunk-like forearms, feature disproportionately small heads and a predominantly fanged mouth. Their skin shades vary from crimson to dark red-brown.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 65 | 130   | 195    | 390   | 650         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin), 20 (vs. electricity).

**Dodge:** 9.

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Electrical conduction, noxious electrical effects, poison.

**Resistances:** +3 to all HT rolls to avoid knockdown, stunning, and torture.

**Vulnerabilities:** The evistro takes x2 injury from holy and silver weapons.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; High Pain Threshold.

**Notes:** The evistro's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +1 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

### Combat

Even alone, an evistro is formidable, though it may retreat if its health is halved, unless it becomes berserk. Carnage demons typically fight in groups, driven by fury rather than tactics, attacking those who most recently harmed them, including their own kind when berserk.

Against armed opponents who may damage the evistro on a successful parry, the evistro prefers to use the Hammer Fist (p. MA73) technique.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 1d+2 cutting, Reach C.

**Hammer Fist (14):** thrust 1d+1 crushing, Reach C. If *Hurting Yourself* (p. B379) would apply, damage is 1/10 of what the evistro rolls, not 1/5. Furthermore, it suffers a point less damage if its hand is parried aggressively or with a weapon, or otherwise stopped painfully.

**Sharp Teeth (14):** thrust 1d+2 cutting, Reach C. If the attack hits, the evistro may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d-1 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d+1 control against larger ones.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 2d-1 control. Reach C. Effective ST 20 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 3.25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 32.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 10                   | 20        | 30                   | 40                 |

### Special Abilities

**Anarchic Touch:** A carnage demon's natural attacks are treated as chaotic for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

**Battle Rage:** When the evistro first enters combat or it suffers damage over ¼ of its HP in the space of one second, it must make a self-control roll against 6 or go berserk (p. B124). Alternatively, the evistro may deliberately go berserk by taking a Concentrate maneuver and making a successful Will (10) roll.

**Unholy Touch:** A carnage demon's natural attacks are treated as unholy for the purpose of such

disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furies*, p. 17).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the evistro can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 10   |

Functioning as the brutes among lesser demons, carnage demons embody rampant chaos. Unlike aimless dretches, they have a singular focus on brutal destruction. While similar in strength to dretches, carnage demons' aggressive nature makes them potent forces in demonic armies, often deployed as shock troops to instill fear and confusion.

**Mentality Traits:** Bloodlust (9).

## Skills

Brawling-14; Climbing-14; Intimidation-12; Wrestling-14.

## Techniques

Hammer Fist-14.

## Other Traits

Ham-Fisted 1.

## Ecology

Native to the Infinite Layers of the Abyss, carnage demons seek portals to spread their havoc indiscriminately across realms. Some theories propose that carnage demons evolved from dretches by demonic lords seeking more effective minions, indicated by their non-tanar'ri nature and vulnerability to silver — possibly hinting at devilish origins.

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Society:** Lacking the intellect for social structure, carnage demons often follow the lead of more cunning demons like adarus or succubi. In the throes of lower plane wars, they are strategically unleashed after dretches, magnifying the terror and disarray among enemy ranks.

## Spoils

When slain outside the Abyss, the body of the demon dissipates, leaving no “natural” spoils.

## Capturing and Training

The values here are given for summoners and other beings who may control evistros.

**Untrained Value:** \$2,300.

**Trained Value:** \$22,980.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.024

**Wage (Monthly):** \$690

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Evistros**

*Battle Rating:* 3

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Impetuous, Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$82,730.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$82,730.

## Racial Template

146 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+8 [80]; IQ-2 [-40]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Will+2 [10]; Per+2 [10].

**Advantages:** Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep (No immunity against sleep effects, -20%) [16]; High Pain Threshold [10]; Immunity to Poison [15]; Infravision [10]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Unaging [15].

*Electricity Resistance* [65]: DR 20 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Electricity, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [50] + Immunity to Electrical Conduction [5] + Immunity to Noxious Electrical Effects [10].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Berserk (6) (Battle Rage, +50%) [-30]; Bloodlust (9) [-15]; Ham-Fisted 1 [-5]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Silver, x2) [-10]; Vulnerability (Holy Weapons, x2) [-10].

**Perks:** Anarchic Touch [1]; Unholy Touch [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 1.

## Demon, Jovoc

Type: Outsider (Chaotic, Demon, Evil, Tanar'ri)



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |         |
|----|----|----|----|--------|---------|
| ST | 10 | HP | 8  | SM     | -1      |
| DX | 12 | BS | 6  | thr/sw | 1d-2/1d |
| HT | 12 | FP | 12 | BL     | 20 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 90 lbs.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-4. 5% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A.

These malicious, dark-souled creatures are designed to sow discord. Their ability to pass on received damage to others makes them highly valuable in the vanguard of the tanar'ri armies. A group of jovocs can endure multiple assaults and spells from adversaries and still manage to deliver devastating retribution.

A jovoc appears as a 4-foot-tall, bloated, hairless humanoid, resembling a gnome's bruised and decaying corpse left rotting in the heat of summer. Its foul odor (-2 reaction) supports this visual, with rough skin that is dark blue or black in color. It has vacant, black eyes and long arms ending in three-fingered hands with long, blood-stained red fingernails.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 20 | 40    | 60     | 120   | 200         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Poison.

**Resistances:** +3 to all HT rolls to avoid knockdown, stunning, and torture.

**Vulnerabilities:** The jovoc takes x2 injury from holy and silver weapons.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; High Pain Threshold; Magic Resistance 1 (Improved).

**Elemental Resistance:** The jovoc has DR 5 against acid, cold, and fire. This includes internal and eye damage.

### Combat

While jovocs may lack high intelligence, they are nimble and skilled in ambush tactics, using their small stature effectively. Years of training have honed their skills in leveraging their retributive aura and rapid healing capabilities. If they can afford to take time, they may attack, then retreat when injured, only to return after regenerating the wounds.

When fighting in pairs or small groups, jovocs prefer a particular strategy. They position themselves just out of enemy reach, ideally hidden by darkness or an obstruction, and then they start attacking each other. Each hit is guaranteed, dealing damage to themselves and to any within their retributive aura. Sometimes, when the opponent is heavily armored, the jovocs injure themselves, as the retributive aura does not care about DR and deals direct injury.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C.

**Sharp Teeth (14):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the jovoc may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-2 control against SM-4 and smaller victims or 1d-4 control against larger ones.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 1d-2 control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 10 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 5                    | 10        | 15                   | 20                 |

### Special Abilities

**Anarchic Touch:** A jovoc's natural attacks are treated as chaotic for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

**Aura of Retribution:** When the jovoc is struck by an attack that does not ignore DR to deal internal damage (such as most Malediction spells), all non-tanar'ri within 8 yards of the jovoc lose the same amount of HP (up to 4), regardless of their DR or other defensive advantages. This is a magical ability.

**Regeneration:** The jovoc recovers 1 HP per minute.

**Telepathy (8):** The demon possesses a magical ability to send telepathic messages that are understood regardless of the languages known by the receiver. To establish contact requires one second of concentration and an IQ (8) roll modified by *Long-Distance Modifiers* (p. B241). If the demon cannot see or otherwise sense the receiver, he has an additional penalty: -1 for close acquaintances; -3 for casual acquaintances; or -5 for someone met only briefly. After that, no concentration is required. The demon can maintain multiple contacts, but the IQ roll is at a cumulative -1 per contact after the first.

**Unholy Touch:** A jovoc's natural attacks are treated as unholy for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

### Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the jovoc can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 10   |

Just like most demons, the jovocs are cruel, sadistic, and bloodthirsty.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bloodlust (9); Callous; Sadism (12).

### Skills

Brawling-14; Stealth-14.

### Other Traits

Bad Grip 2.

### Ecology

Typically, jovocs are found in small groups of three or four. Intelligent demonic commanders recognize their value, particularly when used in conjunction with ranged and area attacks. Demonic leaders like mariliths often head these groups, maintaining control through threats and torture to keep the jovocs in safe formations. Their capacity to transfer the damage they sustain onto others enables the unit to withstand repeated assaults and still unleash devastating retaliation against the enemy. This makes them extremely valuable at the front lines,

where they frequently volunteer to serve in the vanguards of demonic armies.

When Abyssal hordes march, jovocs serve as scouts and lookouts. Their appearance in the world is commonly seen as a bad omen signaling an impending large-scale invasion.

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

### Spoils

When slain outside the Abyss, the body of the demon dissipates, leaving no "natural" spoils.

### Capturing and Training

The values here are given for summoners and other beings who may control jovocs.

**Untrained Value:** \$10,950.

**Trained Value:** \$109,500.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.114

**Wage (Monthly):** \$3,285

### Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Jovocs**

*Battle Rating:* 12.5

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Impetuous, Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$394,200.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$394,200.

### Racial Template

241 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** DX+2 [40]; IQ-2 [-40]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-1; HP-2 [-4]; Will+2 [10]; Per+2 [10].

**Advantages:** Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep (No immunity against sleep effects, -20%) [16]; High Pain Threshold [10]; Immunity to Poison [15]; Infravision [10]; Magic Resistance 1 (Improved, +150%) [5]; Regeneration (Fast) [50]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Telesend (Magical, -10%; Universal, +50%) [42]; Unaging [15].

*Elemental Resistance (A,C,F):* DR 5 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Acid, Cold, Fire, -30%; Tough Skin, -40%) [15].

*Aura of Retribution:* DR 4 (Accessibility on Reflection, Only affects non-tanar'ri, -5%; Area Effect on Reflection, 8 yards, +150%; Cosmic, Irresistible Attack, +300%; Emanation, -20%; Force Field, +20%; Magical, -10%; Provides no DR, -100%; Reflection, +100%) [107].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bad Grip 2 [-10]; Bad Smell [-10]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bloodlust (9) [-15]; Callous [-5]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Holy Weapons, x2) [-10]; Vulnerability (Silver, x2) [-10].

**Perks:** Anarchic Touch [1]; Unholy Touch [1].

## Demon, Vrock

Type: Outsider (Chaotic, Demon, Evil, Tanar'ri)



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |           |
|----|----|----|----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 19 | HP | 17 | SM     | +1        |
| DX | 12 | BS | 6  | thr/sw | 2d-1/3d+1 |
| HT | 12 | FP | 12 | BL     | 72 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 2d-1/2d

**Body Plan:** Angeloid (*GURPS Template Toolkit* 2: Races, p. 10).

**Weight:** 500 lbs.

**Height:** 8 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-10. 10% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** F x 2.

Vrocks are tanar'ri that resemble vulturine humanoids with a penchant for destruction and a craving for human flesh. Notorious among the denizens of the Abyss for their unreliability and greed, these creatures are often distrusted.

Their bodies are grotesque amalgamations of vultures and humans, twisted and muscular, with sinew-covered long necks and limbs. Their broad wings are dusted with grey feathers and emit a stench of decay, impacting their interactions negatively (-2 reaction). Vrocks' fearsome appearance—with elongated talons and vulture heads—is contrasted by the sharp, predatory intelligence in their eyes.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

**Air:** Move 12; exploration 6 miles per hour. Cannot hover – must move at least at Move 3 when flying. In order to take off or land, the vrock must have an open area with a radius of 3 yards in all directions.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 72 | 144   | 216    | 432   | 720         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2\*. Feathers also help shed water, eliminating up to -2 in penalties for being wet – notably for *Cold* (p. B430).

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Electrical conduction, noxious electrical effects, noxious fire effects, poison, sunburn.

**Vulnerabilities:** The vrock takes x2 injury from holy and cold iron weapons.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; Magic Resistance 2 (Improved).

**Elemental Resistance:** The vrock has DR 10 against electricity and fire. This includes internal and eye damage.

### Combat

Known for their ruthless combat style, vrocks dive into their enemies to inflict maximum damage. They display a dramatic flair in battle, intermittently soaring to strike with their clawed feet. However, their love for combat often drives them into disadvantageous melee confrontations.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 2d cutting. Reach C-1.

**Sharp Beak (14):** thrust 2d large piercing. Reach C. If the attack hits, the vrock may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d-1 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d+2 control against larger ones.

**Wing Buffet (10):** thrust 2d+1 crushing. Reach C-1. When in flight, the vrock must roll DX after attempting a Wing Buffet attack, whether it succeeds or fails. If the DX roll fails, the vrock loses control of its flight. It will continue moving in the same direction and speed it was moving on the last turn before it lost control, until it can make an Aerobatics+2 roll to regain control.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 2d-1 control, Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 3.6 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 36 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 2                           | 10                          | 19               | 29                          | 38                        |

### Special Abilities

**Anarchic Touch:** A vrock's natural attacks are treated as chaotic for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

**Dance of Ruin:** To use this ability, a group of at least three vrock must join hands in a circle, dancing wildly and chanting. At the end of 16 seconds of dancing, a wave of crackling energy flashes outward in a 32-yard radius. Everything (except demons) within the radius take 6d crushing damage. This affects even insubstantial creatures. Stunning, paralyzing, or slaying one of the vrock stops the dance. The dance costs each vrock 2 FP.

**Spores:** Once every 15 seconds, a vrock can emit a 2-yard radius cloud of spores around itself. This requires a Concentrate maneuver and costs 1 FP. The spores work as a contact agent, ignoring unsealed DR and dealing 1 point of toxic damage every 10 seconds for 6 cycles total. At the end of this time, the victim is covered with a tangle of viny growths. The vines are harmless and wither away in 1d/2 days. The spores can be removed with a successful Physician roll (takes 10 seconds). Bless, Neutralize Poison, or Remove Disease kills the spores, as does sprinkling the victim with a vial of holy water.

**Stunning Screech (14):** Once per hour, a vrock can emit a screech that stuns every non-demon creature in a cone-shaped area. Cones use special rules; see *Area and Spreading Attacks* (p. B413). The cone has a maximum width of 5 yards at the maximum range of 10 yards. It is possible to make the cone wider by using the rules from *Cones of Power* (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10). This ability has no 1/2D range. Everyone within must resist with HT; Protected Hearing gives +5, Hard of Hearing gives +4, and those with Deafness are immune.

**Telepathy (10):** The demon possesses a magical ability to send telepathic messages that are understood regardless of the languages known by the receiver. To establish contact requires one second of concentration and an IQ (10) roll modified by *Long-Distance Modifiers* (p. B241). If the demon cannot see or otherwise sense the receiver, he has an additional penalty: -1 for close acquaintances; -3 for casual acquaintances; or -5 for someone met only briefly. After that, no concentration is required. The demon can maintain multiple contacts, but the IQ roll is at a cumulative -1 per contact after the first.

**Unholy Touch:** A vrock's natural attacks are treated as unholy for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

## Useful Combat Rules

Area and Spreading Attacks (p. B413).

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furies*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Cones of Power (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 12  | 12     | 12      | 12          | 12    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the vrock can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

Previously believed loyal only to their kin, vrock are actually prone to betrayal, even among themselves, over trivial treasures. Their erratic nature and desire for more powerful allies lead them to frequently abandon their commitments. Although not highly intelligent, vrock are cunning enough to spot opportunities and potential targets. Offering bribes to vrock generally backfires due to their intense bloodlust and preference for the screams and flesh of their victims over any negotiated deals. Rather than bartering, vrock prefer to eliminate negotiators, seize their assets, and satisfy their brutal impulses.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Greed (12); Sadism (12); Selfish (12).

## Skills

Aerobatics-14; Brawling-14; Innate Attack (Breath)-14.

## Ecology

A group of vrock is called a "murder," and their numbers can range from fewer than eight to squadrons of ten or more during wartime. Vrock are employed for various roles including guards, elite assault units, infiltrators, and covert operatives, despite their tendency to plot against their superiors. Their limited intellect does not typically allow their schemes to succeed, but they are still closely monitored for potential disloyalty.

Vrock excel as bodyguards and enforcers for more powerful and intelligent demons, and they thrive in large-scale battles as aerial assault teams. They attack from above, dropping debris on enemies before swooping into combat.

**History:** Surprisingly, vrock used to be far more reliable. Millennia ago, ancient and more powerful vrock were nearly driven to extinction by the wrath of a demon lord, leading to the rise of the less powerful but more manageable modern vrock.

**Origin:** Created from the sins of hatred and wrath in mortal souls bound to the Abyss, vrock initially develop in an egg-like form. These eggs can be prevented from hatching, but once they do, a fully-formed vrock emerges.

**Relations:** Vrocks have strained relationships with other demons such as chasmes, who see them as rivals, and bulezaus, who compete with them as leading frontline troops. The bulezaus lack the magic and mobility of vrocks but make up for it with relentless aggression. The two ferocious demon types will generally fight upon meeting unless they unite against a common baatezu enemy.

In addition to demons, vrocks also align with demonic cults, evil fey, and wicked giants.

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

## Spoils

When slain outside the Abyss, the body of the demon dissipates, leaving no “natural” spoils.

## Capturing and Training

The values here are given for summoners and other beings who may control vrocks.

**Untrained Value:** \$21,700.

**Trained Value:** \$217,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.226

**Wage (Monthly):** \$6,500

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Vrocks

*Battle Rating:* 27

*Classes:* Air.

*Features:* Impetuous, Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 48/192 (air) or 24/96 (land)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$781,500.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$781,500.

## Racial Template

371 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+9 (Size Modifier, -10%) [81]; DX+1 [20]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; HP-2 [-4]; Per+2 [10].

**Advantages:** Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 2 (Flexible, -20%) [8]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep (No immunity against sleep effects, -20%) [16]; Flight (Cannot Hover, -15%; Winged, -25%) [24]; Immunity to Poison [15]; Infravision [10]; Magic Resistance 2 (Improved, +150%) [10]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Beak [1]; Telesend (Magical, -10%; Universal, +50%) [42]; Unaging [15].

*Elemental Resistance (E,F)* [48]: DR 10 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Electricity, Fire, -35%; Tough Skin, -40%) [28] + Immunity to Electrical Conduction [5] + Immunity to Noxious High-Temperature (Electricity and Fire) Effects [15].

*Stunning Screech:* Affliction 1 (HT; Accessibility, Not on demons, -5%; Cone 5, +100%; Hearing-Based, +150%; Increased 1/2D, 10¢, +15%; Magical, -10%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%; Takes Recharge, 1 hour, -30%) [29].

*Spores:* Toxic Attack 1 point (Area Effect, 2 yards, +50%; Contact Agent, +150%; Costs Fatigue, 1 FP, -5%; Cyclic, 5 10-second intervals, +500%; Emanation, -20%; Takes Recharge, 15 seconds, -20%) [8].

*Dance of Ruin:* Crushing Attack 6d (Accessibility, Only with 2 vrock assistants, -10%; Accessibility, Not on demons, -5%; Area Effect, 32 yards, +250%; Affects Insubstantial, +20%; Costs Fatigue, 2 FP, -10%; Emanation, -20%; Magical, -10%; Takes Extra Time 4, -40%) [83].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Ugly) [-8]; Bad Smell [-10]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Greed (12) [-15]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Selfish (12) [-5]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10]; Vulnerability (Holy Weapons, x2) [-10].

**Perks:** Anarchic Touch [1]; Feathers [1]; Unholy Touch [1].

## Drake, Stone

Type: Dragon (Drake, Earth)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 15 | <b>HP</b> | 15 | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+1/2d+1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12 | <b>BL</b>     | 45 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+1/1d+2

**Body Plan:** Quadruped (p. B553).

**Weight:** 200 lbs.

**Length:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Organization:** Solitary, pair, or family (1–2 and 2–5 offspring). 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A.

A stone drake looks like a gray-scaled reptile the size of a very large dog. Its sleek scales accentuate its speed and strength, and its long claws can easily dig into solid stone.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 8; exploration 4 miles per hour.

**Clinging:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour. The stone drake can walk on walls and ceilings as per Clinging (p. B43).

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 65 | 130   | 195    | 390   | 650         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** The stone drake's gray-scaled hide provides DR 3 and protects against sunburn. A nictitating membrane provides DR 2 to the eyes.

**Dodge:** 10 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Immunities:** Paralysis, sleep, sunburn.

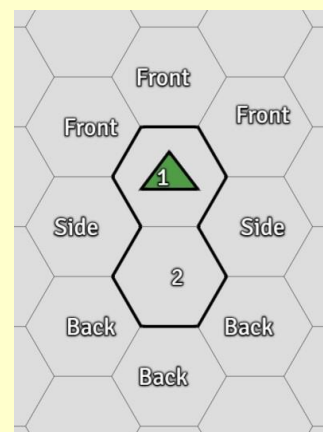
**Resistances:** +2 to all HT rolls concerned with eye damage, +3 to all HT rolls to avoid knockdown, stunning, and torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; High Pain Threshold.

**Notes:** A character can target a stone drake's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Dragons) roll.

### Combat

Stone drakes keep to the shadows, hiding in nooks or clinging to the ceiling above unsuspecting prey. Because of their stealth and cunning, combat usually takes place on the stone drake's terms. To begin a fight, a stone drake charges the foe it has picked out as its meal, attempting to strike quickly and then retreat with its catch.



Thanks to having Extra Attack 1, the stone drake may perform an additional attack per turn, but this attack must be different from other attacks used in that turn. Thus, it usually uses acid bite and front claw, or grapple and acid bite.

**Acid Bite (14):** thrust 1d+1 cutting + follow-up 1d corrosion. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the stone drake may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+1 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-1 control against larger ones.

**Front Claw (14):** thrust 1d+1 cutting. Reach C from hex #1.

**Rear Claw (12):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C from hex #2.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d+1 control. Reach C from hex #1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 22.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 8                    | 15        | 23                   | 30                 |

### Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).  
Surprise Attacks and Initiative (p. B393).

Slam and Overrun (p. B392).

- Defense vs. Slams (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 9).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 12  | 12     | 12      | 12          | 12    |

**Vision:** The stone drake possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

Aside from normal vision, the stone drake can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

The eyes of the drake are adapted to darkness; its **native illumination level is -5**. This lets it see and fight at no penalty at night, but it suffers a -5 penalty during the day. When hunting underground, the stone drake prefers to use Infravision to avoid darkness penalties.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 11 | 12   |

Although they never grow to the size or great age that true dragons reach, stone drakes share their physical prowess and gifted intellects. Unlike true dragons, stone drakes do not covet treasure, and they rarely attack out of any motivation other than hunger.

**Mentality Traits:** Callous.

## Skills

Brawling-14; Stealth-16; Tracking-14.

## Other Traits

Extra Legs (Four Legs); Horizontal; No Fine Manipulators.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Camouflage:** The gray hide of the stone drake lets it blend it with the surrounding rock that is almost omnipresent underground. This gives the stone drake +2 to Camouflage and Stealth when posed still and unclad against rock. This bonus only works against normal vision, not Infravision.

**Diet:** Stone drakes are carnivorous creatures that hunt wild beasts and unwary miners alike.

**Lair:** The claws of the stone drake are adapted for climbing, not digging. If possible, the stone drake tries to lair in a place that is inaccessible to those without similar climbing abilities or flight. This may be an alcove in a vertical cave wall or even a small cave that can only be accessed through an entrance in

the ceiling of another cave. Sometimes, stone drakes cooperate with sapient digging creatures, persuading them to excavate them a suitable lair.

**Language:** Stone drakes speak their own language, but many also know Terran.

**Lifespan:** Stone drakes can live up to 200 years, reaching maturity at 30 years.

## Spoils

While the stone drake is not interested in collecting wealth, its lair may have incidental treasure scattered about – the remains of the consumed victims.

When designing stone drake hide armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid* #3-52, use the following statistics: WM 0.8; Cost \$22, DR/inch 9, Max DR 5, Combustible, Flexible, Construction: fabric, layered fabric, scale.

Stone drake meat is edible, but sour and mildly toxic. Those without at least one level of Reduced Consumption (Cast-Iron Stomach) must roll against HT+2 after eating stone drake meat to become nauseated for margin of failure hours (p. B428) and take 1 point of toxic damage.

It is possible to extract acid from the drake's acid gland. A successful Surgery roll that takes 10 minutes extracts one dose of acid. Failure to successfully remove the gland results in 1d-3 corrosion damage to the handler's hands. Use stats from page 28 of *GURPS Dungeon Fantasy 1: Adventurers*.

## Capturing and Training

The stone drake is a sapient creature, but it can be forced or persuaded into being a war mount, guard, hunter, or war beast.

**Egg Value:** \$500.

**Untrained Value:** \$2,500.

**Trained Value:** \$24,930.

**Supply Cost:** \$8 and 3 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Flightless Lizards).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.026

**Wage (Monthly):** \$750

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Stone Drakes**

**Battle Rating:** 3

**Classes:** None.

**Features:** Night, Terrain (Underground).

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 24/96

**Supply (Weekly):** \$9,600.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$89,750.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$128,150.

## Racial Template

225 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+5 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [30]; DX+2 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [24]; IQ+1 [20]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Will+1 [5]; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move +2 [10].

**Advantages:** Clinging [20]; Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 3 [15]; Extended Lifespan 1 [2]; Extra Attack 1 [25]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; High Pain Threshold [10]; Immunity to Paralysis [10]; Immunity to Sleep [10]; Infravision [10]; Nictitating Membrane 2 [2]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Super Climbing 3 [9].

*Acid Bite:* Corrosion Attack 1d (Follow-Up, Sharp Teeth, +0%) [10].

**Disadvantages:** Callous [-5]; Horizontal [-10]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10].

**Perks:** Limited Camouflage (Rock) [1]; Scales [1].

**Features:** Night Vision 5.

## Eladrin, Celestial

Celestial eladrins are spectacular and passionate beings native to the plane of Arborea – a wilderness of violent moods and deep affections. They share a distant kinship with elves, noble eladrins, fey eladrins, archons, and guardinals. Some speculate that elves, upon transcending their earthly years, transform into eladrins in what could be considered an elven form of the afterlife. Alternatively, it is argued that the benevolent spirits of deceased elves might manifest anew as eladrins within Arborea. Despite these theories, the eladrins do not comment, and indeed, neither conjecture is accurate. While they might occasionally be mistaken for elves and maintain amicable relations with the elven deities, eladrins are inherently born in Arborea from eladrin progenitors, and not crafted from other mortal existences. Their essence is a direct reflection of their homeland: breathtakingly lovely, deceptively fragile, unexpectedly robust, and inherently magical.

Among the group, lesser eladrins such as bralani, coure, noveries, and shieres generally stay within their native plane. However, the greater eladrins, including firres, ghaeles, shiradis, and tulani, are known to traverse the multiverse championing the virtues of good as they see fit.

Planewalkers who have crossed paths with eladrins often label them as untamed, and they indeed stand as the most impulsive among the celestial beings. Reveling in their existence, they support the virtuous against the oppression of evil through spontaneous acts of kindness and bravery. Eladrins epitomize independence, navigating from one plane to another driven by whims, always championing goodness and liberty wherever threats loom.

### Ecology

**Diet:** Like most outsiders, celestial eladrins do not require any sustenance, but they may eat and drink if they wish.

**Lifecycle:** Unlike archons and aasimon, eladrins do not possess true immortality. Similar to elves, their aging process is exceedingly slow. Their extended, blissful youth is spent in Arborea's twilight courts—ethereal and hidden enclosures that drift across the plane, elusive to outsiders. Time does not pass within the courts, so they are able to grow without actually ageing. Upon reaching adulthood and feeling prepared, they venture out to pursue their divinely assigned roles.

When eladrins perish outside Arborea's boundaries, their souls, unless detained, return to their original plane, to be reborn again as eladrin. Deaths within Arborea resonate with pain or glory, affecting all acquainted with the deceased across any distance. This connection manifests as a brief, overpowering

consciousness of the event and, for those emotionally connected, a profound sense of mourning. The specifics of such deaths remain mysterious, though folklore insists that if violence was involved, other eladrins could later discern the perpetrators simply through eye contact.

### Mentality

Eladrins hold the conviction that deeds overpower words. They boldly engage in audacious gambits and unconventional strategies in their unyielding crusade to annihilate malicious forces whenever they emerge. One of their most commendable traits is their steadfast persistence. Facing daunting odds is routine for eladrins, as they strive to repel evil back to the Lower Planes and eradicate it completely.

While some celestial entities adhere to rigid principles like honor, virtue, and charity, eladrins are guided more by innate impulses than strict codes. These celestial beings do not fuss over the philosophical implications of their actions or whether they instigate virtuousness in others. Driven by their intuition, they act according to necessity. Typically, their actions inadvertently support the cause of good even if they seem impulsive at first glance. To curb an eladrin's instinctual actions would be as futile as requesting archons to cease their trumpeting.

Eladrins maintain a strict code of honesty, refusing to lie, cheat, or steal, except under extraordinary circumstances. For instance, an eladrin might temporarily purloin a ranger's blade to coax the hesitant forester into participating in a critical quest. Likewise, in rescuing a fated child from malevolent caretakers, an eladrin might conceal their true nature to prevent any future resentment or imitation by the child.

### Society

**History:** In the ancient past, the eladrins were instrumental in banishing the obyriths from the Abyss. Following the defeat of the Queen of Chaos and her legions on the world of Oerth at the Field of Pesh, and the subsequent ensnarement of her consort Miska the Wolf-Spider in an extradimensional prison, Queen Morwel seized this opportunity to weaken the obyriths' influence. She led an eladrin army, bolstered by legions of ghaeles, alongside Faerinaal and Gwynharwyf into the Abyss where they devastated the obyriths on the Plain of Infinite Portals. This assault, however, inadvertently paved the way for the tanar'ri's ascendancy.

Before their dominion over the Abyss waned, Pale Night, Mother of Demons, deceitfully entangled Ascodei, then Royal Consort to Morwel, in a pact which doomed thousands of eladrin children to the 471st layer of the Abyss, Androlynne. A multitude of

celestial beings, including ki-rin, foo creatures, hollyphants, moon dogs, couatl, and eladrins themselves, rallied to aid these ensnared offspring. The ensuing conflict spanned millennia.

**Planar Role:** Eladrins have no predetermined destinies within the multiverse. They act on personal volition, trusting archons and aasimon to uphold principles of truth and virtue, and depend on guardinals and asuras to counteract significant evils. Believing fervently in personal autonomy, eladrins generally abstain from meddling in mortal affairs. Queen Morwel promotes no governance among her subjects, provided their actions do not threaten the survival of the eladrins.

Where archons symbolize all that is holy and untouched, and the asimon deem themselves protectors of the overarching good, eladrins engage directly with malevolent entities. If they cannot manipulate evil into self-destruction, they are ready to endanger their lives to prevent it from gaining any ground, willing to make the sacrifices necessary to address the imminent threats.

**Politics:** In the ethereal twilight courts of the tulani, eladrins may navigate delicate webs of intrigue, yet they find little value in politics and express distaste for bureaucracy. While Queen Morwel, far from being a despot or oppressor, imposes certain criteria (such as concealing their true nature from denizens of the Prime Material Plane), it is also true that the ruling tulani delight in their courtly games. Nonetheless, political maneuvering holds scant significance within the core structure of eladrin society.

**Relationships with Other Celestials:** Eladrins respect aasimon for their purity and power, including beings like devas, planetars, and solars, but remain wary of their status. They ensure there's room for both aasimon and eladrins on the Upper Planes, coexisting without conflict.

Eladrins and archons differ significantly; while archons focus on guardianship and virtue from Mount Celestia, eladrins rove the planes confronting evil directly, sometimes causing friction with archons who view them as overly confrontational. Any disputes, though, are usually mediated by guardinals or higher powers.

While eladrins find asuras' efforts in defending Arborea commendable, they occasionally resent the asuras' intrusion into their domain. Disagreements remain superficial, involving only brief conflicts that don't deepen tensions.

Eladrins and guardinals share fewer interactions but maintain a favorable relationship, often collaborating on targeted strikes against evils of the Lower Planes. Despite occasional critiques of the guardinals' reserved nature, mutual respect underpins

their relationship, whether in battle or diplomacy.

**Veiling:** While present on the Material Plane, eladrins are compelled to employ magical veiling. Under this guise, veiled eladrins adopt the appearances of creatures indigenous to the locale they traverse. Commonly, they choose humanoid shapes, masquerading as adventurers, peasants, or itinerant bards. Once this veil is donned, they are bound to it, unable to disclose their true forms unless faced with the most grave situations. This dictates that in the company of mortals, veiled eladrins must strictly act within the capabilities of their assumed identities. (Their intrinsic eladrin abilities remain, though they are constrained from utilizing them in the visibility of prime-material beings.) Any eladrins breaching their veils are banished back to Arborea, condemned to remain there for 1,001 years before regaining the privilege to tread the Material Plane. Typically, the deities afford these transgressing eladrins a modest span—perhaps a few moments or up to an hour—to wrap up any urgent affairs prior to their departure.

### New Disadvantage

All eladrins have to act according to a certain code of conduct when on the Material Plane, and this code is more strict than that of other celestials. This is represented by a new disadvantage.

#### *Code of Honor (Celestial Eladrin) [-10]*

When on the Prime Material Plane, you may interact with mortals provided that you refrain from using your powers except in dire need, and then only discreetly; refrain from revealing your true nature or true self to the natives under any circumstances; and refrain from providing assistance or information (especially knowledge of the Upper Planes and their gods) beyond what is absolutely necessary.

Any eladrin who violates these restrictions feels a compulsion to return to the Upper Planes and report his or her infractions. Those who reveal their true forms to the mortals are confined to Arborea for 1,001 years.

## Eladrin, Celestial, Bralani

Type: Outsider (Chaotic, Eladrin, Good)



### Physical Characteristics

#### Humanoid Form

|           |    |           |      |               |         |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|---------|
| <b>ST</b> | 13 | <b>HP</b> | 13   | <b>SM</b>     | +0      |
| <b>DX</b> | 13 | <b>BS</b> | 6.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d/2d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12   | <b>BL</b>     | 34 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d/1d+1

#### Whirlwind Form

|           |    |           |     |               |        |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|--------|
| <b>ST</b> | 0  | <b>HP</b> | 12  | <b>SM</b>     | +0     |
| <b>DX</b> | 14 | <b>BS</b> | 6.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | -      |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12  | <b>BL</b>     | 0 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Humanoid. (Only torso in the whirlwind form.)

**Weight:** 135 lbs. (0.2 lb in the whirlwind form.)

**Height:** 5 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Organization:** 1-6. 5% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** D.

In their natural form, bralanis resemble short, stocky elves – broad in the shoulders, but graceful nonetheless. They have bright, silvery-white hair and eyes like ever-shifting rainbows – indeed, the eye color of these beings seems to flicker and change with their moods.

### Movement and Encumbrance

#### Humanoid Form

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 34 | 68    | 102    | 204   | 340         |

#### Whirlwind Form

**Air:** Move 13; exploration 6.5 miles per hour.

The bralani in the whirlwind form is lighter than air. A wind moves him 1 yard/second in the direction it is blowing, per 5 mph of wind speed.

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** Bralanis do not possess tough skin or any other natural armor, so they usually wear manufactured armor. When a bralani assumes the whirlwind form, he absorbs gear up to his Basic Lift. This means that it is only practical to wear lightweight armor. A typical bralani warrior would wear medium leather armor that provides DR 2\* (-1 against impaling) to the torso (\$100, 12 lbs., Don 30, Holdout -2).

**Wind Resistance:** The bralani has DR 10 against air and wind – including not only Missile and Jet spells, but also effects and spells that bypass normal DR to cause direct, internal damage, such as attacks that steal breath and deal FP damage by draining air from the lungs. In addition, subtract this DR from the damage for the purpose of determining knockback. Resistible air effects other than damage (e.g., a spell that paralyses the subject with winds or causes embolism) simply fail, as though the bralani had successfully resisted. In addition, the bralani is affected by bad weather as though it were a step less severe on the table on *GURPS Magic*, p. 194. Most often means -1 less to rolls to avoid falling overboard, see things through torrential rain, etc.

**Dodge:** 10 (no penalty against attacks from the sides or rear **in whirlwind form**).

**Parry:** 11U (broadsword; humanoid form), 11 (unarmed; humanoid form).

**Injury Resistance (whirlwind form):** Decrease injury received by the bralani in the whirlwind form by 2, and only then apply the injury cap (see *Gaseous* below).

**Immunities (humanoid form):** petrification.

**Immunities (whirlwind form):** blinding, grapple, knockdown, metabolic hazards, pain, petrification, physical stun, physical torture, slams.

**Resistances:** Magic Resistance 2 (Improved).

**Vulnerabilities:** The bralani takes x2 injury from unholy and cold iron weapons. In addition, when in the whirlwind form, the bralani takes x2 injury from vacuum and wind-based attacks.

**Defensive Traits (humanoid form):** Combat Reflexes.

**Defensive Traits (whirlwind form):** Combat Reflexes; Injury Tolerance (Diffuse); Injury Tolerance (No Eyes).

### Combat

The bralani prefers such weapons as falchions, spears, bows, and other weapons favored by desert nomads. Usually, they fight in the humanoid form, and assume the whirlwind form only to catch a fleeing enemy or reach an otherwise inaccessible place.

*Humanoid Form***Punch (15):** thrust 1d crushing, Reach C.**Grapple (13):** thrust 1d control. Reach C.**Large Falchion swing (15):** swing 2d+2 cutting (RS: 2d-1), Reach 1. Unbalanced. 4.5 lbs.**Large Falchion thrust (15):** thrust 1d-1 impaling, Reach 1. Unbalanced. 4.5 lbs.**Straight Composite Bow (15):** thrust 1d+2 impaling, Acc 2, Range 195/260, RoF 1, Shots 1(2).**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.7 lbs.**Effective Slam Weight:** 17 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 2                           | 7                           | 13               | 20                          | 26                        |

**Special Abilities**

**Alternate Form:** A bralani can shift between its humanoid and whirlwind forms by taking 5 consecutive Ready maneuvers. Clothing and gear weighing no more than his BL change with him. If the bralani dies or gets knocked unconscious, he does not revert to his natural form.

**Anarchic Touch:** A bralani's natural attacks are treated as chaotic for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

**Gaseous (whirlwind form only):** The bralani in the whirlwind form is a being composed of living air. It cannot manipulate objects, slam, overrun, trample, or grapple, and it cannot be grappled either. Others may move through a bralani without the need to evade and vice versa. Slams against a bralani deal normal damage, subject to the injury cap described below, but do not cause knockback and cannot knock down the bralani or its opponent. The bralani provides no Cover DR for the purpose of overpenetration.

The bralani cannot seep through cracks, but it can squeeze through narrow openings as if its SM were lower by 2.

The bralani is immune to knockback, unless it was caused by an area-effect, cone, jet, or explosive attack.

Due to being diffuse, the bralani in the whirlwind form is hard to damage and is immune to crippling injuries. Subtract 2 from injury received by the bralani and then cap the remaining injury. Impaling, piercing, and tight-beam burning attacks never do more than 1 HP of injury, and other attacks can never do more than 2 HP of injury with the exception of area-effect, cone, and explosion attacks that deal normal injury.

In addition, the bralani has no blood, no vitals, no brain, no face, no skull, no neck, and no eyes – it's a uniform being with no vulnerable hit locations. Ignore any location-based injury multipliers and knockdown modifiers.

**Holy Touch:** A bralani's natural attacks are treated as holy for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

**Tongues:** Aside from the languages the eladrin knows, it has one slot that it can fill with any spoken language that is not “secret” or “lost” at the Native comprehension level by taking a Ready maneuver.

**Veiling (humanoid form only):** The eladrin may assume a different form as if using the Morph advantage (p. B84). The transformation takes 10 seconds. If he is knocked out or killed, he immediately reverts to his native form (which will also be unconscious or dead). The eladrin can only change his outward appearance. His abilities and racial template are unaffected. He can only choose a humanoid form with the same body layout.

The eladrin can always take on the form of a being he can see or touch, provided its racial template cost does not exceed his. Once he has assumed a form, he can opt to memorize it by concentrating for one minute. This allows him to shapeshift into that form at any time. The eladrin can memorize a number of forms equal to his IQ. If all his “slots” are full, his must overwrite a previously memorized form (his choice) to add the new form. Memorizing cosmetic changes also requires a “slot”.

**Whirlwind (whirlwind form only):** Whenever the bralani in whirlwind form touches anyone or is touched, roll 4d crushing damage determine knockback; however, the victim suffers no actual damage or blunt trauma from the effect. Against enemies with Injury Tolerance (Diffuse), such as gaseous beings and swarms, this becomes a much more potent attack, doing full damage. Ignore the usual injury cap of 2 HP (*Injury to Unliving, Homogenous, and Diffuse Targets*, p. B380). The elemental can switch this effect off and on with a Ready maneuver.

**Spell-Like Abilities:**

The bralani possesses three innate abilities that mimic wizardly spells. This is an array of alternative abilities, and to “switch” between abilities, the bralani must take a Concentrate maneuver. Unlike the actual spells, these abilities do not have verbal and somatic components, and do not require a casting roll (however, Gust of Wind still requires a roll to hit.)

**Blur (Self):** This buff lasts long enough for almost any combat encounter, so if the bralani is expecting trouble, he often keeps this ability in the active slot to cast it as soon as possible and then switch to something else.

**Gust of Wind 3 (15):** While this ability doesn't usually cause injury, it can knock back (and hence knock down) almost any human-sized opponent regardless of how well-armored he is. Aside from this,

it can be a devastating attack against diffuse opponents.

**Mirror Image:** While this ability is quite powerful, it also is situational. Since the images are almost immobile, the bralani only uses this ability when he does not have to move much, such as when fighting in close quarters. Alternatively, it may be used defensively when using a bow from a distance – this way, the enemy will not know for certain against whom to retaliate.

### Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 11          | 11    |

**Vision:** While in the humanoid form, the bralani has **Night Vision 5**.

While in the whirlwind form, the bralani does not have any eyes, but can see everything around himself (**negating penalties for defending against side or rear attacks**, and offering a +5 bonus to detecting Shadowing attempts). In addition, he has **Dark Vision**, which allows him to see in total darkness without any penalty.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 11 | 11   |

Bralani are capricious, volatile, and intensely passionate beings. They quickly succumb to rage, and their fury is nothing short of formidable. While they often seem occupied solely with dancing and racing through the barren stretches of Pelion's deserts, their frivolous pursuits instantly cease when faced with malevolence in their land. Occasionally, a rare and peculiar bralani may travel to different worlds, uniting with local champions of virtue.

In conflicts across different planes, bralani generally adopt roles as scouts or skirmishers, agitating the enemy's sides and rear and utilizing their whirlwinds to cause maximal disruption. On the Prime Material Plane, they take human-like forms and roam either deserts or frozen wastelands, offering support to indigenous nomads and other wayfarers confronting threats of both hot and cold climates.

As with all eladrins, bralani are bound by a vow to never disclose their true identity to mortals on the Prime Material Plane. However, should their true essence be discovered despite their careful concealment, they may then choose to reveal

themselves further, provided those who learn their secret pledge to maintain confidentiality. Typically, the celestial authorities permit such exposed bralani to continue residing on the Prime; if not, they must return to Arborea. Indeed, these bralani may be summoned back to Arborea by their leaders or higher powers at any time for other duties, such as repelling demonic incursions or partaking in other critical missions.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Code of Honor (Celestial Eladrin); Impulsiveness (12); Intolerance (Fiends); Pacifism (Cannot Harm Innocents).

### Skills

Bow-15\*; Brawling-15\*; Broadsword-15\*; Innate Attack (Beam)-15\*; Spear-15\*; Survival (Arborea)-12; Survival (Desert)-12.

\* Increase these skills by +1 in the whirlwind form.

### Other Traits

**Whirlwind Form:** Doesn't Breathe; Doesn't Sleep; Invertebrate; No Legs (Aerial); No Manipulators; No Mouth.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Like most outsiders, the bralani does not require any food or water, even though he can consume food if he wants to.

**Habitat:** Bralani are native to the plane of Arborea. When on the Prime Material Plane, they prefer to dwell in warm or cold deserts. The temperature comfort zone of a bralani falls between -1° and 126°.

**Language:** All bralani know the Eladrin language, but they also can use their *tongues* ability to "learn" another language. This ability is often used when a veiled eladrin has to live in the guise of a mortal. Many also learn Celestial to communicate with their upper-planar peers.

**Lifecycle:** Bralani reach maturity in 60 years, and their average lifespan is around 650 years. However, their actual lifespan may be much longer, as they do not age when spending their time in the twilight courts of the tulani.

### Capturing and Training

The freedom-loving bralani make very poor slaves. The values given below may be used for a magically-controlled bralani used as a guardian or a soldier.

**Untrained Value:** \$4,100.

**Trained Value:** \$40,900.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.046

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,220

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Bralani**

*Battle Rating:* 5

*Classes:* Air.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 28/112 (land) or 52/208 (air)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$147,160.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$149,160.

## Racial Template

314 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+3 [30]; DX+3 [60]; IQ+1 [20]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Combat Reflexes [15]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Extended Lifespan 2.5 [5]; Immunity to Petrification [5]; Magic Resistance 2 (Improved, +150%) [10]; Night Vision 5 [5]; Temperature Tolerance 6 [6].

*Alternate Form:* Alternate Form (Whirlwind Shape, see notes; Can Carry Objects, No Encumbrance, +10%; Magical, -10%; Once On, Stays On, +50%; Reduced Time 1, +20%) [26+15].

*Tongues:* Cosmic Power 3 (Limited, One Spoken Language, -50%; Magical, -10%) [12].

*Veiling:* Morph (Cosmetic, -50%; Magical, -10%; Retains Shape, -20%) [20].

*Wind Resistance* [76]: DR 10 (Absorbs Knockback, +40%; Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Air/Wind, -40%) [65] + Eye of the Storm [1] + Immunity to Noxious Air Effects [10].

*Spell-Like Abilities* (Alternative Abilities) [37]:

[Blur \(Self\)](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [23/5=5];

[Gust of Wind 3](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [18/5=4];

[Mirror Image](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [28].

**Disadvantages:** Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Code of Honor (Celestial Eladrin) [-10]; Impulsiveness (12) [-10]; Intolerance (Fiends) [-5]; Pacifism (Cannot Harm Innocents) [-10]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10]; Vulnerability (Unholy Weapons, x2) [-10].

**Perks:** Anarchic Touch [1]; Holy Touch [1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 0.5.

**Notes:**

*Whirlwind shape* [289]

*Attribute Modifiers:* ST-10 [-100]; DX+4 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [48]; IQ+1 [20]; HT+2 [20].

*Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:* HP+12 [24].

*Advantages:* 360° Vision (Panoptic I, +20%) [30]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Extended Lifespan 2.5 [5]; Flight (Lighter Than Air, -10%) [36]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Immunity to Petrification [5]; Injury Resistance 2 [20]; Injury Tolerance (Diffuse) [100]; Injury Tolerance (No Eyes) [5]; Magic Resistance 2 (Improved, +150%) [10]; Temperature Tolerance 6 [6].

*Tongues:* Cosmic Power 3 (Limited, One Spoken Language, -50%; Magical, -10%) [12].

*Whirlwind:* Crushing Attack 2d (Aura, +80%; Cosmic, Does knockback-based damage against diffuse targets, +50%; Double Knockback, +20%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; No Blunt Trauma, -20%; No Wounding, Except against diffuse targets, -25%) [18].

*Spell-Like Abilities* (Alternative Abilities) [37]:

[Blur \(Self\)](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [23/5=5];

[Gust of Wind 3](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [18/5=4];

[Mirror Image](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [28].

*Disadvantages:* Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Code of Honor (Celestial Eladrin) [-10]; Impulsiveness (12) [-10]; Intolerance (Fiends) [-5]; Invertebrate [-20]; No Manipulators [-50]; No Mouth [-4]; Pacifism (Cannot Harm Innocents) [-10]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10]; Vulnerability (Unholy Weapons, x2) [-10]; Vulnerability (Vacuum and wind-based attacks, x2) [-20].

*Perks:* Anarchic Touch [1]; Holy Touch [1].

*Features:* Early Maturation 0.5; No Legs (Aerial); Taboo Trait (Fixed ST).

## Eladrin, Celestial, Ghaele

Type: Outsider (Chaotic, Eladrin, Good)



### Physical Characteristics

#### Humanoid Form

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 15 | <b>HP</b> | 15 | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+1/2d+1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12 | <b>BL</b>     | 45 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+1/1d+2

#### Globe Form

|           |    |           |    |               |        |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|--------|
| <b>ST</b> | 0  | <b>HP</b> | 10 | <b>SM</b>     | +0     |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | -      |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12 | <b>BL</b>     | 0 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Humanoid. (Only torso in the globe form.)

**Weight:** 170 lbs. (0.2 lb in the globe form.)

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Organization:** 1-6. 5% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** D, C.

The eladrin knights known as ghaeles resemble tall, athletic high elves. Some travelers mistake them for elven nobles, although their pearly eyes and radiant auras reveal their celestial origins.

### Movement and Encumbrance

#### Humanoid Form

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 45 | 90    | 135    | 270   | 450         |

#### Globe Form

**Air:** Move 12; exploration 6 miles per hour.

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** Ghaeles do not possess tough skin or any other natural armor. When a ghaele assumes the color sphere form, he absorbs gear up to his Basic Lift. This means that it is only practical to wear lightweight armor. Typically, ghaeles prefer not to wear armor, though they do employ shields and protective magical devices when needs arise. Those who do wear armor, prefer light segmented plate armor on torso (DR 3; 16 lbs.; Don 45; Holdout -3), arms (DR 3; 8 lbs.; Don 23; Holdout -3), and legs (DR 3; 16 lbs.; Don 45; Holdout -3). This brings the ghaele into light encumbrance (-1 to Dodge, Move 6). When transforming into the light globe form, he cannot absorb all the gear, so the ghaele must choose wisely what items to keep.

**Light Resistance:** The ghaele has DR 10 against light – including not only Missile and Jet spells, but also effects and spells that bypass normal DR to cause direct, internal damage. In addition, the ghaele gets +5 to HT rolls to resist attacks that are trying to overload his sense of vision. Ghaele's vision rapidly adapts to the most intense of stimuli, allowing him to function normally after a maximum of two seconds of impairment.

**Dodge:** 10 (no penalty against attacks from the sides or rear **in globe form**).

**Parry:** 12 (greatsword; humanoid form), 12 (unarmed; humanoid form).

**Injury Resistance (globe form):** Decrease injury received by the ghaele in the globe form by 2, and only then apply the injury cap (see *Light Form* below).

**Immunities (humanoid form):** petrification.

**Immunities (whirlwind form):** blinding, grapple, knockdown, metabolic hazards, pain, petrification, physical stun, physical torture, slams.

**Resistances:** Magic Resistance 3 (Improved).

**Vulnerabilities:** The ghaele takes x2 injury from unholy and cold iron weapons.

**Defensive Traits (humanoid form):** Combat Reflexes.

**Defensive Traits (globe form):** Combat Reflexes; Injury Tolerance (Diffuse); Injury Tolerance (No Eyes).

### Combat

Ghaeles who enter combat prefer direct confrontation and damaging attacks to more subtle or insidious methods. They usually fight in their humanoid form, wielding greatswords. If a ghaele desires mobility, it assumes its globe form and blasts the enemy with light rays. When wielding a one-handed weapon, the ghaele prefers to have a medium shield for extra defensive capabilities.

*Humanoid Form***Punch (16):** thrust 1d+1 crushing, Reach C.**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d+1 control. Reach C.**Fine Thrusting Greatsword swing (16):** swing 3d+1 cutting (RS: 2d+2), Reach 1-2. 7 lbs.**Fine Thrusting Greatsword thrust (16):** thrust 2d+1 impaling, Reach 2. 7 lbs.**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.25 lbs.**Effective Slam Weight:** 22.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 8                    | 15        | 23                   | 30                 |

*Globe Form*

In this form, the ghaele does not have any physical attacks aside from slamming against the target. The preferred form of attack is the *light ray* (see below).

**Special Abilities**

**Alternate Form:** A ghaele can shift between its humanoid and light globe forms by taking 5 consecutive Ready maneuvers. Clothing and gear weighing no more than his BL change with him. If the ghaele dies or gets knocked unconscious, he does not revert to his natural form.

**Anarchic Touch:** A ghaele's natural attacks are treated as chaotic for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

**Holy Touch:** A ghaele's natural attacks are treated as holy for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

**Illumination:** Regardless of the form, the ghaele emits torch-equivalent light. When in the humanoid form, he may suppress this glowing aura with a Ready maneuver to conceal his celestial nature. When in the light globe form, the ghaele glows constantly, and the glow cannot be suppressed.

**Light Form (light globe form only):** The ghaele in the light globe form is a being composed of living light. It cannot manipulate objects, slam, overrun, trample, or grapple, and it cannot be grappled either. Others may move through a ghaele without the need to evade and vice versa. Slams against a ghaele deal normal damage, subject to the injury cap described below, but do not cause knockback and cannot knock down the ghaele or its opponent. The ghaele provides no Cover DR for the purpose of overpenetration.

The ghaele cannot seep through cracks, but it can squeeze through narrow openings as if its SM were lower by 2.

The ghaele is immune to knockback, unless it was caused by an area-effect, cone, jet, or explosive attack.

Due to being diffuse, the ghaele in the light globe form is hard to damage and is immune to crippling injuries. Subtract 2 from injury received by the ghaele and then cap the remaining injury. Impaling, piercing, and tight-beam burning attacks never do more than 1 HP of injury, and other attacks can never do more than 2 HP of injury with the exception of area-effect, cone, and explosion attacks that deal normal injury.

In addition, the ghaele has no blood, no vitals, no brain, no face, no skull, no neck, and no eyes – it's a uniform being with no vulnerable hit locations. Ignore any location-based injury multipliers and knockdown modifiers.

**Light Ray (14) (only in light globe form):** 2d tight-beam burning. Acc 3, Range 10/100, costs 1 FP. The beam is easily reflected. Normally it cannot be blocked, but someone may use a mirror or a highly polished shield to do so; this causes the attack to bounce off in a random direction, possibly striking the wrong target (p. B389). The mirror-wielder may even attempt to reflect it back at the ghaele, but this gives -2 to Block; the ghaele defends normally. On the upside, the ghaele may make use of mirrored surfaces to “ricochet” the beam. This inflicts -2 per bounce to the attack roll, but may allow the attacker to bypass cover; in addition, the target is at -1 per bounce to defend.

**Tongues:** Aside from the languages the eladrin knows, it has one slot that it can fill with any spoken language that is not “secret” or “lost” at the Native comprehension level by taking a Ready maneuver.

**Veiling (humanoid form only):** The eladrin may assume a different form as if using the Morph advantage (p. B84). The transformation takes 10 seconds. If he is knocked out or killed, he immediately reverts to his native form (which will also be unconscious or dead). The eladrin can only change his outward appearance. His abilities and racial template are unaffected. He can only choose a humanoid form with the same body layout.

The eladrin can always take on the form of a being he can see or touch, provided its racial template cost does not exceed his. Once he has assumed a form, he can opt to memorize it by concentrating for one minute. This allows him to shapeshift into that form at any time. The eladrin can memorize a number of forms equal to his IQ. If all his “slots” are full, his must overwrite a previously memorized form (his choice) to add the new form. Memorizing cosmetic changes also requires a “slot”.

**Spell-Like Abilities:**

The ghaele possesses innate abilities that mimic arcane spells. This is an array of alternative abilities,

and to “switch” between abilities, the ghaele must take a Concentrate maneuver. Unlike the actual spells, these abilities do not have verbal and somatic components, but most of them still have a roll to cast against Will or IQ, or a roll to hit.

**Color Spray (14):** A ghaele is likely to start a fight with this spell, trying to affect as many enemies as possible and to avoid affecting any allies.

**Detect Thoughts (13):** A ghaele may use this ability to gather information and seek out potential infiltrators when veiled on the Material Plane.

**Dispel Magic (13):** Obviously, this spell is used to dispel ongoing magical effects cast by hostile spellcasters.

**Ghaele's Gaze 3 (13):** While it is easy to get bonuses to resist fear, the ghaele uses this spell on the most formidable opponents due to the Rule of 14 (p. B360) capping the effective Will for the purpose of Fright Checks. An opponent stunned (or worse) by a Fright Check is an easy target for a greatsword strike.

**Major Image 1:** This is a very versatile spell. A ghaele may use it to influence actions of others when veiled on the Material Plane, perhaps, trying to pass the illusion off as a divine message. In combat, this is much less useful, as the ghaele has to actively concentrate to maintain it.

**Minor Healing (13)** (*GURPS Thaumatology: Sorcery*, p. 19): The ghaeles try not to use this spell too often on others, as it would compromise their veil. Thus, they mostly use it on themselves or on unconscious allies.

## Useful Combat Rules

All-Out Attack (Cone) (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

Making Things Burn (p. B433).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 12  | 12     | 12      | 12          | 12    |

**Vision:** While in the humanoid form, the ghaele has **Night Vision 5**.

While in the light globe form, the ghaele does not have any eyes, but can see everything around himself (**negating penalties for defending against side or rear attacks**, and offering a +5 bonus to detecting Shadowing attempts). In addition, it has **Dark Vision**, which allows it to see in total darkness without any penalty.

In addition, the ghaele possesses a magical ability to **see through magical invisibility**.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 13 | 13   |

In Arborea, ghaeles play the roles of counselors and advisors to the tulani eladrins, standing as stalwart protectors of their domain, fending off intruders like fiends and slaadi who sneak in through hidden portals and gates. Though their affection for Arborea is profound, ghaeles harbor a unique affinity for the Prime Material Plane and feel uneasy when away from it for an extended period. These beings revel in mingling with mortals, dispensing counsel to virtuous souls brave enough to confront their tyrants. More than their eladrin counterparts, ghaeles tend to operate in secrecy, and their tasks often weigh down their spirits. They are committed, yet burdened, lacking a sense of humor in their daily existence.

Ghaeles find ample opportunities to aid mortals in vanquishing evil on prime-material worlds. Whether joining a group of champions to cleanse an old dungeon of its malevolent residents, sealing off passages to the Lower Planes, thwarting the liberation of a captive marquis cambion, or foiling the plots of a nefarious warlord, ghaeles are active in the fight against darkness. They might also assist a human knight in gathering a force to rescue allies from a githyanki stronghold, or aid an indulged princess in preparing for her queenship by encouraging her to reconcile the conflicting parties under her command. In elven courts, disguised ghaeles often share sage advice with lords striving to protect their woods from advancing foes such as malevolent humans, dragons, and despots.

For ghaeles, the fulfillment of their mission is the only reward they seek. They do not pursue fame or gratitude for their deeds, yet they often form deep bonds with certain mortals, visiting them from time to time.

When venturing away from Arborea, ghaeles must exercise caution and conceal their powers from mortals. Those who expose their true essence on the Prime Material Plane face immediate summons back to Arborea and a daunting confinement of 1,001 years—a punishment excruciatingly lengthy for creatures used to wandering the planes in support of benevolent entities. Ghaeles serving the tulani in Arborea may endure this restrictive existence, unable to leave the plane for several additional centuries, a situation that casts a shadow of despair over them, evident in their demeanor.

While lesser eladrins like coures may indulge in occasional mischief, the higher powers of Arborea keep a close watch on ghaeles. Should a ghaele act malevolently or uncharitably, or neglect to display

kindness and generosity, they are swiftly recalled and reassigned to other duties.

**Mentality Traits:** Charitable (12); Code of Honor (Celestial Eladrin); Impulsiveness (12); Intolerance (Fiends); No Sense of Humor; Pacifism (Cannot Harm Innocents).

### Skills

Brawling-16; Broadsword-16; Diplomacy-14; Innate Attack (Beam)-14; Leadership-15; Shield-14; Tactics-15; Two-Handed Sword-16.

### Other Traits

*Globe Form:* Doesn't Breathe; Doesn't Sleep; No Legs (Aerial); No Manipulators; No Mouth.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Like most outsiders, the ghaele does not require any food or water, even though he can consume food if he wants to.

**Habitat:** Ghaeles are native to the plane of Arborea. The temperature comfort zone of a ghaele falls between -1° and 126°.

**Language:** All ghaeles know the Eladrin language, but they also can use their *tongues* ability to "learn" another language. This ability is often used when a veiled eladrin has to live in the guise of a mortal. Many also learn Celestial to communicate with their upper-planar peers.

**Lifecycle:** Ghaeles reach maturity in 70 years, and their average lifespan is around 800 years. However, their actual lifespan may be much longer, as they do not age when spending their time in the twilight courts of the tulani.

### Capturing and Training

The freedom-loving ghaeles make very poor slaves. The values given below may be used for a magically-controlled ghaele used as a guardian or a soldier.

**Untrained Value:** \$7,950.

**Trained Value:** \$79,450.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.083

**Wage (Monthly):** \$2,380

### Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Ghaeles**

*Battle Rating:* 10

*Classes:* Air, F.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 28/112 (land) or 52/208 (air)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$286,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$288,000.

### Racial Template

406 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+5 [50]; DX+2 [40]; IQ+2 [40]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Will+1 [5]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Combat Reflexes [15]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Extended Lifespan 3 [6]; Immunity to Petrification [5]; Magic Resistance 3 (Improved, +150%) [15]; Night Vision 5 [5]; See Invisible (Magical; Magical, -10%) [14]; Temperature Tolerance 6 [6].

*Alternate Form:* Alternate Form (Globe Form, see notes; Can Carry Objects, No Encumbrance, +10%; Magical, -10%; Reduced Time 1, +20%; Once On, Stays On, +50%) [26 + 62].

*Light Resistance* [30]: DR 10 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Light, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [25] + Protected Vision [5].

*Tongues:* Cosmic Power 3 (Limited, One Spoken Language, -50%; Magical, -10%) [12].

*Veiling:* Morph (Cosmetic, -50%; Magical, -10%; Retains Shape, -20%) [20].

*Spell-Like Abilities* (Alternative Abilities) [97]:

[Color Spray](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, and IQ Roll, +30%) [31/5=7];

[Detect Thoughts](#) (No Gestures and Incantation, +20%) [18/5=4];

[Dispel Magic](#) (No Gestures and Incantation, +20%) [60];

[Ghaele's Gaze 3](#) [45/5=9];

[Major Image 1](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, and IQ Roll, +30%) [47/5=10];

Minor Healing [32/5=7] – *GURPS Thaumatology: Sorcery*, page 19.

**Disadvantages:** Charitable (12) [-15]; Code of Honor (Celestial Eladrin) [-10]; Impulsiveness (12) [-10]; Intolerance (Fiends) [-5]; No Sense of Humor [-10]; Pacifism (Cannot Harm Innocents) [-10]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10]; Vulnerability (Unholy Weapons, x2) [-10].

**Perks:** Anarchic Touch [1]; Holy Touch [1]; Illumination [1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 1.

**Notes:**

*Globe shape* [407]

*Attribute Modifiers:* ST-10 [-100]; DX+2 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [24]; IQ+2 [40]; HT+2 [20].

*Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:* HP+10 [20]; Will+1 [5].

*Advantages:* 360° Vision (Panoptic I, +20%) [30]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Extended Lifespan 3 [6]; Flight [40];

Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Immunity to Petrification [5]; Injury Resistance 2 [20]; Injury Tolerance (Diffuse) [100]; Injury Tolerance (No Eyes) [5]; Magic Resistance 3 (Improved, +150%) [15]; See Invisible (Magical; Magical, -10%) [14]; Temperature Tolerance 6 [6].

*Light Ray*: Burning Attack 2d (Costs Fatigue, 1 FP, -5%; Magical, -10%; Nuisance Effect, Reflective, -5%) [8].

*Tongues*: Cosmic Power 3 (Limited, One Spoken Language, -50%; Magical, -10%) [12].

*Spell-Like Abilities* (Alternative Abilities) [97]:

[Color Spray](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, and IQ Roll, +30%) [31/5=7];

[Detect Thoughts](#) (No Gestures and Incantation, +20%) [18/5=4];

[Dispel Magic](#) (No Gestures and Incantation, +20%) [60];

[Ghaele's Gaze 3](#) [45/5=9];

[Major Image 1](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, and IQ Roll, +30%) [47/5=10];

Minor Healing [32/5=7] – *GURPS Thaumatology: Sorcery*, page 19.

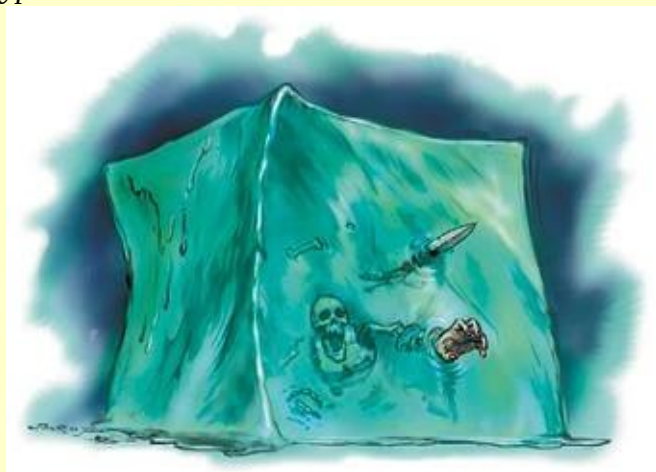
*Disadvantages*: Charitable (12) [-15]; Code of Honor (Celestial Elardin) [-10]; Impulsiveness (12) [-10]; Intolerance (Fiends) [-5]; No Manipulators [-50]; No Mouth [-4]; No Sense of Humor [-10]; Pacifism (Cannot Harm Innocents) [-10]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10]; Vulnerability (Unholy Weapons, x2) [-10].

*Perks*: Anarchic Touch [1]; Holy Touch [1]; Illumination [1].

*Features*: Early Maturation 1; No Legs (Aerial); Taboo Trait (Fixed ST).

## Gelatinous Cube

Type: Ooze



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 50 | <b>HP</b> | 147 | <b>SM</b>     | +4        |
| <b>DX</b> | 8  | <b>BS</b> | 1   | <b>thr/sw</b> | 5d+2/8d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12  | <b>BL</b>     | 500 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 5d+2/6d

**Body Plan:** Only torso.

**Weight:** 50,000 lbs.

**Length:** 12 ft.

**Effective Height:** 15 ft.

**Organization:** Solitary. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure:** B.

The nearly transparent gelatinous cube, also known as the athcoid, travels slowly along dungeon corridors and cave floors, absorbing carrion, creatures, and trash. Inorganic material remains trapped and visible inside the cube's body.

Gelatinous cubes may flow through openings as small as 1' across.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 1; exploration 0.5 miles per hour.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 125 | 250   | 375    | 750   | 1,250       |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Control DR:** 5.

**Dodge:** 4 (no penalty against side or rear attacks).

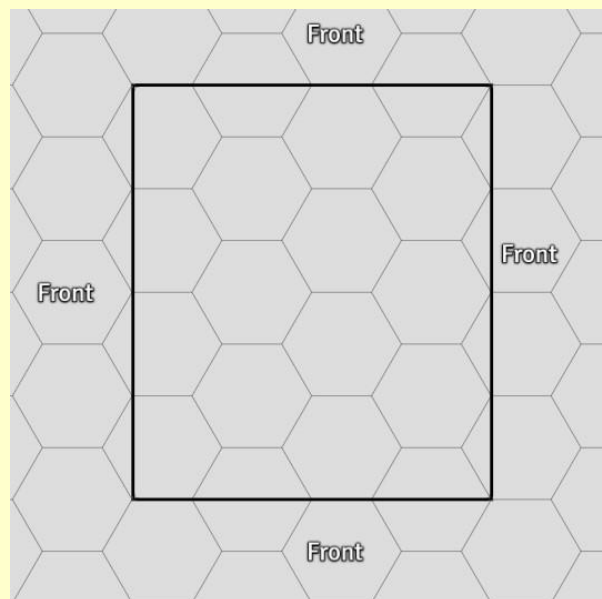
**Immunities:** metabolic hazards.

**Resistances:** +3 to all HT rolls to avoid knockdown, stunning, and torture.

**Defensive Traits:** High Pain Threshold; Injury Tolerance (Homogenous, No Blood, No Eyes, No Head, No Neck).

### Combat

The gelatinous cube's only mode of attack is simply moving through the prey and engulfing it.



**Engulf:** If the gelatinous cube starts its turn in close combat with prey or can move there on its turn, it tries to engulf its target; no attack roll is necessary and its quarry may defend only by dodging and retreating out of the way, if possible. In addition, if it is moving through an SM+1 or smaller creature, this counts as an automatic slam attempt (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6). Failure to dodge means being sucked inside and pinned if of lower SM than the gelatinous cube, or partly stuck in the gelatinous cube and grappled if of equal or greater SM. The victim can break free by winning a Quick Contest of ST (allowed only every 10 seconds if pinned; and on a 17 or 18, he becomes so entangled that he cannot escape on his own); the gelatinous cube has +10 to ST if pinning or +5 if grappling. Engulfed victims cannot breathe. If they run out of breath before they break free, they start to suffocate (see *Holding Your Breath*, p. B351 and *Suffocation*, p. B436). The typical gelatinous cube can pin/grapple one foe; later enemies are pushed along in front of it unless they win a Quick Contest of ST to prevent it from moving. The gelatinous cube can actively constrict engulfed victims, attacking them each turn with a Constriction Attack (p. B43). This ability has effective ST 30.

**If using FDG,** this ability works a bit differently. Upon the first contact, the gelatinous cube deals 3d control damage, and on each subsequent turn it may "attack" as a free action to automatically inflict 1d+2 extra control points. Grappled victims cannot breathe, and in addition, the gelatinous cube can actively constrict them (see *Strangle*, p. FDG5).

If a gelatinous cube's slam attempt is parried or blocked, the cube deals control damage against the weapon or shield. If the control rolled is more than half the victim's Control Maximum, it disarms the victim, keeps the weapon, and moves right along.

The cube must win a *Grab and Go* (p. FDG5) contest of its ST 50 vs. the target's ST+4 in order to keep moving. It can continue at its full move if it has engulfed creatures with total ST of 25 or less, half Move at total ST 26–50, and one yard if the total ST is ST 51–75. (In this case, this is always one yard, unless the gelatinous cube has been magically quickened.) Regardless of ST, it cannot *engulf* creatures of SM+3 or higher, but they are still grappled normally.

**Acid:** The creature secretes a digestive acid that dissolves organic materials, but does not affect stone and metal. Any organic creature or object touching the gelatinous cube takes 1d-1 corrosion damage per second. Engulfed creatures and objects take it as *Large-Area Injury* (p. B400).

**Paralysis:** A gelatinous cube secretes an anesthetizing slime. If a creature touches the gelatinous cube with its bare skin, it must roll HT to resist. It becomes paralyzed for 3 seconds per point of margin of failure. After that, the subject is stunned (p. B420) and may roll vs. HT once per second to recover. When the gelatinous cube is underwater, this slime is diluted – the victims get +3 to their HT rolls.

**Slipperiness:** The gelatinous cube has +5 on all ST, DX, and Escape rolls to slip restraints, break free in close combat, or squeeze through narrow openings. If using FDG, this gives Control DR 5 and +5 to DX when attacking to break free of an existing grapple.

**Trample:** thrust 2d+2 crushing. Can only be dodged. If the gelatinous cube knocks down a foe in a collision or slam and keeps on moving, it tramples automatically (damage halving is taken into account).

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 250 lbs.

| Control Thresholds |         |     |         |       |
|--------------------|---------|-----|---------|-------|
| ≥0.1×CM            | ≥0.5×CM | ≥CM | ≥1.5×CM | ≥2×CM |
| 5                  | 25      | 50  | 75      | 100   |

## Special Abilities

**Transparency:** The gelatinous cube is transparent both to normal vision, Infravision, and Ultravision. When motionless, this is identical to total invisibility (see p. B394), but the occasional random object floating in a well fed gelatinous cube's body could also serve as a warning of its presence to dungeon delvers. When the cube moves, it becomes easier to see – **Vision and attack rolls against it are at -6**, which is for the most part offset by SM.

## Useful Combat Rules

Holding Your Breath (p. B351).

Incidental Collisions (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

None Shall Pass (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 7).

Slam and Overrun (p. B392).

- Defense vs. Slams (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 9).

Suffocation (p. B436).

Trampling (p. B404).

Visibility (p. B394).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | -      | 10      | 15          | 10    |

**Ooze Senses:** The gelatinous cube is blind, but its entire body is a primitive sensory organ that can ascertain prey by scent and vibration. It uses standard range penalties instead of a -1/yard penalty when detecting smells, and gets a +5 bonus on Smell and Taste rolls (Sense roll 15). Its smell operates both in air and underwater. In addition, the ooze can detect vibrations in the air. It can locate prey in the dark, but cannot detect details. To use Vibration Sense, the ooze must make a Sense roll (10). Consult the *Size and Speed/Range Table* (p. B550) and apply separate bonuses for the target's size and speed, and a penalty for the range to the target. Wind will generate “noise” that interferes with this sense. Find the speed of the wind on the table and assess the relevant speed penalty. A successful roll reveals the rough size, location, speed, and direction of movement of the target, allowing the ooze to move to it and attempt to engulf it.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 0  | 0    |

The gelatinous cube is a mindless creature that slithers around in search of food.

**Mentality Traits:** Hidebound.

## Skills

None.

## Other Traits

Doesn't Breathe; Doesn't Sleep; Invertebrate; Mute; No Legs (Slithers); No Manipulators.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Gelatinous cubes are omnivorous scavengers that digest anything organic from living creatures to trash and carrion. They require no water to sustain themselves and have to consume about 25 lbs of organic material per month.

**Habitat:** Gelatinous cubes typically are found in underground locations or dungeons, preferably the heavily frequented ones. They can survive fine

underwater, but their paralyzing slime becomes diluted.

Gelatinous cubes avoid cold climates, as they begin to freeze in temperatures below 35°. A gelatinous cube that dies due to exposure to cold is indistinguishable from an ice block.

**Life Cycle:** Gelatinous cubes reproduce by division into two identical smaller cubes every six years. The little cubes grow to their full size in three months. The gelatinous cube does not age – it can only die due to injury or starvation.

### Capturing and Training

Being a mindless creature, the gelatinous cube cannot be tamed or trained. Sometimes, wizards or dungeon dwellers use gelatinous cubes as a means of cleaning out their lair of all manner of organisms and trash.

Using an *amulet of ooze riding*, a creature may “ride” the gelatinous cube. The cube rider sits in a force sphere created by the amulet inside the cube and bangs on the sphere to create vibrations to direct the cube.

**Untrained Value:** \$8,500.

**Trained Value:** \$85,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Gelatinous Cube).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.088

**Wage (Monthly):** \$2,550

### Mass Combat Statistics

#### 20 Gelatinous Cubes

*Battle Rating:* 2

*Classes:* Arm.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 4/16

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$51,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$51,000.

### Racial Template

286 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+40 (Size Modifier, -40%; No Manipulators, -40%) [80]; DX-2 [-40]; IQ-10 [-200]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+4; HP+97 (Size Modifier, -40%) [117]; Per+10 [50]; Basic Speed -4.00 [-80].

**Advantages:** Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink (Water Only, -50%) [5]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; High Pain Threshold [10]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Injury Tolerance (Homogenous, No Blood, No Eyes, No Head, No Neck) [62]; Invisibility (Affects Machines, +50%; Fringe, -10%) [56]; Reduced Consumption 4 (Food Only, -50%) [4];

Slippery 5 [10]; Unaging [15]; Universal Digestion [5].

**Acid:** Corrosion Attack 1d-1 (Accessibility, Only on organic materials, -15%; Always On, -20%; Aura, +80%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; Selective Effect, +20%) [10].

**Engulf:** Binding 30 (Always On, -20%; Aura, +80%; Constricting, Only on smaller targets, +55%; Engulfing, Only on smaller targets, +40%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; One-Shot, -10%; Selective Effect, +20%; Suffocating, Only on smaller targets, +55%; Unbreakable, +40%) [198].

**Ooze Senses** [22]: Acute Taste and Smell 5 [10] + Long-Range Smell [1] + Universal Smell [1] + Vibration Sense (Air) [10].

**Paralysis:** Affliction 1 (HT; Always On, -20%; Aura, +80%; Contact Agent, -30%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; Nuisance Effect, +3 to resist underwater, -5%; Paralysis, +150%; Reduced Duration, 1/20, -25%) [22].

**Disadvantages:** Blindness [-50]; Hidebound [-5]; Invertebrate [-20]; Mute [-25]; No Manipulators [-50].

**Features:** Early Maturation 5; No Legs (Slithers).

## Ghost (Lens)

Type: Undead (Spirit)



Forbidding mansions, poisoned wells, and abandoned temples—these forsaken places are where ghosts haunt and the living fear to venture. While many haunting rumors may be unfounded, those rooted in misery, terror, and death may hold truth. A ghost is a remnant of a being whose soul, unable to move on after death, is trapped, often due to an unfulfilled task. Less commonly, a ghost can arise from extreme evil, traumatic death, or lack of a proper burial.

A ghost's appearance often reflects its appearance in life, with variations influenced by its reason for becoming a ghost; for example, a drowning victim might constantly shed ghostly water, while a hanged man's head hangs loosely.

A ghost is an ectoplasmic being and hence vulnerable to certain substances and spells that affect ectoplasmic beings.

### Ecology

**Ghostly Prisoners:** While ghosts typically emerge from the state of mind of the recently deceased, they can also be artificially created. Malicious individuals can use a ghost charm—a rune-inscribed object buried with a fresh corpse—to trap a soul as a ghost. This soul can be freed by destroying the charm or removing it from the burial site. Impermanent charms, like parchment, may eventually disintegrate on their own.

**Habitat:** Ghosts inhabit the Ethereal Plane and bordering planes, primarily the Material Plane, as they cannot exist anywhere else. The ghost's temperature

comfort zone is extended by 5xHT degrees in both directions.

**Undead:** As undead creatures, ghosts do not need food, water, sleep, air, or experience aging. They are immune to metabolic hazards. Ghosts do not possess a FP score and are unable to reproduce sexually. However, unlike most undead, ghosts do replenish HP naturally.

### Mentality

Ghosts, unlike other forms of undead, retain their souls, though these souls are often corrupted. They typically arise from beings whose lives were marred by murder, vengeance, cruelty, or obsession. When these beings die, their compassion and love vanish, leaving only the darkest remnants of their personalities. Without a rational mind, the soul pursues its desires without regard for consequences.

An all-consuming purpose traps the soul in the mortal realm, transforming it into a ghost. For instance, a sadistic torturer may return to inflict suffering, while a victim might seek revenge on their murderer. Even though a ghost exists to fulfill its goal, it often lacks the ability to achieve it. Some ghosts have a clear purpose but are confined to a specific location, while others may wander aimlessly, gripped by strong emotions yet unable to recall what drives their anger. Such ghosts are doomed to unrest without external help, often lashing out at anyone who intrudes upon their domain.

Ghosts seldom submit to others. They may only serve someone if convinced that cooperation will help them achieve their goal. Bribes or threats are ineffective; instead, they might follow a charismatic figure offering false promises or become bound to a powerful spellcaster. An enslaved ghost resents its master, expressing its frustration through hateful words and by causing nearby objects to rattle or break.

A ghost perceives the world through a veil, filtering experiences according to its obsessions. If it has a hated enemy, it may view anyone it encounters as an agent of that enemy. Vivid memories of traumatic past events drive the ghost to relive its suffering, causing it to lash out in an attempt to avoid its tragic fate. However, in rare instances, a ghost might recognize living beings as those it once loved or respected. An intruder resembling a deceased spouse or long-lost child may inadvertently communicate with the delusional spirit. Clarity of mind for a ghost only arises when faced with its obsession, whether a person, place, or object, which remains clear in its perception.

Ghosts do not have any mandatory mental disadvantages, but most of them have either Obsession or Compulsive Behavior.

## Spoils

Some ghosts are bound to their burial place or site of death, where their valuable belongings may remain.

## Ghostly Equipment

When a ghost forms, all its equipment and carried items usually become ethereal along with it. In addition, the ghost retains 1d items that it particularly valued in life (provided they are not in another creature's possession). The equipment works normally on the Ethereal Plane but passes harmlessly through material objects or creatures.

The original material items remain behind, just as the ghost's physical remains do. If another creature seizes the original, the ethereal copy fades away. This loss invariably angers the ghost, who stops at nothing to return the item to its original resting place.

## Lens

526-723 points

**Applicable to:** Any aberration, animal, dragon, giant, humanoid, magical beast, monstrous humanoid, or plant.

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** HP+8 [16].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; ER 4 (Magic) [12]; Flight (Slow, -25%; Substantial Only, -10%) [26]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (Homogenous, No Blood) [45]; Resistant to Turning (+3) [1]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15].

**Etherealness** [257]: Insubstantiality (Accessibility, Not on the Ethereal Plane, -10%; Affect Substantial, +100%; Always On, -50%; Can Carry Objects, Heavy Encumbrance, +100%) [192] + Jumper (Planar; Accessibility, Only on the Ethereal Plane and planes that border it, -5%; Limited Access, Ethereal, -20%; Magical, -10%) [65].

**Rejuvenation:** Unkillable 3 (Accessibility, As long as it cannot rest in peace, -10%) [135].

**Ghost Abilities** (Select one to three of the following abilities) [6-203]:

**Acid Resistance** [46]: DR 20 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Limited, Acid, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [30] + Immunity to Noxious Acidic Effects [10] + Sealed (Acid-Resistant Only, -60%) [6].

**Chill Ray:** Fatigue Attack (Affects Substantial, +40%; Costs Fatigue, 1 ER, -10%; Freezing, +20%; Increased 1/2D, 5x, +10%; Magical, -10%; Side Effect, DX-2 and Numb, +90%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%) [21].

**Cold Resistance** [40]: DR 20 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Limited, Cold, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [30] + Immunity to Noxious Cold Effects [10].

**Corrupting Gaze:** Toxic Attack 1d (Magical, -10%; Malediction 1, +100%; Vision-Based, -20%; Vision-Based, Reversed, -20%) [6].

**Disease** [22]: Toxic Attack 1d-2 (Accessibility, Only affects the host, -10%; Affects Substantial, +40%; Always On, -10%; Aura, +80%; Contact Agent, Variant, -30%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; Onset, 1 day, Exposure Time, -50%; Resistible, HT-2, -20%) [2] + Possession (Does not allow control, -100%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Spiritual, -20%) [20].

**Draining Touch:** Natural Weapon (Toxic; Affects Substantial, +40%; Cannot Parry, -40%; Hidden, +20%; Intangible, +50%; Magical, -10%; No Signature, +20%) [8].

**Electricity Resistance** [45]: DR 20 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Limited, Electricity, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [30] + Immunity to Electrical Conduction [5] + Immunity to Noxious Electrical Effects [10].

**Energy Drain:** Leech 1 (Accelerated Healing, +25%; Affects undead spirits, +10%; Costs Fatigue, 2 ER, -15%; Magical, -10%; Malediction 2, +150%; Ranged, +40%; Requires Gestures, -10%; Requires Magic Words, -10%; Takes Extra Time 1, -10%; Vision-Based, Reversed, -20%) [63].

**Fire Resistance** [40]: DR 20 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Limited, Fire, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [30] + Immunity to Noxious Fire Effects [10].

**Frightful Moan:** Terror (-2) (Hearing; Magical, -10%) [45].

**Horrific Appearance** [12]: Horrific (Universal, +25%) [-30] + Terror (-3) (Vision; Always On, -20%; Magical, -10%) [42].

**Laughter of Madness:** Terror (-2) (Hearing; Confusion; Magical, -10%) [45].

**Lore:** Wild Talent 1 (Focused, Mental Skills, -20%; Game Time, +0%; Magical, -10%) [14].

**Magical Radiance:** Detect (Magic; Area Effect, 16 yards, Spherical, +265%; Based on IQ, Own Roll, +20%; Cannot Analyze, -10%; Costs Fatigue, 2 ER, -15%; Extended Duration, 3x, +20%; Magical, -10%; Persistent, +40%; Precise, +100%; Ranged, +40%; Reflexive, +40%; Requires Gestures, -10%; Requires Magic Words, -10%; Takes Extra Time 2, -20%; Visible, -10%) [54].

**Major Image:** Illusion (Costs Fatigue, 1 ER, -10%; Extended, Infravision, Smell/Taste, Touch, +50%; Magical, -10%; Ranged, +40%; Requires Gestures, -10%; Requires Magic Words, -10%) [38].

**Malevolence:** Possession (Magical, -10%; Spiritual, -20%) [70].

**Magic Resistance:** Magic Resistance 2 (Improved, +150%) [10].

**Suggestion:** Mind Control (Accessibility, Only on sapient beings, -10%; Costs Fatigue, 2 ER, -15%; Extended Duration, 10x, +40%; Fixed Duration, +0%;

Independent, +70%; Magical, -10%; Rationalization, +20%; Requires Magic Words, -10%; Suggestion, -40%; Takes Extra Time 2, -20%) [63]

**Telekinesis** [70]: Telekinesis 4 (Affects Substantial, +40%; Magical, -10%) [26] + Telekinesis 8 (Affects Substantial, +40%; Lift Only, -20%; Magical, -10%) [44]

**Disadvantages:** Dread (Religious Symbols; 5 yards) [-14]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Extra Skull DR [-2]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue.

**Creature Type:** Undead.

When applying the lens, make sure to check for conflicts between the two templates, remove traits that are not appropriate for a ghost, and modify lens characteristics that are affected by the base creature's traits, such as Size Modifier for the HP bonus.

## Mandatory Special Abilities

Due to the modularity of the ghost lens, most ghosts will have a varied array of special abilities. Thus, all the abilities should be explained in detail here. Each ghost has two mandatory abilities – etherealness and rejuvenation.

**Etherealness:** The ghost dwells on the Ethereal Plane, where it is invisible and insubstantial to material beings, but visible and tangible to other ethereal beings. It can perceive the tangible world with a -4 penalty to spot objects at any range, and -8 to resolve fine details, but not speak normally to those within it, and it cannot pick up normal objects or affect them in any way.

The ghost can materialize on the Material Plane or other plane that coexists with the Ethereal Plane at its current position as an insubstantial being, transporting itself through the planar boundaries as if using Jumper (p. B64). Physical and energy attacks cannot harm the materialized ghost, unless they have the Affects Insubstantial enhancement, but it is still vulnerable to psionic and (nonmaterial) magical attacks that target it directly (Maledictions and similar effects). Likewise, its physical and energy attacks cannot affect physical opponents. The ghost's psi abilities and magic spells (Maledictions and similar effects) can affect the physical world at no penalty. While materialized, the ghost can carry gear up to its Heavy Encumbrance.

Whether substantial or insubstantial, the ghost can fly in any direction at Move equal to its Basic Speed without making any noise.

Since this is a magical ability, the ghost cannot shift to the Ethereal Plane and back if there is no mana present. Likewise, if it somehow found a way to a

plane that does not border the Ethereal Plane, it is insubstantial there.

**Rejuvenation:** The ghost is very hard to destroy. Injury affects it normally. Once the ghost reaches 0 HP, it dissipates, but continues to heal normally. Once it is at full HP, its fully intact body will coalesce in a location of the GM's choosing and returns to its old haunts. The only way to get rid of a ghost for sure is to determine the reason for its existence and set right whatever prevents it from resting in peace. The exact means varies with each spirit and may require a good deal of research.

## Optional Special Abilities

The rest of the abilities are optional. A ghost usually has from one to three of them.

**Acid Resistance:** The ghost's entire body, including the eyes, has DR 20 against acid attacks and is immune to noxious acidic effects, including DR erosion.

**Chill Ray:** By spending 1 ER, the ghost may fire a ray of frost from its hand at a single target. The target may be substantial or insubstantial. This is a ranged attack that uses the Innate Attack (Beam) skill to hit with normal range penalties. The beam deals 1d fatigue damage, has Acc 3, 1/2D 5, and Max 10. Treat FP lost to the attack identically to FP lost to cold (p. B430). Targets who took damage from this spell must make an HT roll, at -1 per 2 points of FP lost, or take a -2 penalty to DX and become Numb (p. B146) for (20-HT) minutes (minimum 1 minute). If your foe is within one yard of the ghost, he may attempt to parry this attack (actually parrying the ghost's hand). This is a magical ability.

**Cold Resistance:** The ghost's entire body, including the eyes, has DR 20 against cold attacks and is immune to noxious cold effects.

**Corrupting Gaze:** With a Concentrate maneuver, the ghost may make its eyes glow bright red and assault the subject's soul. This magical ability is resolved as a Quick Contest of Will that requires the victim and the ghost to see each other with their unaided vision. The ghost's roll takes a -1 penalty per yard of distance. If the ghost wins, the victim takes 1d toxic damage, ignoring DR.

See *Avoiding Gaze Attacks (Serpents of Legend, p. 8)* for details on averting or hiding one's eyes.

**Disease:** A ghost with this magical ability may possess substantial creatures without actually controlling the body. The host possessed by a ghost with this ability suffers from a supernatural disease - he must roll against HT-2 every day of possession or take 1d-2 toxic damage, ignoring DR.

The ghost remains insubstantial during the possession, traveling inside the host but otherwise inaccessible to him and effectively mindless. Attacks

that affect insubstantial beings can injure the possessing ghost if they penetrate the host's DR. In this case, the host's HP act as extra DR. A genuine exorcist can cast the ghost out by winning a Quick Contest of his exorcism ability vs. the ghost's Will.

The ghost cannot return to a body it has been cast out of for at least 24 hours. It may choose to release his host at any time. If it is exorcised or leaves voluntarily, the host recovers after 1d seconds of mental stun.

To possess a new host, the ghost must concentrate for one second and physically touch him. Attempts to possess its own Puppet (p. B78) succeed automatically. In all other cases, roll a Quick Contest: the ghost's IQ vs. the subject's Will. The victim resists at +5 if he is in combat with the ghost or otherwise wary of it. If the ghost loses or ties, it is mentally stunned for 1d seconds. In addition, it may never attempt to possess that subject again – he is “immune” to the ghost. If the ghost wins, it merges with the victim's body.

**Draining Touch:** A ghost with this magical ability may touch any other insubstantial or substantial creature with its hand using Brawling or DX, dealing thrust toxic damage.

**Electricity Resistance:** The ghost's entire body, including the eyes, has DR 20 against electrical attacks and is immune to noxious electrical effects, including electrical conduction.

**Energy Drain:** This ability works identically to the [Soulrinker 1 \(Ranged\)](#) wizard spell but costs 2 ER instead of FP and the skill roll to cast is replaced with a Will roll.

**Fire Resistance:** The ghost's entire body, including the eyes, has DR 20 against fire attacks and is immune to noxious fire effects.

**Frightful Moan:** When a creature hears the moan or song of the ghost, it must roll a Fright Check at a -2 penalty. Regardless of the result, the victim becomes immune to this ability for one hour. The base Hearing range of this ability is 8 yards. This is a magical ability.

**Horrific Appearance:** The ghost has a truly disfigured and horrific appearance. This gives -6 on reaction rolls. When a creature sees the ghost, it must roll a Fright Check at a -3 penalty. Regardless of the result, the victim becomes immune to this ability for one hour. The Fright Check aspect of this is a magical ability.

**Laughter of Madness:** When a creature hears the maddening laughter of the ghost, it must roll a Fright Check at a -2 penalty using the Confusion variant table (*GURPS Powers*, p. 85). Regardless of the result, the victim becomes immune to this ability for one hour. The base Hearing range of this ability is 8 yards. This is a magical ability.

**Lore:** Once per day, tapping into the memories of the dead, a ghost may attempt a roll against any mundane skill based on IQ, Perception, or Will, using its score in the appropriate attribute. Default penalties are not applied, but situational and equipment modifiers apply normally, as do any modifiers for advantages or disadvantages. Tech level is irrelevant. This is a magical ability.

**Magic Resistance:** The ghost has Magic Resistance 2 with Improved (p. B67).

**Magical Radiance:** This ability works identically to the [Reveal Magic 4](#) wizard spell but costs 2 ER instead of FP and the skill roll to cast is replaced with an IQ roll.

**Major Image:** This ability works identically to the [Major Image](#) wizard spell but costs 1 ER instead of FP and doesn't require a skill roll to cast.

**Malevolence:** The ghost can possess material creatures. The ethereal body merges with and occupies the body of the ghost's host. It remains insubstantial during the possession, traveling inside the host but otherwise inaccessible to him and effectively mindless. Attacks that affect insubstantial beings can injure the possessing ghost if they penetrate the host's DR. In this case, the host's HP act as extra DR. A genuine exorcist can cast the ghost out by winning a Quick Contest of his exorcism ability vs. the ghost's Will.

The ghost cannot return to a body it has been cast out of for at least 24 hours. It may choose to release his host at any time. If it is exorcised or leaves voluntarily, the host recovers after 1d seconds of mental stun.

To possess a new host, the ghost must concentrate for one second and physically touch him. Attempts to possess its own Puppet (p. B78) succeed automatically. In all other cases, roll a Quick Contest: the ghost's IQ vs. the subject's Will. The victim resists at +5 if he is in combat with the ghost or otherwise wary of it. If the ghost loses or ties, it is mentally stunned for 1d seconds. In addition, it may never attempt to possess that subject again – he is “immune” to the ghost. If the ghost wins, it takes over the victim's body, completely suppressing his personality. The previous host regains control of its body (if sentient) after 1d seconds of mental stun, and “comes to” with no memory of the possession.

The ghost gain the new host's ST, DX, and HT (and secondary characteristics calculated from these scores), as well as his physical advantages and disadvantages. The ghost keeps its own IQ, Perception, and Will, and all of its mental traits. Its social traits may apply, depending on the laws and values of its society. Skills are a special case. The ghost's IQ-, Perception-, and Will-based skills are unchanged. Other skills remain at the same relative

skill level. For instance, if the ghost have Acrobatics at DX+3, then it would have Acrobatics-12 in a DX 9 body and Acrobatics-14 in a DX 11 body.

If the ghost occupies a sentient host, it has sufficient access to his memories for the first few hours of the takeover to learn his name and daily routine, but not enough to learn IQ-based skills. To recall a specific fact from the host's memories, the ghost must roll vs. IQ, at -1 per hour since the takeover. Only one attempt is allowed for any given memory!

This is a magical ability.

**Suggestion:** This ability works identically to the [Suggestion \(Ranged\)](#) wizard spell but costs 2 ER instead of FP and requires an IQ roll instead of a skill roll to cast.

**Telekinesis:** The ghost has a magical ability to manipulate insubstantial or substantial objects at a distance. This ability has a range of 10 yards and ST 12. It may move objects at Move 4, modified by encumbrance as usual.

Using this ability requires uninterrupted Concentrate maneuvers. This invisible pair of hands can take any one standard maneuver, using DX of the ghost. If this ability is used to grapple or attack, the foe defends as if against an invisible attacker. For more detail, see Telekinesis (p. B92).

## Ghost (Human Fighter)

Type: Undead (Spirit)

### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |     |        |         |
|----|----|----|-----|--------|---------|
| ST | 13 | HP | 21  | SM     | +0      |
| DX | 11 | BS | 5.5 | thr/sw | 1d/2d-1 |
| HT | 11 | FP | -   | BL     | 34 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d/1d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 95% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** B.

This is a ghost risen from a dead soldier. It possesses higher attributes than a typical human and has some combat skills. It cannot find rest due to improper burial. This ghost does not have legs – its ethereal lower body simply trails off into nothingness.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Air:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 34 | 68    | 102    | 204   | 340         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 3 (torso, arms, skull). Unlike most creatures, ghosts do not have extra 2 skull DR.

**Dodge:** 11.

**Parry:** 13 (thrusting broadsword).

**Block:** 13 (medium heavy shield; DB 2; \$60; 14 lbs.; DR 4, HP 20, Cover DR 9).

**Immunities:** knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Resistances:** +3 against turning.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes, Injury Tolerance (Homogenous, No Blood).

**Weaknesses:** Ghosts, as many undead spirits, suffer from a supernatural aversion to obviously presented religious symbols and must keep a distance of at least 5 yards from them. If outside forces bring the ghost and the symbol closer than that, the ghost must move away as fast as possible, by the most direct route possible, and may do nothing else until it moves beyond 5 yards. Ghosts can instantly sense the presence of such symbols as soon as they enter the forbidden radius but not their exact location. However, they do know the direction to them and hence the direction of flight.

### Combat

Most ghosts are unable to affect the material world without magical abilities, but they are able to combat other insubstantial creatures normally. The following attacks work *only against insubstantial beings*. Against substantial opponents, the ghost usually tries to use the malevolence ability.

**Thrusting Broadsword swing (14):** swing 2d cutting (RS: 1d+2), Reach 1, 3 lbs.

**Thrusting Broadsword thrust (14):** thrust 1d+2 impaling, Reach 1, 3 lbs.

**Shield Bash (14):** thrust 1d crushing, Reach 1, 14 lbs.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-1 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.7 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 17 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 7                    | 13        | 20                   | 26                 |

### Special Abilities

**Energy Reserve:** The ghost has ER 4 that is can use to power magical abilities. This particular ghost, however, has no abilities that would require it to spend ER.

**Etherealness:** The ghost dwells on the Ethereal Plane, where it is invisible and insubstantial to material beings, but visible and tangible to other ethereal beings. It can perceive the tangible world with a -4 penalty to spot objects at any range, and -8 to resolve fine details, but not speak normally to those within it, and it cannot pick up normal objects or affect them in any way.

The ghost can materialize on the Material Plane or other plane that coexists with the Ethereal Plane at its current position as an insubstantial being, transporting itself through the planar boundaries as if using Jumper (p. B64). Physical and energy attacks cannot harm the materialized ghost, unless they have the Affects Insubstantial enhancement, but it is still vulnerable to psionic and (nonmaterial) magical attacks that target it directly (Maledictions and similar effects). Likewise, its physical and energy attacks cannot affect physical opponents. The ghost's psi abilities and magic spells (Maledictions and similar effects) can affect the physical world at no penalty. While materialized, the ghost can carry gear up to its Heavy Encumbrance.

Whether substantial or insubstantial, the ghost can fly in any direction at Move equal to its Basic Speed without making any noise.

Since this is a magical ability, the ghost cannot shift to the Ethereal Plane and back if there is no mana present. Likewise, if it somehow found a way to a plane that does not border the Ethereal Plane, it is insubstantial there.

**Malevolence (10):** The ghost can possess material creatures. The ethereal body merges with and occupies the body of the ghost's host. It remains insubstantial during the possession, traveling inside the host but otherwise inaccessible to him and effectively mindless. Attacks that affect insubstantial beings can injure the possessing ghost if they penetrate the host's DR. In this case, the host's HP act as extra DR. A genuine exorcist can cast the ghost out by winning a Quick Contest of his exorcism ability vs. the ghost's Will.

The ghost cannot return to a body it has been cast out of for at least 24 hours. It may choose to release his host at any time. If it is exorcised or leaves voluntarily, the host recovers after 1d seconds of mental stun.

To possess a new host, the ghost must concentrate for one second and physically touch him. Attempts to possess its own Puppet (p. B78) succeed automatically. In all other cases, roll a Quick Contest: the ghost's IQ vs. the subject's Will. The victim resists at +5 if he is in combat with the ghost or otherwise wary of it. If the ghost loses or ties, it is mentally stunned for 1d seconds. In addition, it may never attempt to possess that subject again – he is

“immune” to the ghost. If the ghost wins, it takes over the victim's body, completely suppressing his personality. The previous host regains control of its body (if sentient) after 1d seconds of mental stun, and “comes to” with no memory of the possession.

The ghost gain the new host's ST, DX, and HT (and secondary characteristics calculated from these scores), as well as his physical advantages and disadvantages. The ghost keeps its own IQ, Perception, and Will, and all of its mental traits. Its social traits may apply, depending on the laws and values of its society. Skills are a special case. The ghost's IQ-, Perception-, and Will-based skills are unchanged. Other skills remain at the same relative skill level. For instance, if the ghost have Acrobatics at DX+3, then it would have Acrobatics-12 in a DX 9 body and Acrobatics-14 in a DX 11 body.

If the ghost occupies a sentient host, it has sufficient access to his memories for the first few hours of the takeover to learn his name and daily routine, but not enough to learn IQ-based skills. To recall a specific fact from the host's memories, the ghost must roll vs. IQ, at -1 per hour since the takeover. Only one attempt is allowed for any given memory!

This is a magical ability.

**Rejuvenation:** The ghost is very hard to destroy. Injury affects it normally. Once the ghost reaches 0 HP, it dissipates, but continues to heal normally. Once it is at full HP, its fully intact body will coalesce in a location of the GM's choosing and returns to its old haunts. The only way to get rid of a ghost for sure is to determine the reason for its existence and set right whatever prevents it from resting in peace. The exact means varies with each spirit and may require a good deal of research.

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | -           | -     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the ghost has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

### Skills

Bow-14; Broadsword-14; Shield-14; Stealth-14.

## Equipment

All the following equipment is ghostly – it cannot affect substantial beings and it disappears as soon as its original counterpart is taken by somebody.

Thrusting Broadsword (\$600; 3 lbs.)

Medium Heavy Shield (\$60; 14 lbs.)

Light Plate Armor (torso) (DR 3; \$1,000; 8 lbs.; Don 45; Holdout -3)

Light Plate Armor (arms) (DR 3; \$500; 4 lbs.; Don 23; Holdout -3)

Light Plate Pot Helm (DR 3; \$200; 1.6 lbs.; Don 9; Holdout -4)

*Total Weight:* 30.6 lbs.

*Total Cost:* \$2,360

## Capturing and Training

A ghost may be persuaded or bribed into serving as a soldier.

**Untrained Value:** \$30,130.

**Trained Value:** \$301,300.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.314

**Wage (Monthly):** \$9,000

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Ghost Fighters

*Battle Rating:* 37.5

*Classes:* Air, Eng.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80 (air)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$1,084,700.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$1,084,700.

## Racial Template

560 points

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** HP+8 [16].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; ER 4 (Magic) [12]; Flight (Slow, -25%; Substantial Only, -10%) [26]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (Homogenous, No Blood) [45]; Resistant to Turning (+3) [1]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15].

*Etherealness* [257]: Insubstantiality (Accessibility, Not on the Ethereal Plane, -10%; Affect Substantial, +100%; Always On, -50%; Can Carry Objects, Heavy Encumbrance, +100%) [192] + Jumper (Planar; Accessibility, Only on the Ethereal Plane and planes that border it, -5%; Limited Access, Ethereal, -20%; Magical, -10%) [65].

*Malevolence:* Possession (Magical, -10%; Spiritual, -20%) [70].

*Rejuvenation:* Unkillable 3 (Accessibility, As long as it cannot rest in peace, -10%) [135].

**Disadvantages:** Dread (Religious Symbols; 5 yards) [-14]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Extra Skull DR [-2]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** No Legs (Aerial); Not Subject to Fatigue.

# Ghoul

Type: Undead



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |           |
|----|----|----|----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 11 | HP | 11 | SM     | +0        |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5  | thr/sw | 1d-1/1d+1 |
| HT | 10 | FP | -  | BL     | 24 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-1/1d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-24. 20% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** C.

Ghouls are undead humanoids who devour the flesh of corpses. A ghoul appears as an emaciated, almost-hairless, mottled creature with a decaying hide stretched tight over its bones. It has the sharp teeth of a carnivore and sunken eyes that burn like hot coals. A grave stench accompanies ghouls at all times (-2 to reaction).

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 24 | 48    | 72     | 144   | 240         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** As an undead creature, the ghoul is destroyed when it reaches 0 HP.

## Combat

Ghouls ambush and surprise unwary victims, usually hiding behind gravestones or in shallow graves they can swiftly burst out of. Up close, they slash at victims with their filthy claws and fangs.

**Sharp Teeth (10):** thrust 1d-2 cutting + follow-up disease (ghoul fever; see below). Reach C. If the attack hits, the ghoul may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-1 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-3 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (10):** thrust 1d-2 cutting + follow-up paralysis (see below). Reach C.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.2 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 12 lbs.

### Control Thresholds

| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| 2                    | 6                    | 11        | 17                   | 22                 |

## Special Abilities

**Ghoul Fever:** Any living creature that has been injured by the ghoul's bite contracts ghoul fever unless it resists with a HT roll. This disease has an incubation period of one day, after which it deals 1d-2 toxic damage each day for six days. Each instance of damage can be negated with a HT roll. When the victim takes 1/3 of its HP in damage from this disease, it begins experiencing moderate pain until it heals above this threshold. Taking 1/2 HP in damage increases this effect to severe pain, and 2/3 HP in damage makes this terrible pain.

An afflicted humanoid who dies of ghoul fever must roll 1d. On 1-5, it rises as a ghoul at the next midnight. On a 6, it rises as a ghost instead. A humanoid who becomes a ghoul in this way retains none of the abilities it possessed in life. It is not under the control of any other ghouls, but it hungers for the flesh of the living and behaves like a normal ghoul in all respects.

**Paralysis:** The ghoul's claws are covered in paralytic ichor. Any living creature injured by the ghoul's claws must make a HT roll or become paralyzed for margin of failure seconds. After paralysis ends, the victim is physically stunned but able to recover normally.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the ghoul has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

Though a ghoul is an intelligent creature and not a mindless automaton, its hunger is an abiding reality. Ghouls also spend time decorating their lairs, tormenting prisoners, reading ancient texts, or exploring their territories. Usually, a ghoul seeks to satiate its hunger once per day, emerging at nightfall to seek out prey. Each ghoul's tastes vary, which can limit violent interactions with the living.

## Skills

Stealth-12.

## Ecology

**Diet:** Despite not requiring sustenance, a ghoul has an uncontrollable craving for carrion and flesh of the living. When encountering a living creature, the ghoul must roll against 6 to resist attacking it. Necromancers are fascinated by what happens to the meat ghouls consume. Ghouls have no natural digestive process and do not excrete solid or liquid wastes. Instead, consumed flesh is absorbed directly into the ghoul's decaying body, fueling the necromantic force that replaces the continuously rotting flesh. Ghouls forced to go without feeding are less likely to lose body parts, as the decay process is fueled by the same mechanism.

**Frightening Aura:** Besides exuding a vile smell, ghouls possess an unnatural aura that frightens animals. Animals react at -4 to ghouls, usually with fear or aggression.

**Habitat:** Ghouls haunt graveyards, battlefields, and other places rich with carrion. These creatures lurk wherever the stench of death hangs heavy, ready to devour the unwary.

Ghouls have their temperature comfort zone extended by 5xHT degrees in both directions.

**Origin:** Ghouls are said to be created upon the death of a person who savored human flesh. This assertion may or may not be true, but it explains their behavior. Some believe that anyone of exceptional

debauchery and wickedness risks becoming a ghoul. The transformation warps their minds, making them cunning and feral.

**Speech:** Ghouls retain their ability to speak any languages they knew in life, but are not good at talking. Their disturbing voice gives -2 on any speech-based reaction roll and -2 to Diplomacy, Fast-Talk, Performance, Public Speaking, Sex Appeal, and Singing.

**Undead:** As undead creatures, ghouls do not need food, water, sleep, air, or experience aging. They are immune to metabolic hazards. Ghouls do not possess a FP score, cannot naturally heal HP, and are unable to reproduce sexually.

## Spoils

Ghouls are intelligent creatures and sometimes are known to use weapons and other equipment.

## Capturing and Training

Some necromancers employ ghouls in their armies.

**Untrained Value:** \$3,320.

**Trained Value:** \$33,200.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.037

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,000

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Ghouls

*Battle Rating:* 4

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$119,600.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$119,600.

## Racial Template

The following racial template represents a humanoid ghoul. It can be applied as a lens to another racial template to simulate ghouls risen from non-human beings.

*9 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+1 [10].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (Unliving, No Blood) [25]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15].

*Ghoul Fever:* Toxic Attack 1d-2 (Cyclic, 6 1-day cycles, Resistible, +30%; Delay, 1 day, +0%; Follow-

Up, Teeth, +0%; Resistible, HT, -30%; Symptoms, 1/3 HP, Moderate Pain, +60%; Symptoms, 1/2 HP, Severe Pain, +80%; Symptoms, 2/3 HP, Terrible Pain, +60%) [6].

*Paralysis:* Affliction 1 (HT; Follow-Up, Claws, +0%; Paralysis, +150%; Reduced Duration, 1/60, -35%) [22].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Bad Smell [-10]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Frightens Animals [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Uncontrollable Appetite (6) (Living Flesh) [-30]; Unhealing (Total) [-30].

**Features:** Carrier (Must die of ghoul fever); Not Subject to Fatigue.

# Ghoul, Ghast

Type: Undead



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |         |
|----|----|----|------|--------|---------|
| ST | 14 | HP | 14   | SM     | +0      |
| DX | 11 | BS | 5.25 | thr/sw | 1d/2d   |
| HT | 10 | FP | -    | BL     | 39 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d/1d+2

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-24. 20% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** C.

Ghasts are a more powerful subtype of ghouls. They resemble very closely their undead cousin, except perhaps being just a bit more slender and ghost-like. The stench of death and rot lingers around their undead forms (-2 to reaction).

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 39 | 78    | 117    | 234   | 390         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 9 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** As an undead creature, the ghast is destroyed when it reaches 0 HP.

## Combat

Ghasts ambush and surprise unwary victims, usually hiding behind gravestones or in shallow graves they can swiftly burst out of. Up close, they slash at victims with their filthy claws and fangs.

**Sharp Teeth (13):** thrust 1d cutting + follow-up disease (ghoul fever; see below). Reach C. If the attack hits, the ghast may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-2 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (13):** thrust 1d cutting + follow-up paralysis (see below). Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.95 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 19.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 7                    | 14        | 21                   | 28                 |

## Special Abilities

**Ghoul Fever:** Any living creature that has been injured by the ghast's bite contracts ghoul fever unless it resists with a HT roll. This disease has an incubation period of one day, after which it deals 1d-2 toxic damage each day for six days. Each instance of damage can be negated with a HT roll. When the victim takes 1/3 of its HP in damage from this disease, it begins experiencing moderate pain until it heals above this threshold. Taking 1/2 HP in damage increases this effect to severe pain, and 2/3 HP in damage makes this terrible pain.

An afflicted humanoid who dies of ghoul fever must roll 1d. On 1-5, it rises as a ghoul at the next midnight. On a 6, it rises as a ghast instead. A humanoid who becomes a ghoul in this way retains none of the abilities it possessed in life. It is not under the control of any other ghouls, but it hungers for the flesh of the living and behaves like a normal ghoul in all respects.

**Paralysis:** The ghast's claws are covered in paralytic ichor. Any living creature injured by the ghast's claws must make a HT roll or become paralyzed for margin of failure seconds. After paralysis ends, the victim is physically stunned but able to recover normally.

**Stench:** Any living creature that inhales the stench exuded by the ghast in a 4-yard radius becomes

nauseated for margin of failure minutes unless it makes a successful HT roll.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).  
Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the ghast has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

In most regards, ghosts are the same as ghouls, but they exhibit greater cunning than their lesser cousins.

## Skills

Brawling-13; Stealth-13.

## Spoils

Ghosts are intelligent creatures and sometimes are known to use weapons and other equipment.

## Capturing and Training

Some necromancers employ ghosts in their armies.

**Untrained Value:** \$4,260.

**Trained Value:** \$42,600.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.044

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,275

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Ghosts

*Battle Rating:* 5.5

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$153,300.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$153,300.

## Racial Template

The following racial template represents a humanoid ghost. It can be applied as a lens to another racial template to simulate ghosts risen from non-human beings.

90 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+4 [40]; DX+1 [20].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (Unliving, No Blood) [25]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15].

*Ghoul Fever:* Toxic Attack 1d-2 (Cyclic, 6 1-day cycles, Resistible, +30%; Delay, 1 day, +0%; Follow-Up, Teeth, +0%; Resistible, HT, -30%; Symptoms, 1/3 HP, Moderate Pain, +60%; Symptoms, 1/2 HP, Severe Pain, +80%; Symptoms, 2/3 HP, Terrible Pain, +60%) [6].

*Paralysis:* Affliction 1 (HT; Follow-Up, Claws, +0%; Paralysis, +150%; Reduced Duration, 1/60, -35%) [22].

*Stench:* Affliction 1 (HT; Always On, -20%; Area Effect, 4 yards, +100%; Aura, +80%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; Nauseated, +30%; Respiratory Agent, +50%) [31].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Bad Smell [-10]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Frightens Animals [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Uncontrollable Appetite (6) (Living Flesh) [-30]; Unhealing (Total) [-30].

**Features:** Carrier (Must die of ghoul fever); Not Subject to Fatigue.

# Ghoul, Lacedon

Type: Undead



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 11 | <b>HP</b> | 11 | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-1/1d+1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | -  | <b>BL</b>     | 24 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-1/1d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-24. 20% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** C.

Lacedons, also known as sodden ghouls, are an aquatic type of ghoul. Similar to ghouls in all other respects, they are distinguished by their natural ability to swim as well as they can walk. A putrid stench accompanies lacedons at all times (-2 to reaction).

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 24 | 48    | 72     | 144   | 240         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** As an undead creature, the ghoul is destroyed when it reaches 0 HP.

## Combat

Lacedons ambush and surprise unwary victims, usually hiding in water.

**Sharp Teeth (10):** thrust 1d-2 cutting + follow-up disease (lacedon fever; see below). Reach C. If the attack hits, the lacedon may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-1 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-3 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (10):** thrust 1d-2 cutting + follow-up paralysis (see below). Reach C.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.2 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 12 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 6                    | 11        | 17                   | 22                 |

## Special Abilities

**Lacedon Fever:** Any living creature that has been injured by the lacedon's bite contracts lacedon fever unless it resists with a HT roll. This disease has an incubation period of one day, after which it deals 1d-2 toxic damage each day for six days. Each instance of damage can be negated with a HT roll. When the victim takes 1/3 of its HP in damage from this disease, it begins experiencing moderate pain until it heals above this threshold. Taking 1/2 HP in damage increases this effect to severe pain, and 2/3 HP in damage makes this terrible pain.

An afflicted humanoid who dies of lacedon fever must roll 1d. On 1-5, it rises as a lacedon at the next midnight. On a 6, it rises as a deep lacedon instead. A humanoid who becomes a lacedon in this way retains none of the abilities it possessed in life. It is not under the control of any other lacedons, but it hungers for the flesh of the living and behaves like a normal lacedon in all respects.

**Paralysis:** The lacedon's claws are covered in paralytic ichor. Any living creature injured by the lacedon's claws must make a HT roll or become paralyzed for margin of failure seconds. After paralysis ends, the victim is physically stunned but able to recover normally.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Teeth (p. MA115).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid* #3-26, pp. 7-8).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the lacedon has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

In most regards, lacedons are the same as ghouls.

## Skills

Stealth-12.

## Ecology

**Aquatic:** Lacedons are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater.

**Habitat:** Lacedons often lurk near reefs and rocky shores, places where ships and living creatures are likely to pass by. When not on land they are in water, usually prowling near unseen reefs and other dangerous locations where boats and ships are at risk of sinking.

Lacedons have their temperature comfort zone extended by 5xHT degrees in both directions.

Lacedons can survive at pressures up to 10 atmospheres. This lets them survive on most continental shelves.

**Speech:** Lacedons retain their ability to speak any languages they knew in life, but are not good at talking. Their disturbing voice gives -2 on any speech-based reaction roll and -2 to Diplomacy, Fast-Talk, Performance, Public Speaking, Sex Appeal, and Singing. Being aquatic creatures, lacedons are able to speak underwater.

## Spoils

Lacedons are intelligent creatures and sometimes are known to use weapons and other equipment.

## Capturing and Training

Some necromancers employ lacedons in their armies.

**Untrained Value:** \$3,320.

**Trained Value:** \$33,200.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.037

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,000

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Lacedons

**Battle Rating:** 4

**Classes:** Naval.

**Features:** Night.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 20/80

**Supply (Weekly):** \$0.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$119,600.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$119,600.

## Racial Template

The following racial template represents a humanoid lacedon. It can be applied as a lens to another racial template to simulate lacedons risen from non-human beings.

29 point

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+1 [10].

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (Unliving, No Blood) [25]; Pressure Support 1 [5]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Speak Underwater [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15].

**Lacedon Fever:** Toxic Attack 1d-2 (Cyclic, 6 1-day cycles, Resistible, +30%; Delay, 1 day, +0%; Follow-Up, Teeth, +0%; Resistible, HT, -30%; Symptoms, 1/3 HP, Moderate Pain, +60%; Symptoms, 1/2 HP, Severe Pain, +80%; Symptoms, 2/3 HP, Terrible Pain, +60%) [6].

**Paralysis:** Affliction 1 (HT; Follow-Up, Claws, +0%; Paralysis, +150%; Reduced Duration, 1/60, -35%) [22].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Bad Smell [-10]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Frightens Animals [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Uncontrollable Appetite (6) (Living Flesh) [-30]; Unhealing (Total) [-30].

**Features:** Carrier (Must die of lacedon fever); Not Subject to Fatigue.

# Goblin

Type: Humanoid (Goblin, Goblinoid)



**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 60 lbs.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Unattractive (-1 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** 40-400. 70% are warriors, 10% are bashers, 20% are archers. One healer per 100, one druid per 200. 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** L.

Goblins are small goblinoids common across Karilan, typically living in near-surface underground caverns. While often subjugated by other goblinoids, notably hobgoblins, goblins are a distinct and numerous race. They have flat faces, sloped foreheads, pointed ears, broad noses, small sharp fangs, and eyes ranging from red to yellow. Their skin varies from yellow to orange, deep red, or green, with each tribe sharing a uniform skin tone.

Despite their brutish and vulgar nature, goblins are surprisingly concerned with appearance, often engaging in body modifications to signify prestige or individuality in a collectivist society. Ear piercings are common among both sexes, with leaders and warriors often sporting numerous rings of precious metal. Damaged ears—marked by tears or notches—are typically the result of status changes, theft, or tribal conflicts. Tattoos and scarification, often depicting tribal totems, war, and death, are widespread and considered marks of pride. Prominent battle scars increase one's status, while branding, typically used for punishment or marking female ownership or slavery, is far harsher.

However, a sense of "fashion" does not extend to clothing. Goblin attire is ragged and stolen, with males favoring dark breeches, cloaks, and shirts, while females wear simple shifts designed for their role in constant childbirth.

## Mentality

Goblins are notoriously short-tempered, greedy, and prone to selfish behavior. Raised to be aggressive

and self-reliant, they preemptively eliminate rivals and exploit the weaknesses of others. They are known as universal bullies, targeting those weaker but fleeing from greater threats.

Culturally, goblins find it illogical to treat others kindly without gain, and their communities are often harsh and cutthroat. However, not all goblins are cruel or dim-witted. Rare individuals have overcome their greed and temper, becoming heroes and earning acceptance among more benevolent societies. For such goblins, choosing to serve good over evil can lead to long-term rewards despite the struggle against their upbringing.

**Typical Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Chauvinistic; Greed (15).

## Ecology

**Diet:** Goblins are omnivorous creatures who rarely bother about the quality of the food they consume. If supplies run short, they are willing to eat sentient creatures, including each other.

**Habitat:** Temperate plains and underground. The temperature comfort zone of a goblin falls between 35° and 90°.

**Lifecycle:** Female goblins are viewed as communal property, except for a few marked as belonging to leaders, priests, or heroes. Their vital role in reproduction offers them some protection from violence, though troublesome or infertile females risk execution. Goblin females are highly fertile, with annual pregnancies following a five-month gestation period and brief recovery. Infertility is viewed as a curse, and childbirth complications are a leading cause of female mortality.

Young goblins develop rapidly, crawling by three months, walking by six, and growing fangs and hair by their first year. Mothers nurse infants until they birth their next young, after which the children join peer groups by age three, learning survival and dominance skills. By nine, goblins reach maturity and integrate into tribe life, though many young succumb to competition, predation, or cannibalistic adults, particularly pregnant females seeking sustenance.

Goblins can live up to 80 years, but most die before 20. Females and priests live the longest, while males frequently perish in raids, internal conflicts, or executions for incompetence. Entire scouting or raiding parties may be sacrificed to Maglubiyet for failure or cannibalized if they return empty-handed.

## Society

Goblin society is tribal, typically led by the strongest or occasionally the smartest individual, who claims the best weapons and power through betrayal or aggression. Some leaders gain authority as clerics of goblin gods. Due to their violent culture, goblins

are often dominated by larger, stronger beings, such as hobgoblins or bugbears.

Privacy is foreign to goblins, who live and sleep in communal spaces. Only their leaders enjoy private chambers. Goblin lairs are filthy and riddled with simple traps for defense, with the inner chambers being the most populated and secure. Goblin settlements are filled with children, as goblin females are expected to birth frequently to offset high mortality rates. However, young goblins rarely outnumber adults since their lives are equally perilous.

Males sustain tribes through raiding and theft, operating under the cover of night, while females are confined to reproduction. Many female goblins leave this rigid lifestyle to integrate into other societies. Tribes may ambush travelers or capture slaves for labor in their lairs or camps.

**Language:** Goblins speak Goblin, a language that serves as the root of other goblinoid tongues. Most goblins, however, are illiterate.

**Religion:** Goblins primarily worship Maglubiyet, the chief deity of the goblinoid pantheon.

**Relationships:** Goblins are widely regarded as nuisances and distrustful of most other races, especially fellow goblinoids. They share an uneasy cooperation with orcs and half-orcs but form true alliances only with worgs, who act as their mounts and battle companions. Goblins are particularly hostile toward dwarves, gnomes, and elves. Some tribes manage to domesticate large wolves to aid in hunting or combat.

## Racial Template

-39 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-2 [-20]; DX+1 [20].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM-1; HP-1 [-2]; Basic Move -1 [-5].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 1 [2]; Infravision [10]; Rapid Healing [5]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Silence 1 [5].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Unattractive) [-4]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (12) [-10]; Greed (15) [-7]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10].

**Quirks:** Chauvinistic [-1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 1.

## Goblin Archer

*Type: Humanoid (Goblin, Goblinoid)*

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 9  | <b>HP</b> | 8   | <b>SM</b>     | -1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-2/1d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | 10  | <b>BL</b>     | 16 lbs.   |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-2/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 60 lb.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Unattractive (-1 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

This is an experienced goblin archer.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 16 | 32    | 48     | 96    | 160         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2\* (torso; medium leather armor; -1 vs. impaling).

**Dodge:** 9.

**Parry:** 9 (dagger); 10 (unarmed).

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

### Combat

Goblin archers try to stay away from their enemies and take well-aimed shots at vulnerable body parts, such as face to try to stun the enemy.

**SM-1 Regular Bow (13):** thrust 1d-1 impaling, Acc 2, x15/x20 (135/180), RoF 1, 1(2), Bulk -7.

**SM-1 Dagger (13):** thrust 1d-3 impaling, Reach C, 0.2 lb.

**SM-1 Dagger throw (8):** thrust 1d-3 impaling, Acc 0, x0.5/x1 (4/9), 0.2 lb., Bulk -1.

**Sharp Teeth (12):** thrust 1d-3 cutting, Reach C. If the attack hits, the goblin may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-2 control against SM-4 and smaller victims or 1d-4 control against larger ones.

**Punch (12):** thrust 1d-3 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-2 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.8 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 8 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 5                    | 9         | 14                   | 18                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 12          | 11    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the goblin can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Chauvinistic; Greed (15).

## Other Traits

Rapid Healing; Silence 1.

## Skills

Bow-13; Camouflage-13; Climbing-13; Fast-Draw (Arrow)-12; Knife-13; Stealth-13\*.

\* Includes a +1 from Silence. Add an extra +1 if staying still.

## Equipment

SM-1 Dagger (\$13; 0.2 lbs.)

SM-1 Regular Bow (\$64; 1.3 lbs.)

SM-1 Shoulder Quiver (\$6.4; 0.32 lbs.)

12 x SM-1 Arrow (\$1.3; 0.06 lb.)

SM-1 Medium Leather Armor (torso) (DR 2\*; \$64; 7.7 lbs.; Don 30; Holdout -2)

*Total Weight:* 10.24 lbs.

*Total Cost:* \$163

## Capturing and Training

Goblins are often bullied into serving as soldiers by stronger races.

**Young Value:** \$75.

**Untrained Value:** \$135.

**Trained Value:** \$3,850.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.25 and 1.1 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.004

**Wage (Monthly):** \$115

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Goblin Archers**

*Battle Rating:* 0.5

*Classes:* F, Recon.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 16/64

*Supply (Weekly):* \$600.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$13,900.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$18,300.

## Goblin Basher

*Type:* Humanoid (Goblin, Goblinoid)

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |         |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|---------|
| <b>ST</b> | 10 | <b>HP</b> | 9   | <b>SM</b>     | -1      |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-2/1d |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | 11  | <b>BL</b>     | 20 lbs. |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-2/1d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 60 lb.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Unattractive (-1 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

This is an experienced goblin warrior with better-than-normal gear.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

With the current loadout, the goblin basher is lightly encumbered, so his actual speed is Move 3; exploration 1.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 20 | 40    | 60     | 100   | 200         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 3 (torso and legs; light segmented plate armor).

**Dodge:** 9 (-1 for encumbrance is taken into account).

**Parry:** 9U (morningstar); 10 (unarmed).

**Block:** 11 (small heavy shield; DB 1; \$25.6; 3.84 lb.; DR 4, HP 10, Cover DR 6).

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

### Combat

Despite having good equipment, goblin bashers rarely use complex tactics unless supervised.

**SM-1 Morningstar (12):** swing 1d+2 crushing, Reach 1, unbalanced, 3.8 lb. Attempts to parry morningstars are at -4; fencing weapons can't parry at all! Attempts to block such weapons are at -2.

**Shield Bash (12):** thrust 1d-2 crushing, Reach 1, 3.84 lb.

**Sharp Teeth (11):** thrust 1d-3 cutting, Reach C. If the attack hits, the goblin may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per

**Teeth** (p. MA115), applying 1d-2 control against SM-4 and smaller victims or 1d-4 control against larger ones.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-3 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-2 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 10 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 4                    | 8         | 12                   | 16                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 11          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the goblin can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Chauvinistic; Greed (15).

## Other Traits

Rapid Healing; Silence 1.

## Skills

Flail-12; Shield-12; Stealth-12\*.

\* Includes a +1 from Silence. Add an extra +1 if staying still.

## Equipment

SM-1 Morningstar (\$51; 3.8 lbs.)

SM-1 Small Heavy Shield (DB 1; \$25.6; 3.84 lb.; DR 4, HP 10, Cover DR 6)

SM-1 Light Segmented Plate Armor (torso) (DR 3; \$384; 10.24 lbs.; Don 45; Holdout -3)

SM-1 Light Segmented Plate Armor (legs) (DR 3; \$384; 10.24 lbs.; Don 45; Holdout -3)

**Total Weight:** 28.12 lbs.

**Total Cost:** \$844.6

## Capturing and Training

Goblins are often bullied into serving as soldiers by stronger races.

**Young Value:** \$75.

**Untrained Value:** \$135.

**Trained Value:** \$4,400.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.25 and 1.1 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.005

**Wage (Monthly):** \$130

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Goblin Bashers**

**Battle Rating:** 0.5

**Classes:** None.

**Features:** Night.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 12/48

**Supply (Weekly):** \$600.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$15,850.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$2,000.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$20,250.

## Goblin Druid

**Type:** Humanoid (Goblin, Goblinoid)

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 8  | <b>HP</b> | 7   | <b>SM</b>     | -1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | 11  | <b>BL</b>     | 13 lbs.   |

**Reduced Swing:** 1d-3/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 60 lb.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Unattractive (-1 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

As a rule, goblins rarely care about nature. The goblin druid is an exile from the goblin society who has taken up a role of a forest protector.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 13 | 26    | 39     | 78    | 130         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 11 (staff); 8 (unarmed).

### Combat

Goblin druid prefers to avoid melee combat, trying to rely on his spells instead.

**SM-1 Long Staff swing (12):** swing 1d crushing (RS: 1d+1), Reach 2-3, 2.6 lb.

**SM-1 Long Staff thrust (12):** thrust 1d-1 crushing, Reach 2-3, 2.6 lb.

**Sharp Teeth (11):** thrust 1d-4 cutting, Reach C. If the attack hits, the goblin may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-3 control against SM-4 and smaller victims or 1d-5 control against larger ones.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-4 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-3 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.65 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 6.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 4                    | 8         | 12                   | 16                 |

## Special Abilities

**Spellcasting:** The goblin druid is a divine spellcaster with Druidic Talent 1. The goblin druid has three learned spells:

[Create Water 1](#) (10);

[Hail of Stone](#) (11);

[Wall of Thorns 1](#) (11).

For more detailed rules for druidic spellcasting, see *Powers of Karilan*.

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 12          | 11    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the goblin can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 11 | 11   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Chauvinistic; Greed (15).

## Other Traits

Rapid Healing; Silence 1.

## Skills

First Aid-12; Herb Lore-10; Innate Attack (Gaze)-12; Naturalist (Earthlike)-12; Religious Ritual (Druidic)-12; Staff-12; Stealth-12\*; Theology (Druidic)-10.

\* Includes a +1 from Silence. Add an extra +1 if staying still.

**Spellcasting Skills:** Domain of Earth-11; Domain of Plant-11; Domain of Water-10.

## Capturing and Training

Goblins are often bullied into serving as soldiers by stronger races.

**Young Value:** \$75.

**Untrained Value:** \$135.

**Trained Value:** \$19,800.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.25 and 1.1 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.021

**Wage (Monthly):** \$595

## Goblin Healer

Type: Humanoid (Goblin, Goblinoid)

### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |           |
|----|----|----|------|--------|-----------|
| ST | 8  | HP | 7    | SM     | -1        |
| DX | 11 | BS | 5.25 | thr/sw | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| HT | 10 | FP | 10   | BL     | 13 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-3/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 60 lb.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Unattractive (-1 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

This is a goblin whose main mission is not to attack or rob, but to tend to the wounds of the injured tribe members. He knows where to find curative herbs and how to treat injuries, but does not possess any supernatural abilities.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 13 | 26    | 39     | 78    | 130         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8 (baton); 8 (unarmed).

### Combat

Goblin healer generally tries to avoid combat, but if presented with no other choice, he will try to fight with a stick.

**SM-1 Baton swing (10):** swing 1d-2 crushing (RS: 1d-1), Reach 1, 0.6 lb.

**SM-1 Baton thrust (10):** thrust 1d-3 crushing, Reach 1, 0.6 lb.

**Sharp Teeth (11):** thrust 1d-4 cutting, Reach C. If the attack hits, the goblin may elect to hold on and

grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-3 control against SM-4 and smaller victims or 1d-5 control against larger ones.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-4 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-3 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.65 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 6.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 4                    | 8         | 12                   | 16                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

*Teeth* (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 12          | 11    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the goblin can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Chauvinistic; Greed (15).

## Other Traits

Rapid Healing; Silence 1.

## Skills

First Aid-12; Naturalist (Earthlike)-12; Shortsword-10; Stealth-12\*.

\* Includes a +1 from Silence. Add an extra +1 if staying still.

## Capturing and Training

Goblins are often bullied into serving as soldiers by stronger races.

**Young Value:** \$75.

**Untrained Value:** \$135.

**Trained Value:** \$1,100.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.25 and 1.1 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.003

**Wage (Monthly):** \$100

# Goblin Warrior

*Type: Humanoid (Goblin, Goblinoid)*



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |           |
|----|----|----|------|--------|-----------|
| ST | 8  | HP | 7    | SM     | -1        |
| DX | 11 | BS | 5.25 | thr/sw | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| HT | 10 | FP | 10   | BL     | 13 lbs.   |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-3/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 60 lb.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Unattractive (-1 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

This is a goblin warrior with basic weapon training.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 13 | 26    | 39     | 78    | 130         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2\* (torso; medium leather armor; -1 vs. impaling).

**Dodge:** 9.

**Parry:** 9U (mace); 9 (javelin); 9 (unarmed).

**Block:** 9 (small light shield; DB 1; \$10; 1 lb.; DR 2, HP 8, Cover DR 4).

## Combat

Being bullied by bigger, stronger creatures has taught goblins to exploit what few advantages they have: sheet numbers and malicious ingenuity. The concept of a fair fight is meaningless in their society.

They favor ambushes, overwhelming odds, dirty tricks, and any other edge they can devise.

Goblins have a poor grasp of strategy and are cowardly by nature, tending to flee the field if a battle turns against them. With proper supervision, though, they can implement reasonably complex plans, and in such circumstances their numbers can be a deadly advantage.

**SM-1 Small Round Mace (11):** swing 1d-1 crushing (RS: 1d), Reach 1, unbalanced, 1.9 lb.

**SM-1 Small Round Mace throw (7):** swing 1d-1 crushing (RS: 1d), Acc 1, x1/x1.5 (8/12), 1.9 lb., Bulk -3.

**SM-1 Javelin throw (11):** thrust 1d-2 impaling, Acc 3, x1.5/x2.5 (12/20), 1.3 lbs., Bulk -4.

**SM-1 Javelin thrust (11):** thrust 1d-2 impaling, Reach 1, 1.3 lbs.

**Shield Bash (11):** thrust 1d-3 crushing, Reach 1, 1 lb.

**Sharp Teeth (11):** thrust 1d-4 cutting, Reach C. If the attack hits, the goblin may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-3 control against SM-4 and smaller victims or 1d-5 control against larger ones.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-4 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-3 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.65 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 6.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 4                    | 8         | 12                   | 16                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 11          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the goblin can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Chauvinistic; Greed (15).

## Other Traits

Rapid Healing; Silence 1.

## Skills

Axe/Mace-11; Shield-11; Spear-11; Stealth-12\*; Throwing Weapon (Spear)-11.

\* Includes a +1 from Silence. Add an extra +1 if staying still.

## Equipment

SM-1 Small Round Mace (\$16; 1.9 lbs.)

SM-1 Javelin (\$19; 1.3 lbs.)

SM-1 Small Light Shield (DB 1; \$10; 1 lb.; DR 2, HP 8, Cover DR 4)

SM-1 Medium Leather Armor (torso) (DR 2\*; \$64; 7.7 lbs.; Don 30; Holdout -2)

**Total Weight:** 11.9 lbs.

**Total Cost:** \$109

## Capturing and Training

Goblins are often bullied into serving as soldiers by stronger races.

**Young Value:** \$75.

**Untrained Value:** \$135.

**Trained Value:** \$1,350.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.25 and 1.1 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.001

**Wage (Monthly):** \$40

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Goblin Warriors**

**Battle Rating:** 0.16

**Classes:** None.

**Features:** Night.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 12/48

**Supply (Weekly):** \$600.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$4,850.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$2,000.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$9,250.

## Gray Render

Type: *Magical Beast*



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 28 | <b>HP</b> | 28  | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 3d-1/5d+1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12  | <b>BL</b>     | 157 lbs.  |

*Reduced Swing:* 3d-1/3d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 4,000 lbs.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Organization:** Solitary. 20% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E, C.

Fierce and ferocious, the gray render is a lethal predator residing in isolated wilderness areas. With dense muscles and robust bones, gray renders are colossal and formidable beings. They walk on two feet with a hunched posture, their elongated arms dragging on the ground. Despite this stance, they stand about nine feet tall, and their broad shoulders span four feet.

A gray render's body is hairless, featuring sharp claws on its hands and powerful jaws filled with black teeth. Perhaps most distinctively, it possesses six small, yellow eyes, arranged in two rows on its sloping forehead. Rangers have reported witnessing renders using their jaws to uproot trees three feet in diameter and splintering them within minutes.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 157 | 314   | 471    | 942   | 1,570       |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 3\* (tough skin).

**Skull:** In addition to the normal additional DR 2, the skull is covered by thick bone plates that provide extra DR 4. Thus, the skull has total DR 9.

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Notes:** A character can target a gray render's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Gray Render) roll.

The gray render's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +2 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

Unlike most creatures, the gray render has six eyes.

### Combat

When a gray render attacks, it aims to kill, whether hunting prey or protecting itself and those it has adopted. While hunting, it sometimes hides and awaits unsuspecting prey. Gray renders possess exceptional manual dexterity, comparable to that of a human. They might pick up a discarded weapon and break it in half, though they rarely wield weapons themselves. Despite having the ability to use tools, they prefer to rely on their razor-sharp claws to rip apart their opponents, which is how they earned their name.

**Bite (14):** thrust 3d+1 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the gray render may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 3d+2 control against SM+0 and smaller victims or 3d control against larger ones.

**Claws (14):** thrust 3d+1 cutting. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 3d+2 control. Reach C-1. Effective ST 30 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 7.85 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 78.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 15                   | 30        | 45                   | 60                 |

### Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5). Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 14     | 11      | 15          | 11    |

**Vision:** A gray render's eyes are one of its most distinctive features and cause naturalists all sorts of difficulties. There is no doubt as to their insectlike structure, each being composed of hundreds of tiny ocelli. The gray render possesses **Peripheral Vision** (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

Gray renders are able to see well at night. They have **Night Vision 5**.

Aside from normal vision, the gray render can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

In addition, gray render's eyes are able to detect light polarization. The gray render knows the true direction of the sun even through clouds, and can navigate without a penalty for being unable to see it. It has +2 to spot water surfaces from above or below.

**Smell:** The gray render has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

**Hearing:** Gray renders lack external ears. Nonetheless, a gray render enjoys a sense of hearing comparable to that of a human.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 6  | 10   |

Gray renders are bestial creatures with a savage temper.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bloodlust (9); Sense of Duty (Adopted Creatures); Wild Animal.

## Skills

Brawling-14; Intimidation-14; Stealth-11; Survival (Swampland)-13; Tracking-15; Wrestling-14.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Day.

**Bonding:** For unknown reasons, a gray render always forms a bond with a group of other creatures and remains close to them, protecting them as if they were its own offspring. Instances of this behavior include gray renders bonding with diverse creatures such as horses, wolves, displacer beasts, and even humanoid groups. Aerial creatures like pegasi and hippogriffs are less common companions due to the

difficulty the gray render faces in staying with them when they fly, though such bonds do occur.

There is always only a single gray render with any group; they avoid others of their kind and are never found in numbers. This might explain their bonding tendency: lacking their own kind, gray renders might seek companionship and belonging by adopting members of other species. Despite their formidable appearance and aggressive nature in defense, their primary drive may be an overwhelming sense of isolation and loneliness.

Regardless of what their bond-creatures eat, gray renders offer fresh meat daily. Herbivores ignore these offerings, which then attract scavengers like jackals and hyenas that follow the render's "family." Gray renders view anyone approaching their adopted group as intruders and attack to kill but do not pursue retreating enemies.

Over time, the bond between the gray render and its adopted wards, particularly herbivores, becomes mutual. Recognizing the gray render's protective role, many animal herds prefer to keep their guardian in sight. The instinct to protect runs deep in gray renders, so much so that they risk their lives for their adopted group and will not harm them, even if attacked by them initially.

This behavior has led some sages to speculate that gray renders are a created race, possibly designed by wizards to protect various groups of animals or as devoted bodyguards. Others believe gray renders might have developed naturally on another world, with wizards later learning to create them in magical laboratories due to their obvious advantages.

**Bone Plates:** The thick, bony plates on a gray render's head have unique patterns, making it easy to distinguish between different "families." A newborn's crest matches that of its parent, while a newly-created gray render, crafted by a wizard's intricate magical rituals, has a unique crest. Subsequent generations inherit this original crest. However, gray renders themselves ignore their crests and avoid others of their kind regardless of pattern.

**Diet:** Gray renders are carnivorous predators, often followed by other predators or scavengers seeking leftover scraps from their kills.

**Habitat:** They inhabit temperate marshes, thriving in temperatures between 35° and 90°F.

**Language:** With an IQ of 6, gray renders can understand spoken language but have none of their own. They learn languages from nearby creatures, especially if they adopt humanoid tribes, and can be trained to follow verbal commands. In the wilderness with animal families, they lack the opportunity to learn language. Gray renders cannot speak but can grunt, roar, and snarl.

**Lifecycle:** Gray renders reproduce asexually once in their lifetime, shortly after reaching adulthood. They produce a single offspring that grows from a bud and develops in the adult's marsupial pouch, nursing there for six months until it reaches the size of a small chimpanzee.

In the following year, the young gray render rapidly grows to full size and chooses an adopted animal family. This is biologically driven, as they can't function without a family to protect. They adopt vertebrates between SM-2 and SM+1, preferring larger groups, animals with lower intelligence, and herbivores or omnivores. The more defenseless the group, the more likely the gray render will bond with them.

Once bonded, gray renders remain loyal, watching over many generations of their adopted family. If all members die, they seek a new group; however, they stay with any remaining member, no matter the circumstances, often providing food until the last ward perishes.

**Origin:** Many sages speculate that gray renders may originate from the Outer Planes or an alternate reality, due to their unique features such as a mammalian (marsupial) build, insectoid eyes, and unusual asexual reproduction. Some believe they were created by the neogi, given their occasional companionship with these creatures.

In reality, gray renders are a created race, designed thousands of years ago by silver dragon wizards (often in elven form) as bodyguards for their minions. Their instinctive drive to bond and self-replicating reproduction were intended to ensure the silver dragons wouldn't need to create new bodyguards frequently.

This creation method was passed down from silver dragons to elven communities and then to wizards of various races. Today, the knowledge of creating gray renders is fairly common among wizardly scholars, though their origins are largely forgotten.

**Sleep:** Gray renders possess the **Light Sleeper** disadvantage (p. B142).

**Teeth:** Gray render teeth grow continuously, with new teeth replacing older ones. The multiple layers of teeth contribute to its powerful bite. Dislodged teeth are often found embedded in bite victims due to new growth pushing older teeth out.

## Spoils

A gray render's teeth can be used as primitive arrowheads, and larger ones as spearheads. While the claws are too curved for thrown weapons, they are often embedded in wooden clubs as spikes. The claws and teeth of a gray render are also worn as tokens of

martial prowess, given the danger of battling such a creature.

When designing gray render hide armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid #3-52*, use the following statistics: WM 0.8, Cost \$35, DR/inch 9, Max DR 6, Combustible, Flexible, Construction: fabric, layered fabric, scale.

Skull bone plates also can be used to create armor. Use the following statistics: WM 1, Cost \$45, DR/inch 10, Max DR 7, Construction: scale, solid. A typical gray render yields 3 square feet of bone plates.

## Capturing and Training

Gray renders can be controlled and used in warfare, especially if the controller is one of the bonded creatures.

**Young Value:** \$2,500.

**Untrained Value:** \$12,725.

**Trained Value:** \$127,250.

**Supply Cost:** \$18 and 6.8 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Training Skill:** Animal Handling (Gray Render).

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Gray Render).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.133.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$3,800.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Gray Renders

*Battle Rating:* 8

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96.

*Supply (Weekly):* \$9,600.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$195,450.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$235,900.

## Racial Template

*180 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+18 (Size Modifier, -10%) [162]; IQ-4 [-80]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Will+4 [20]; Per+5 [25]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Acute Vision 3 [6]; Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 4 (Outer Layer; Partial, Skull Only, -70%) [8]; DR 3 (Tough Skin, -40%) [9]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Extended Lifespan 4 [8]; Infravision [10]; Night Vision 5 [5]; Payload 5 [5]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1].

**Disadvantages:** Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bloodlust (9) [-15]; Light Sleeper [-5]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Sense of Duty (Adopted Creatures) [-5]; Wild Animal [-30].

**Perks:** Polarization Detection [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; Early Maturation 8; Parthenogenesis.

# Griffon

Type: *Magical Beast (Hybrid)*



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 16 | <b>HP</b> | 16 | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+1/2d+2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | 11 | <b>BL</b>     | 51 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+1/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Winged Quadruped (p. B553).

**Weight:** 500 lbs.

**Length:** 8 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-10. 25% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** H.

The griffon, a famous creature in both legend and lore, is viewed as both a formidable monster and a coveted flying mount. Described by scholars as a ferocious avian carnivore, it is arguably the most successful large flying predator, surpassing even dragons in both commonality and ferocity.

Griffons feature the body of a lion, coupled with the taloned forelimbs, wings, and heads of eagles, along with distinctive tufted ears. Their fur ranges from golden bronze to dark brown, darkening as they age. Males display touches of red on their breast feathers, while females sport duller hues.

Comparable in size to the largest lions and tigers, griffons are robust, particularly in the chest and shoulders to support their wings and flight muscles. Contrary to artistic depictions of them with slender forelimbs, a griffon's forelegs are as powerful as a lion's, capable of neck-breaking strikes. Their six-inch talons can slash and grip with bone-crushing force, and they can topple large animals with a single sweep.

With wingspans of eight to nine yards, griffons are awe-inspiring in flight. Though their tails

resemble that of a lion, they aid in steering and balance. Their moderately pointed wings are ideal for both soaring and diving onto prey. Griffon feathers are gold, often with black patterns, completing their majestic appearance.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 8/12; exploration 6 miles per hour.

**Air:** Move 12/24; exploration 12 miles per hour. Cannot hover – must move at least at Move 3 when flying. In order to take off or land, the griffon must have an open area with a radius of 5 yards in all directions.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 51 | 102   | 153    | 306   | 510         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** The front part of the griffon (hex #1), including torso, forelimbs, neck, wings, and head, are protected with thick feathers with DR 2\*. The rest of the body is protected with DR 1\* (tough skin). Feathers also help shed water, eliminating up to -2 in penalties for being wet – notably for *Cold* (p. B430).

**Dodge:** 10.

**Immunities:** Sunburn.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

## Combat

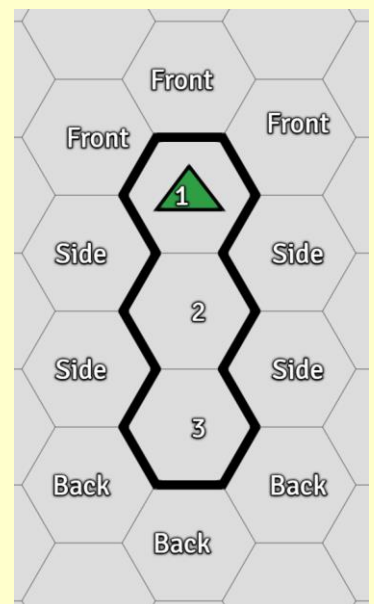
Griffons prefer to pounce on their prey, either diving to the attack or leaping from above.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 1d+1 cutting. Reach C-1 from hex #1.

**Sharp Beak (14):** thrust 1d+1 large piercing. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the griffon may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+1 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d-1 control against larger ones.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d+1 control. Reach C-1 from hex #1.

**Wing Buffet (10):** thrust 1d+2 crushing. Reach C-1 from hex #2. When in flight, the griffon must roll DX after attempting a Wing Buffet attack, whether it succeeds or fails. If the DX roll fails, the griffon loses control of its flight. It will continue moving in the same direction and speed it was moving on the last



turn before it lost control, until it can make an Aerobatics+2 roll to regain control.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.55 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 22.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 2                           | 8                           | 16               | 24                          | 32                        |

### Useful Combat Rules

Area and Spreading Attacks (p. B413).

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furies*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid #3-77*, pp. 4-5).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

Teeth (p. MA115).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 12  | 16     | 16      | 12          | 12    |

**Vision:** Griffons' eyes, often described as resembling living flames, come in ruby red, burning yellow, or icy blue. They possess eagle-like keen vision, able to spot a horse from two miles away. If they could read, they'd discern normal print from 100 feet. While they lack infravision, they see well in the dark, thanks to their eyes' ability to gather faint light, boasting **Night Vision 6**.

**Hearing:** Griffons have acute hearing, capable of detecting hoofbeats on packed earth from a mile altitude and responding to a trainer's call from the same distance.

**Smell:** Their sense of smell is average for predators—better than humans but inferior to dogs. They might track quarry by scent alone and detect enemies approaching upwind, though not as effectively as many of their prey, with **Discriminatory Smell (p. B49)**.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 6  | 10   |

Without adequate food, griffons become poor fliers and uncooperative. When food is plentiful, they may overeat and become too heavy to fly efficiently, though they require less frequent feedings afterward. Riders should ensure griffons don't overindulge between adventures to avoid lethargy.

Griffons are curious and bold, often investigating intriguing objects despite potential dangers.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (15); Bestial; Curious (15); Gluttony (12); Hidebound; Overconfidence (15).

### Skills

Aerobatics-13; Brawling-14; Flight-13; Mount-13; Weather Sense-12.

### Other Traits

Extra Legs (Four Legs); Horizontal; No Fine Manipulators.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Diurnal.

**Flying:** Griffons, like eagles, can roll in midair, albeit with difficulty due to their size, making aerobatics risky. Midair loops and somersaults might be possible under ideal conditions but likely not with a rider. While less nimble than pegasi, griffons are powerful fliers, built to catch moderately quick prey and carry it to their nests.

Griffons can fly in nearly any weather, with an innate sense of atmospheric conditions, including weather changes, downdrafts, and thermals. Both griffons and their riders require substantial training to fly proficiently together. Occasionally, griffons may refuse to fly or carry a rider, typically for valid reasons, as they are confident in their aerial abilities.

**Hunting:** Griffons are exceptional hunters, combining speed, agility, and natural weaponry. They prefer hunting ground-dwelling animals, especially herd animals and horses, though they can strike large prey mid-flight. Opportunistic by nature, griffons hunt anything from rabbits to buffalo, including humans at times, but they are not scavengers and prefer fresh kills. Typically hunting during the day, they excel in open plains, savannahs, and rolling grasslands, though they can locate prey in near-total darkness.

When injured, griffons can hunt on land, often becoming man-eaters due to their slower movement. On land, they adopt techniques similar to big cats, either stalking and pouncing like leopards or stalking and charging like tigers. With partially functioning wings, they can drop onto prey from trees or cliffs. Despite their versatility, griffons are obsessed with equine flesh and will prioritize horses, considering the risk before attacking mounted warriors.

Experienced griffons exhibit clever hunting tactics, such as spooking horses at night to isolate them from their camps before making a kill. They might also execute quick aerial attacks on tied-down horses to secure food after the human party has left.

**Lifespan:** Griffons can live for several centuries, with an average lifespan of 150 years in the wild. Some serve multiple generations of a family.

**Origins:** The origins of griffons are unclear. Some scholars believe they resulted from ancient magical experiments, but legends indicate they may be the product of natural magical forces, similar to

centaurs, combining traits of different animals into a powerful being.

## Society

**Family Matters:** Griffons have an extensive range, from tropics to subarctic regions and from coastal areas to high mountains. The temperature comfort zone of griffons falls between 24° and 90°. Their adaptability and ability to fly long distances for food and water make them the dominant predators in areas unsuitable for other large hunters.

Griffons prefer to nest in remote, inaccessible locations such as cliffs, mountaintops, caves, large ruins, and even sturdy great trees. While nests are typically spread out, griffons can be gregarious and nest closer together if prey is plentiful.

Like eagles, griffons are monogamous, mating for life. Devoted parents, they fiercely defend their mate and young. The male hunts while the female guards the nest. Typically, two eggs are laid every 1d years, hatching in four weeks. Each egg weighs 7 lbs and has 6 HP. The ravenous young consume their weight in food daily for the first three months. At four months, fledglings resemble large dogs and move about on the ground, learning hunting methods without using wings. Flight training begins at six months and lasts another six months. The young leave the parents after two years to establish their own territories.

Occasionally, two or more griffons, usually related males, team up for hunting, sometimes for life or until one finds a mate. These bachelor groups, less cautious than mated pairs, are more commonly seen and shape most people's impressions of griffons. They are intensely loyal to each other and offer mutual support in various situations.

Griffons rarely fight among themselves. Males are protective of females, even non-mates, showcasing their loyalty and discipline. This makes griffons more dependable battle mounts compared to horses and most other flying steeds. Naturally combative and fearless, they avoid fighting without reason.

**Friends and Foes:** Griffons are selective in choosing humanoid companions, rejecting those who mistreat animals, such as orcs, gnolls, and kobolds, whom they see as untrustworthy. Notably, they will never hunt other griffons.

With few natural enemies and none that prey on them regularly, griffons only consider humanoid species as significant threats. They naturally oppose creatures like hippogriffs, pegasi, manticores, and harpies, the latter's hypnotic song only serving to enrage them. Perytons also fall prey to griffons, which helps keep certain threats to humanity at bay.

Griffons, having as few natural allies as enemies,

get along well with giant eagles. Races attuned to nature, such as elves, understand them best. In contrast, griffons are perpetually at odds with centaurs and other quasi-equine beings.

**Language:** Griffons communicate through squawks and growls, covering topics like flying, hunting, weather, and appearances. Their language lacks abstract concepts.

## Spoils

Attracted to shiny items, they collect assorted treasures for nest decoration and defend them fiercely, occasionally trading them for more captivating objects.

In a griffon's nest, durable metal objects are most likely to survive their rough handling. Potions, furs, clothes, leather goods, and scrolls usually suffer damage.

A rare griffon species can detect gold at short distances with a Perception roll, a power that resides in a dark fur strip on their chest. However, this ability, primarily used for nest decoration, fades for a year if the fur is removed, which is necessary for enchanting items to locate gold.

Even trained griffons are possessive and curious, expecting a share of adventure spoils, especially if involved in locating treasure. However, a nestless griffon may quickly lose interest in its valuable "toys" and discard them soon after.

## Capturing and Training

Griffons, while loyal when trained, present unique challenges compared to horses. Unlike domesticated horses that thrive in groups and captivity, griffons prefer solitude and open spaces, and will often refuse to eat if caged.

Acquiring a griffon is difficult and expensive. Raising young griffons is more challenging than most adventurers anticipate. To bond, fledglings must be captured before their first feathers grow at three months old. Older griffons are unlikely to accept new owners and have a high chance of desertion, particularly if mistreated or confined.

Training young griffons involves teaching them to hunt, essential for their mental well-being. While flying is instinctive, fledglings need encouragement to take flight. Outdoor skills are crucial for trainers, who may also teach griffons specific skills for adventures, such as dropping bombs or grabbing ground objects.

Learning to fly with a griffon is arduous for adventurers, typically taking 11-16 weeks, or 9-14 weeks with the aid of spells. Those lacking agility and dexterity may struggle, and low-endurance individuals are prone to motion sickness. The ride is turbulent, requiring riders to hang on and resist the wind.

Griffons may bond with adventurers who rescue or heal them, forgoing the need for training. These griffons, especially loyal to those valuing loyalty, integrate well into a group.

Griffons reject common horse restraints like corraling, hobbles, and branding. Bits and bridles hinder them, while vocal commands and body movements suffice, with a hackamore used for special situations. Griffons, being more intelligent and battle-ready, can follow complex commands better than horses.

Griffon saddles must be custom-made, accommodating their wings without hindering flight. Standard horse saddles don't fit, and sidesaddles are impractical. If made of horse leather, they might even be eaten. Saddles can be positioned in front or behind the wings; behind the wings may be less tiring but restricts the rider's vision and ability to fight. Barding is rare due to its impact on flight speed and maneuverability. Light head, neck, and chest armor is acceptable if it weighs significantly less than a rider.

A griffon rider must handle activities in high winds while bobbing up and down, strapped between the flapping wings of a large predator that resents drag from an upright posture. Proper harnessing allows at least one free hand for fighting or grasping objects. Flight clothing should accommodate wind chill, weather, and weight load.

Griffons can traverse rough terrain but are best used for flying rather than overland travel. Though more temperamental than horses, they don't spook at small animals or shadows. Unlike horses, griffons may chase and eat smaller animals and can retaliate against abusive riders. Male griffons are preferable mounts due to their larger size, strength, calmness, and patience.

Owning a griffon comes with challenges. After prolonged exposure, a rider's proximity to other horses may cause distress due to the griffon's predatory scent. Town visits can be problematic; townspeople might blame griffons for disappearing horses, and griffons won't easily accept iron rations if their rider is eating steak.

Griffons are fearless and aggressive predators but also loyal and capable mounts if moody. Proper training and a suitable environment are essential for maintaining a harmonious relationship with these majestic creatures.

The rare gold-sending fur of one griffon can be used as 4 EP when enchanting items that detect gold.

**Pelt:** 18.5 lbs., \$1,850.

**Claws:** 1.6 lbs., \$700.

**Feathers:** 8d feathers, 2dx\$10 per feather., 1.1 lb per feather. Typical plumage – 28 feathers, \$1,960, 30.8 lbs.

**Egg Value:** \$6,000.

**Fledgling Value:** \$2,950.

**Untrained Value:** \$14,770.

**Trained Value:** \$147,700.

**Supply Cost:** \$72.5 and 27.2 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Training Skill:** Animal Handling (Griffons).

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Griffons).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.154.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$4,400.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Griffons

*Battle Rating:* 9

*Classes:* Air, Cv.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 96/384 (air) or 48/192 (land).

*Supply (Weekly):* \$38,400.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$117,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$272,600.

## Racial Template

77 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+6 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%; Size Modifier, -10%) [30]; DX+2 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [24]; IQ-4 [-80]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Will+4 [20]; Per+6 [30]; Basic Speed +0.25 [5]; Basic Move +3 [15].

**Advantages:** Acute Hearing 4 [8]; Acute Vision 4 [8]; Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 2 (Directional, Front, -20%; Flexible, -20%) [6]; DR 1 (Directional, Not front, -20%; Tough Skin, -40%) [2]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Enhanced Move 1 (Air) [20]; Enhanced Move 0.5 (Ground) [10]; Extended Lifespan 1 [2]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Flight (Cannot Hover, -15%; Winged, -25%) [24]; Night Vision 6 [6]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Beak [1]; Temperature Tolerance 1 (Cold) [1].

**Disadvantages:** Bad Temper (15) [-5]; Bestial [-10]; Curious (15) [-2]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Hidebound [-5]; Horizontal [-10]; Increased Consumption 1 [-10]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Overconfidence (15) [-2]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10].

**Perks:** Feathers [1].

**Quirks:** Likes horse meat [-1]; Likes shiny things [-1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 4; Tail.

## Hag



Hags are sinister and ancient witches, dark fey tied to primal forces, often feared in fairy tales and nightmares. Representing ugliness both inside and out, they usually appear as unsightly old women with features like crooked crone figures, wrinkled skin, and sharp nails and teeth. Though they dress like ragged peasants, they deliberately enhance their repulsiveness with grime and gruesome accessories. Hags are known for augmenting their deformities, sharpening teeth, and worsening sores to appear more fearsome. While they can magically disguise themselves, these illusions are superficial, reflecting their inner malevolence.

### Ecology

**Diet:** Ravenous hags can devour entire humans in just ten minutes, preferring human flesh but consuming demihumans or creatures like orcs when necessary.

**Habitat:** Hags inhabit desolate areas such as dark forests, gloomy swamps, bone-strewn glens, misty moors, stormy coastlines, damp caverns, howling mountains, and biting tundra. While each hag type has preferred environments, they may travel or join covens in different regions, particularly older hags engaging in long-term plans in unfamiliar areas. Many hags also reside where the Feywild and Prime Material Plane intersect, favoring locations rich in magical energy, like burial grounds or standing stone circles. All standard hag subspecies, along with night hags and silats, can also be found in the Demiplane of Dread.

**Reproduction:** Approximately every century, hags use kidnapping, disguise, charm, and coercion to persuade humanoid males—preferably humans or half-elves—to mate with them. Afterward, they often kill the males as a form of mercy. Once pregnant, hags enter a lethargic state for nine months, relying on allies for protection yet capable of defending themselves if necessary. The resulting female child appears as a normal member of her father's species, though she may develop her hag heritage over time,

revealing traits that hint at her true nature without making her look overtly different. The male offspring is known as hagspawn.

**Lifespan:** Hags have an unknown lifespan, traditionally living for centuries or even millennia, comparable to dragons. Very old hags are called "aunties," a title they can earn by bearing children or joining powerful covens. The oldest and wisest hags are referred to as "grandmothers."

### Mentality

Hags are embodiments of pure malice, reveling in creating misery and chaos. Their evil nature goes beyond typical descriptions, finding pleasure in ugliness and causing horror, even disfiguring the beautiful. Despite their inherent brutality, they are unpredictable, with motives that are often unfathomable, even to immortal beings. They hoard forbidden knowledge, acquired through dark means, making them even more dangerous. Any friendliness is deceiving, as hags are ultimately self-serving, often expressing blunt, lewd, or threatening remarks. Their schemes are patient and manipulative, sometimes bringing about positive outcomes inadvertently. Although rare, hags can show affection outside themselves, occasionally exhibiting motherly devotion, but this does not imply a general benevolence.

Hags, despite their many flaws, eagerly strike bargains, but not from genuine generosity. They delight in manipulating others, often crafting deals that force compromises or render the agreement ultimately unbeneficial. For hags, corrupting mortals through these bargains is more enjoyable than overt violence, as it involves the victim's complicity in their own downfall.

While both hags and fiends use deals to corrupt mortals, their motivations differ fundamentally. Fiends pursue souls to gain power and status, indifferent to the emotional state of their victims. In contrast, hags engage in this corruption as a form of entertainment, reveling in making others miserable without concern for their victims' cosmic fate.

Hags are quick to take offense, especially towards mortals, whom they often view as inferior. Their arrogance can lead to carelessness; their cleverness may cause them to reveal too much in conversation.

When negotiating with a hag, the best approach is to offer something they genuinely desire, as their enjoyment comes from both greed and the victim's suffering. Hags are open about their wants, often examining objects or people with great curiosity, assessing their value thoroughly.

Unique or useful bribes can compel a hag to offer significant returns, such as freeing captives or sharing local lore. Offering a gift without expecting anything

in return is even better, as hags dislike being in anyone's debt. However, even seemingly straightforward deals with hags are fraught with hidden motives and cryptic intentions.

## Society

Hags cherish their independence, shunning attachments, even to other hags. Despite their differences, they share a kinship as part of a sinister sisterhood bound by an age-old code of conduct. This includes announcing their presence in each other's territory, bringing gifts when visiting, and keeping oaths, unless deceptively crossing their fingers.

Despite their mutual dislike, hags maintain a shadowy sorority, prone to bickering and feuds lasting centuries. They may reconcile against a common enemy, forming the closest bond they have to "friendship." Their extensive network of magic, communication, and messengers keeps all hags informed, even those living in isolation, ensuring they possess at least some knowledge of one another.

Hags are alerted when one of their own is attacked or killed, prompting various responses: avenging a liked hag, transferring debts to the assailants, or treating the killers cordially if the victim was disliked. Hags belong to a hierarchical structure, dictated by age, powers, influence, allies, and experience—factors that are unfairly distributed between earned and inherited traits. Within this complex system, each hag strives to elevate their rank.

**Coven:** Hags generally loathe sharing their homes, but will form covens as a necessity when facing a common goal or threat. This reluctant collaboration requires them to endure living together and suppress their inherent selfishness to work as equals. Coven hags maintain a semblance of civility while pursuing personal power, with disputes mediated by a third member. Typically, covens consist of three hags, often of different types, though they can grow up to thirteen members, which usually leads to disaster.

Despite the challenges, covens offer significant advantages. They combine diverse forces, allowing them to command various beings and even rule kingdoms. Additionally, covens enable hags to harness greater powers through shared ritual magic. When a member dies, the remaining hags seek a replacement, initiating tryouts where candidates compete to prove their malice. This process can bring long-term chaos to the area as natural and supernatural disasters ensue.

Occasionally, particularly wicked mortal spellcasters, like wizards and warlocks, are invited to compete for a place in the coven, typically if their unique skills benefit the group, such as serving as spies in humanoid settlements. However, involving

mortals carries inherent risks given the hags' distrust of them.

**Lairs:** A hag's lair, reflecting her nature and magic, is always unpleasant and unsettling. Often twisted by Feywild magic, these lairs feature elements of corruption and death, such as dead trees or caves that resemble skulls, alongside constructed forms like taverns, ruined towers, mausoleums, giant coffins, or even gingerbread houses. Each lair has defenses, including hazardous paths, magical wards, or disguised captives to lure the unwary. Hags typically position their homes near mortal settlements—far enough to avoid immediate suspicion but close enough to attract malcontents seeking them out.

**Language:** Hags possess an ancient language with dialects for each subrace and also speak various others, including Aventian, and other demihuman, draconic, giant, or sylvan tongues. Their names, given by predecessors but ultimately chosen by themselves, often reflect whimsical black humor. A typical name consists of a first name followed by a title or last name, with titles highlighting negative traits or physical deformities, and last names combining body parts, animals, plants, or grotesque substances. While hags may adopt new names while disguised, they still prefer their original titles.

**Relations:** While usually solitary, hags occasionally crave companionship, which they fulfill by collecting servitors. However, these servitors are not friends; hags charm or threaten them into submission, often resorting to insults or violence. Even ordinary animals serve as minions, primarily for self-defense, while bound mortals act as effective pawns, providing innocent appearances that allow them to spy or represent the hag.

Hag minions fall into two categories: servants and brutes. Servants include constructs, undead, and unintelligent creatures that obey orders without question and help protect the lair. Brutes are free-willed mercenaries who carry out errands, patrol areas, and handle mundane tasks. Though hags may hire ogres, they generally prefer cunning creatures capable of cruelty, such as evil giants, lycanthropes, dark fey, bugbears, gargoyles, kenku, doppelgangers, and aberrations like ettercaps.

Hags are intrigued by other powerful beings, including dragons, fiends, genies, and formidable mortals, respecting those with accurate knowledge. Their magical and political capabilities can lead to control over dangerous entities through favors or blood debts. Hags may serve powerful evildoers, offering their dark insights, but they are generally untrustworthy and will seize any opportunity to usurp power. Moreover, their wicked deeds have made them powerful enemies, including good-aligned dragons and giants, who seek to hunt them down.

While the Seelie Court tends toward good and the Unseelie toward evil, both admire true beauty and are largely free of hags. Hags may be accepted in these courts only if they are weak or willing to assume a less hideous guise. Preferring personal freedom, hags are indifferent to the whims of a fey queen.

In their dealings with fey and other powerful beings, hags show more respect than they do with mortals. Fey creatures are stronger and capable of retribution, and unlike short-lived humanoids, they can spend centuries planning revenge. Although this doesn't necessarily improve hags' treatment of fey, it forces them to temper their behavior and comments based on how much the other entity might tolerate.

**Religion:** Hags possess such immense arrogance that they view their magic as a challenge to the gods. They frequently blaspheme deities and disregard their powers, yet they may appeal to dark gods for personal gain. While they lack a cohesive pantheon, various hag gods exist independently.

Cegilune, the patron goddess of hags, is a bitter moon deity with grudges against many divine beings and mortal races. From Hag's End, a pit in the Gray Waste, she creates abominations and wields profane magic. Although some worship her, most hags fear her greed and avoid her ire, as she demands information, magic, and spoils that they prefer to keep. Cegilune views hags merely as tools to fulfill her vendettas and trades souls with demon lords to maintain her power, clinging to divinity solely for revenge.

Furthermore, hags are spiritual beings with their own superstitions, the most notable being the Rule of Three. This principle, prevalent in many realms, holds that all things come in threes—good, bad, and strange. Magic returns threefold, spells are often chanted thrice, and covens function in groups of three. While the oldest hags claim to have invented or named this rule, their narcissism and tendency to lie make this dubious; some may have simply adopted the concept from other planes.

**History:** Hags are an ancient race believed to have originated in the Feywild, embodying nature's cruelty since its inception. Known for their egotism and deceit, their claims about their heritage are often distorted perceptions or outright lies. They feature in the legends of many cultures, but the truth behind these tales is elusive.

Baba Yaga is linked to night, green, and annis hags, though the exact nature of their connections remains unclear. According to shared stories from elves and orcs, the first green hag was named Green Mary, a druid who betrayed nature by consorting with a hunter she was meant to punish. Olhydra, the Princess of Elemental Water, asserts that all hags descend from a greater race of sea hags, but her

claims are as suspect as those of the hags themselves. There is speculation that oni may share an ancestral link with annis hags, and the silat subrace reproduces only with ogre mages, yielding silats from female offspring and oni from male.

In giant mythology, the concept of "proto" races mating with gods to create modern versions includes proto-hags. Some myths suggest Annam All-Father mated with a tall ogress who concealed her ugliness with magic, resulting in Vaprak. Karontor, after being banished by Annam, learned dark secrets from an ancient race of subterranean hags. The hill giant deity Grolantor is said to have interbred various early giant runts and contributed to the degenerate stock by mating with earth-bound monstrosities, including medusa-like hags and Cegilune.

Despite these varied legends, one story encompasses all hags, including green, annis, sea hags, and the hag goddess Cegilune. This account is supported by longstanding myths among ogres and hill giants, potentially shedding light on the true origins of hags.

In the early days of the world, when darkness prevailed, terrified races sought protection from lurking dangers. In answer, the moon appeared, and with it, Cegilune, a silver-haired goddess. Her beauty inspired widespread worship, and she chose the most devout priestesses as daughters, granting them powers to elevate her status. Her prophets could walk on water to spread her word, her songs enchanted others into service, and her protectors defended her worshipers.

However, Cegilune was as changeable as the moon. Her vanity led her to favor followers whose beauty mirrored her own. Over time, she became complacent and self-indulgent, offering little in return for worship. As new deities emerged, only her adopted daughters remained loyal, while others sought new patrons and mocked her aloofness. Unaware of her dwindling adoration, Cegilune's rage exploded with her first wrinkle, resulting in a deadly rampage against her former followers.

This outburst proved disastrous as her younger rivals had more worshipers. Exhausted and diminished, Cegilune was forced into hiding. Her twisted blessings transformed her followers: water-walking prophets became sea hags, sweet-voiced singers turned into green hags, and powerful protectors became annis hags. Today, these hags, driven by ancient spite, scheme to afflict mortals. The once-beautiful moon goddess now fosters her remaining divinity to ruin races she views as traitors and to extinguish the new stars, the "imposter" gods that replaced her.

## **New Disadvantage**

Most hags abide by an ancient code of conduct when interacting with other hags. This is represented by a new disadvantage.

### ***Code of Honor (Hag)* [-5]**

A hag must announce her presence in another hag's territory, bring gifts when visiting, and keep oaths, unless deceptively crossing their fingers. A hag must inform other hags about major events in her territory. When a common goal or threat presents itself, the hags must put aside their bickering and form a coven.

# Hag, Annis

Type: Fey (Hag)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |     |        |           |
|----|----|----|-----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 17 | HP | 17  | SM     | +1        |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5.5 | thr/sw | 1d+2/3d-1 |
| HT | 12 | FP | 12  | BL     | 58 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+2/2d-1

- Body Plan: Humanoid.
- Weight: 325 lbs.
- Height: 8 ft.
- Effective Height: 9 ft.
- Appearance: Hideous (-4 reaction).
- Social Stigma: Monster (-3 reaction).
- Organization: Solitary or covey (3 hags of any kind plus 1–8 ogres and 1–4 evil giants). 50% lair encounter chance.
- Treasure Type: F (individual).

Annis hags are the most formidable of their kind, defying the crone stereotype with muscular physiques. They vary from lean and quick to more ogre-like with rugged muscles. Their skin is scarred, blue-black, and their nails are iron, capable of inflicting severe wounds. These nails oxidize over time, turning from glossy black to rusty. Their teeth and hair also have a metallic shine, and their horns are short, decorative rather than functional.

Annis hags indulge in bodily modifications to enhance their already grotesque appearances.

Normally dressed in ragged clothes, they can use illusions to blend into different societies, transforming into everything from wizened women to animals like bears.

## Movement and Encumbrance

Ground: Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 58 | 116   | 174    | 348   | 580         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

- DR: 3\* (tough skin).
- Dodge: 9.
- Parry: 12 (unarmed).
- Resistances: Magic Resistance 2 (Improved).
- Vulnerabilities: cold iron (x2).
- Defensive Traits: Combat Reflexes.

## Combat

Underestimating annis hags as mere savages would be a grave mistake. Although powerful and proud, they avoid straightforward assaults. Instead, they disorient foes before battle, using disguises or mist to catch victims off guard. The fog serves to confuse adversaries or delay attacks. In combat, annis hags prefer grappling, using their immense strength and sharp talons and teeth to overpower and kill their opponents.

Annis hags have **Extra Attack 1**.

**Sharp Teeth (16):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the annis hag may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d-1 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d+1 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (16):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (16):** thrust 2d-1 control. Reach C-1. Effective ST 19 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

- Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight: 2.9 lbs.
- Effective Slam Weight: 29 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 10                   | 19        | 29                   | 38                 |

## Special Abilities

**Magic Touch:** An annis’s natural attacks are treated as magical for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

**Spell-Like Abilities:**

The annis hag possesses innate abilities that mimic wizardly spells. This is an array of alternative

abilities, and to “switch” between abilities, the annis hag must take a Concentrate maneuver. Unlike the actual spells, these abilities do not have verbal and somatic components, and do not require a skill-based casting roll.

**Disguise Self 1:** This is an important ability of the green hag that allows her to disguise herself when interacting with others. Due to its limited duration, the hag has to renew the effect from time to time. Hags who need to maintain a disguise for a very long time often try to develop ER (Magic) to not tire themselves out by using this ability.

**Fog Cloud 2 (11):** This ability only obscures normal vision, letting the annis gain an edge over her opponents with her Infravision.

### Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid #3-77*, pp. 4-5).

Teeth (p. MA115).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the annis hag can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 12 | 14   |

Intelligent and egotistical, annis hags are stronger than other hags, often dominating humanoid brutes who admire their strength. They are territorial, capable of destroying whole settlements to eliminate threats. They find joy in subjugating and terrifying the weak, especially other hags. They leave signs of their reign on territory edges and enjoy spreading fear within communities. By interacting with children under a guise of kindness, they gradually corrupt their morals, leading to community chaos.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (9); Callous; Code of Honor (Hag); Compulsive Scheming (12); Greed (12); Sadism (12); Selfish (6).

### Skills

Acting-14; Brawling-16; Climbing-14; Fast-Talk-14; Innate Attack (Gaze)-11; Intimidation-15; Stealth-13; Tracking-13; Wrestling-16.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Annis hags are omnivorous and willingly consume humanoids and other sentient beings.

**Habitat:** As the strongest hags, annis hags prefer mountainous or hilly regions, but they also inhabit cold, dark areas like moors, marshes, forests, and swamps. Their temperature comfort zone lies between 11° and 90°.

**Lifespan:** Annis hags have a lifespan of about 500 years, reaching maturity at the same age as humans.

### Society

Unlike most hags who favor clever minions, annis hags dominate less intelligent beings, including ogres, trolls, and evil giants, often adopting them and acting as abusive matriarchs in a racially diverse community. They maintain control through brute force and superstition, ensuring their needs for information, companionship, security, and food are met. Annis hags may take a supportive role behind a chieftain but typically act alone or in covens formed by overpowering weaker hags. These covens are often riddled with tension, rarely fostering cooperation, and frequently end in betrayal.

**Lair:** Annis hags dwell in ruins and caverns marked by signs of their leatherworking, such as flayed skins of children. Their lairs may also feature treacherous paths and minor cairns containing bones, often haunted by skeletons, specters, or angry fey.

**History:** Annis hags, characterized by their bruise-blue skin and horns, are thought by some scholars to be related to ogre mages, while others speculate they share a lineage with night hags. Some theories suggest they are the deteriorated descendants of night hags and humans or demihumans, with green hags resulting from such unions. These theories assert that annis hags are a less magical, shorter-lived offshoot, speaking a corrupted version of the night hags' language.

### Spoils

Being greedy creatures, hags are likely to have coins, gems, and magic items in their lairs. However, art objects and other beautiful items are very unlikely to be found there.

### Capturing and Training

Hags are rarely interested in open warfare, preferring to scheme behind the scenes, but a hag may be persuaded or bribed to serve as a spy.

**Young Value:** \$1,450.

**Untrained Value:** \$7,250.

**Trained Value:** \$72,380.

**Supply Cost:** \$4.5 and 6.8 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.075.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$2,170.

## Racial Template

128 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+7 (Size Modifier, -10%) [63]; IQ+2 [20]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Will+2 [10]; Per-2 [-10]; Basic Move +2 [10].

**Advantages:** Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 3 (Tough Skin, -40%) [9]; Extended Lifespan 3 [6]; Extra Attack 1 [25]; Infravision [10]; Magic Resistance 2 (Improved, +150%) [10]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Temperature Tolerance 2 (Cold) [2].

*Spell-Like Abilities* (Alternative Abilities) [45]:

[Disguise Self 1](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [25/5=5];

[Fog Cloud 2](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [40].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (9) [-15]; Callous [-5]; Code of Honor (Hag) [-5]; Compulsive Scheming (12) [-5]; Greed (12) [-15]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Selfish (6) [-10]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10].

**Perks:** Magic Touch [1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 3.

## Hag, Green

Type: Fey (Hag)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |         |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|---------|
| <b>ST</b> | 10 | <b>HP</b> | 10   | <b>SM</b>     | +0      |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-2/1d |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | 11   | <b>BL</b>     | 20 lbs. |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-2/1d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 120 lbs.

**Height:** 5'5".

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary or covey (3 hags of any kind plus 1–8 ogres and 1–4 evil giants). 50% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** B (individual).

Green hags, known as shellycoats when near rivers or swamps, are the most common hags, notorious for their deceit and corrupting influence. These vile beings, akin to dark druids, have a strong connection to nature and prey upon primal vices to incite anguish and bestial savagery.

Physically, green hags are the least intimidating, resembling ordinary humans, which makes them uniquely unsettling. While they typically appear as withered, hunched females, they can vary widely in body type, from skeletal to morbidly obese. Without distinct markers, they could easily be mistaken for elderly women, especially when using illusory disguises to conceal their true forms. However, their rough, bark-like skin is usually a pallid green, often marked by knobby, cancerous growths, some hidden beneath tattered peasant rags.

Their faces typically bear warts and exaggerated features, framed by tangled, vine-like hair in shades of moldy olive green to near-black. Below their orange or amber eyes are needle-sharp fangs, and their slender fingers end in filthy black or yellow talons.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 20 | 40    | 60     | 120   | 200         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed).

**Resistances:** Magic Resistance 1 (Improved).

**Vulnerabilities:** cold iron (x2).

### Combat

Cowardly by nature, green hags only attack when they are sure of victory, often using the cover of moonless nights to exploit their Infravision. They employ mimicry and illusions to separate their prey and lead them into vulnerable positions, ambushing rather than engaging in fair fights. Their victims are often toyed with, much like a cat plays with a mouse.

Green hags frequently drown their foes, using their ability to breathe underwater to incapacitate them before dragging them away. Any stagnant pool might hide a green hag waiting for unsuspecting travelers or fishermen, who would struggle to escape unless the hag decided to take them to her lair for magical or, in the worst case, carnal purposes.

While they are prone to fleeing from strong opposition, green hags are more likely than other hags to undergo training, learning combat skills, arcane magic, or divine magic.

**Fangs (14):** thrust 1d-2 impaling. Reach C. If the attack hits, the green hag may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-1 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-3 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C.  
Effective ST 12 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 10 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 6                    | 12        | 18                   | 24                 |

## Special Abilities

**Aquatic:** Green hags are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. They can breathe water and air. Green hags are able to speak underwater.

**Mimicry:** The hag can duplicate any simple sound (clash of swords, bowshot, etc.) by listening to it for one second and making a successful IQ roll. She can also imitate voices by spending at least 10 seconds listening to them and making an IQ roll. This is a mundane ability.

### Spell-Like Abilities:

The green hag possesses innate abilities that mimic wizardly spells. This is an array of alternative abilities, and to “switch” between abilities, the green hag must take a Concentrate maneuver. Unlike the actual spells, these abilities do not have verbal and somatic components, and do not require a skill-based casting roll.

**Disguise Self 1:** This is an important ability of the green hag that allows her to disguise herself when interacting with others. Due to its limited duration, the hag has to renew the effect from time to time. Hags who need to maintain a disguise for a very long time often try to develop ER (Magic) to not tire themselves out by using this ability.

**Ghost Sound 1:** This ability is used by the hag when its mimicry doesn’t suffice. It can be used to distract or lure potential prey into a vulnerable position.

**Invisibility (Self):** A hag uses invisibility to escape from dire situations or to attack unsuspecting prey, usually from behind.

**Light:** While the hag can see in the dark, infravision can be compromised, so the hag may cast use this ability on a small item to provide light.

**Touch of Weakness:** This spell is used as a Quick Contest of the hag’s IQ against the victim’s HT. The hag is not very strong naturally, so she may prefer to weaken the prey before wrestling it down and possible drowning. Typically, the hag uses this spell while invisible, breaking the effect in the process.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furries*, p. 17).

Teeth (p. MA115).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid #3-26*, pp. 7-8).

Visibility (p. B394).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 12  | 12     | 12      | 12          | 12    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the green hag can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 12 | 12   |

Green hags derive immense pleasure from tragedy, relishing in the act of shattering hope and replacing it with despair. Among the hags, they are the most consumed by hate, driven by a pure, unbridled malice that motivates their desire for societal downfall. They aim to replace civilization's beauty with nature's brutal moral bankruptcy. However, their cunning methods reveal a level of sophistication that belies their savage goals.

While not necessarily more intelligent than other hags, green hags are the most cunning, excelling at temptation, persuasion, and manipulation through webs of lies and hidden intentions. Their devious plots often involve luring travelers into their swampy lairs, where they can use their abilities to mimic cries for help or fearsome sounds to direct victims.

These hags also craft local legends to attract the curious, posing as wise women or enchanting fey. They often seduce individuals into secluded areas, revealing their deception just before or after a deadly encounter, leaving survivors traumatized.

Though they engage in smaller schemes, their true ambitions lie in grander manipulations. They infiltrate positions of power, becoming lovers of leaders or idols among savage tribes, encouraging depravity and profane acts. Despite their wickedness, green hags are the least xenophobic of their kind, willing to cooperate with like-minded individuals, despite their inherent sense of superiority.

Nonetheless, they are also exceedingly cautious, often remaining hidden within their lairs, and rarely confronting strong opposition. They enjoy toying with weaker prey but flee from any serious threat, embodying a conspiratorial form of bullying toward those they perceive as vulnerable.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Callous; Code of Honor (Hag); Compulsive Scheming (12); Cowardice (15); Greed (12); Sadism (12); Selfish (9).

## Skills

Acting-15\*; Brawling-14; Fast-Talk-15\*; Intimidation-15\*; Stealth-13; Wrestling-14.

\* Includes +1 from Smooth Operator.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Green hags are carnivores with a preference for humanoid flesh.

**Habitat:** Green hags inhabit wet, temperate areas such as dark swamps, dying forests, and misty marshes. They often choose locations near bodies of water like rivers, but can also be found in isolated countryside and desolate regions. Their ideal temperature range is between 35° and 90°.

**Lifespan:** Green hags are the longest-living hags, with a lifespan of about 2,500 years, reaching maturity at the same age as humans.

## Society

Green hags are the most tolerant of their kind, adept at infiltrating humanoid civilizations they wish to terrorize, even joining adventuring parties to achieve their goals. They blend into urban settings more effectively than other hags, often hunting their prey in their own homes. Covens of green hags, whether mixed or exclusively of their kind, form more frequently than those of other hags.

They have been known to ally with the malicious will-o'-wisps, work alongside evil druids, and engage with less intelligent creatures like ogres and hill giants to acquire information, food, and protection in exchange for trinkets stolen from their victims. However, any partnership involving a green hag is temporary, lasting only until the hag no longer benefits or can seize control.

**Lair:** Green hags typically inhabit twisted trees, underwater caverns, and caves hidden by foliage or rocks, or they may create their own warrens. In urban areas, they often reside in slums or conceal themselves in sewers.

**History:** Green hags have a shared creation myth known across many races. Commonly referred to as Green Mary, she is called Kiersana the Unfaithful by elves and Grigga Toegnawer by orcs. Her story frightens children of all races. Once, she was a beautiful druid who protected her woodland domain, maintaining a symbiotic relationship with nature. When a powerful hunter arrived, he began to recklessly chop down trees for weapons, prompting the forest to seek vengeance. However, Mary and the hunter fell in love, leading her to disobey the forest's commands.

As punishment, the forest transformed Mary into a creature resembling the very wilderness she was meant to protect. In a fit of horror, she killed her lover

and fled in despair to the most fetid swamp, becoming the first green hag. Consumed by a desire for humanoids and their destruction, her dalliances with civilization made her both a pariah to nature and an enemy of civilized beings.

## Spoils

Being greedy creatures, hags are likely to have coins, gems, and magic items in their lairs. However, art objects and other beautiful items are very unlikely to be found there.

## Capturing and Training

Hags are rarely interested in open warfare, preferring to scheme behind the scenes, but a hag may be persuaded or bribed to serve as a spy.

**Young Value:** \$1,200.

**Untrained Value:** \$5,600.

**Trained Value:** \$55,900.

**Supply Cost:** \$8 and 3 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.075.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,670.

## Racial Template

80 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** IQ+2 [40]; HT+1 [10].

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Doesn't Breathe (Gills, -50%) [10]; Extended Lifespan 5 [10]; Fangs [2]; Infravision [10]; Magic Resistance 1 (Improved, +150%) [5]; Mimicry [10]; Sharp Claws [5]; Smooth Operator 1 [15]; Speak Underwater [5].

*Spell-Like Abilities* (Alternative Abilities) [78]:

[Disguise Self 1](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [25/5=5];

[Ghost Sound 1](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [29/5=6];

[Invisibility \(Self\)](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [58];

[Light](#) (No Incantation, IQ Roll, +20%) [22/5=5];

[Touch of Weakness](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, +20%) [19/5=4].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Callous [-5]; Code of Honor (Hag) [-5]; Compulsive Scheming (12) [-5]; Cowardice (15) [-5]; Greed (12) [-15]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Selfish (9) [-7]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10].

**Features:** Early Maturation 5.

# Hag, Sea

Type: Fey (Hag)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |         |
|----|----|----|------|--------|---------|
| ST | 10 | HP | 10   | SM     | +0      |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5.25 | thr/sw | 1d-2/1d |
| HT | 11 | FP | 11   | BL     | 20 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d

- Body Plan:** Humanoid.
- Weight:** 140 lbs.
- Height:** 6 ft.
- Effective Height:** 6 ft.
- Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).
- Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).
- Organization:** Solitary or covey (3 hags of any kind plus 1–8 ogres and 1–4 evil giants). 50% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** B (individual).

Sea hags are the most repugnant of hags, taking pride in their grotesque appearance. These wicked fey inhabit large bodies of water, often preying on those unfortunate enough to encounter them. While all hags are hideous, sea hags are particularly abominable, exhibiting a gaunt appearance despite their appetite for flesh. They may vary in size but are commonly emaciated, with bodies covered in warts and oozing sores.

Their skin resembles rotting fish—pallid yellow with greenish patches, slimy scales, and bony protrusions. Their lifeless, fish-like eyes have deep black pupils surrounded by red.

## Movement and Encumbrance

- Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.
- Water:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 20 | 40    | 60     | 120   | 200         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

- DR:** 1\* (tough skin).
- Dodge:** 8.
- Parry:** 10 (unarmed).
- Immunities:** sunburn.
- Resistances:** Magic Resistance 1 (Improved).
- Vulnerabilities:** cold iron (x2).
- Weaknesses:** immersion in fresh water (1d HP per 30 minutes).

## Combat

In combat, sea hags typically rely on ambush tactics, hiding or disguising themselves to lure prey before attacking. They prefer to use their horrific glare to incapacitate foes and consume them quickly, resorting to melee and daggers only when outnumbered.

**Sharp Teeth (14):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the sea hag may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-1 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-3 control against larger ones.

- Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C.
- Grapple (14):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C. Effective ST 12 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.
- Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1 lb.
- Effective Slam Weight:** 10 lbs.

| Control Thresholds |         |     |         |       |
|--------------------|---------|-----|---------|-------|
| ≥0.1×CM            | ≥0.5×CM | ≥CM | ≥1.5×CM | ≥2×CM |
| 2                  | 6       | 12  | 18      | 24    |

## Special Abilities

- Aquatic:** Sea hags are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. They can breathe water and air. Sea hags are able to speak underwater.
- Evil Eye (14):** By taking a Concentrate maneuver and spending 2 FP, a sea hag can cast its dire gaze upon any single creature. If the hag wins in a Quick Contest of Will, the victim becomes paralyzed for three days. The hag’s roll takes a -1 penalty per yard

of distance. After that, the subject is mentally stunned (p. B420) and may roll vs. Will once per second to recover.

**Weakening Presence:** The sight of a sea hag is so revolting that anyone within 8 yards (other than creatures excluded by the hag) who sets eyes upon one must roll against HT every second or lose 1 ST for three minutes. Lower all skills based on ST by a like amount. ST penalties also reduce BL and damage. HP is not otherwise affected. This ability can only affect living beings, and its effects are cumulative.

See *Avoiding Gaze Attacks* (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8) for details on averting or hiding one's eyes.

### Useful Combat Rules

Avoiding Gaze Attacks (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8).

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid* #3-26, pp. 7-8).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the sea hag can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 12 | 14   |

While all hags possess a warped sense of beauty, sea hags particularly despise anything attractive. They react with fury to beauty, often seeking to corrupt rather than destroy it, transforming symbols of hope into sources of despair.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Callous; Code of Honor (Hag); Compulsive Scheming (12); Greed (12); Loner (12); Sadism (12); Selfish (9).

### Skills

Acting-14; Brawling-14; Fast-Talk-14; Intimidation-14; Stealth-13; Wrestling-14.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Sea hags are carnivores with a preference for humanoid flesh.

**Habitat:** Sea hags inhabit warm coastal waters with overgrown vegetation, preferring temperatures between 35° and 90°. They usually dwell in bleak areas surrounded by underwater monsters and nearby settlements, residing in sunken shipwrecks, polluted shores, or cliffs.

Sea hags can survive at pressures up to 10 atmospheres. This lets them live comfortably at a depth up to 112 yards.

**Lifespan:** Sea hags have a lifespan of about 800 years, reaching maturity at the same age as humans.

### Society

Sea hags generally live as gloomy recluses in dismal lairs, simmering with jealousy as they observe others. They are driven to express their rage, sometimes attacking intruders or hunting victims among surface dwellers and aquatic beings.

**History:** According to myths, the moon goddess Cegilune is said to be the progenitor of the hag race, with sea hags among the original creations of her worshipers. Others believe that greater sea hags descend from more powerful beings, possibly linked to the Elemental Evil Princess of Elemental Water, Olhydra, who asserts that all hags are the degenerate spawn of her greater sea hags.

### Spoils

Being greedy creatures, hags are likely to have coins, gems, and magic items in their lairs. However, art objects and other beautiful items are very unlikely to be found there.

### Capturing and Training

Hags are rarely interested in open warfare, preferring to scheme behind the scenes.

**Young Value:** \$2,120.

**Untrained Value:** \$10,600.

**Trained Value:** \$105,900.

**Supply Cost:** \$8 and 3 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.110.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$3,170.

### Racial Template

104 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** IQ+2 [40]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Will+2 [10]; Per-2 [-10]; Water Move +2 [4].

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Doesn't Breathe (Gills, -50%) [10]; Extended Lifespan 4 [8]; Infravision [10]; Magic Resistance 1 (Improved, +150%) [5]; Pressure Support 1 [5]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Speak Underwater [5].

**Evil Eye:** Affliction 1 (Will; Based on Will, +20%; Costs Fatigue, 2 FP, -10%; Extended Duration, 300x, +100%; Fixed Duration, +0%; Magical, -10%; Malediction 1, +100%; Paralysis, +150%; Vision-Based, Reversed, -20%) [43].

**Weakening Presence:** Affliction 1 (HT; Accessibility, Only on living beings, -10%; Always On, -10%; Area Effect, 8 yards, Spherical, +190%;

Attribute Penalty, ST-1, +5%; Aura, +80%; Cumulative, +400%; Fixed Duration, +0%; Magical, -10%; Malediction 1, +100%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; Selective Effect, +20%; Vision-Based, -20%) [82].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Callous [-5]; Code of Honor (Hag) [-5]; Compulsive Scheming (12) [-5]; Greed (12) [-15]; Loner (12) [-5]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Selfish (9) [-7]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10]; Weakness (Immersion in fresh water, 1d per 30 minutes) [-5].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 4.

## Hag, Freshwater

Type: Fey (Hag)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |         |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|---------|
| <b>ST</b> | 10 | <b>HP</b> | 10   | <b>SM</b>     | +0      |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-2/1d |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | 11   | <b>BL</b>     | 20 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 140 lbs.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary or covey (3 hags of any kind plus 1–8 ogres and 1–4 evil giants). 50% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** B (individual).

The freshwater hag is a much less common subrace of the sea hag.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 20 | 40    | 60     | 120   | 200         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** sunburn.

**Vulnerabilities:** cold iron (x2).

**Weaknesses:** immersion in saline water (1d HP per 30 minutes).

### Combat

**Sharp Teeth (14):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C.

If the attack hits, the freshwater hag may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-1 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-3 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C. Effective ST 12 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 10 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 6                    | 12        | 18                   | 24                 |

### Special Abilities

**Aquatic:** Freshwater hags are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. They can breathe water and air. Freshwater hags are able to speak underwater.

**Evil Eye (14):** By taking a Concentrate maneuver and spending 2 FP, a freshwater hag can cast its dire gaze upon any single creature. If the hag wins in a Quick Contest of Will, the victim becomes paralyzed for three days. The hag's roll takes a -1 penalty per yard of distance. After that, the subject is mentally stunned (p. B420) and may roll vs. Will once per second to recover.

**Weakening Presence:** The sight of a freshwater hag is so revolting that anyone within 8 yards (other than creatures excluded by the hag) who sets eyes upon one must roll against HT every second or lose 1 ST for three minutes. Lower all skills based on ST by a like amount. ST penalties also reduce BL and damage. HP is not otherwise affected. This ability can only affect living beings, and its effects are cumulative.

See *Avoiding Gaze Attacks* (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8) for details on averting or hiding one's eyes.

## Useful Combat Rules

Avoiding Gaze Attacks (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8).

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid* #3-26, pp. 7-8).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the freshwater hag can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 12 | 14   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Callous; Code of Honor (Hag); Compulsive Scheming (12); Greed (12); Loner (12); Sadism (12); Selfish (9).

## Skills

Acting-14; Brawling-14; Fast-Talk-14; Intimidation-14; Stealth-13; Wrestling-14.

## Ecology

**Habitat:** Freshwater hags inhabit non-arctic bodies of water such as lakes, preferring temperatures between 35° and 90°.

Freshwater hags can survive at pressures up to 10 atmospheres. This lets them live comfortably at a depth up to 112 yards.

## Capturing and Training

Hags are rarely interested in open warfare, preferring to scheme behind the scenes.

**Young Value:** \$2,120.

**Untrained Value:** \$10,600.

**Trained Value:** \$105,900.

**Supply Cost:** \$8 and 3 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.110.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$3,170.

## Racial Template

99 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** IQ+2 [40]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Will+2 [10]; Per-2 [-10]; Water Move +2 [4].

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Doesn't Breathe (Gills, -50%) [10]; Extended Lifespan 4 [8]; Infravision [10]; Pressure

Support 1 [5]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Speak Underwater [5].

**Evil Eye:** Affliction 1 (Will; Based on Will, +20%; Costs Fatigue, 2 FP, -10%; Extended Duration, 300x, +100%; Fixed Duration, +0%; Magical, -10%; Malediction 1, +100%; Paralysis, +150%; Vision-Based, Reversed, -20%) [43].

**Weakening Presence:** Affliction 1 (HT; Accessibility, Only on living beings, -10%; Always On, -10%; Area Effect, 8 yards, Spherical, +190%; Attribute Penalty, ST-1, +5%; Aura, +80%; Cumulative, +400%; Fixed Duration, +0%; Magical, -10%; Malediction 1, +100%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; Selective Effect, +20%; Vision-Based, -20%) [82].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Callous [-5]; Code of Honor (Hag) [-5]; Compulsive Scheming (12) [-5]; Greed (12) [-15]; Loner (12) [-5]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Selfish (9) [-7]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10]; Weakness (Immersion in saline water, 1d per 30 minutes) [-5].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 4.

## Hag, Sea, Greater

Type: Fey (Hag)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |         |
|----|----|----|------|--------|---------|
| ST | 14 | HP | 14   | SM     | +0      |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5.25 | thr/sw | 1d/2d   |
| HT | 11 | FP | 11   | BL     | 39 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d/1d+2

**Body Plan:** Tritonoid (*GURPS Template Toolkit* 2: Races, p. 10).

**Weight:** 170 lbs.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary or covey (3 hags of any kind plus 1–8 ogres and 1–4 evil giants). 50% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** F (individual).

Greater sea hags, rare and feared denizens of the deep, are believed to be twisted descendants of Olhydra's servitors, the evil water creature princess. They are wrinkled, green-scaled crones with seaweed-green hair, iron claws, fiery red eyes, and fishlike tails instead of legs.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Water:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 39 | 78    | 117    | 234   | 390         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** mind control, sunburn.

**Resistances:** Magic Resistance 2 (Improved).

**Vulnerabilities:** cold iron (x2).

**Weaknesses:** immersion in fresh water (1d HP per 30 minutes).

## Combat

Greater sea hags prefer to avoid direct combat unless they manage to deliver a deadly blow to an unsuspecting victim. If they have to battle an opponent directly, they use their claws or manufactured weapons, such as coral daggers or short swords.

**Sharp Teeth (16):** thrust 1d cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the greater sea hag may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+1 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-1 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (16):** thrust 1d cutting. Reach C.

**Grapple (16):** thrust 1d+1 control. Reach C. Effective ST 16 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.95 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 19.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 8                    | 16        | 24                   | 32                 |

## Special Abilities

**Aquatic:** Greater sea hags are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. They can breathe water and air, even though they cannot move on land. Greater sea hags are able to speak underwater.

**Charming Gaze (13):** A greater sea hag can charm a sapient being by locking eyes with them, taking a Concentrate maneuver, and spending 1 FP, initiating a Quick Contest of IQ against the victim's Will, adjusted for range penalties (p. B550). If the hag wins, the victim must obey her commands for a duration of 5 hours multiplied by the hag's margin of victory. During this time, the victim temporarily gains the Reprogrammable disadvantage (p. B150), having the hag as their master.

If the hag becomes incapacitated (stunned, knocked out, etc.) or tries to force the victim to act against their principles (e.g., harm themselves or others), another Quick Contest occurs. If the victim wins, they break free; this roll happens at the moment of crisis—like before jumping off a cliff.

If the hag loses the contest, she cannot attempt to charm that individual for 24 hours, and the victim senses her mental coercion. A critical failure means she also loses control over anyone else currently under her influence.

See *Avoiding Gaze Attacks* (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8) for details on averting or hiding one's eyes.

**Weakening Presence:** The sight of a greater sea hag is so revolting that anyone within 8 yards (other than creatures excluded by the hag) who sets eyes upon one must roll against HT every second or lose 1 ST for three minutes. Lower all skills based on ST by a like amount. ST penalties also reduce BL and damage. HP is not otherwise affected. This ability can only affect living beings, and its effects are cumulative.

See *Avoiding Gaze Attacks* (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8) for details on averting or hiding one's eyes.

### Spell-Like Abilities:

The greater sea hag possesses innate abilities that mimic wizardly spells. This is an array of alternative abilities, and to “switch” between abilities, the greater sea hag must take a Concentrate maneuver. Unlike the actual spells, these abilities do not have verbal and somatic components, and do not require a skill-based casting roll.

**Disguise Self 1:** This is an important ability of the greater sea hag that allows her to disguise herself when interacting with others. Due to its limited duration, the hag has to renew the effect from time to time. Hags who need to maintain a disguise for a very long time often try to develop ER (Magic) to not tire themselves out by using this ability. Greater sea hags usually assume forms of sea creatures such as nereids

or mermaids to deceive seafarers into following a dangerous course and then seize their sunken treasure and devour the drowned ones.

**Ghost Sound 1:** This ability is used by the hag to distract or lure potential prey into a vulnerable position.

**Invisibility (Self):** A hag uses invisibility to escape from dire situations or to attack unsuspecting prey, usually from behind.

**Light:** While the hag can see in the dark, infravision can be compromised, so the hag may cast use this ability on a small item to provide light. It is often used to lure seafarers sailing at night.

## Useful Combat Rules

Avoiding Gaze Attacks (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8).

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid #3-26*, pp. 7-8).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 11          | 11    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the greater sea hag can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 13 | 15   |

When not hunting, these hags focus on hoarding treasure, aided by charmed minions or malevolent aquatic creatures. They are very familiar with their undersea habitats, quickly detecting concealed or magically disguised intruders through changes in the seafloor. Greater sea hags are bold explorers, venturing into unfamiliar waters. Unlike most hags, they are jealous and mistrustful of all life and do not adhere to the hag code of conduct.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Callous; Compulsive Scheming (12); Greed (12); Jealousy; Loner (12); Sadism (12); Selfish (9).

## Skills

Acting-16; Area Knowledge (Local)-18; Brawling-16; Fast-Talk-16; Intimidation-15; Stealth-14; Wrestling-16.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Greater sea hags are carnivores with a preference for humanoid flesh.

**Habitat:** Preferring warm waters between 35° and 90°, greater sea hags typically lair in undersea

caves filled with treasures from sunken vessels, sometimes claiming opulent captain's cabins. They favor areas with intriguing seafloor features, such as reefs and ship graveyards.

Greater sea hags can survive at pressures up to 10 atmospheres. This lets them live comfortably at a depth up to 112 yards.

**Lifespan:** Greater sea hags have a lifespan of about 1,000 years, reaching maturity at the same age as humans.

## Society

Thankfully rare, greater sea hags seldom reproduce and may live alongside lesser hags without joining them in covens. They are drawn to danger and act as apex predators, with most sharks avoiding them due to their deadly magic.

## Spoils

Being greedy creatures, greater sea hags are likely to have coins, gems, and magic items in their lairs, as well as other sunken treasure.

## Capturing and Training

Hags are rarely interested in open warfare, preferring to scheme behind the scenes.

**Young Value:** \$4,220.

**Untrained Value:** \$21,100.

**Trained Value:** \$211,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$8 and 3 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.220.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$6,330.

## Racial Template

338 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+4 [40]; IQ+3 [60]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Will+2 [10]; Per-2 [-10]; Water Move +2 [10].

**Advantages:** DR 2 (Tough Skin, -40%) [6]; Doesn't Breathe (Gills, -50%) [10]; Extended Lifespan 4.5 [9]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Infravision [10]; Magic Resistance 2 (Improved, +150%) [10]; Pressure Support 1 [5]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Speak Underwater [5].

**Charming Gaze:** Mind Control (Accessibility, Only sapient beings, -10%; Costs Fatigue, 1 FP, -5%; Extended Duration, 300x, +100%; Independent, +70%; Magical, -10%; Vision-Based, -20%) [113].

**Weakening Presence:** Affliction 1 (HT; Accessibility, Only on living beings, -10%; Always On, -10%; Area Effect, 8 yards, Spherical, +190%; Attribute Penalty, ST-1, +5%; Aura, +80%; Cumulative, +400%; Fixed Duration, +0%; Magical, -10%; Malediction 1, +100%; Melee Attack, Reach C,

-30%; Selective Effect, +20%; Vision-Based, -20%) [82].

*Spell-Like Abilities* (Alternative Abilities) [74]:

[Disguise Self 1](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [25/5=5];

[Ghost Sound 1](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [29/5=6];

[Invisibility \(Self\)](#) (No Gestures, Incantation, IQ Roll, +30%) [58];

[Light](#) (No Incantation, IQ Roll, +20%) [22/5=5].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Callous [-5]; Compulsive Scheming (12) [-5]; Greed (12) [-15]; Jealousy [-10]; Loner (12) [-5]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Selfish (9) [-7]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10]; Weakness (Immersion in fresh water, 1d per 30 minutes) [-5].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 4.5; No Legs (Aquatic).

## Kobold

Type: Humanoid (Kobold, Reptile)



**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 40 lbs.

**Height:** 2.5 ft.

**Effective Height:** 3 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** 40-400. One sorcerer per 100.  
40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** I, G.

Kobolds, often dismissed as filthy little reptiles akin to goblins, are far more cunning and industrious than they appear. While they may seem harmless when found mining in their lairs, this underestimation works to their advantage. These meticulous creatures, with innate sorcery in their blood, exhibit cleverness, resilience, and a formidable work ethic. Though often disregarded as pests, only the unwise ignore the real threat kobolds pose.

Physically, kobolds have scaly skin ranging from rusty brown to reddish-black, strong teeth, and claw-tipped digits. Their crocodile-like jaws can open wide enough to hold a melon. Their alert, wide eyes span from burnt ochre to red, and small horns above their brows grow larger toward the back of their skulls.

### Mentality

Kobolds navigate a world dominated by creatures far larger than themselves, yet they thrive without competing for dominance. Unlike gnomes or halflings who integrate with others, kobolds remain insular, guided by their deity Kurtulmak and adhering to introspective traditions. While they disdain other races, kobolds embrace being underestimated, viewing it as a strength that has served them for generations.

Kobolds live in quiet contentment, undeterred by adversity and deeply aware of their draconic lineage. This connection, rooted in legend and myth, instills them with unwavering confidence. To kobolds, their

dragon blood is a source of pride and resilience: “The dragon scale toughens our skin. The dragon bone adorns our skull. The dragon heart flames our sorcery. We are the dragon, and for the dragon we live. Long live the dragon.”

This heritage fuels kobolds with an enduring will to survive. While their lives are short compared to dragons, their collective impact is profound. When their tribe is threatened, kobolds act with self-sacrificing bravery, often facing impossible odds to protect their kin. However, they value life and retreat when necessary, avoiding needless risks.

Despite their small size and physical frailty, kobolds play to their strengths. They rely on numbers, speed, and strategy to outwit larger foes, employing flanking maneuvers, hit-and-run tactics, and ingenious traps in their lairs. Should all else fail, they will charge an enemy fearlessly, sacrificing themselves to protect their tribe. Kobolds are weak in body but strong in spirit, blending cunning, invention, and determination to thrive against all odds.

Kobolds are not forgiving toward other races. They harbor long-lasting grudges and are slow to pardon, treasuring revenge like a cherished purpose. Kobold retribution is often calculated and patient, striking when their enemies are at their weakest or when kobold sabotage has paved the way. Simply put, kobolds excel at holding grudges and delivering precise, deliberate vengeance.

**Typical Mentality Traits:** Admires true dragons; Chauvinistic; Holds a grudge; Intolerance (Gnomes); Selfless (15).

### Ecology

**Diet:** Kobolds are omnivorous and can draw nutrition from nearly any organic matter, including bark, bones, leather, dirt, and shells. Desperation, especially in harsh conditions, pushes them to eat whatever is available, even intelligent creatures in the case of evil tribes. When resources are scarce, kobolds prioritize feeding their youngest members with any edible materials.

**Habitat:** Temperate forests and underground. The temperature comfort zone of a kobold falls between 35° and 90°, but see *Temperature Regulation* below.

**Lifecycle:** Kobolds hatch from hard-shelled eggs, with females laying one egg (occasionally two) 2 weeks after fertilization. After 60 days of incubation, the egg hatches into a wyrmling capable of walking and feeding within hours. Prosperous kobold tribes might have one young per five adults, while food scarcity lowers birth rates.

Rare “dragonwrought” eggs, influenced by true dragons, are marked with distinctive dragon-colored spots that grow as the embryo develops. Kobold embryos are resilient; they rarely perish unless their

egg is broken within the last 15 days of incubation. After hatching, a wyrmling matures in just 3 years, and kobolds can live up to 140 years.

**Temperature Regulation:** The kobold is a cold-blooded creature. While it has +2 HT to resist damage from high or low body temperature, it tends to stiffen up in cold weather. After 30 minutes in cold conditions, the kobold gets -1 to Basic Speed and DX per 10° below 50°F. The kobold regains lost Basic Speed and DX at the rate of one point of each per hour once it returns to a warm climate. Double this rate in an exceptionally warm environment. At temperatures below 32°, the kobold must roll vs. HT or take 1 HP of damage.

## Society

Kobold society values the tribe above all else, where individual success is defined by contributions to the collective. Growth is vital to a tribe's success, so kobolds reproduce prolifically. Mating is purely pragmatic, with no concept of love, lust, or monogamy. Overpopulation is celebrated, prompting part of the tribe to split off and claim new territory.

Overcrowding in kobold lairs eliminates privacy. Sleeping areas are communal, with personal space reserved for the most industrious. Nudity carries no stigma, and clothing is worn for function or decoration rather than modesty. Living in close quarters often leads to conflict, but disputes are resolved openly and quickly, preventing lingering resentment or deadly outcomes.

Kobold society thrives on work, especially during the discovery of new veins of metal or precious minerals. The lair becomes alive with activity, reflecting the kobolds' deep-rooted materialism, akin to dragons. Leaders must ensure every kobold feels they are both contributing to and benefiting from the tribe's wealth, fostering unity and purpose.

Merit determines a kobold's position, with no rigid social structure to hinder advancement. In essence, kobold culture revolves around industriousness, resourcefulness, and communal success.

**Arts and Crafts:** Trapmaking is a prized kobold art form, with master trapmakers obsessing over the smallest details. Ingenious traps often incorporate spells, technology, or surprising mechanisms, rivaling the marvels of their gnome adversaries. Warrens and mines are meticulously planned using divination magic to locate ore or gems, emphasizing both functionality and aesthetics. Tribes also preserve their history through detailed carvings in communal spaces and personal dwellings, showcasing significant events.

Practicality defines kobold craftsmanship, with functionality favored over beauty, except for jewelry.

Jewelry-making is a passion, with kobolds crafting intricate pieces from rare metals and unique mineral combinations. Their love for baubles rivals dragon-like hoarding tendencies.

Though rare, kobold bards are valued as lorekeepers. They excel with percussion and wind instruments—used both to coordinate work and communicate over distances. Percussion serves as a rhythmic tool for labor, while wind instruments can soothe and provide focus during tasks, underscoring a kobold bard's importance to the tribe.

**Clothing:** Kobolds prioritize practicality in their attire, opting for functional clothing suited to their tasks. Workwear typically consists of sleeveless leather tunics and knee-length breeches, designed for ease of movement during mining. With stable subterranean temperatures, kobolds rarely need clothing for warmth. Footwear is entirely absent, as their tough, callused feet and agile legs provide natural protection and stability over rough terrain.

Resources like cotton are scarce, so kobolds utilize silk harvested from underground insects and durable leather for their clothing. Finely tailored garments are reserved for tribal leaders or special occasions. Bold colors like dark reds and fiery oranges are favored, often reflecting their connection to specific dragon types, while dyes are highly valued for accenting clothing.

Jewelry and ornamentation are beloved by kobolds, with metal and gem-encrusted pieces being prized. Both sexes wear a variety of accessories, including tail rings, while warriors add symbolic pieces like bracers or gorgets. For real armor, kobolds prefer lightweight options like leather or the shells of giant beetles, as they value speed over heavy protection.

**Grooming:** Mining is a demanding, dirty profession, but kobolds excel at it, showing resilience where most humans falter. Despite the grime that comes with the job, kobolds maintain strict hygiene practices.

As reptilian humanoids, kobolds shed their skin in patches—growing kobolds do so weekly or monthly, while adults shed seasonally. This process can take up to a week but is often sped up by scrubbing. To maintain shiny, healthy scales, adults apply bitterleaf oil, which can even delay shedding indefinitely.

Kobolds also enjoy natural springs found during excavations, using them for bathing and socializing, though they don't build public baths. Swimming is a favorite pastime.

They are equally meticulous about grooming teeth and claws. Each kobold home has a flat stone for polishing claws, while chewing roots and bones helps strengthen gums and clean their teeth.

**Magic and Technology:** Kobolds see no sharp divide between magic and technology, using both to manipulate their environment and protect themselves. These disciplines complement each other, and wise kobold leaders ensure investment in both.

Kobolds are industrious and rival dwarves in productivity. Despite their small size, they compensate with sheer numbers. Kobold labor resembles an efficient ant colony: swarms working in harmony, instinctively avoiding obstacles—even using their tails to prevent collisions. This diligence extends to every aspect of their magical and technological advancements, where planning and execution are swift and skillful.

Kobolds are familiar with alchemy, creating practical inventions like bitterleaf oil. This traditional product keeps their scales healthy, delays shedding, and treats minor wounds—especially valued by miners. Their fascination with volatile chemicals leads them to use explosives like ditherbombs for mining, warfare, and traps.

**Searching for the Dragon:** Each day begins with a unique communal meditation. The tribe gathers in a rudimentary hall, sits silently, and reflects on their shared heritage for 15 minutes. This ritual, known as "Searching for the Dragon," fills the tunnels with stillness and is a deeply unifying practice.

**Love:** Kobolds devote great care to raising wyrmlings, finding fulfillment in being role models for the young. Juveniles showing promise are encouraged and steeped in kobold traditions through simple teaching methods and swift, often physical, corrections aimed at being instructive rather than harmful.

Work defines a kobold's life, providing purpose and belonging. Even young kobolds mimic adult labor, and contributing to the tribe is paramount. Those who refuse to help risk exile, as a kobold without purpose is considered useless.

Romantic love is rare among kobolds, as their tribal life usually satisfies emotional needs. While mating occurs regularly, it is driven by instinct and duty to sustain the tribe with healthy young. Emotional bonds between kobolds are formed through mutual respect and productivity, typically among coworkers who perform better together.

Such bonded pairs, called "chosen ones," take an oath to support each other, approved by the all-watcher, with a priest blessing the union. Monogamy is uncommon, as mating is instinctual, and extramarital encounters cause no friction due to the lack of emotional weight associated with sex.

Couples deemed valuable to the tribe may be granted personal quarters, which they are responsible for excavating, based on their status and contributions.

**Kobolds at War:** In wartime, all kobold adults are expected to fight, though warbands typically patrol and defend lairs while maintaining traps. Kobolds have one of the highest birth rates among humanoids, with tribes often splitting when a warren can no longer support their numbers. Each half forms a smaller but complete tribe, and one migrates to prevent resource competition. These migrations often lead to conflict, especially in crowded areas, with gnomes as a primary target. Parent tribes sometimes support migrating groups in war when conflict is anticipated.

Kobolds prefer ranged combat, avoiding melee whenever possible. They excel as slingers and crossbow users, employing hit-and-run tactics. They often improvise battlefield traps, such as setting pitch-filled moats aflame, using them as barriers to maintain distance while launching ranged attacks. In melee, kobolds favor long weapons like spears, charging or using defensive formations to keep enemies at bay. Waves of spear-wielding warriors relentlessly press forward if defenses break, relying on sheer numbers to overwhelm opponents.

Specialized kobold warriors, recognizable by their chitin armor, are rare, while the strongest and bravest form light cavalry as dire weasel riders. During sieges, kobolds employ rolling ballistae, catapults, and crossbow-wielding troops. Sorcerers defend key positions, with powerful spellcasters acting as artillery. Commanders use ditherbombs to breach fortifications, and their success stems from sheer numbers rather than combat skill, overwhelming defenses through relentless attacks at the cost of heavy casualties.

Despite their effectiveness, kobolds avoid large-scale warfare unless migration forces it. They prefer defending their lairs with traps that minimize direct combat, lacking a formal strategic approach to war due to their preference for smaller-scale skirmishes.

**Death:** Kobolds, while having one of the highest birth rates, also suffer from high mortality. However, kobolds who remain in their lair can live well past 120 years. The deceased are treated as waste and immediately incinerated, regardless of their societal status. To outsiders, this may seem callous, but kobolds emphasize reincarnation over the physical body.

Kobolds believe those who die in service to their tribe are reincarnated by Kurtulmak as the next egg laid. When a significant tribal member dies, the next egg is closely monitored, often raised to emulate and inherit the deceased kobold's position, even adopting a variation of their name. If an entire tribe perishes, their souls are thought to join other tribes.

Kobolds who die serving personal interests are reborn as dire weasel pups, destined for servitude,

while traitors are reincarnated as giant stag beetles, their bodies hunted for armor. The greatest honor is reserved for those who sacrifice their lives for their tribe's greater good, as they are welcomed into Kurtulmak's mine. The most loyal among these kobolds may eventually reincarnate as chromatic dragons.

This belief system instills the lesson that service to the tribe is paramount. Consequently, kobolds spend little time mourning and remain focused on their duties.

**All-Watcher:** The kobold all-watcher serves as the tribe's leader and chief accountant, overseeing the allocation of wealth, approving "chosen one" bonds, and handling disputes like betrayal and exile. A key duty involves distributing resources from the mines to strengthen the tribe's position in the world. This includes funding lair improvements, expanding influence, and advancing kobold knowledge and power as proposed by scholars, priests, and spellcasters. Military commanders also rely on her to assess strategic engagements.

Beyond decision-making, an all-watcher enforces deadlines and assigns tasks, ensuring projects are completed efficiently. Most are skilled sorcerers themselves.

**Specialists:** Kobold experts are key contributors to tribal development and research. Despite their specialized skills, they are treated no differently than other workers, serving the tribe equally. Trapmakers, however, hold special status for protecting kobold territories through ingenious designs that prevent open warfare, saving lives. Common expert roles include agronomists, alchemists, blacksmiths, hunters, jewelers, leatherworkers, miners, and weaponsmiths, among others.

**Sorcerers:** Unlike other humanoids, kobolds nurture sorcerer talent through guided training rather than trial and error. Entering the path of sorcery is deeply ceremonial, akin to joining the priesthood, and requires lifelong commitment. Sorcery is held in high reverence within kobold culture.

**Merchants:** Kobold merchants are the most independent members of their tribe, spending more time aboveground than others as they negotiate with other tribes and races. To protect their tribe, they pose as other races using glamers and illusions during trade. While kobolds value these interactions, secrecy remains paramount, so many trading partners remain unaware they are dealing with kobolds.

This independence sometimes leads merchants to go rogue. By forming outside connections and corrupting their warrior escorts with promises of wealth, a merchant may eventually start her own mine and establish herself as an all-watcher. Such plans

often coincide with population surges, allowing for smooth tribal expansion.

Wise all-watchers intentionally select independent kobolds with leadership potential to become merchants. This ensures potential troublemakers remain removed from daily life while increasing the likelihood of successful proliferation.

**Workers:** Kobold workers, mostly miners, form the backbone of any tribe. They are highly self-sufficient and motivated, relying on daily rituals and collective decision-making when clerics of Kurtulmak are unavailable. Mining projects are meticulously planned, with simplified layouts displayed for reference and clergy drafting detailed designs. Experienced kobolds naturally take the lead, guiding others through the process.

This flexible structure empowers kobold workers, as their opinions and expertise are respected. While kobolds lack a rigid social hierarchy, their structured work schedules foster a sense of pride and belonging within their community.

**Family Bonds:** Kobolds do not track parentage due to females mating with multiple partners. Instead, they instinctively recognize blood relatives by scent and avoid mating with them, as such unions are sterile. To blur family lines further, all eggs are laid in one communal area, with females returning to their duties soon after.

Dedicated individuals, called fosterers, are responsible for caring for and guarding the eggs and hatchlings. Many fosterers are also skilled warriors, ensuring the young are well-protected. Wyrmlings are named and nurtured by fosterers until they gain independence—around 8 to 12 months—at which point they become the collective responsibility of all adults.

By three years of age, juvenile kobolds begin training in professions aligned with their abilities and tribal needs, joining existing work groups. This communal upbringing instills values of action, contribution, and interdependence. A kobold's worth is defined by what they provide to the tribe and their shared connection with others.

Kobolds treat their tribe as an extended family, with professional groups functioning as their closest equivalent to traditional family structures. These groups live and work together for efficiency and foster a strong sense of belonging in the tribe's social fabric.

**Kobolds and Other Races:** Kobolds are isolationists who distrust and dislike other humanoids, viewing outsiders as threats and defending their lairs with traps. They are oversensitive and prone to conflict, often reacting to perceived insults with swift, vengeful actions instead of words. This paranoia leads to unnecessary disputes, and other races regard

kobolds with suspicion, especially since many visitors to kobold territory never return. Their hostility turns into raw hatred toward fey and gnomes, making alliances with those who favor these races nearly impossible.

*Dragonborn of Bahamut:* Kobolds view dragonborn with suspicion but grudgingly respect the divine touch of Bahamut that elevates them. However, they cannot fully overlook their origins, especially if a dragonborn was once a gnome. Despite this, kobolds may cooperate with dragonborn when interests align.

*Dragon-Descended:* Kobolds revere dragon-descended beings, particularly half-dragons, nearly as much as true dragons. While rare, they are willing to aid draconic characters, regardless of lineage, though they remain loyal only to exceptionally charismatic half-dragons.

*Dwarves:* Kobolds and dwarves are rivals for underground resources, often clashing over territory. Dwarves' alliances with gnomes further fuel hostility, though outright violence is not as inevitable as with gnomes. However, if forced to collaborate, kobolds and dwarves can discover shared values and forge respectful relationships.

*Elves:* Kobolds mistrust elves due to their resemblance to fey but grant them a grudging respect for their long history and arcane prowess. Rarely, elves and kobolds exchange arcane lore, with elves sharing vast knowledge while kobolds contribute their recorded draconic history.

*Gnomes:* Kobolds despise gnomes with an intensity rivaled only by the gnomes' hatred for them. Even under the best diplomatic circumstances, their shared enmity is barely contained. The kobolds' grudge stems from the legend of Kurtulmak and Garl Glittergold, perpetuating ongoing atrocities committed by both sides. Peace between these races is rare and only serves as a prelude to further violence.

*Half-Dragons:* Half-dragons are both revered and envied by kobolds, with their respect varying based on the individual's draconic lineage. While most half-dragons receive a degree of admiration, a half-gnome half-dragon is deemed an abomination and immediately targeted for destruction. Kobolds also show curiosity toward dragon disciples who gain draconic powers through sorcery.

*Half-Elves:* Kobolds see half-elves as intermediaries, valued for their knack for diplomacy. While generally mistrustful, kobolds would consider relying on a half-elf to represent their interests if they were ever to trust an outsider—a rare occurrence.

*Half-Orcs:* Kobolds associate orcs with chaos and war, extending this perception to half-orcs. However, half-orcs are seen as the most reasonable among orc-kind, often acting as intermediaries for trade, especially if they speak Draconic. In human lands,

half-orcs find little respect from kobolds unless they prove themselves as fair trade brokers.

*Halflings:* Kobolds' disdain for fey carries over to halflings, whose cheerful demeanor is often misinterpreted as deceitful. Though kobolds view halflings with suspicion, they share a mutual appreciation for trapmaking. This shared interest offers rare moments of cooperation between the two races.

*Humans:* Human behavior baffles kobolds, who see them as unpredictable yet relentless in their pursuits. Though kobolds would avoid humans if possible, humans' ubiquity forces them to assess each community individually to determine whether they might be allies or threats.

*Spellscales:* Despite their draconic heritage, spellscales frustrate kobolds, who view them as chaotic and wasteful. Only kobold sorcerers temper their disdain with respect for spellscale sorcerous power. Even so, extended contact with spellscales tries the patience of any kobold.

*True Dragons:* To kobolds, dragons are divine figures and the pinnacle of existence. Kobolds devote themselves entirely to dragons—both figuratively and literally—regarding them as ancient, wise kin to be revered and served. Dragons embody the cultural and spiritual ideal of kobold society that Kurtulmak himself cannot provide.

**Religion:** Kobolds are deeply pious despite their focus on work, treating hard labor and tribal service as acts of worship.

Kurtulmak, their primary deity, is honored in small temples within kobold lairs that serve as housing for clerics and storage for treasures, rather than places of congregation. Clerics oversee workers, offering support, healing, and motivation to maintain productivity. Kobolds view unwavering dedication, personal sacrifice, and even martyrdom as acts of supreme devotion, honoring those who die for the tribe as folk heroes akin to saints.

Clerics play vital roles within kobold communities. They supervise mining efforts, act as physicians, and bolster workers' stamina. They also care for eggs and wyrmlings believed to be reincarnations of notable kobolds. Clerics perform rituals, including receiving vows from kobolds destined to become sorcerers.

While Kurtulmak is the central figure of kobold worship, the pantheon includes other deities. Gaknulak, god of traps and trickery, is revered for safeguarding kobold warrens. In wartime, kobolds honor Dakarnok the Raider. Kuraulyek, worshiped by the winged urds, is shunned by most kobolds. In the Iron Theocracy, kobolds worship Weximaze, an iron dragon seeking divine ascension.

**History:** Kobold settlements are hard to trace, as they abandon depleted mines after stripping them of valuables. Their old lairs, often dangerous and occupied by other creatures, still hold kobold history etched into the walls. Being meticulous recordkeepers, kobolds engrave events from their lives into each lair they establish, even after numerous migrations. Subterranean races sometimes gut and repurpose these mines, and kobold markings have even been found in ancient dwarf strongholds.

Kobolds' wide dispersal across unrelated regions has puzzled scholars. Their nomadic search for metals and gems cannot fully explain their global presence, leading some to speculate on divine or draconic intervention in their history.

**Language:** Kobolds speak Kobold, a language derived from the languages of true dragons.

**Settlements:** Kobold tribes inevitably grow, causing overcrowding despite mining additional living spaces. When space runs out, the all-watcher declares a split, a moment of celebration as the tribe expands to new lands.

The tribe divides evenly, ensuring essential professions are represented in the new lair. Young adults lead the effort to establish the settlement, with older kobolds joining later once construction progresses. The new lair must feature rich metal veins or gem deposits, and kobold sorcerers and priests pinpoint suitable sites in advance. Scouts assess potential threats and competitors, determining if conflict is necessary. Ideal locations include mountains, valleys, rivers, and natural caverns requiring minimal modification. Mining only begins after a profitable site is secured.

**Economy:** Kobolds are extraordinarily wealthy, though their riches primarily serve their dragon allies. Kobold-mined treasures fill dragons' hoards, reflecting the ancient bond between the two. Dragons' love for precious resources aligns perfectly with kobolds' unmatched mining ingenuity, even surpassing dwarves in productivity. Some kobold tribes mint gold coins bearing their dragon's likeness.

Aware of the demand for their skills, kobolds have long supplied realms averse to dealing with dwarves, often underselling their competition with disguised merchants. These kobold traders established their own tribes, perpetuating the cycle of wealth.

This economic system empowers kobolds on two fronts: gaining favor with dragons, elevating their status, and making civilizations reliant on their metals. Such reliance reduces threats to their existence and enables kobolds to subtly influence regional affairs.

## Spoils

Leather made from kobold skin is soft and flexible, and elves are known to craft items from it. Kobold bones are sometimes used in the hilts of weapons.

## Racial Template

-40 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-5 [-50]; DX+1 [20].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM-2; Basic Move -1 [-5].

**Advantages:** DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Extended Lifespan 1 [2]; Infravision [10]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [3].

**Disadvantages:** Cold-Blooded (50°) [-5]; Intolerance (Gnomes) [-2]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Selfless (15) [-2]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Quirks:** Admires true dragons [-1]; Chauvinistic [-1]; Holds a grudge [-1].

**Features:** Born Biter 3; Early Maturation 3; Night Vision 5.

The template above represents a common kobold adapted to underground environments. Kobolds that live predominantly aboveground, such as the kobolds of the Iron Theocracy, do not have the Night Vision 5 feature.

## Kobold Warrior

Type: Humanoid (Kobold, Reptile)



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 5  | <b>HP</b> | 5    | <b>SM</b>     | -2        |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 5.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-4/1d-3 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | 10   | <b>BL</b>     | 5 lbs.    |

Reduced Swing: 1d-4/1d-3

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 40 lb.

**Height:** 2.5 ft.

**Effective Height:** 3 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

This is a kobold warrior with basic weapon training.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 5  | 10    | 15     | 30    | 50          |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 7 (dagger); 8 (javelin); 8 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Sunburn.

**Notes:** The kobold's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +3 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

## Combat

Kobolds like to attack with overwhelming odds – at least two to one – or trickery; should the odds fall below this threshold, they usually flee. Due to short height and low damage, kobolds try to target unarmored body parts, such as feet and legs, and use Extra Effort (Mighty Blows), All-Out Attack (Strong), or Committed Attack (Strong) when possible.

**SM-2 Dagger (11):** thrust 1d-5 impaling, Reach C, 0.1 lb.

**SM-2 Dagger throw (6):** thrust 1d-5 impaling, Acc 0, x0.5/x1 (2/5), 0.1 lb., Bulk -1.

**SM-2 Javelin throw (11):** thrust 1d-3 impaling, Acc 3, x1.5/x2.5 (7/12), 0.5 lbs., Bulk -4.

**SM-2 Javelin thrust (11):** thrust 1d-3 impaling, Reach 1, 0.5 lbs.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-5 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-4 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.25 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 2.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 3                    | 5         | 8                    | 10                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** The kobold possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

Aside from normal vision, the kobold can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

The eyes of the kobold are adapted to darkness; its **native illumination level is -5**. This lets it see and fight at no penalty at night, but it suffers a -5 penalty during the day.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Admires true dragons; Chauvinistic; Holds a grudge; Intolerance (Gnomes); Selfless (15).

## Skills

Knife-11; Spear-11; Stealth-11; Throwing Weapon (Spear)-11.

## Capturing and Training

Kobold slaves are often used as fodder in armies of drow and other underground races.

**Young Value:** \$25.

**Untrained Value:** \$120.

**Trained Value:** \$1,185.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.008 and 0.25 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.0012

**Wage (Monthly):** \$35

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Kobold Warriors**

*Battle Rating:* 0.15

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Nocturnal.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 12/48

*Supply (Weekly):* \$20.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$4,275.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$4,350.

## Kobold Sorcerer

Type: Humanoid (Kobold, Reptile)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 5  | <b>HP</b> | 5    | <b>SM</b>     | -2        |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 5.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-4/1d-3 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | 10   | <b>BL</b>     | 5 lbs.    |

Reduced Swing: 1d-4/1d-3

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 40 lb.

**Height:** 2.5 ft.

**Effective Height:** 3 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

This is a kobold sorcerer with the white dragon  
bloodline.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 5  | 10    | 15     | 30    | 50          |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 7 (dagger); 8 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Sunburn.

**Notes:** The kobold's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +3 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

### Combat

Kobold sorcerers stay away from melee combat, preferring to use their Ray of Frost spell from afar to weaken opponents and let their allies finish them.

**SM-2 Dagger (11):** thrust 1d-5 impaling, Reach C, 0.1 lb.

**SM-2 Dagger throw (6):** thrust 1d-5 impaling, Acc 0, x0.5/x1 (2/5), 0.1 lb., Bulk -1.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-5 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-4 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.25 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 2.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 1                           | 3                           | 5                | 8                           | 10                        |

### Special Abilities

**Spellcasting:** The kobold sorcerer is a spellcaster with Sorcery Talent 1. It has a white dragon bloodline that limits his scope of spells to cold spells, meta-spells, and flight spells, but has no Sorcerous Empowerment. The kobold sorcerer has two learned spells that do not require skill-based casting roll and mandatory verbal and somatic components:

[Detect Magic](#) (12);

[Ray of Frost 1](#) (13).

For more detailed rules for sorcerous spellcasting, see *Powers of Karilan*.

### Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** The kobold possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

Aside from normal vision, the kobold can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

The eyes of the kobold are adapted to darkness; its **native illumination level is -5**. This lets it see and fight at no penalty at night, but it suffers a -5 penalty during the day.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 11 | 12   |

**Mentality Traits:** Admires true dragons; Chauvinistic; Holds a grudge; Intolerance (Gnomes); Selfless (15).

### **Skills**

Innate Attack (Beam)-12; Knife-11; Occultism-11; Stealth-11.

### **Capturing and Training**

Kobold slaves are often used as fodder in armies of drow and other underground races.

**Young Value:** \$25.

**Untrained Value:** \$120.

**Trained Value:** \$1,185.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.008 and 0.25 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.0012

**Wage (Monthly):** \$35

## Kreen, Thri-Kreen

Type: *Monstrous Humanoid (Kreen)*



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 16 | <b>HP</b> | 16  | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+1/2d+2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | 11  | <b>BL</b>     | 51 lbs.   |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d+1/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid (four arms) (p. B552).

**Weight:** 460 lbs.

**Height:** 7'.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** 5-10. 20% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** G.

The thri-kreen are an insectoid, nomadic race inhabiting the Teji Desert. Resembling giant bipedal praying mantises, they have six limbs—two for walking and four serving as arms ending in four-fingered, claw-like hands for handling tools and weapons. Their insectoid heads feature multi-faceted compound eyes, small antennae, and sharp mandibles. Distinguishing between male and female thri-kreen is difficult for outsiders.

Their carapaces, typically sandy yellow but ranging from sandy brown to pale green, allow them to blend seamlessly into their desert surroundings. Thri-kreen wear minimal clothing, opting for simple leather belts and harnesses to carry essentials, and they avoid adornments.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 8; exploration 4 miles per hour.

**Water:** The thri-kreen cannot swim. They cannot float without support, and their arms, legs, and hands are not built to propel them through water.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 51 | 102   | 153    | 306   | 510         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2. Eyes are protected by Nictitating Membrane 1.

**Antennae** (-7): DR 0. Located in hex #1. 1 HP of injury cripples an antenna; any excess injury is lost.

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 11 (gythka; unbalanced after swinging); 10 (unarmed), 9 (chatkcha).

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against damage caused by high or low body temperature; +1 to all HT rolls concerned with eye damage.

**Immunities:** Kreen poison, sunburn.

**Vulnerabilities:** Drowning (x2 FP).

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

### Combat

In hunting, thri-kreen use camouflage and psionic powers to enhance their abilities, closing in with speed and agility. If the hunt turns against them, they retreat and hide. In melee combat, they become whirling dervishes of violence, using their claws, venomous bites, and unique weapons: the gythka (same stats as a lajatang) and the chatkcha (a crystalline throwing wedge). Thanks to their four arms, they can wield two gythkas or throw two (or sometimes more) chatkchas simultaneously, excelling with these exotic weapons.

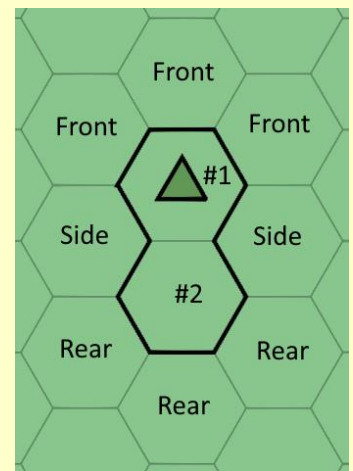
Sand imposes no movement or DX penalties on thri-kreen.

Thri-kreen have **Ambidexterity** (p. B39) and **Extra Attack 1**.

**SM+1 Gythka swing (14):** swing 3d+1 cutting (RS: 2d+2), Reach 1-3\* from hex #1. Unbalanced, two-handed. 15.75 lbs.

**SM+1 Gythka thrust (14):** thrust 2d cutting, Reach 1-3\* from hex #1. Two-handed. 15.75 lbs.

**SM+1 Dasl Chatkcha throw (14):** thrust 1d+2 impaling, Range 64/96 (x4/x6), T(1), Bulk -3, 1.5 lb. If thrown parallel to the ground (no more than 1 yard



of height difference), it will return to the thrower, provided it missed the target, the target dodged, and it was not otherwise stopped. The thri-kreen may catch it automatically, unless it moved more than a step before or after throwing it, is stunned, or otherwise distracted. In that case, the catch requires a DX-2 roll. The caught chatkcha is considered ready, but since it returns at the end of the second it was thrown, it cannot be thrown again in that combat round. The thri-kreen may throw a chatkcha at an additional -4 penalty to make it return to another creature within range. Note that on a failed throw, the chatkcha flies 1d yards past the thrower and falls.

**SM+1 Dasl Chatkcha swing (12):** swing 2d+1 cutting (RS: 1d+2), Reach 1 from hex #1. 1.5 lb.

**SM+1 Dasl Chatkcha thrust (12):** thrust 1d+2 impaling, Reach 1 from hex #1. 1.5 lb.

**Sharp Claws (13):** thrust 1d+1 cutting, Reach C-1 from hex #1.

**Mandibles (13):** thrust 1d+1 cutting plus follow-up venom (see below), Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the thri-kreen may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+1 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d-1 control against larger ones.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d+1 control, Reach C-1 from hex #1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.55 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 25.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 8                    | 16        | 24                   | 32                 |

## Special Abilities

**Leaping:** Thri-kreen double the distance and height they can achieve when jumping (see *Jumping*, p. B352). The thri-kreen's has Move 8 when jumping.

If the thri-kreen falls a distance less than or equal to 4 yards, he or she takes no damage. The thri-kreen can increase this distance by five yards with a successful Acrobatics roll.

*Standing Jump Height:* 2 yards, 4 inches.

*Running Jump Height:* 4 yards, 8 inches.

*Standing Jump Distance:* 8 yards, 2 feet.

*Running Jump Distance:* 17 yards, 1 foot.

**Psionics:** Thri-kreen is an innately psionic race. Their racial memory provides them with Absolute Direction only one level of Photorefraction, but many improve the latter ability and/or learn new ones:

*Absolute Direction* – this passive ability of the ESP power lets the thri-kreen retrace a path he or she followed within the past month and gives +3 to Body

Sense and Navigation. The thri-kreen always knows which way is north.

*Photorefraction 3 (11)* – p. PP36.

**Racial Memory:** All thri-kreen access information and general abilities through racial memory, including language and some skills. In addition, a thri-kreen's racial memory may provide passive insights. The GM secretly rolls against IQ for the thri-kreen in any situation that its ancestors might have encountered. A critical success gives a vivid replay of an ancestral memory, while a normal success just gives a feeling of déjà vu about the situation that is up to the thri-kreen to interpret. Critical failure gives a wrong impression.

**Venom:** Any living creature injured by the thri-kreen's mandibles must roll against HT one minute later or take a -3 penalty to DX for margin of failure minutes. If the victim fails by 5 or more or fails critically, he instead becomes paralyzed for margin of failure minutes. Upon recovering, he becomes physically stunned and may recover from stun as normal. This ability cannot be used outside of combat and similar stressful situations.

Note that the venom may also be used to produce a crystalline substance called *dasl* and is disabled for some time after it is used that way. For more details, see *Venom* and *Dasl* in the Ecology section below.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furies*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Incidental Collisions (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 6).

Slam and Overrun (p. B392).

- Defense vs. Slams (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 9).

*Teeth* (p. MA115).

Tramplng (p. B404).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 14          | 5     |

**Hearing:** Thri-kreen use their antennae to detect sound, with hearing similar to humans.

**Smell:** While they use antennae to detect pheromones, this is not their primary means of communication. Thri-kreen can interpret basic emotions and desires through pheromone discharges from other kreen and insects within 2 yards as per **Empathy** (p. B51), while also providing **Discriminatory Smell** (p. B49).

**Touch:** Thri-kreen hands, encased in chitin, lack sensitivity. They can feel temperature and surface roughness, but finer textures (e.g., burlap vs. silk) are indistinguishable.

**Vibration Sense (11):** Vibration Sense lets the thri-kreen make a Sense roll subject to *separate* bonuses for the target's size, speed (invert the penalty), and a penalty for range to the target based on the *Size and Speed/Range Table* (p. B550) to detect something by sensing vibrations that propagate through the air. Success allows ignoring visibility penalties in combat that second. Wind will generate "noise" that imposes penalties, and the same penalties are applied to attacks that rely on this ability.

**Vision:** The thri-kreen possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

Thri-kreen eyes consist of a sphere within a tough, translucent black shell. The sphere contains three eyespots and secondary motion detectors, giving the eyes a multi-faceted appearance. Pheromone discharges change the eye color, indicating emotions: lighter for pleasant, darker for unpleasant, and bright for strong feelings. Thri-kreen eyesight functions like mammalian eyesight for practical purposes.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 10   |

Influenced by tokchak (clutch mentality) and the hunt, thri-kreen have a unique mindset. Their racial memory provides them with cunning and wisdom, though they lack memorization skills and aptitude for magic. This insect nature makes them largely misunderstood and often disliked.

Tokchak shapes a thri-kreen's life, leading them to seek or form a clutch. Knowing one's place within the hierarchy is vital; not knowing can cause insecurity and psychological issues. Thri-kreen mate for life, sharing possessions within the clutch and having little need for money. They may barter outside their clutch, often giving away coins. This sharing mentality can appear suspicious to others.

Thri-kreen do not like being called "bugs" or referred to as "it," as they are persons with lives, histories, roles, and genders. Freedom and individuality are important, but they embrace the responsibility of being clutchmates.

Thri-kreen are pragmatic about life and death. They lay eggs and accept their destruction as natural, ready to lay more. They don't fear death, seeing it as inevitable but not welcoming it, as it ends their contribution to the clutch.

They don't believe in an afterlife but have a basic belief in reincarnation. Eggs are laid where old thri-kreen rest, believing young inherit their characteristics.

Thri-kreen view the world through the lens of the clutch and the hunt, respecting and caring for their environment, avoiding overhunting and harming plants.

Outside their natural environment, thri-kreen find the world confusing. Non-kreen compete for their food, cities replace hunting grounds, and wizards manipulate unnatural energies. The clutch and the hunt help thri-kreen categorize everything, giving them a functional, though alien, worldview.

Thri-kreen are fascinated by the number three: they prefer packs with three clutches, make agreements lasting three days or years, and favor weapons like the three-bladed chatkcha and gythka.

**Mentality Traits:** Code of Honor (Thri-Kreen); Congenial; Dislike urbanites; Doesn't understand money; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings); Sees sleep as weakness.

### Skills

Armoury (Thri-Kreen)-10; Brawling-13; Knife-14; Polearm-14; Stealth-12; Survival (Desert)-14; Thrown Weapon (Disc)-14.

**Psionic Skills:** Photorefraction-11.

### Ecology

**Abdomen:** The abdomen is segmented and protected by chitin bands. It contains digestive and reproductive organs, with the stomach and intestines near the front and excretory and reproductive systems at the back. Female reproductive organs are on top, male's underneath, both under chitin plates, making gender differences subtle to other races. Pheromones exude from side pores, indicating mood to other insects but remain mostly undetectable to humanoids.

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Camouflage:** The sandy carapace of the thri-kreen lets it blend it with the surrounding sand. This gives the thri-kreen +2 to Camouflage and Stealth when posed still and unclad against sand. This bonus only works against normal vision, not Infravision.

**Diet:** Thri-kreen primarily prefer to eat non-kreen animals, favoring reptiles, birds, and herbivores over carnivores, but can consume insects and other arthropods when necessary. While they rarely use plants, they occasionally harvest herbs for flavoring meat, medicine, or making chatkcha crystal.

Thri-kreen see almost any unintelligent creature as potential prey, which is why they don't ride animals; it's akin to playing with food for them. Known for their taste for elves, thri-kreen generally prefer hunting unintelligent prey over intelligent beings, avoiding the latter except in dire circumstances. This restraint is crucial for their survival and the ecosystem.

Despite this, thri-kreen feel no moral qualms about eating other sapient beings; it's a matter of survival and social code. Only thri-kreen and their clutchmates are considered people; other lifeforms, including most sapient creatures, hold little significance in their insect minds.

Thri-kreen require only two quarts of water per week to survive. However, thanks to being cold-blooded, the thri-kreen needs much less food to survive – two one-pound meals a day.

**Exoskeleton:** Thri-kreen, like other insects, have an exoskeleton and three body segments: head, thorax, and abdomen. This chitinous exoskeleton, reinforced by internal cartilage strips, supports muscles and internal organs. The chitin provides natural DR, is lightweight, and helps retain moisture while allowing heat dissipation. Although tough and flexible at joints, thri-kreen cannot perform certain movements like shrugging or curling into a ball. Their muscles attach to the chitin segments via tendons, enabling a strong "backhand" attack.

**Habitat:** Warm and temperate plains and deserts. The temperature comfort zone of a thri-kreen falls between 35° and 112°, but see *Temperature Regulation* below.

**Healing:** Because damage to a thri-kreen usually indicates damage to the thri-kreen's chitin, thri-kreen healing is also different from that of other beings. A thri-kreen's internal injuries heal at about the same rate as similar injuries done to humanoids. With a thri-kreen, platelets reaching a wound become exposed to air and cause the blood to not only clot, but harden; the hardening blood develops into chitin in a relatively short time. Thus, a thri-kreen **regenerates 1 HP every 12 hours** in addition to normal healing, but this **does not apply to injuries delivered to vitals** and other internal damage.

A thri-kreen who receives a deep wound might develop a lump of chitin beneath the outer shell; this might be re-absorbed by the body over a period of a year or more, depending on its size. Such a growth seldom interferes with the thri-kreen in any way.

New chitin is usually of a slightly lighter color than the surrounding material, usually making scars more evident on a thri-kreen than on a humanoid. Wounds do not always heal smoothly; the new chitin is often rough and exudes past the surface of uninjured chitin. Care must be taken if the thri-kreen wants a wound to heal smoothly; sandstone and other rough materials can be used to smooth the area. Thri-kreen usually wear their scars with some pride, and an old thri-kreen often has chitin laced with scars and covered with knobs and other protrusions.

Besides damage to chitin, a thri-kreen can suffer other injuries as well. A broken chitin segment must be set, like a broken bone in a human, and eventually

heals. Removing a segment of a thri-kreen's arm is like severing a humanoid's arm.

**Lifecycle:** Thri-kreen mature rapidly and are considered adults at age five and venerable at twenty-five. During the lifetime of a typical non-kreen Karilan, multiple thri-kreen generations come and go.

In six years, thri-kreen grow from one to eleven feet. Hatchlings emerge with a soft shell, which hardens to adult toughness within a day. The term "larva" is misleading, as thri-kreen larvae resemble miniature adults with four legs and two primitive clawed arms. They can run immediately after hatching and survive on ancestral "racial memory" that aids both mentally and physically, including hunting instincts and language.

Hatchlings possess basic abilities such as hunting, antenna use, no need for sleep, and reduced water needs. Advanced skills like leaping, venom production, and wielding the chatkcha develop later. While adults hunt, young thri-kreen are taught food preparation and preservation.

During the first year, larvae undergo two molts, transitioning into the child stage, where middle limbs start to become functional. By the end of the second year and third molt, they enter the "young" stage, with fully developed, functional claws.

Advantages evolve in early stages, such as rapid growth, survival traits, and ancestral knowledge, adapting them efficiently for their short lifespans and dynamic lifestyles.

A young thri-kreen is a smaller, slender version of the adult. During this year, it learns to use claws for attack and to manipulate tools and weapons. Nearby adults often provide chatkcha or small gythka for practice, though young thri-kreen primarily rely on natural weapons due to insufficient dexterity. They can match adult thri-kreen's movement speed.

At this stage, they also develop the leaping ability within 10 days post-transition from "child" to "young" due to metabolic changes enhancing their racial memory.

Specialized young thri-kreen (warriors, shamans, or chakaks) begin practicing their professions. The transition to young adulthood, differing primarily in size, involves further learning with tools and weapons, especially under the guidance of older mentors. Thri-kreen specializing in specific skills continue developing them.

At the year's end, the young adult molts, gaining the broader body and larger claws characteristic of mature thri-kreen, marking the transition to the "adult" stage.

By adulthood, thri-kreen reach full sexual maturity and are socially recognized as adults. Mating typically occurs before entering the "wandering age."

Adult thri-kreen hunters develop the ability to produce venom and crystals for chatkcha shortly after this transition, thanks to racial memory and enzyme production. Within 60 days of molting into adulthood, they usually create and wield their first chatkcha in a ceremony marking full acceptance into their pack.

Thri-kreen not on the hunter path don't produce venom at this age but must complete the chatkcha ceremony for pack acceptance, possibly using a non-crystal chatkcha until they generate their own. Most wait until venom production begins to learn chatkcha skills. Early proficiency is recognized as a different, accepted path often leading to wandering.

A mature adult thri-kreen is larger, a year older, and more skilled. They typically reproduce during this year. The sixth year brings the last two molts, with few changes other than size. Between ages six and 25, physical changes are minimal unless due to injury or disease.

Thri-kreen experience a decline in ability much later compared to other species. During these years, they wander, often as part of nomadic or raiding packs.

Around age six or later, some seek adventure, sometimes integrating with other races. Special abilities triggered by racial memory allow warriors, shamans, or chakaks to leap, unless they pursue multiple specializations, delaying this ability.

Wandering thri-kreen epitomize their species, focused on hunting or professional pursuits with minimal ties.

Barring accidents or tragedy, thri-kreen typically live at least 25 years, rarely reaching beyond 35. At 25, thri-kreen, considered venerable, experience a decline in abilities, slowing down and becoming weaker. Their chitin lightens, starting at the joints.

Venerable thri-kreen settle near egg-laying grounds to teach larvae and young. These areas are often close to burial grounds, making it convenient when death approaches. Elders remain active until they sense their natural end, preferring to die while hunting.

Expired elders' bodies are taken to the nearest burial ground to feed predators or young thri-kreen. If a shaman or druid is present, elemental rites are performed: shallow burial for earth, cremation for fire, exposure for air, and immersion for water. Eventually, their exoskeleton bleaches white, becomes brittle, and returns to the elements.

**Limbs:** Thri-kreen have no wings and feature four arms and two legs, unlike mantises like trin. Limb joints are flexible, similar to shoulders and hips, allowing good rotation. Their feet have four toes—a backward one and three forward ones connected by a membrane, enhancing sand mobility.

**Mandibles:** Thri-kreen mouths are typical for

insects, lacking lips and real teeth. Main mandibles open horizontally, and an additional lower jaw segment assists in swallowing. Inner mandibles help manipulate food, while their rough, short tongue contains taste buds similar to those of humanoids. The antennae's scent receptors also enhance taste.

**Molting:** Molting is a painful process where a thri-kreen sheds old chitin and grows new. This occurs twice a year for the first six years, totaling 12 molts before full growth. Between molts, growth is minimal, with chitin plates stretching to their limits.

As molting approaches, thri-kreen enter a feeding frenzy to gather necessary nutrients. During the eight-day molting period, they require twice their usual liquid intake, about a quarter-gallon daily. The thri-kreen sheds parts of its shell in stages, allowing the exposed areas to grow and harden into new chitin, often eating the shed pieces to regain nutrients.

Each molt results in significant growth; for instance, a larva grows from one to three feet in the first year, doubling its size with each molt. This growth is so rapid that it can be observed visibly during the early molts.

While molting, thri-kreen are vulnerable and avoid danger, ceasing to travel or hunt. Their defense and dexterity sharply decline during this time. Clutches molt concurrently within a few days of each other, leaving them incapacitated. Often, older thri-kreen from the pack guard molting clutches.

Following molting, thri-kreen resume intense hunting and eating to develop the new chitin fully.

**Reproduction:** Thri-kreen mature at four years old with four molts remaining, completing their physical development and becoming fertile. They can breed from ages four to twenty-five and often choose mates early, before reaching sexual maturity. Mating occurs only with clutchmates, eliminating inbreeding issues.

Mating typically happens late in the year, with eggs laid 30 days later. Each clutch consists of 10 to 30 six-inch, dun-colored eggs, buried in a sand-covered chamber. The pack pauses for egg-laying, setting up a defensive perimeter. This is the only time females receive different treatment from males due to the importance of reproduction.

Egg-laying grounds often coincide with burial sites, believed to imbue the young with the traits of deceased thri-kreen. Carapaces provide shelter, and carcasses attract food for hatchlings. After burial, the pack moves on.

Predators consume some eggs, which thri-kreen see as a natural population control. Survivors hatch about 60 days later, during the highest sun, and begin feeding and honing hunting skills. Clutch survival rates vary, with some clutches fully destroyed and others retaining up to 20 members.

**Sleep:** Thri-kreen do not sleep, unlike other intelligent beings, and they see sleep as a weakness. They use the vulnerability of sleeping prey to their advantage in hunts. Thri-kreen find it hard to understand why any intelligent creature would choose to sleep, viewing it as a bad habit and those who do so as lazy and unworthy clutchmates.

Impatient with sleepers, thri-kreen remain active at night, often engaging in storytelling and conversations. Though they might agree to stay in one place at night, they prefer to interact rather than rest.

Despite their initial disdain, thri-kreen in mixed groups learn to tolerate sleep and may come to understand it as a necessity for non-kreen. Some thri-kreen are fascinated by sleepers, closely observing them, which can be unsettling for beings like humans or elves who wake to find a thri-kreen watching them.

**Temperature Regulation:** The thri-kreen is a cold-blooded creature. While it has +2 HT to resist damage from high or low body temperature, it tends to stiffen up in cold weather. After 30 minutes in cold conditions, the thri-kreen gets -1 to Basic Speed and DX per 10° below 65°F. The thri-kreen regains lost Basic Speed and DX at the rate of one point of each per hour once it returns to a warm climate. Double this rate in an exceptionally warm environment. At temperatures below 32°, the thri-kreen must roll vs. HT or take 1 HP of damage.

**Thorax:** The thorax, split into the prothorax and lower thorax, houses lungs and two closely synced hearts, divided by a cartilage strip. The lungs and hearts, each with distinct arteries and veins, oxygenate and circulate blood in a four-beat cadence. The prothorax contains various organs and poison glands and can rotate 90 degrees and bend 45 degrees forward or backward, allowing for remarkable flexibility and posture changes.

The lower thorax, cushioned by strong muscles, absorbs shock from powerful leaps and holds major arteries, veins, and the digestive tract. It primarily contains the *gyth'sa*, a spongy organ crucial for blood production. The thri-kreen's dark yellow blood, thick and rich in essential components, is produced here. The lower thorax connects to the abdomen via a joint that allows limited movement, enabling slight raising, lowering, and side-to-side motion.

**Venom and Dasl:** Thri-kreen produce venom enzymes in an upper thorax organ, which are secreted onto their mandibles and delivered through bites. This venom paralyzes almost any creature within a minute, except thri-kreen and their close relatives. Contrary to rumors, both male and female thri-kreen are immune to each other's venom, as well as to that of related species like tohr-kreen and trin.

Thri-kreen use venom effectively in combat and hunting to quickly paralyze prey. Venom production

is triggered by adrenaline from stress or combat, and it helps thri-kreen secure more prey for their clutch.

Venom also allows thri-kreen to create *dasl*, a crystalline substance used mainly for making chatkcha, important in their culture and adulthood ceremonies. Dasl holds a near-religious significance for thri-kreen because it is produced by them. The origin of dasl is a closely guarded secret, with others believing it is found in hidden places. Thri-kreen can produce chatkcha in a few days if they have the necessary herb, giving them an advantage even in captivity.

Dasl is created by thri-kreen through a process involving sand, venomous saliva, and a common herb called fejik (can be found with a Naturalist roll.) Fejik acts as a catalyst, and when mixed with venom and spit onto sand, it forms an opaque, crystalline substance similar to cloudy glass. This material remains soft enough to shape for about a day using claws or simple tools. This requires an Armoury (Thri-Kreen) roll. This is a new limited specialty of the Armoury skill that covers all the thri-kreen weapons. Unlike other specialties, this is an Easy difficulty skill.

Dasl is as heavy as stone but as durable as steel, making it ideal for weapon creation. However, producing dasl has limitations:

1. Secrecy: The process is a guarded racial secret.
2. Venom Use: Creating dasl inhibits venom production, as chewing fejik paralyzes venom glands for a day. A venomous bite also depletes enzyme stores, necessitating a 12-hour wait before dasl creation. Each use of the venom for dasl production creates 0.25 lb. of dasl and disables venom for one day.

3. Suitability: Dasl is unsuitable for large or complex items, only stable in small, three-pronged forms like chatkcha and gythka heads.

Though admired for its strength and cultural reverence, dasl's use is mostly limited to chatkcha and gythka. It is rarely used for other purposes due to its secretive nature, impact on venom production, and structural limitations. The material can't withstand the stress of larger constructions, such as long swords or breastplates.

Dasl's exclusivity and strength make it highly coveted. A thri-kreen carrying multiple dasl weapons would attract significant attention and potential danger, similar to a human carrying several metal weapons.

## Clutch, Pack, and Nation

Most humans and other non-kreen misunderstand the thri-kreen concept of clutch mentality, often confusing packs with clutches. Clutch mentality, known as *tokchak* ("egg-mind"), is not merely basic

instinct. Unlike true hive beings, thri-kreen behavior requires thought and lacks the sub-psionic and pheromonal communication.

Clutch has three meanings:

1. All eggs laid by a kreen at one time (up to 30 eggs).
2. All thri-kreen hatched from the same batch of eggs ("birth clutch").
3. A thri-kreen and any beings it accepts as clutchmates.

A clutch of eggs is called *tok* (egg/eggs), and living group of thri-kreen and their clutchmates is *g'tok* (egg-family). Thri-kreen usually belong to their birth clutch and one or more other clutches formed later. Birth clutches hold a special status.

A pack (*tek*) is a group of interrelated clutches, with shared members between different clutches within the pack.

Thri-kreen seek new clutchmates based on trust, liking, and respect, often accepting those who fight alongside them. New members can't join the birth clutch but form a new one, requiring approval from existing members. Approval may be verbal or assumed through observation, especially with non-kreen members, as explaining the process can be complex.

New clutchmates bond through special pheromones. A seasoned thri-kreen may belong to multiple clutches with varying memberships.

A thri-kreen can still accept new clutchmates without group approval, forming new clutches. Some clutches may have multiple members while others might have only two. Clutchmates can even belong to multiple clutches if accepted by all members of those clutches.

Thri-kreen inherently know when a bond forms through pheromones. When one accepts another, they release a bonding pheromone; if reciprocated, the bond is formed. If not, a negative pheromone is released, preventing the bond. This can cause confusion with non-kreen, who don't release pheromones. Wise thri-kreen inform non-kreen prospects of the bond to avoid misunderstandings.

Being a clutchmate comes with many duties, responsibilities, and privileges. Clutchmates give and receive support and this bond defines a thri-kreen's place in the universe. These relationships transcend personal worldview; thri-kreen always act with good intentions towards their clutch, even if their overall worldview varies, sometimes causing them to seem unpredictable.

The primary duty of a clutchmate is to help the clutch. Thri-kreen understand these duties intuitively and seldom need to articulate them, making it hard to explain clutch dynamics to non-kreen.

## New Disadvantage

The clutch mindset of the thri-kreen is represented with the following new disadvantage.

### **Code of Honor (Thri-Kreen) [-10]**

If a thri-kreen were to outline the duties of a clutchmate, they would be as follows:

- Do not reveal the true nature of dasl to non-kreen.
- Protect and assist the clutch and fellow clutchmates.
- Hone hunting and other survival skills.
- Prioritize aid: first to clutchmates, then packmates, other kreen, other intelligent beings, and lastly, prey.
- Obey the clutchleader's commands.
- Challenge a weakened clutchleader for the good of the clutch and be ready to take over leadership if necessary.
- Advise the clutchleader on any knowledge they might lack.
- Accept challenge outcomes without dispute. Being a clutchsecond or the weakest member carries no shame—every role, from the strongest to the weakest, is essential. It is enough to belong to the clutch.

**Breaking the Ties:** For thri-kreen, leaving a clutch typically only occurs through death, making quitting a clutch unheard of. Non-kreen can cease being clutchmates either by their own decision (if they understand *tokchak*) or more commonly, by the thri-kreen's choice.

Sometimes a thri-kreen will accept a non-kreen as a clutchmate, but may later decide this was a mistake due to misunderstandings about expectations. In such cases, the thri-kreen can sever the bond, informing the non-kreen if necessary without any ill will.

Thri-kreen rarely break bonds with other kreen. If disagreements arise, they might separate but still honor the clutch-bond. Formal bond severance is rare and requires mutual agreement, potentially leading to conflict if perceived as an insult.

On rare occasions, a clutchmate may act so reprehensibly that they are immediately expelled and revenge is sought. Betrayal within the clutch is met with death. The term "*g'tokxhko•*," meaning "clutch-breaker," is a grave insult, and such individuals are killed swiftly and then erased from memory.

**Clutch Leadership:** A clutch operates under a strict hierarchy determined by dominance. Peaceful recognition of power and aggressiveness usually establishes this hierarchy. Orders and suggestions shape the positions: the most followed individual becomes the clutchleader, followed by the clutchsecond, down to the least dominant member. Charisma, intelligence, aggressiveness, and strength all influence leadership acceptance.

Unhappy members can issue dominance challenges, leading to fights until one surrenders or

dies, after which no animosity remains. Unlike humans, thri-kreen do not delegate all tasks downward. When a clutchleader gives an order, it targets a specific thri-kreen, either the most suited, someone being tested, or one needing experience. If unspecified, the clutchsecond or best-suited thri-kreen assumes the responsibility.

**Pack and Nation:** A pack consists of several clutches, whereas a nation, particularly in the Teji Desert, is a loose collection of packs identified by humans and non-kreen for convenience. Thri-kreen themselves do not recognize nations but do identify with their packs.

Each pack has a leader, packsecond, a council clutch, and local customs dictating interactions among packmates. The pack leader is the most powerful clutchleader, not necessarily from the largest clutch. The clutchleaders within a pack form an informal council for advisory purposes.

Pack leadership is determined through challenges, not mere orders. When a clutch joins a pack, its leader challenges other clutchleaders to establish a hierarchy. Packs typically have 30-100 members divided into 2-12 clutches. Packs larger than 50 members tend to split due to impractical hunting conditions, with the packleader and packsecond leading separate groups.

While non-kreen may occasionally become members of clutches, they are rarely considered part of the pack overall. Though packs may temporarily accept non-kreen leadership, such arrangements are rare and unstable.

Packmate duties are similar to clutchmate duties but less binding. While thri-kreen feel a strong compulsion to treat clutchmates a certain way, the urge to treat packmates similarly is weaker. Packmates are respected and may be considered for clutchmate status. Thri-kreen away from their kind might initially accept non-kreen as packmates before fully accepting them as clutchmates.

## The Hunt

The hunt profoundly shapes the thri-kreen lifestyle, influencing various aspects beyond mere survival. This "hunter-mind" (*tikchak*) permeates their daily activities, which revolve around preparing for, executing, and responding to the hunt.

Despite their innate hunting instincts, thri-kreen devote considerable time to skill development. From a young age, they engage in hunting-related games to refine their abilities. Adults also practice hunting skills such as tracking, stalking, running, and hiding.

Additionally, thri-kreen invest significant time in weapon maintenance and personal grooming. While they often prefer using their claws and mandibles, they understand that certain prey may require specialized tools like gythka or chatkcha.

**Hunting:** Thri-kreen excel in various hunting techniques, including stalking and lying in wait to surprise prey among rocks or plants. They can relentlessly pursue prey for days, covering extensive ground and waiting for an opportune moment to strike, such as when the prey falls asleep. Their speed and stamina are their greatest assets.

When thri-kreen attack, they do so swiftly and ruthlessly, aiming to surprise, disorganize, and quickly take down their prey to avoid injury and prevent escapes. In hunting herds of unintelligent animals, they typically attack from one side, kill enough for sustenance, and allow the rest to escape to ensure future prey populations. When attacking sapient beings or in desperate situations, they surround their prey to prevent escape.

Against particularly dangerous prey, including intelligent beings, thri-kreen close in rapidly and in large numbers to overwhelm and disorganize the target. This tactic prevents the prey from effectively counter-attacking. They use pack tactics, rotating attackers to maintain pressure and exploit the prey's focus on a few individuals.

While some thri-kreen have learned to set snares and traps, this is rare due to their nomadic nature. They prefer fresh meat, and the harsh climate of the Teji Desert often reduces trapped creatures to carrion by the time they return to check their traps.

**After the Hunt:** Once prey is killed, the thri-kreen gather to eat, following a dominance order if food is scarce. Young thri-kreen do not receive special treatment as adults are key for the pack's survival. There is no selfishness; all hunting is for the clutch.

After eating, they preserve useful parts of the carcass like bones or chitin, but mainly focus on the meat. Sinews and large bones are utilized for making sledges, and large skin pieces are also preserved.

Excess meat is cut into strips to dry. If available, salt or spices may be added for preservation. They do not use fire or smoke, relying instead on sun and wind. Once dried, meat is bundled, placed on a sledge or travois, and carried for future use. It can also be used as bait for larger predators.

Unused parts are left for scavengers and to dry in the sun.

**When Prey is Scarce:** Thri-kreen expand their search area when prey is hard to find, risking territory conflicts with other packs. They eat preserved meat until it runs out. If unintelligent animals remain scarce, they may raid caravans or hunt sapient prey temporarily.

Thri-kreen forced to hunt sapient creatures might leave their pack to live in human cities, giving them a savage reputation. In cities, they hunt vermin or beggars and might eat in taverns if they understand and obtain money.

In extreme cases, wild thri-kreen may eat carrion or resort to cannibalism. Population control occurs when too many thri-kreen overhunt an area, leading to territorial conflicts and internal wars. Losers are consumed by winners, ensuring survival, but clutchmates never fight each other for food. Only fallen members are eaten if necessary for the clutch's survival.

Overall, thri-kreen prefer fresh meat, followed by dried food, city food, sapient flesh, carrion, and lastly, other thri-kreen.

**Other Types of Hunt:** Thri-kreen primarily hunt to survive, but their strong hunting mindset (tikchak) influences other aspects of their lives. Combat is seen as part of the hunt, with fallen enemies considered "spoils of war." Thri-kreen warriors fight individually, without military drills or formations.

Trade is another aspect of the hunt. When trading, which is rare, thri-kreen are ritualistic traders. The buyer is the hunter, and the seller is the prey. Money is foreign to them, and they do not use it.

Thri-kreen also engage in philosophical, intellectual, and spiritual hunts for enlightenment or information. Popular name roots include *ka* ("seeker") and *tik* ("hunter"). Their language has many words for "hunt" and similar concepts like "search," "find," and "stalk."

In these hunts, thri-kreen are as relentless as in food hunts. Non-kreen might find it odd, but adventuring thri-kreen often quest for knowledge or enlightenment.

## Society

Thri-kreen lead simple lives focused mainly on hunting, guided by their racial memory. Their society incorporates several key concepts:

1. Tikchak (hunt-mind): Central to their daily life.
2. Tokchak (clutch-mind): Influences individual and societal behavior, ensuring mutual protection and establishing dominance orders.
3. Government: Described as "democratic tyranny."
  - Democratic: All clutchmates can voice opinions and participate in decisions.
  - Tyrannical: The clutchleader's word is law, though leaders are thoughtful and any member can challenge for leadership.
  - Anarchic: No formal laws, but biological instincts enforce certain behaviors.

**Dominance Challenge:** Within clutches and packs, thri-kreen determine dominance through frequent challenges:

- Formal Initiation: A challenge is formally issued with a simple declaration, like "I challenge you."
- Resolution: The challenged can step down, especially if injured or aging. If accepted, the fight

ensues, typically with natural weapons, though psionics or gythka may also be used.

- Agreements: Different contest types (e.g., psionics, sparring) can be chosen. Spell use is rare but acceptable if clerical.

- Outcome: Fights may end with blood drawing, surrender, or death, though shamans or druids often stand by to prevent fatalities.

**Pack Challenge:** A pack challenge arises from a disagreement between two thri-kreen packs, often settling territorial disputes or hunting rights through a contest of champions rather than open conflict. The pack being challenged can set their own terms of victory. These challenges:

- Formal Declaration: Initiated with a statement like, "On behalf of the Chtik-tek, I challenge the K'ro-kek for the right to travel through their lands unharmed."

- Terms: The challenged pack decides the number of champions and whether the fight is to the death. Only natural weapons may be used, even by non-kreen participants. Magic and psionics must be agreed upon beforehand, typically forbidden.

- Rewards: Winners receive the agreed-upon prize. They can also take one item from each living loser. If the fight is to the death, all possessions of the deceased may be claimed, except *dasl chatkchas*, which are spared to avoid ongoing feuds. Leftover possessions go to the loser's pack if not claimed.

**"War" Challenge:** Challenges between thri-kreen and non-kreen are rare and typically rejected unless a thri-kreen fights for the non-kreen side. These challenges:

- Strict Rules: No weapons allowed.
- Meat Animals: Thri-kreen do not challenge or accept challenges from non-kreen considered "meat" animals, as they are deemed unskilled in proper combat.

**Religion:** Most thri-kreen have little use for religion. They lack gods and religious holidays but show reverence for nature and the elements. Rumors exist about spelljamming thri-kreen who worship the Mantis God of the Eternal Lotus, but this deity is unknown on Karilan.

**Time:** Thri-kreen do not prioritize the passage of time and remain active even during the night. Timekeeping is typically left to shamans or other religious figures, who track it by the position of the sun and moons. Thri-kreen measure time primarily in days and years, without named months or specific units beyond days and years.

**The Chatkcha Ceremony:** To signify maturity, a thri-kreen undergoes the chatkcha ceremony. Typically, this occurs after the fourth birthday, or the sixth birthday for those pursuing professions like warrior, shaman, or chakati.

The ceremony only begins once a thri-kreen starts producing venom enzymes. Soon after, they create their first crystalline chatkcha using the fejik herb, which, when mixed with venom, transforms sand into a durable crystal (dasl). The skill for crafting chatkcha is innate and triggered by venom production.

Upon completing at least one chatkcha, the thri-kreen is ready for the ceremony, scheduled at the clutchleader's discretion and often conducted with multiple participants. The simple ceremony involves presenting the chatkcha to the clutchleaders, who assess its quality and craftsmanship, offering compliments for exceptional work.

Participants must successfully throw their chatkcha at a target and then make a throw that returns to them. They have one attempt per task; failures require retrying later. After passing these tests, the thri-kreen announces their name, which can be new or retained from childhood, reflecting their goals or profession. The final step involves using the chatkcha in a hunt or battle to draw blood, completing their transition to adulthood.

Exceptions allow an early ceremony, usually for warriors. Since young thri-kreen can't produce venom, they must procure a dasl chatkcha, often inherited or gifted by a mentor. The early petitioner undergoes the same ceremony as others.

**Gender Relations and Raising the Young:** Male and female thri-kreen have equal roles in society, sharing tasks like hunting, food preparation, and child care, with no distinction in skill.

Courtship can be initiated or rejected by either gender and starts with gift exchanges. Couples spend time hunting, crafting, and talking together before declaring themselves mated for life. They prefer privacy for mating, often venturing into the desert or creating a special burrow, which poses some danger due to the hostile environment.

When a female carries eggs, her activities are limited for about 15 days before laying. Eggs are usually buried in the sand and left to hatch, with thri-kreen often returning to the hatching site in time. Sometimes, eggs or young are transported on sledges until they can keep up with the adults.

The entire clutch cares for and educates the young, splitting duties evenly between genders. Parental interest in individual offspring is minimal, as clutch and pack structures substitute for familial relationships. Thri-kreen generally refer to each other as clutchmates or packmates rather than in familial terms like mother or daughter.

**Treatment of Enemies:** Thri-kreen treatment of enemies is the stuff of legends, mixing fact with fiction. They can be brutal and relentless, but typically fight for survival, not malice. Thri-kreen seek vengeance against those who

harm their pack, maintaining a lasting grudge and potentially declaring a "*gythtik*" or blood hunt, tracking their enemies with persistence and stealth.

A single thri-kreen might stalk its enemies for weeks, waiting for a moment to attack. Packs may carry grudges for years, passing down the details of conflicts to younger members to continue the hunt.

They also fight to protect their prey and water sources. Anyone hunting in thri-kreen territory or harming their water supply risks their enmity. Even the most ruthless thri-kreen would not poison water, as it goes against their "*tikchak*" or hunt mentality.

Thri-kreen hunters rarely take prisoners or show mercy to those who surrender. While they seldom eat their enemies, they do loot fallen attackers for food, water, weapons, and other valuable items, often preferring unique finds over common necessities.

**Travel and Camps:** Thri-kreen are nomadic, constantly hunting or moving to new grounds. They carry most of their gear by hand or in small packs, occasionally using sledges and travois. Their camps are minimal, often just a brief pause to rest. They may camp longer during bad weather, egg-laying, or when feasting on a large kill. Shelters are rare but they might dig small burrows if needed.

**Art and Sculpture:** Thri-kreen art includes body painting, sand painting, and carving. They create large stone reliefs of thri-kreen faces and animals, often leaving them behind after carving. Smaller carvings in bone, wood, and stone are carried and traded. Their carvings, while not highly detailed, are quite lifelike.

**Clothing and Decoration:** Thri-kreen are not materialistic, valuing items for utility or decoration. They wear harnesses to carry weapons and possessions, and sometimes clothing to protect from sand and grit. Brightly colored scarves, sashes, shirts, cloaks, and robes are common, especially for special occasions and among priests. They also adorn themselves with leg and arm wrappings, bands, bracelets, and rings. Skilled chitinworkers can create decorations on their chitin and shape new chitin over wounds.

**Recreation:** Though devoted to hunting and survival, thri-kreen enjoy recreational activities related to combat and hunting practice. Their games include tag, stalking, and tracking. Sports involve throwing (stones for the young, *gythka* and chatkcha for adults), racing, and *gythka* sparring. Thri-kreen also perform a dance called *tik-dul*, which mimics hunting movements, and is often seen as a blend of martial arts and spider-like actions by non-kreen. Percussive rhythms play a significant role in thri-kreen entertainment, especially at night, using sticks, rocks, and their own bodies. Occasionally, they combine *tik-dul* with rhythmic backing and a clicking

chant, creating an eerie effect. Thri-kreen do not engage in singing or poetry.

**Adventuring:** Thri-kreen are drawn to adventuring for its varied challenges and goals, such as seeking knowledge or hunting diverse species. In adventuring groups, thri-kreen are valuable allies once dominance is established. They defend companions fiercely and never abandon them unless absolutely necessary. The clutch is of paramount importance, influencing their behavior. Though they may appear docile to group members, they can become deadly against outsiders. In less formal groups, thri-kreen often become leaders due to their aggression, but they initially struggle with non-kreen cultures. Over time, a thri-kreen leader learns to recognize and utilize the skills of their clutchmates.

## Spoils

As a rule, thri-kreen rarely possess any conventionally valuable items. Collectors may pay a lot for a genuine gythka (especially one made of dasl) and chatkcha, or any other items made of dasl. Items made of dasl weigh half as much as normal stone or metal items, but act as steel items otherwise. Treat this as a +4 CF.

It is possible to extract a thri-kreen's venom. A successful Poisons roll that takes 10 minutes extracts one dose of poison plus one additional dose for every 2 points of margin of success, up to the maximum of 4 doses. Each dose costs \$40.

Butchering a thri-kreen provides 15% of its body weight in chitin +1% per point of success on the Professional Skill (Butcher) roll, up to the maximum of 22%. For a typical 460 lbs. thri-kreen, this is 69 lbs. + 4.6 lbs. per point of success. When designing thri-kreen chitin armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid #3-52*, use the following statistics: WM 1; Cost \$12.5, DR/inch 8, Max DR 4, Construction: scale, solid.

## Capturing and Training

Thri-kreen are valuable slave laborers, but they are never used as slave soldiers, as they are very likely to attack their masters.

**Egg Value:** \$600.

**Untrained Value:** \$3,000.

**Trained Value:** \$29,930.

**Supply Cost:** \$6 and 2.2 lbs./day.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Mantises).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.031

**Wage (Monthly):** \$900

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Thri-Kreen Warriors**

*Battle Rating:* 3.5

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Terrain (Desert).

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 32/128

*Supply (Weekly):* \$6,200.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$92,500.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$117,400.

## Racial Template

223 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+6 (Size Modifier, -10%) [54]; DX+1 [20]; IQ-1 [-20]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Basic Move +3 [15]; Will+1 [5]; Per+1 [5].

**Advantages:** Absolute Direction (ESP, -10%) [5]; Ambidexterity [5]; Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 2 [10]; Discriminatory Smell (Biological (Passive), -5%; Emotion Sense, Racial, +40%) [21]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Extra Arms 2 [20]; Extra Attack 1 [25]; Immunity to Kreen Poison [5]; Nictitating Membrane 1 [1]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Racial Memory (Passive) [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 (Water Only, -50%) [3]; Regeneration (Slow; Doesn't work for vitals and internal damage, -10%) [9]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Super Jump 1 [10]; Temperature Tolerance 2 (Hot) [2]; Terrain Adaptation (Sand) [5]; Vibration Sense (Air; Biological (Passive), -5%) [10].

*Venom* [11]: Affliction 1 (HT; Attribute Penalty, -3 to DX, +30%; Emergencies Only, -30%; Follow-Up, Sharp Teeth, +0%; Onset, 1 minute, -10%; Nuisance Effect, Disabled for a day after creating dasl, -20%; Secondary Paralysis, +30%) [10] + Create Dasl 0.16 (Cosmic, No die roll required, +100%; Reduced Fatigue Cost 1, +20%; Transmute Sand to Dasl, +50%; Transmutation Only, -100%; Trigger, Common Herb, -10%) [2/5=1].

**Disadvantages:** Code of Honor (Thri-Kreen) [-10]; Cold-Blooded (50°) [-5]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10]; Vulnerability (Drowning, x2; Fatigue Only, -50%) [-10].

**Perks:** Exotic Weapon Training (Chatkcha) [1]; Limited Camouflage (Sand) [1].

**Quirks:** Congenial [-1]; Dislikes urbanites [-1]; Doesn't understand money [-1]; Dull Touch 5 [-5]; Sees sleep as weakness [-1].

**Racial Psionic Abilities:** Photorefraction 1 [5].

**Racial Psionic Skills:** Photorefraction (H) IQ-2 [1].

**Racial Skills:** Armoury (Thri-Kreen) (E) IQ [1]; Thrown Weapon (Disc) (E) DX [1].

## Lizard, Monitor

Type: Animal (Reptile)



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |   |        |           |
|----|----|----|---|--------|-----------|
| ST | 7  | HP | 7 | SM     | -1        |
| DX | 12 | BS | 6 | thr/sw | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| HT | 11 | FP | 9 | BL     | 9.8 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-3/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Quadruped (p. B553).

**Weight:** 44 lbs.

**Length:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 3 ft. when horizontal and 4.5 ft. when upright.

**Organization:** Solitary. 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

The monitor lizard, a predator found typically in warmer regions, exhibits a robust build when fully grown, characterized by a stout form with broad neck and sturdy limbs. It possesses a lengthy tail with a pronounced keel that aids in swimming. The extensive range of the monitor lizard contributes to a diverse scope of subspecies.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

Typically, the monitor lizard moves on all four limbs, but it is able to awkwardly walk upright with Move 2. While upright, the monitor lizard can use both forearms to attack and parry. Its effective height for the purpose of combat modifiers becomes 4.5 ft.

The monitor lizard can **move and fight unimpeded on undergrowth and uneven surfaces**.

**Water:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour. The monitor lizard is an adept swimmer. Aside from being able to swim fast, the monitor lizard takes no skill penalties from being underwater and is able to hold its breath 16 times longer than normal.

**Climbing:** Equipped with claws suited for gripping onto softer, penetrable materials like bark, the monitor lizard climbs such surfaces at Move 1.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 9.8 | 19.6  | 29.4   | 58.8  | 98          |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** Scaly hide gives the monitor lizard DR 2\*.

**Dodge:** 10 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed; forearm; only when upright).

**Immunities:** sunburn.

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against damage caused by high or low body temperature; +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; Hard to Kill 2; Hard to Subdue 2.

**Notes:** A character can target a monitor lizard's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Lizards) roll.

The monitor lizard's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +1 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

### Combat

Male monitor lizards fight each other for territory and mates. Typically, they fight in the upright position, going for a torso grapple, then trying to knock the opponent down and pin him.

When fighting prey, the monitor lizards use their claws and serrated teeth. When trying to discourage another predator or other dangerous being from approach, they use their powerful tail.

**Bite (14):** thrust 1d-3 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the monitor lizard may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-2 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-4 control against larger ones.

In addition, the monitor lizard's saliva carries an anticoagulant poison. Anyone injured by the bite attack must roll against HT or gain Hemophilia (p. B138) for 30 minutes per point of margin of failure.

**Front Claw (14):** thrust 1d-3 cutting. Reach C.

**Rear Claw (12):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C.

**Tail (14):** thrust 1d-2 crushing. Reach C. Front hexes are attacked at -2. Cannot parry.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d-2 control. Reach C. Effective ST 9 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.49 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 4.9 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 5                    | 9         | 14                   | 18                 |

## Special Abilities

**Tail:** The monitor lizard's powerful tail not only allows it to swim fast and attack, but also enhances its sense of balance. While the tail is not crippled, the monitor lizard has +6 for walking a narrow surface in normal conditions, and +4 in bad conditions; +3 in combat to avoid falling/being knocked down; and +1 to Acrobatics, Climbing, and Piloting.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid #3-77*, pp. 4-5).

Holding Your Breath (p. B351).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 12  | 12     | 12      | 15          | 12    |

**Vision:** The monitor lizard possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

The monitor lizard's vision is adapted to work best in daylight, they have poor vision at night – they have **Night Blindness** (p. B144).

**Smell:** The monitor lizard has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 3  | 10   |

Monitor lizards are revered as some of the most intellectually adept members of the reptilian realm. These creatures demonstrate intricate behaviors such as forming bonds with mates, vigilantly guarding their nests, and displaying individual recognition and interaction capabilities. In captivity, monitor lizards have shown an impressive ability to learn swiftly, and some individuals can even be taught basic tricks.

However, despite their cognitive skills, monitor lizards are governed by certain innate reptilian constraints. They lack emotional intelligence and are unable to comprehend the feelings or intentions of others. It's impossible for them to anticipate the desires of their owners or understand the impact of their actions on others' feelings of discomfort or pain.

Additionally, while monitor lizards have a slightly better ability to identify objects and individuals visually compared to other reptiles, their primary sense for recognition is olfactory. This reliance on scent over sight can sometimes lead to unintended consequences for their human caretakers. For example, if a hungry monitor lizard detects the scent of food or senses food nearby, it may instinctively strike at any moving object within reach, including, occasionally, the hands of the person feeding it. This stark limitation is a lesson many owners have learned through unfortunate, firsthand experience.

**Mentality Traits:** Gluttony (12); Low Empathy; Wild Animal.

## Skills

Brawling-14; Climbing-14; Intimidation-10; Stealth-12; Survival (Island/Beach)-12; Tracking-15; Wrestling-14.

## Other Traits

Extra Legs (Four Legs); No Fine Manipulators.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Day.

**Diet:** Predominantly, the monitor lizard consumes aquatic life such as fish and crabs. Its diet, however, is not limited to these alone. Exhibiting typical predatory flexibility, monitor lizards consume virtually anything they can physically manage, including significant threats such as canines and small cervids. Their dietary range also extends to rodents and aquatic birds. While not posing a direct threat to humans, these lizards do scavenge, disturbing and consuming human remains when encountered. Post feeding, these creatures often indulge in extensive sunbathing sessions to digest their substantial meals.

**Habitat:** Monitor lizards thrive near various aquatic environments—from mountain rivulets to seaside locales. Adapted to both fresh and saltwater, these lizards are proficient swimmers, capable of traversing extensive distances, including sea passages to isolated islets. Despite their affinity for water, they also spend considerable time on terrestrial pursuits such as sunbathing, foraging, and resting in natural or self-made shelters. They adapt well to human proximity, often seen in urban waterways and agricultural settings such as rice fields where they hunt pests.

**Lair:** Adapted to burrowing, monitor lizards use their robust forelimbs and substantial claws to excavate, even through tough surfaces like termite mounds, which also serve as ideal incubators for their eggs due to the controlled climate maintained by the termites, who generally leave the eggs undisturbed.

When calculating digging rates (p. B350), treat the monitor lizard as if it is equipped with a shovel.

**Lifespan:** Monitor lizards can live for up to 22 years, with sexual maturity typically reached by the age of 2.

**Organization:** Typically solitary, monitor lizards display tolerance towards others of their kind of comparable size under non-threatening conditions. They are known to congregate, albeit aggressively, at food sources, establishing pecking orders that are aggressively maintained by dominant members. Mating seasons witness males engaging in displays of strength and dominance reminiscent of judo, grappling to impress potential mates.

**Reproduction:** Breeding occurs from late spring to early autumn. Females lay eggs, ranging from 10 to 40, about a month post-mating in decayed wood, where they incubate for 6 to 7 months. Upon hatching, the young are immediately self-sufficient.

**Temperature Regulation:** The monitor lizard is a cold-blooded creature. While it has +2 HT to resist damage from high or low body temperature, it tends to stiffen up in cold weather. After 30 minutes in cold conditions, the monitor lizard gets -1 to Basic Speed and DX per 10° below 65°F. The monitor lizard regains lost Basic Speed and DX at the rate of one point of each per hour once it returns to a warm climate. Double this rate in an exceptionally warm environment. At temperatures below 32°, the monitor lizard must roll vs. HT (11) or take 1 HP of damage.

## Spoils

The durable hide of these robust lizards is highly prized for crafting quality leather goods, making them targets for significant commercial harvesting. Despite the pressures of exploitation, the species' rapid reproductive rates and swift maturation allow them to persist and even flourish under challenging conditions. The meat and eggs of the monitor lizard are also considered consumable.

## Capturing and Training

In certain contexts, monitor lizards are cultivated not just for their skins but also as exotic companions or pets. These lizards have found their roles extending to magical realms, acting as animal companions for druids and as familiars for wizards. There are instances where troglodytes domesticate these creatures, employing them as protective sentinels for their subterranean abodes.

**Egg Value:** \$75.

**Untrained Value:** \$380.

**Trained Value:** \$3,830.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.32 and 0.37 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Training Skill:** Animal Handling (Reptiles).

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Flightless Lizards).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.004

**Wage (Monthly):** \$115

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Monitor Lizards

*Battle Rating:* 0.5

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Marine.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96 (land or water)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$300.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$13,800.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$15,000.

## Racial Template

-41 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-3 [-30]; DX+2 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [24]; IQ-7 [-140]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-1; Will+7 [35]; Per+9 [45]; FP-2 [-6]; Basic Speed +0.25 [5]; Climbing Move -2 [-4].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 3 [6]; Amphibious [10]; Breath-Holding 4 [8]; Clinging (Requires claw-holds, -30%) [14]; Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 2 (Flexible, -20%) [8]; Excellent Balance (Biological (Passive), -5%) [10]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Hard to Kill 2 [4]; Hard to Subdue 2 [4]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Striker (Tail; Crushing; Cannot Parry, -40%; Limited Arc, Side or rear, -20%; Long 1, +100%; Reversed Arc, +0%) [7]; Terrain Adaptation (Undergrowth) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Uneven) [5].

**Antocoagulant:** Affliction 1 (HT; Biological (Passive), -5%; Disadvantage, Hemophilia, +30%; Extended Duration, 30x, +60%; Follow-Up, Bite, +0%) [19].

**Disadvantages:** Cold-Blooded (65°) [-10]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Low Empathy [-20]; Night Blindness [-10]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Semi-Upright [-5]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Wild Animal [-30].

**Perks:** Burrower [1]; Scales [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 1; Early Maturation 1; Tail.

## Mephit



Mephits are minor elemental creatures, more curious than evil, with natures shaped by their elemental origins. They appear as small, winged beings with humanoid features, and their elemental roots are immediately recognizable.

### Ecology

**Diet:** Mephits do not need sustenance but can eat and drink if they wish.

**Lifecycle:** Mephits are ageless beings.

### Mentality

Mephits' dispositions vary by their plane of origin, but they are universally capricious tricksters, often vulgar and mischievous. They seek to please their masters and adapt their behavior accordingly, becoming malleable and impressionable. When serving evil-doers, they can become sadistic and malicious. Mephits give themselves grandiose names, like "Garbenafenthal, Sprite-slayer, Greatest of All Steam Mephits, Favorite of the Lower Planes."

### Society

Mephits of the same type are usually polite to each other, while different types settle disputes with games like tug-a-demihuman.

They spend their time delivering messages, transporting packages, retrieving individuals, delivering magical items, or spreading mayhem.

On some Lower Planes, spellcasters use live mephits as signals in vendettas. A fire mephit indicates displeasure; an ice mephit signifies a ban; a

radiant mephit offers a truce. Recipients may destroy, employ, or free the mephit. Mephits are never given to friends due to their troublesome nature.



## Mephit, Air

Type: Outsider (Air, Mephit)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 7  | <b>HP</b> | 7  | <b>SM</b>     | -1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 13 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | 10 | <b>BL</b>     | 9.8 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-3/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Angeloid (*GURPS Template Toolkit 2: Races*, p. 10) with no legs and feet.

**Weight:** 1 lb.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Organization:** Solitary (1), gang (2–4 mephits of mixed types), or mob (5–12 mephits of mixed types). 30% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A (gang), B (mob).

An air mephit has pale white skin. Like all mephits, air mephits are impish in appearance and have wispy wings, which sprout from their humanoid upper torsos. They have whirlwinds where one would expect their legs to be.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Air:** Move 12; exploration 6 miles per hour. In order to take off or land, the air mephit must have an open area with a radius of 8 feet in all directions.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 9.8 | 19.6  | 29.4   | 58.8  | 98          |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 9 (10 with Blurred Breeze).

**Parry:** 9 (unarmed).

**Vulnerabilities:** The air mephit takes x2 injury from vacuum and wind-based attacks.

### Combat

Air mephits would rather flee than fight, but, if pressed, would attack by clawing and using their breath weapon.

**Sharp Claws (13):** thrust 1d-4 cutting. Reach C.

**Wing Buffet (9):** thrust 1d-3 crushing. Reach C. When in flight, the mephit must roll DX after attempting a Wing Buffet attack, whether it succeeds or fails. If the DX roll fails, the mephit loses control of its flight. It will continue moving in the same direction and speed it was moving on the last turn before it lost control, until it can make an Aerobatics+2 roll to regain control.

**Grapple (13):** thrust 1d-3 control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.49 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 4.9 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 4                    | 7         | 11                   | 14                 |

### Special Abilities

**Blurred Breeze:** When the air mephit flies at Move 6 or faster, its form becomes blurred. Attempts to spot the mephit with normal vision and Infravision are at -4, as are attacks that rely on these senses. In addition, the mephit gains a +1 bonus to Dodge. This is a magical ability.

**Breath Weapon (13):** An air mephit may spend 1 FP to spew forth a blast of air and abrasive grit. This blast does 1d crushing damage, doubled, for the purposes of knockback only, plus 1 point of linked corrosion damage, and has a 1/2D range of 5 yards. It can also snuff out candles, sweep the floor, and so on. Against enemies with Injury Tolerance (Diffuse), such as gaseous beings and swarms, this becomes a much more potent attack, doing full crushing damage – including the doubling! Ignore the usual injury cap of 2 HP (*Injury to Unliving, Homogenous, and Diffuse Targets*, p. B380).

This is a 1-yard-wide cone attack that uses the rules for *Cone Attacks* (p. B413). On the battle map, it is a 1x10 row of hexes. This cone is too tight to affect many targets, but gets better chances to hit. The mephit targets a hex right in front of him, at +4, and the cone extends out from there. It is possible to make the cone wider by using the All-Out Attack (Cone) maneuver (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).

Even though a one-hex creature is big enough to block the cone, everyone in the hex where the cone stops is fully affected. If a cone passes between two adjacent creatures, then both are hit. The cone cannot be parried or blocked, but it can be dodged by diving for cover or retreating out of the affected area. If a creature does that, then those behind it may get affected by the cone normally.

**Lightweight:** Air mephits have -2 to ST when they resist knockback.

**Regeneration:** The air mephit recovers 1 HP per minute as long as there is moving air present.

## Useful Combat Rules

Area and Spreading Attacks (p. B413).

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid #3-77*, pp. 4-5).

Cones of Power (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 9    |

Air mephits tend to be more skittish and cowardly than other mephits. Like all other mephits, air mephits exhibit a tendency for vulgar and annoying behavior that imposes a -2 on reaction rolls.

**Mentality Traits:** Cowardice (12); Curious (12); Odious Racial Habit (Vulgar and annoying behavior).

## Skills

Aerobatics-15; Brawling-13; Innate Attack (Breath)-13.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Habitat:** Air mephits live predominantly on the Elemental Plane of Air. When on the Material plane, they prefer living in places where the wind is constantly blowing, such as mountaintops or shores. The temperature comfort zone of an air mephit falls between -15° and 90°. An air mephit can breathe in a thin atmosphere without penalty, and treats very thin atmosphere as thin atmosphere; see *Atmospheric Pressure* (p. B429).

**Organization:** Solitary (1), gang (2–4) mephits of mixed types), or mob (5–12) mephits of mixed types).

## Spoils

When slain outside the Elemental Plane of Air, the body of the mephit dissipates, leaving no “natural” spoils.

## Capturing and Training

The values here are given for summoners and other beings who may control air mephits.

**Young Value:** \$260.

**Untrained Value:** \$1,290.

**Trained Value:** \$12,900.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.013

**Wage (Monthly):** \$385

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Air Mephits**

*Battle Rating:* 1.5

*Classes:* Air.

*Features:* None.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 48/192 (air)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$46,450.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$46,450.

## Racial Template

122 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-3 [-30]; DX+3 [60]; IQ-1 [-20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-1; Per+1 [5]; Basic Speed +0.25 [5].

**Advantages:** Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Flight (Winged, -25%) [30]; Regeneration (Fast; Accessibility, Only in moving air, -10%) [45]; Sharp Claws [5]; Temperature Tolerance 5 (Cold) [5]; Unaging [15].

**Breath Weapon** [13]: Corrosion Attack 1 point (Cone 1, +60%; Increased 1/2D, 5x, +10%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%) [5] + Crushing Attack 1d (Cone 1, +60%; Cosmic, Does knockback-based damage against diffuse targets, +50%; Costs Fatigue, 1 FP, -5%; Double Knockback, +20%; Increased 1/2D, 5x, +10%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; No Blunt Trauma, -20%; No Wounding, Except against diffuse targets, -25%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%) [8].

**Blurred Breeze** [28]: Enhanced Dodge 1 (Accessibility, Only when moving at half Move or faster, -20%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%) [12] + Obscure 4 (Vision; Accessibility, Only when moving at half Move or faster, -20%; Defensive, +50%; Extended, Infravision, +20%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; No Area Effect, -50%; Stealthy, +100%) [16].

**Disadvantages:** Cowardice (12) [-10]; Curious (12) [-5]; Odious Racial Habit (Vulgar and annoying

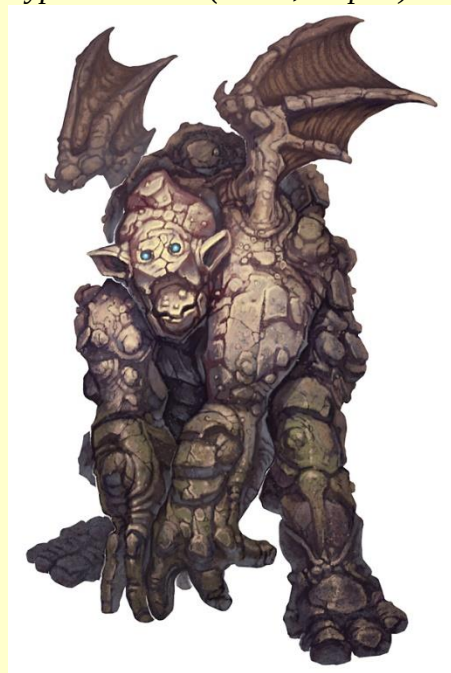
behavior) [-10]; Skinny [-5]; Vulnerability (Vacuum and wind-based attacks, x2) [-20].

**Perks:** Pressure-Tolerant Lungs (Thin) [1].

**Features:** No Legs (Aerial).

## Mephit, Earth

Type: Outsider (Earth, Mephit)



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |           |
|----|----|----|------|--------|-----------|
| ST | 9  | HP | 9    | SM     | -1        |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5.25 | thr/sw | 1d-2/1d-1 |
| HT | 11 | FP | 11   | BL     | 16 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Angeloid (*GURPS Template Toolkit* 2: *Races*, p. 10).

**Weight:** 80 lbs.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Organization:** Solitary (1), gang (2–4 mephits of mixed types), or mob (5–12 mephits of mixed types). 30% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A (gang), B (mob).

An earth mephit is an impish winged humanoid with tough skin resembling stone. Their bodies have dwarflike proportions but are hairless and have large misshapen wings.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

**Air:** Move 10; exploration 5 miles per hour. Cannot hover – must move at least at Move 2 when flying. In order to take off or land, the earth mephit must have an open area with a radius of 8 feet in all directions.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 16 | 32    | 48     | 96    | 160         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2.

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 9 (unarmed).

**Vulnerabilities:** The earth mephit takes x2 injury from sonic attacks.

### Combat

Earth mephits would rather flee than fight, but, if pressed, would attack by clawing and using their breath weapon.

**Sharp Claws (12):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C.

**Wing Buffet (8):** thrust 1d-1 crushing. Reach C. When in flight, the mephit must roll DX after attempting a Wing Buffet attack, whether it succeeds or fails. If the DX roll fails, the mephit loses control of its flight. It will continue moving in the same direction and speed it was moving on the last turn before it lost control, until it can make an Aerobatics+2 roll to regain control.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-2 control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.8 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 8 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 5                    | 9         | 14                   | 18                 |

### Special Abilities

**Breath Weapon (12):** An earth mephit may spend 1 FP to spew forth a blast of rock shards and pebbles. This blast does 1d crushing damage and has a 1/2D range of 5 yards.

This is a 1-yard-wide cone attack that uses the rules for *Cone Attacks* (p. B413). On the battle map, it is a 1x10 row of hexes. This cone is too tight to affect many targets, but gets better chances to hit. The mephit targets a hex right in front of him, at +4, and the cone extends out from there. It is possible to make the cone wider by using the All-Out Attack (Cone) maneuver (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).

Even though a one-hex creature is big enough to block the cone, everyone in the hex where the cone stops is fully affected. If a cone passes between two adjacent creatures, then both are hit. The cone cannot be parried or blocked, but it can be dodged by diving for cover or retreating out of the affected area. If a creature does that, then those behind it may get affected by the cone normally.

**Camouflage:** The stony skin of the earth mephit lets it blend it with the surrounding rock and stone. This gives the snake +2 to Camouflage and Stealth when posed still and unclad against rock. This bonus only works against normal vision, not Infravision.

**Regeneration:** The earth mephit recovers 1 HP per minute as long as it is underground or buried up to its waist in earth.

**Spell-Like Ability:** The earth mephitis possesses an innate ability that mimics a wizardly spell – [Transmute Rock to Mud 8](#). Unlike the actual spell, this ability does not have verbal and somatic components, and the casting roll is made against IQ (9) instead of skill. This ability transforms up to 640 pounds of rock into mud. On average, a hex of rock weighs 112 pounds per inch of thickness, so this ability may affect one hex that is 5.7 inches deep or six continuous hexes nearly one inch deep to create a slippery surface.

### Useful Combat Rules

Area and Spreading Attacks (p. B413).

Bad Terrain/Footing ([link](#)).

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid #3-77*, pp. 4-5).

Cones of Power (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the earth mephitis can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 9    |

Earth mephitis tend to be less cruel than many of the other mephitis types. They are curious about mortals, perhaps because they rarely see any in the remote places they call home. Like all other mephitis, earth mephitis exhibit a tendency for vulgar and annoying behavior that imposes a -2 on reaction rolls.

**Mentality Traits:** Curious (12); Odious Racial Habit (Vulgar and annoying behavior).

### Skills

Aerobatics-12; Brawling-12; Innate Attack (Breath)-12.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Habitat:** Earth mephitis live predominantly on the Elemental Plane of Earth. When on the Material plane, they prefer living deep underground. The temperature comfort zone of an earth mephitis falls between 35° and 90°.

**Organization:** Solitary (1), gang (2–4) mephitis of mixed types), or mob (5–12) mephitis of mixed types).

### Spoils

When slain outside the Elemental Plane of Earth, the body of the mephitis dissipates, leaving no “natural” spoils.

### Capturing and Training

The values here are given for summoners and other beings who may control earth mephitis.

**Young Value:** \$485.

**Untrained Value:** \$2,435.

**Trained Value:** \$24,350.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.025

**Wage (Monthly):** \$730

### Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Earth Mephitis**

**Battle Rating:** 3

**Classes:** Air.

**Features:** None.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 40/160 (air) or 8/32 (land)

**Supply (Weekly):** \$0.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$87,720.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$87,720.

### Racial Template

110 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-1 [-10]; IQ-1 [-20]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-1; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move -1 [-5].

**Advantages:** DR 2 [10]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Flight (Cannot Hover, -15%; Winged, -25%) [24]; Infravision [10]; Regeneration (Fast; Accessibility, Accessibility, Only underground or buried up to its waist in earth, -30%) [35]; Sharp Claws [5]; Unaging [15].

**Breath Weapon:** Crushing Attack 1d (Cone 1, +60%; Costs Fatigue, 1 FP, -5%; Increased 1/2D, 5x, +10%; Magical, -10%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%) [7].

**Spell-Like Ability:** [Transmute Rock to Mud 8](#) [48].

**Disadvantages:** Curious (12) [-5]; Odious Racial Habit (Vulgar and annoying behavior) [-10]; Vulnerability (Sound, x2) [-20].

**Perks:** Limited Camouflage (Stone) [1].

## Mephit, Fire

Type: Outsider (Fire, Mephit)



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |           |
|----|----|----|------|--------|-----------|
| ST | 7  | HP | 7    | SM     | -1        |
| DX | 11 | BS | 5.25 | thr/sw | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| HT | 10 | FP | 10   | BL     | 9.8 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Angeloid (*GURPS Template Toolkit 2: Races*, p. 10).

**Weight:** 1 lb.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Organization:** Solitary (1), gang (2–4 mephits of mixed types), or mob (5–12 mephits of mixed types). 30% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A (gang), B (mob).

Fire mephits have red, black-streaked bodies, bat-like wings wreathed in flames, and often sport fake facial hair like mustaches or goatees. Unlike other mephits, they have tails.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

**Air:** Move 10; exploration 5 miles per hour. Cannot hover – must move at least at Move 2 when flying. In order to take off or land, the fire mephit must have an open area with a radius of 8 feet in all directions.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 9.8 | 19.6  | 29.4   | 58.8  | 98          |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 9 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** noxious fire effects.

**Fire Resistance:** Fire mephits have DR 20 against fire. This includes internal and eye damage.

**Vulnerabilities:** The fire mephit takes x2 injury from cold attacks.

**Weaknesses:** Water (1d per minute).

### Combat

Fire mephits would rather flee than fight, but, if pressed, would attack by clawing and using their breath weapon.

**Sharp Claws (13):** thrust 1d-3 cutting. Reach C.

**Wing Buffet (9):** thrust 1d-2 crushing. Reach C. When in flight, the mephit must roll DX after attempting a Wing Buffet attack, whether it succeeds or fails. If the DX roll fails, the mephit loses control of its flight. It will continue moving in the same direction and speed it was moving on the last turn before it lost control, until it can make an Aerobatics+2 roll to regain control.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-3 control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.49 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 4.9 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 4                    | 7         | 11                   | 14                 |

### Special Abilities

**Breath Weapon (12):** A fire mephit may spend 1 FP to spew forth a blast of fire. This blast does 1d burning damage and has a 1/2D range of 5 yards.

This is a 1-yard-wide cone attack that uses the rules for *Cone Attacks* (p. B413). On the battle map, it is a 1x10 row of hexes. This cone is too tight to affect many targets, but gets better chances to hit. The mephit targets a hex right in front of him, at +4, and the cone extends out from there. It is possible to make the cone wider by using the All-Out Attack (Cone) maneuver (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).

Even though a one-hex creature is big enough to block the cone, everyone in the hex where the cone stops is fully affected. If a cone passes between two adjacent creatures, then both are hit. The cone cannot be parried or blocked, but it can be dodged by diving for cover or retreating out of the affected area. If a creature does that, then those behind it may get affected by the cone normally.

**Fire Aura:** The fire mephit is constantly surrounded by an aura of magical fire, unless it is underwater or in a vacuum. The aura sheds light like a torch and deals 1d-2 burning damage each second to everything that the fire mephit touches.

**Lightweight:** Fire mephits have -2 to ST when they resist knockback.

**Regeneration:** The fire mephitis recovers 1 HP per minute as long as it is touching a fire at least as large as a torch.

**Spell-Like Ability:** The fire mephitis possesses an innate ability that mimics a wizardly spell – [Warm 1 \(40°F\)](#). Unlike the actual spell, this ability does not have verbal and somatic components, and the casting roll is not required.

### Useful Combat Rules

Area and Spreading Attacks (p. B413).  
 Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).  
 Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).  
 - Height Effects (*Pyramid #3-77*, pp. 4-5).  
 Cones of Power (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).  
 Flying Combat (p. B398).  
 Making Things Burn (p. B433).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 9    |

Proud of their fiery heritage, they see themselves as superior to non-fire creatures, indulging in torment and mischievous pranks. Like all other mephitis, fire mephitis exhibit a tendency for vulgar and annoying behavior that imposes a -2 on reaction rolls.

**Mentality Traits:** Curious (12); Intolerance (Non-fire creatures); Odious Racial Habit (Vulgar and annoying behavior); Selfish (12).

### Skills

Aerobatics-13; Brawling-13; Innate Attack (Breath)-12; Innate Attack (Gaze)-11.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Habitat:** Fire mephitis live predominantly on the Elemental Plane of Fire. When on the Material plane, they prefer volcanic regions. The temperature comfort zone of a fire mephitis falls between 35° and 140°.

**Organization:** Solitary (1), gang (2–4) mephitis of mixed types), or mob (5–12) mephitis of mixed types).

### Spoils

When slain outside the Elemental Plane of Fire, the body of the mephitis dissipates, leaving no “natural” spoils.

### Capturing and Training

The values here are given for summoners and other beings who may control fire mephitis.

**Young Value:** \$270.

**Untrained Value:** \$1,340.

**Trained Value:** \$13,400.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.014

**Wage (Monthly):** \$400

### Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Fire Mephitis**

*Battle Rating:* 1.5

*Classes:* Air.

*Features:* None.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 40/160 (air) or 8/32 (land)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$48,240.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$48,240.

### Racial Template

42 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-3 [-30]; DX+1 [20]; IQ-1 [-20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-1; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move -1 [-5].

**Advantages:** Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Flight (Cannot Hover, -15%; Winged, -25%) [24]; Regeneration (Fast; Accessibility, Only if it is touching a flame at least as large as a torch, -40%) [30]; Sharp Claws [5]; Temperature Tolerance 5 (Hot) [5]; Unaging [15].

**Breath Weapon:** Burning Attack 1d (Cone 1, +60%; Costs Fatigue, 1 FP, -5%; Increased 1/2D, 5x, +10%; Magical, -10%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%) [7].

**Fire Aura** [4]: Burning Attack 1d-2 (Always On, -20%; Aura, +80%; Environmental, Air, -5%; Magical, -10%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4] + Illumination (Magical, -10%; Only when fire aura is active, -10%) [1].

**Fire Resistance** [60]: DR 20 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Fire, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [50] + Immunity to Noxious Fire Effects [10].

**Spell-Like Ability:** [Warm 1 \(40°F\)](#) [17].

**Disadvantages:** Curious (12) [-5]; Intolerance (Non-fire creatures) [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Vulgar and annoying behavior) [-10]; Selfish (12) [-5]; Skinny [-5]; Vulnerability (Cold, x2) [-30]; Weakness (Water; 1d per minute) [-40].

## Mephit, Water

Type: Outsider (Mephit, Water)



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |           |
|----|----|----|----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 7  | HP | 7  | SM     | -1        |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5  | thr/sw | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| HT | 10 | FP | 10 | BL     | 9.8 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Angeloid (*GURPS Template Toolkit* 2: *Races*, p. 10).

**Weight:** 30 lbs.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Organization:** Solitary (1), gang (2–4 mephits of mixed types), or mob (5–12 mephits of mixed types). 30% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A (gang), B (mob).

Water mephits have semi-liquid, light-blue, scaled bodies, bulbous eyes, and fin-like wings. They travel with ease by running, flying, or swimming and exude a briny scent, dripping salt water.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

**Air:** Move 10; exploration 5 miles per hour. Cannot hover – must move at least at Move 2 when flying. In order to take off or land, the water mephit must have an open area with a radius of 8 feet in all directions.

**Water:** Move 4/8; exploration 4 miles per hour.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 9.8 | 19.6  | 29.4   | 58.8  | 98          |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 9 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** pressure, sunburn.

**Elemental Resistance:** Water mephits have DR 5 against fire and acid. This includes eye damage.

**Vulnerabilities:** The water mephit takes x2 injury from cold and dehydrating attacks.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (Homogenous, No Blood).

### Combat

Water mephits would rather flee than fight, but, if pressed, would attack by punching and using their breath weapon.

**Punch (12):** thrust 1d-3 crushing. Reach C.

**Wing Buffet (8):** thrust 1d-2 crushing. Reach C. When in flight, the mephit must roll DX after attempting a Wing Buffet attack, whether it succeeds or fails. If the DX roll fails, the mephit loses control of its flight. It will continue moving in the same direction and speed it was moving on the last turn before it lost control, until it can make an Aerobatics+2 roll to regain control.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 1d-3 control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.49 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 4.9 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 4                    | 7         | 11                   | 14                 |

### Special Abilities

**Aquatic:** Water mephits are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. They can breathe water and air with equal ease. Water mephits are able to speak underwater.

**Breath Weapon (12):** A water mephit may spend 1 FP to spew forth a blast of water. This blast does 2d crushing damage, doubled, for the purposes of knockback only, and has a 1/2D range of 5 yards. It deals no injury, but deals knockback and blunt trauma. It can also snuff out flames. Against enemies with Injury Tolerance (Diffuse), such as gaseous beings and swarms, this becomes a much more potent attack, doing full crushing damage – including the doubling! Ignore the usual injury cap of 2 HP (*Injury to Unliving, Homogenous, and Diffuse Targets*, p. B380).

This is a 1-yard-wide cone attack that uses the rules for *Cone Attacks* (p. B413). On the battle map, it is a 1x10 row of hexes. This cone is too tight to affect many targets, but gets better chances to hit. The mephit targets a hex right in front of him, at +4, and the cone extends out from there. It is possible to make

the cone wider by using the All-Out Attack (Cone) maneuver (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).

Even though a one-hex creature is big enough to block the cone, everyone in the hex where the cone stops is fully affected. If a cone passes between two adjacent creatures, then both are hit. The cone cannot be parried or blocked, but it can be dodged by diving for cover or retreating out of the affected area. If a creature does that, then those behind it may get affected by the cone normally.

**Double-Jointed:** Notably flexible, water mephits get +5 on Climbing, Erotic Art, and Escape rolls, and can ignore up to -5 penalties for working in close quarters.

**Lightweight:** Water mephits have -2 to ST when they resist knockback.

**Regeneration:** The water mephit recovers 1 HP per minute as long as it is submerged in water.

### Useful Combat Rules

Area and Spreading Attacks (p. B413).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid #3-77*, pp. 4-5).

Cones of Power (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid #3-26*, pp. 7-8).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 9    |

Cheerful to the point of annoyance, they enjoy splashing others and creating currents, though it often lands them in trouble. Like all other mephits, fire mephits exhibit a tendency for vulgar and annoying behavior that imposes a -2 on reaction rolls.

**Mentality Traits:** Curious (12); Odious Racial Habit (Vulgar and annoying behavior); Playful.

### Skills

Aerobatics-12; Aquabatics-12; Brawling-12; Innate Attack (Breath)-12.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Unlike most mephits, they must drink liquids to survive, absorbing anything from water to poisons or acids.

**Habitat:** Water mephits live predominantly on the Elemental Plane of Water. When on the Material plane, they prefer to live underwater. The temperature comfort zone of a water mephit falls between 35° and 90°. Water mephits are immune to pressure.

**Organization:** Solitary (1), gang (2–4) mephits of mixed types), or mob (5–12) mephits of mixed types).

### Spoils

When slain outside the Elemental Plane of Water, the body of the mephit dissipates, leaving no “natural” spoils.

### Capturing and Training

The values here are given for summoners and other beings who may control water mephits. Water mephits sometimes join adventuring parties uninvited or are used by humanoids to maintain aquariums or extinguish fires in kitchens.

**Young Value:** \$270.

**Untrained Value:** \$1,340.

**Trained Value:** \$13,400.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.014

**Wage (Monthly):** \$400

### Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Water Mephits**

**Battle Rating:** 1.5

**Classes:** Air, Naval.

**Features:** None.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 40/160 (air) or 8/32 (land) or 32/128 (water)

**Supply (Weekly):** \$0.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$48,240.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$48,240.

### Racial Template

**105 points**

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-3 [-30]; IQ-1 [-20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-1; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move -1 [-5].

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; Doesn't Breathe (Gills, -50%) [10]; Doesn't Eat or Drink (Food Only, -50%) [5]; Double-Jointed [15]; Enhanced Move 1 (Water) [20]; Flight (Cannot Hover, -15%; Winged, -25%) [24]; Injury Tolerance (Homogenous, No Blood) [45]; Pressure Support 3 [15]; Regeneration (Fast; Accessibility, Only when submerged in water, -30%) [35]; Speak Underwater [5]; Unaging [15]; Universal Digestion (Liquids Only, -60%) [2].

**Breath Weapon:** Crushing Attack 2d (Cone 1, +60%; Cosmic, Does knockback-based damage against diffuse targets, +50%; Costs Fatigue, 1 FP, -

5%; Double Knockback, +20%; Increased 1/2D, 5x, +10%; Magical, -10%; No Blunt Trauma, -20%; No Wounding, Except against diffuse targets, -25%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%) [15].

*Elemental Resistance (A,F):* DR 5 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Limited, Acid, Fire, -35%; Tough Skin, -40%) [9].

**Disadvantages:** Curious (12) [-5]; Odious Racial Habit (Vulgar and annoying behavior) [-10]; Skinny [-5]; Vulnerability (Cold, x2) [-30]; Vulnerability (Dehydration, x2) [-20].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Quirks:** Playful [-1].

# Mind Flayer

Type: Aberration (Mind Flayer)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |           |
|----|----|----|------|--------|-----------|
| ST | 11 | HP | 11   | SM     | +0        |
| DX | 11 | BS | 5.75 | thr/sw | 1d-1/1d+1 |
| HT | 12 | FP | 12   | BL     | 24 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-1/1d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lbs.

**Length:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-5 and 6-10 grimlocks. 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A (individual), C.

Few monsters inspire as much horror as the illithids, feared by all for their undiluted evil, cruelty, and cunning. Their mysterious origins, enigmatic plans, and alien culture make them terrifying. Better known as mind flayers, they attack the mind, peeling back a target's personality and tearing the brain from conscious, screaming prey.

Sages have long been baffled by their origins, motives, and love for cruelty. Illithids are humanoid, with pale mauve, slime-covered flesh, and heads

resembling four-limbed octopuses. They crave living brains and are psionically gifted, with some also being wizards or, rarely, sorcerers.

Mind flayers have three long fingers and an opposable thumb on each hand, and two webbed toes on each foot, with soft nails that pose little danger. They dwell underground, sometimes in surface ruins, but are most dangerous in their subterranean realm filled with fearsome races and monsters.

A lone mind flayer is a formidable match for a group of surface warriors, but they rarely hunt alone, often accompanied by enslaved monsters or other illithids. Explorers of the deep underground agree: better almost any other death than falling into the clutches of the mind flayers.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 24 | 48    | 72     | 144   | 240         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Tentacles (-3):** Each of the four face tentacles can be attacked. Treat it as an arm for the purpose of injury multipliers.

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8 (unarmed).

**Resistances:** +3 against psionics.

## Combat

Mind flayers like to fight from a distance, using Mental Blow. If pressed into melee combat, a mind flayer tries to grapple the head with its tentacles and use Dissolving Enzyme.

**Sharp Teeth (11):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the mind flayer may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-1 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-3 control against larger ones.

**Tentacle (11):** The mind flayer has four short tentacles that encircle its mouth. These are treated as four short arms with Reach C and effective ST of 5. The mind flayer can use tentacles to attack for 1d-5 crushing damage, but usually uses the tentacles for grappling and manipulating objects. The tentacles are considered to be "off-hands" for the purpose of penalties, but not for the purpose of determining the arc of attack.

**Tentacle Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-4 control. Reach C.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-2 crushing. Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.2 lbs.

**Effective Tentacle Attack Weight:** 0.25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 12 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 6                    | 11        | 17                   | 22                 |

## Special Abilities

**Dissolving Enzyme (7):** The mouth tentacles have ducts that can transmit a powerful dissolving enzyme. This takes time – the mind flayer must first perform a Ready maneuver, and only then follow-up with a Reach C melee attack with one or more of its tentacles. No attack roll is required if the tentacles are grappling the victim. If it succeeds, it deals 2d corrosion damage. If it only has three tentacles in contact with the victim, then decrease it by 25%; if it only has two tentacles in contact with the victim, then decrease it by 50%; if it only has one tentacle in contact with the victim, then decrease it by 75%. Usually, the mind flayer uses this attack when grappling the head with all four tentacles to corrode its way through the skull and extract the brain. Each use costs 2 FP.

**Psionics:** Mind flayers possess an array of innate telepathic abilities. Like all telepathic abilities, these can only affect sapient beings. A mind flayer has innate access to the following abilities:

*Mental Blow 4 (14)* – p. PP65;

*Mental Surgery 1 (13)* – p. PP61;

*Suggestion 3 (13)* – p. PP63;

*Telereceive 1 (13)* – p. PP58;

*Telespeak 3 (14)* – p. PP60.

Many mind flayers acquire other psionic abilities or improve the innate ones further.

**Slipperiness:** The mind flayer has +3 on all ST, DX, and Escape rolls to slip restraints, break free in close combat, or squeeze through narrow openings. If using FDG, this gives Control DR 3 and +3 to DX when attacking to break free of an existing grapple.

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 7       | 10/-        | 11    |

Although their white, pupilless eyes suggest blindness, mind flayers see quite well. Aside from normal vision, the mind flayer can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infra-vision** (p. B60).

The eyes of the mind flayer are adapted to darkness; its **native illumination level is -7**. This lets it see and fight at no penalty at moonless night, but it suffers a -7 penalty during the day.

Mind flayers have no sense of smell and are **Hard of Hearing** (p. B138).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 13 | 14   |

Mind flayers possess alien thought processes and enigmatic objectives, viewing themselves as master manipulators. Driven by immense ambition and self-importance, they seek to dominate the world and reshape reality according to their designs. Though often seen as monsters, they believe themselves to be agents of "Order", taming a chaotic universe and improving it by enslaving other races.

Mind flayers believe in their inherent superiority and view themselves as destined rulers. They consider other creatures as thralls, meant to serve, be consumed, or act as vessels for more of their kind. Despite their arrogance, they feel a sense of gratitude towards those they consume, believing they bestow gifts upon their "livestock".

Illithids need to dominate to achieve their goals and fulfill basic personal needs. They form intimate bonds with their thralls, suffering when they die and sometimes going mad from loneliness. Each illithid maintains at least one personal thrall, treating favored ones with special care and granting them tokens when not working.

While almost every illithid seeks racial dominion, each is an intelligent, individual entity with unique strategies—some use military might, while others employ psionics or magic items. Their actions, often seeming bizarre, are ultimately aimed at achieving supremacy.

Despite valuing order, mind flayers are competitive and individualistic, enhancing the group through personal success. They recognize that communal intelligence grows as each member gains wisdom and experience. If an individual fails, they prioritize the collective good.

Mind flayers' natural competitiveness and intelligence foster innovation. Whether through psionics, alchemy, magic, or technology, they are creative and cunning problem-solvers. They base their existence on shared knowledge, continuously seeking to expand their understanding by cross-checking and verifying information. Mind flayers get a **+1 bonus on any task that requires creativity**.

In their quest for knowledge, illithids bargain, interrogate, spy, steal, and plunder, gathering information from various sources. They collect arcane secrets, forgotten lore, recent news, supernatural discoveries, and items of power, valuing knowledge differently: some see no worth in lesser beings' information, while others find all data valuable.

Illithids view the present as all that matters, with the past maintained by the elder brain. They keep no historical records, thus showing indifference toward

the past. Their concept of the future is an inevitable extension of the present but not fixed; they understand that their race could die out, so they avoid complacency. Only by acquiring more knowledge can they predict and shape the future, fulfilling their destiny.

To non-illithids, mind flayers appear calm and emotionless, dominated by a desire to control others. Any display of fury often seems calculated. Although theories suggest they lack emotions or possess extreme self-control, illithids actually experience a full emotional range, often intensely. However, these feelings remain internalized, hidden during moments of inner turmoil.

While mind flayers indeed feel emotions, they are predominantly negative. They experience anger and hate when thwarted in their quest for dominance, fear in the presence of uncontrollable minds, shame for failures in mind control, envy over knowledge they do not possess, abhorrence of wasteful thrall use, disgust towards those who interact with lesser beings as equals, and sadness at the loss of compatriots. Frustration is their most common emotion, derived from dissatisfaction with their unfulfilled goals. Thus, illithids have **-3 on all Carousing, Connoisseur, Erotic Art, and Gambling** rolls.

True happiness is foreign to illithids. The closest they come is the sadistic delight of consuming a brain; their highest emotional state is self-satisfaction, driven by pride or curiosity. They seek luxury and mastery over their psionic abilities. Love or deep friendships are rare, as they have supernatural ways to fill emotional voids.

Illithids are cold, calculating, and cruel, known for inflicting pain for amusement and forcing captives into gladiatorial games. Treating others as equals is usually a facade for manipulation. Respectful behavior is strategic, with underlying betrayal plans.

A significant barrier to mind flayer world domination is their self-serving nature. Few see causes or companions worth dying for, prioritizing self-preservation. Minor setbacks often lead to retreat. Despite inherent tendencies for evil, it is possible—though rare—for an illithid to move toward neutrality or even goodness.

Some illithids may question their nature, potentially altering their moral compass.

**Mentality Traits:** Callous; Intolerance (Non-illithids); Killjoy; Megalomania; Selfish (12).

## Skills

Brainwashing/TL3-14; Expert Skill (Psionics)-14; Interrogation-14; Intimidation-14; Research/TL3-14; Thaumatology-14.

**Psionic Skills:** Mental Blow-15; Mental Surgery-12; Suggestion-14; Telereceive-14; Telesend-14.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Development and Aging:** After a week of ceremorphosis (see Reproduction below), the victim's tissues are entirely replaced with mind flayer tissue. The creature, now hermaphroditic and warm-blooded, has a life expectancy of up to 135 years. Though it appears fully grown, it is an infant in terms of sentience and requires about twenty years to mature fully. Immature illithids rarely venture outside of their well-protected subterranean cities.

**Habitat:** Mind flayers dwell underground, thriving in temperatures between 35° and 90°F. Despite discounting by scholars, some rumors suggest that not all mind flayers live below the surface. Tales speak of nautilus-shaped ships capable of space travel. Although often dismissed as fantasy, illithids know these tales are true. These ships are remnants of a future empire spanning the universe. The knowledge to build these vessels is currently lost, but the remaining ships cautiously navigate space, searching for lost colonies and hidden githyanki outposts.

**Internal Anatomy:** Illithids are internally similar to humans, with recognizable hearts, lungs, livers, spleens, stomachs, and digestive systems. Ceremorphosis alters their appearance but not their function. However, the nervous system is drastically advanced and extensive, with the entire body "wired" into the brain, giving illithids exceptional physical awareness.

Ceremorphosis transforms the brain into a parasitic organ essential for survival, but it doesn't produce necessary enzymes, hormones, or psychic energy. These must be derived from consumed brains and other foods rich in these components. Illithids consume **two meals daily, and at least one brain of a sapient creature per month to avoid losing 1 HP per day.**

Their digestive system, integrated with their nervous system, absorbs nutrients, enzymes, hormones, and psychic energy. Illithid blood is silvery-white.

**Memory:** Illithids typically retain no memory of their previous lives, but some experience "partialism," retaining fragments of their host's mind. These fragments often manifest when the illithid is distracted, displaying behaviors like finger tapping, humming, or writing in the host's language. Though rare, some illithids may retain a complete memory capable of autonomous action, as illustrated by the myth of the Adversary, an entity thought to have overpowered an illithid's mind.

Partialism disqualifies an illithid from joining the elder brain. Many affected illithids are unaware of their condition but react with horror upon discovery, often attempting psionic surgery or other means to

remove the partialism. Illithids regularly eliminate subconscious personality fragments to prevent partialism.

**Mouth and Tentacles:** Illithid tentacles range from 2 to 4 feet when extended and are highly dexterous, often used as additional hands. These tentacles surround a circular, jawless mouth with rows of small rasping teeth that grip brain matter. Illithids dissolve their victim's skin and skull with a powerful enzyme released through the tentacles, which acts so quickly it appears they pass through the scalp and bone as if through soft clay. This enzyme is highly unstable and decomposes upon brief air contact, making it impossible to harvest from dead illithids.



**Reproduction:** An illithid's life cycle is both unique and horrifying. Mind flayers are amphibious, starting their life as tadpoles hatched from eggs. Adults spawn hermaphroditically two to three times, depositing about a thousand eggs in a briny pool. These eggs hatch in a month, releasing tadpoles into the pool.

For ten years, the tadpoles are nurtured with a fatty mash of brain material before growing from a fraction of an inch to about 3 inches. Despite this growth, they remain relatively unintelligent. The pool contains an elder brain that preys on the tadpoles, with only a few surviving to undergo ceremorphosis, the process by which they become mind flayers.

Ceremorphosis involves inserting a mature tadpole into a humanoid host's ear, nostril, or eye. Over several days, the tadpole consumes the host's brain, replacing it and taking control of the nervous system. The host dies, but the body is reanimated by the tadpole.

A victim can be saved if rescued early, as they lose 1 point of IQ and DX per hour. Restoration spells can recover lost attributes but won't kill the tadpole.

The only effective way to kill the tadpole is to destroy the host's head, after which Resurrection might be needed to restore the victim.

The entire ceremorphosis process lasts a week and is irreversible once any attribute hits 0. Only certain humanoid races (e.g., humans, elves, orcs) of specific sizes are suitable hosts for this transformation.

## Society

**Colonies:** Mind flayer communities, or colonies, typically range from two hundred to two thousand illithids, each commanding at least two slaves. These colonies operate as hive minds under the control of an elder brain, which telepathically commands all mind flayers within a certain radius. The elder brain, residing in a pool of briny fluids and composed of deceased illithid brains, serves as the colony's communication hub, knowledge repository, and command center.

While mind flayers may strive for individual control within the colony, they are ultimately subservient to the elder brain. Historically, illithids believed that survival required strict obedience to the elder brain, especially after the collapse of their empires. Within colonies, mind flayers are organized into factions known as Creeds, based on their abilities and philosophies. Representatives from these Creeds form Elder Concords to coordinate colony activities under the elder brain's guidance. Multiple colonies may form a "Grand Elder Concord" for common objectives.

When issues arise or secrets need uncovering, a team of mind flayers, known as an "inquisition," is assembled, utilizing individual talents to achieve their goals. For more significant missions, a larger group called a "cult" is formed, led by two mind flayers competing for power. Such missions, operating beyond the elder brain's direct control, are dangerous but potentially highly rewarding.

Mind flayers can regain free will if they remain outside the elder brain's influence long enough, becoming renegade illithids. These renegades might establish their own colonies or cooperate with other species, although such independence vanishes if they fall under elder brain control again.

Some colonies are led by creatures other than elder brains, such as paragon mind flayers or brainstealer dragons. On Karilan, for example, the notable mind flayer colony Taliqua is led by a brainstealer dragon.

**Fashion:** Illithids dress in dramatic flowing robes and cloaks, with distinctively two-lobed boots concealing their webbed feet. They often wear high collars, dark hats, and various ornaments.

**Goals:** Mind flayers aim to dominate the universe. They are aware that the future can change,

particularly due to threats from githyanki and githzerai, so they are vigilant, not complacent.

Elder brains have long-term plans spanning decades or centuries, making their schemes difficult for outsiders to deduce. Even mind flayers sometimes don't fully understand the elder brain's instructions.

In the short term, mind flayers focus on:

- Opposing and killing githyanki and githzerai.
- Establishing links with non-illithids for service and potential raid targets.
- Maintaining a steady supply of brains for nourishment.
- Expanding their knowledge to better predict the future.
- Undermining surface empires experimentally to learn from their collapses.

Their most ambitious goal is to find a way to extinguish the sun. While not harmed by sunlight, illithids hate it and avoid it, hoping to expand from their subterranean lairs to the sunless surface where the best brains are.

**Language:** Mind flayers communicate via telepathy and tentacle motions, initially limited to short ranges and line of sight. As they mature, their telepathy extends farther and can engage multiple minds simultaneously. They often know other languages like Aventian, Drow, Aquan, and Infernal, though they dislike speaking them aloud. They read Qualith, a written language resembling raised dashes meant to be read by touch, which is nearly impossible for non-illithids to understand.

**Origin:** The origin of illithids is shrouded in mystery, with scholars relying on fragments from ancient texts for clues. *The Planetreader's Primer* from Sigil describes an illithid empire that spanned worlds and nearly disrupted the eternal Blood War. *The Astromundi Chronicles* depict illithids as "monstrous spawn" hidden by their unknown progenitors, whom they eventually annihilated. The oldest source, the *Sargonne Prophecies*, on cryptic stone tablets, tells of an illithid world destroyed by a fiery cataclysm, leading them to flee in flying ships.

Scholars, piecing together this sparse information and oral histories, conclude that illithids once ruled an ancient, vast empire built on slavery and domination. Eventually, enslaved races developed resistance, revolted, and overthrew their masters. This led to an era of relentless revenge, during which surviving pockets of illithids were hunted and nearly exterminated.

After gaining freedom, the former slaves, now known as the githyanki and githzerai, began warring among themselves. This allowed the surviving illithids to retreat and secure fortresses deep underground, beyond the reach of their former captives.

While the rebellion of the gith did occur roughly two thousand years ago, the mind flayers had only recently arrived from a distant future. Facing extinction in their own time, they devised a desperate plan. In a last stand, they sacrificed countless elder brains to create a psionic maelstrom, tearing through time and ultimately arriving in the present world's ancient past, as noted in the *Sargonne Prophecies*.

In this new era, the illithids quickly enslaved the gith, striving to rebuild their empire. After centuries, the gith revolted, destroying much of the knowledge and magic the illithids brought from the future. Scattered and disorganized, the mind flayers began to regroup, patiently waiting in the darkness.

In the distant future, when stars have become cold, red cinders, the illithids plan to rise again. From their subterranean lairs, they will aim to reestablish their lost empire, stronger and more ruthless than before, extinguishing all hope.

**Relations with Other Creatures:** Mind flayers have no true friends, interacting with other races mainly for information and trade. They pretend friendship and resort to enslavement and consumption. They respect drow and duergar only for self-serving purposes. They have a particular enmity for githyanki and githzerai, showing and receiving no mercy. Mind flayers fear undead as they cannot be psionically detected or dominated.

**Religion:** Illithid religion stands apart in its indifference to the afterlife, as mind flayers believe they merge with the elder brain upon death. Instead, they venerate Ilsensine, a deity who embodies their values: knowledge, darkness, mental power, and racial superiority.

Ilsensine exists as a colossal, pulsing brain in the Caverns of Thought beneath the Outlands, extending infinite ganglia to access all knowledge. It peers into the minds of sages, extracts memories from dead wizards, and spans time and space, deeming mind flayers the greatest mortal beings.

Mind flayers do not worship Ilsensine as humans or elves worship their gods. They revere it for its immense mental capacity, seeing it as the ultimate form of an elder brain. Their ego prevents true worship, but they seek Ilsensine's favors and knowledge.

The priesthood of Ilsensine is exclusive and monastic, dedicated to knowledge and psionic experimentation. These clerics, aided by the all-knowing Ilsensine, rarely engage with illithid society and often use cranium rats for communication. When direct intervention is needed, Ilsensine's proxy, Lugribosk, acts on its behalf.

A smaller sect worships Maanzecorian, embodying perfect knowledge and memory. Some

mind flayers see this deity's traits in aboleths, leading to conflicts between the two.

**Technology:** Originally a technologically advanced race from the future, mind flayers lost much of their technological knowledge post-gith rebellion. Remaining colonies possess ultra-tech artifacts they can't reproduce or fully understand.

**Thralls:** Illithid communities rely heavily on thralls, or slaves, to perform all menial tasks such as household chores, public work, and serving as draft animals. Thralls also serve as expendable soldiers in illithid armies, absorbing enemy attacks while the mind flayers use their powerful psychic abilities.

Captured slaves undergo inspection, disinfection, and constant psychic bombardment to ensure obedience. Escaped thralls describe their enslavement as a conscious nightmare, fully aware of their actions but powerless to resist. The mental captivity imposes a relentless sense of hopelessness and horror.

While many thralls are captured during raids, others are selectively bred for attributes like strength, docility, coloration, or height. Most thralls are eventually consumed by their masters, with their bodies (minus brains) fed to other thralls.

Beyond their labor, thralls serve to bolster an illithid's prestige. Dominating a valuable or exotic thrall enhances an illithid's status, whereas lacking thralls signifies weakness.

## Spoils

Throughout their lifespan, mind flayers collect rare objects and enchanted items. The most valuable treasure they possess is their ancient, advanced technology.

## Capturing and Training

Mind flayers tend to avoid direct military confrontations, preferring to rely on thralls to do the dirty work. Nonetheless, the stats are given.

**Tadpole Value:** \$1,200.

**Untrained Value:** \$6,100.

**Trained Value:** \$61,100.

**Supply Cost:** \$1.3 and 2 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.064

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,830.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Mind Flayers

*Battle Rating:* 7.5

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80

*Supply (Weekly):* \$1,600.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$220,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$229,000.

## Racial Template

*123 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+1 [10]; IQ+3 [60].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Per-2 [-10]; Will+1 [5].

**Advantages:** DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Extended Lifespan 1 [2]; Infravision [10]; Reduced Consumption 1 [2]; Resistant to Psionics (+3) [10]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Slippery 3 [6]; Versatile [5].

*Dissolving Enzyme:* Corrosion Attack 2d (Accessibility, Can only be delivered with mouth tentacles, -10%; Costs Fatigue, 2 FP, -10%; Melee Attack, Reach C, Cannot Parry, -35%; Nuisance Effect, Effect decreases depending on the number of tentacles, -5%; Takes Extra Time 1, -10%) [6].

*Mouth Tentacles:* Extra Arms 4 (Extra-Flexible, +50%; Short, -50%; Weak, 1/2 ST, -25%) [30].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bully (12) [-10]; Callous [-5]; Dependency (Brain of a sapient creature; Occasional; Monthly) [-20]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Intolerance (Non-illithids) [-10]; Killjoy [-15]; Megalomania [-10]; No Sense of Smell/Taste (No Smell only, -50%) [-2]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Selfish (12) [-5]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15].

**Features:** Early Maturation 1; Night Vision 7.

**Racial Psionic Abilities:** Mental Blow 4 (Accessibility, Only sapient beings, -10%) [27]; Mental Surgery 1 (Accessibility, Only sapient creatures, -10%) [10]; Suggestion 3 (Accessibility, Only sapient creatures, -10%) [25]; Telereceive 1 (Accessibility, Only sapient creatures, -10%) [16]; Telespeak 3 (Accessibility, Only sapient creatures, -10%) [33].

**Racial Psionic Skills:** Mental Blow (H) Will-2 [1]; Mental Surgery (H) IQ-2 [1]; Suggestion (H) IQ-2 [1]; Telereceive (H) IQ-2 [1]; Telesend (H) IQ-2 [1].

# Mind Flayer Sorcerer

Type: Aberration (Mind Flayer)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |           |
|----|----|----|------|--------|-----------|
| ST | 11 | HP | 11   | SM     | +0        |
| DX | 11 | BS | 5.75 | thr/sw | 1d-1/1d+1 |
| HT | 12 | FP | 12   | BL     | 24 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-1/1d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lbs.

**Length:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-5 and 6-10 grimlocks. 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A (individual), C.

While arcane magic is considered an abomination by the mind flayers, some renegade illithids still practice it. This includes mind flayer sorcerers whose innate magic forces them to exclude themselves from the illithid society.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 24 | 48    | 72     | 144   | 240         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Tentacles (-3):** Each of the four face tentacles can be attacked. Treat it as an arm for the purpose of injury multipliers.

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8 (unarmed).

**Resistances:** +3 against psionics.

## Combat

Mind flayers like to fight from a distance, using Mental Blow. If pressed into melee combat, a mind flayer tries to grapple the head with its tentacles and use Dissolving Enzyme.

**Sharp Teeth (11):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the mind flayer may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-1 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-3 control against larger ones.

**Tentacle (11):** The mind flayer has four short tentacles that encircle its mouth. These are treated as four short arms with Reach C and effective ST of 5. The mind flayer can use tentacles to attack for 1d-5 crushing damage, but usually uses the tentacles for grappling and manipulating objects. The tentacles are considered to be “off-hands” for the purpose of penalties, but not for the purpose of determining the arc of attack.

**Tentacle Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-4 control. Reach C.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-2 crushing. Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.2 lbs.

**Effective Tentacle Attack Weight:** 0.25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 12 lbs.

## Control Thresholds

| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| 2                    | 6                    | 11        | 17                   | 22                 |

## Special Abilities

**Dissolving Enzyme (7):** The mouth tentacles have ducts that can transmit a powerful dissolving enzyme. This takes time – the mind flayer must first perform a Ready maneuver, and only then follow-up with a Reach C melee attack with one or more of its tentacles. No attack roll is required if the tentacles are grappling the victim. If it succeeds, it deals 2d corrosion damage. If it only has three tentacles in contact with the victim, then decrease it by 25%; if it only has two tentacles in contact with the victim, then decrease it by 50%; if it only has one tentacle in contact with the victim, then decrease it by 75%. Usually, the mind flayer uses this attack when grappling the head with all four tentacles to corrode its way through the skull and extract the brain. Each use costs 2 FP.

**Psionics:** Mind flayers possess an array of innate telepathic abilities. Like all telepathic abilities, these

can only affect sapient beings. A mind flayer has innate access to the following abilities:

*Mental Blow 4 (14)* – p. PP65;

*Mental Surgery 1 (13)* – p. PP61;

*Suggestion 3 (13)* – p. PP63;

*Telereceive 1 (13)* – p. PP58;

*Telespeak 3 (14)* – p. PP60.

Many mind flayers acquire other psionic abilities or improve the innate ones further.

**Slipperiness:** The mind flayer has +3 on all ST, DX, and Escape rolls to slip restraints, break free in close combat, or squeeze through narrow openings. If using FDG, this gives Control DR 3 and +3 to DX when attacking to break free of an existing grapple.

**Spellcasting:** The mind flayer sorcerer is a spellcaster with Sorcery Talent 2. It has a gloom dragon bloodline that limits his scope of spells to mind control spells, necromantic spells, meta-spells, and flight spells, but has no Sorcerous Empowerment. The mind flayer sorcerer has several learned spells that do not require skill-based casting roll and mandatory verbal and somatic components:

[Daze \(Ranged\)](#) (17);

[Detect Magic](#) (15);

[Disrupt Undead 3](#) (14);

[Ray of Enfeeblement](#) (14);

[Ray of Exhaustion](#) (14).

For more detailed rules for sorcerous spellcasting, see *Powers of Karilan*.

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 7       | 10/-        | 11    |

Although their white, pupilless eyes suggest blindness, mind flayers see quite well. Aside from normal vision, the mind flayer can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

The eyes of the mind flayer are adapted to darkness; its **native illumination level is -7**. This lets it see and fight at no penalty at moonless night, but it suffers a -7 penalty during the day.

Mind flayers have no sense of smell and are **Hard of Hearing** (p. B138).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 14 | 15   |

**Mentality Traits:** Callous; Intolerance (Non-illithids); Killjoy; Megalomania; Selfish (12).

## Skills

Brainwashing/TL3-15; Expert Skill (Psionics)-15; Innate Attack (Beam)-12; Interrogation-15; Intimidation-15; Research/TL3-15; Thaumatology-15.

**Psionic Skills:** Mental Blow-15; Mental Surgery-12; Suggestion-14; Telereceive-14; Telesend-14.

## Spoils

Throughout their lifespan, mind flayers collect rare objects and enchanted items. The most valuable treasure they possess is their ancient, advanced technology.

## Capturing and Training

Mind flayer sorcerers are much more likely to work with others, possibly as mercenaries.

**Tadpole Value:** \$1,200.

**Untrained Value:** \$6,100.

**Trained Value:** \$121,100.

**Supply Cost:** \$1.3 and 2 lb./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.126

**Wage (Monthly):** \$3,630.

# Minotaur

Type: Monstrous Humanoid (Hybrid, Minotaur)



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |         |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|---------|
| <b>ST</b> | 18 | <b>HP</b> | 18  | <b>SM</b>     | +1      |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+2/3d |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12  | <b>BL</b>     | 65 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d+2/2d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 700 lbs.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-8. 20% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E.

Minotaurs are imposing, muscular humanoids with bull-like heads and human-like torsos and limbs, except for their hooved feet. Their fur, often covering the forearms, chest, abdomen, and legs, varies from brown to black. Males, or bulls, can reach up to 9 feet tall, while females, or cows, stand around 7 feet with broader hips and humanoid breasts.

Minotaurs share a similar physique with ogres, possessing large, strong hands with thick, sharp yellow nails, used in battle but prone to breakage. Their heads resemble bulls but have distinct predatory features: longer snouts, sharp carnivore teeth, prominent canines, and eyes positioned for better

depth perception. Some have tails, though it is uncommon.

Their horns resemble regular bulls', curving forward, with males typically having longer and thicker horns. Horn colors can vary, with darker furred minotaurs often having dark yellow or brown horns, ranging from 1 to 3 feet in length.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 65 | 130   | 195    | 390   | 650         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 2\* (tough skin). The skull has an additional DR 2 (total DR 6). Hooves add +1 DR to feet.

**Dodge:** 9.

**Parry:** 10U (two-handed axe/mace); 10 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** sunburn.

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

## Combat

Though not highly intelligent, minotaurs are instinctively cunning, excelling in ambushes and melee combat. They prefer using their horns for charge attacks and wield two-handed poleaxes, clubs, hammers, flails, and spears, often avoiding armor and ranged weapons.

**SM+1 Great Axe (13):** swing 5d-1 cutting (RS: 4d-1), Reach 1-3\*, unbalanced, becomes unready after attacking, 18 lbs.

**Horns (13):** thrust 2d-1 impaling, Reach C-1. The minotaur may gore with both horns as a single attack; if it hits, figure damage for each horn separately. Horns have DR 4 and HP 11. Damage dealt to the horns is not subtracted from the minotaur's HP. If the minotaur loses one horn, it may still attack with the other.

**Bite (13):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the minotaur may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+2 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d control against larger ones.

**Claws (13):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C-1.

**Kick (11):** thrust 2d crushing. Reach C-1. On a miss with a kick, roll vs. DX to avoid falling.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 1d+2 control. Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 3.25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 32.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 9                    | 18        | 27                   | 36                 |

## Special Abilities

**Absolute Direction:** Minotaurs have an innate sense of direction, always knowing which way is north, and can retrace any path they've taken in the past month, except in environments like interstellar space or the Astral Plane. This ability still functions underground, underwater, and on other planets, providing a +3 bonus to Body Sense and Navigation (Air, Land, or Sea).

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).  
Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 14          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the minotaur can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

**Smell:** The minotaur has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 9    |

Minotaurs are perpetually hungry, which intensifies their aggression. They exhibit little affection towards their parents and generally dislike torture. Despite their brutality, they are capable of kindness and empathy. Gnolls are considered ancestral enemies of the minotaur race and are usually attacked on sight.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Dislikes torture; Gluttony (9); Intolerance (Gnolls).

## Skills

Brawling-13; Intimidation-14; Tracking-14; Two-Handed Axe/Mace-13.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Minotaurs are eternally hungry man-eating carnivores. Despite their ravenousness, they could survive without food and water for a very long time, requiring only one meal per month.

**Habitat:** Minotaurs are most likely found underground or in the thickest of forests. They have a temperature comfort zone between 11° and 90°.

**Lifecycle:** Like humans, minotaurs procreate year-round, driven more by the need to replenish their numbers than by emotions. Typically, a cow gives birth to one calf, while twins are rare and seen as a religious blessing or sometimes an ill omen. Minotaurs mature quickly: a two-year-old calf has fully formed horns and can kill an orc, a five-year-old towers over other humanoids, and by ten, they are considered adults, capable of procreation as early as three years. Culturally, birthing a strong male warrior is the highest aspiration for a cow, while a bull aims to sire many calves.

Sages suggest that minotaurs average 80 years, though many die young due to violence, with a thirty-year-old regarded as a seasoned veteran. Their maximum lifespan is thought to be around 200 years. Minotaurs can mate with each other or female humanoids, resulting in half-minotaurs.

## Society

Minotaur society is patriarchal. Weaker females are treated almost like slaves, while older females are respected only if they remain physically superior. Younger minotaurs avoid older males to dodge conflicts and dominance displays. Adults consume alcohol heavily and duel over treasures, females, and power. Bulls practice polygamy, sometimes forming harems of six or seven cows. Infanticide occurs in cases of physical deformity. Slavery exists, with males keeping weaker creatures as slaves and females allowed to dominate them.

Minotaurs easily adapt traditions from other races, favoring those aimed at aggression and intimidation.

**Leadership:** The tribe's leader, known as the elder, is the strongest bull, not necessarily the smartest. Minotaur kings lead raids, while solitary minotaurs and small clans are common. Combat education starts early, with parents and male tribe members teaching youths to fight. Male calves develop brutal rivalries, encouraged by adults.

**Horn Culture:** Minotaurs take pride in their horns, spending free time polishing and decorating them with brass and silver tacks. Horn color often denotes status, with some using oils to darken them. Repaired severed horns are common in skilled tribes, and duel winners take their opponent's left horn, turning it into a musical instrument. Jewelry is rare, with fanciful girdles or gauntlets being closest to decorations.

**Relations:** Minotaurs get along with ogres and respect giants and trolls for their strength, but consider smaller humanoids like humans, elves, and

dwarves beneath them. Gnolls and minotaurs are sworn enemies, attacking each other on sight.

**Religion:** Many minotaurs worship the demon lord Baphomet, maintaining a secluded society with varying levels of reverence and traditions. Priests decorate their horns with carved pictograms filled with blood and stained with yellowing agents. Instead of traditional garb, they adorn their bodies with soil, plant matter, and battle-spilled blood, particularly from gnolls, for reasons known only to the priests. Worship includes sacrificial ceremonies in labyrinthine homes decorated with the bones of victims, often featuring humans as the most common sacrifice. Respect for clerics is limited, primarily based on physical strength, though horns from defeated bull priests are highly valued.

Death is not feared; instead, it is seen as a sacred event. Minotaurs believe a good death is quick, clean, and comes in the heat of battle, with honor killings deeply embedded in their cultural and religious beliefs.

**Magic:** Wizardly spellcasting is extremely rare among minotaurs as most lack the curiosity to pursue the art of magic. The most common arcane spellcasters are warlocks who forged a pact with Baphomet.

Magic items hold little value for most minotaurs and are traded away for other valuables or alcohol most of the time.

**Language:** Minotaur language is very similar to the Ogre language, allowing those who are proficient in one tongue quickly pick up the intricacies of the other. One unique part of the Minotaur language is a number of vocalizations only known and comprehensible by their own kin, reminiscent of grunts and sounds emitted by mundane cattle bulls.

**Origin:** The minotaur species' origin is unknown. Some believe Geryon created them from ogres, but minotaurs only praise Baphomet. Another theory suggests devoted Baphomet cultists were transformed into minotaurs, a high honor in Baphomet's church. A different myth involves the Lady of Pain, claiming she created the first minotaurs to guard her magical maze prisons. In Sigil, a legend states Baphomet crossbred minotaurs and tanar'ri to create bulezau, though this remains unconfirmed.

## Spoils

A powdered minotaur horn counts as 1 EP for the purpose of enchanting a magic item that increases strength or locates something or someone, or as \$150 in alchemical reagents for potions that increase strength. A minotaur heart counts as 8 EP for the purpose of enchanting a minogon construct. Minotaur hide can be used as material for leather armor.

## Capturing and Training

Evil wizards sometimes place minotaur clans in labyrinths, feeding them interlopers and adventurers. Minotaurs, with their innate sense of direction, often raid passersby or work as mercenaries, fighters, and servants. They are also enslaved by Underdark inhabitants like mind flayers and drow.

**Young Value:** \$880.

**Untrained Value:** \$4,400.

**Trained Value:** \$44,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.0006 and 0.0007 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0. The supply costs are so low that there is nothing wrong with just ignoring them.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.046

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,320.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Minotaurs

*Battle Rating:* 2.5

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night, Terrain (Underground).

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$79,170.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$81,170.

## Racial Template

72 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+8 (Size Modifier, -10%) [72]; IQ-1 [-20]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Absolute Direction [5]; DR 2 (Tough Skin, -40%) [6]; DR 2 (Partial, Skull, -70%) [3]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Extended Lifespan 1 [2]; Hooves [3]; Infravision [10]; Reduced Consumption 4 [8]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Temperature Tolerance 2 (Cold) [2].

*Horns* [8]: 2 x Natural Weapon (Impaling; Cannot Parry, -40%; Link, +10%; Single, -20%) [4].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (12) [-10]; Gluttony (9) [-7]; Intolerance (Gnolls) [-2]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10].

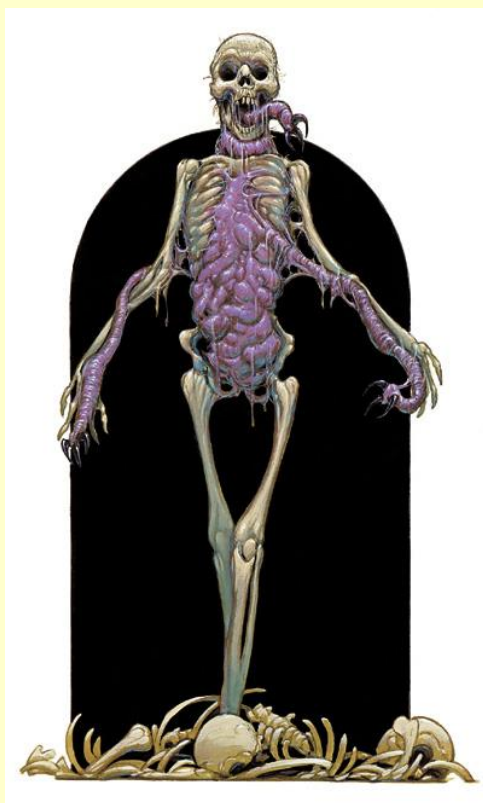
**Perks:** Fur [1].

**Quirks:** Dislikes torture [-1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 2.

# Mohrg

Type: Undead



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |         |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|---------|
| <b>ST</b> | 14 | <b>HP</b> | 17 | <b>SM</b>     | +0      |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 7  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d/2d   |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | -  | <b>BL</b>     | 39 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d/1d+2

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 120 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-4 and 5-10 zombies. 30% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** B.

Mohrgs are vile undead that appear as skeletons containing animated viscera. Unrepentant killers in life, mohrgs retain an intense hatred for all living beings, especially those who can fear death.

A mohrg appears as a skeletal corpse with a ribcage stuffed with writhing internal organs. Notably, their long, cartilaginous tongue ends in small claws.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 39 | 78    | 117    | 234   | 390         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed).

**DR:** 3.

**Tongue (-6):** DR 0. The tongue can only be targeted when the mohrg is feeling an object with it. HP 3, any excess injury is lost.

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving).

**Vulnerabilities:** The mohrg takes x2 injury from crushing attacks.

**Weaknesses:** Mohrgs, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A mohrg that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

**Brittle:** Whenever an injury cripples one of the mohrg's limbs or extremities, it breaks off. If it can make a HT roll, it falls off in one piece; otherwise, it shatters irrecoverably. Furthermore, the mohrg must make a HT roll upon being brought down to 0 HP. If it fails, it is instantly crumbles, as if it had gone down to -10xHP.

**Lightweight:** Mohrgs have -2 to ST when they resist knockback.

## Combat

To catch prey off guard, mohrgs strike with their fists or lash with their tongues, which can paralyze victims lacking fortitude.

**Punch (14):** thrust 1d crushing. Reach C.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d+1 control. Reach C. Effective ST 16 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.95 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 19.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 8                    | 16        | 24                   | 32                 |

## Special Abilities

**Create Spawn:** Creatures killed by a mohrg rise after 2d days as zombies under the mohrg's control. They do not possess any of the abilities they had in life.

**Paralyzing Tongue (14):** A mohrg can lash out with its tongue to paralyze its victim. This attack has Reach C, 1 and cannot parry. If the tongue touches bare skin, the victim must roll HT to resist. He becomes paralyzed for 3 seconds per point of margin of failure. After that the subject is physically stunned (p. B420) and may roll vs. HT once per second to recover.

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | -           | 10    |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the mohrg has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

**Touch:** Mohrgs are **Numb** (p. B146), unless they are using their tongues to feel objects, since this fleshy part is quite sensitive. Tongue is not armored and is not a manipulatory organ. When using the tongue to feel an object outside of its mouth, the mohrg cannot speak or bite.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

Regardless of their animation or past memories, mohrgs primarily desire to extinguish life. They brood angrily when not killing, plotting to spread further death. Despite their compulsive need to kill, mohrgs are intelligent. They feel perverse joy from killing, especially when it involves intelligent beings, and experience pleasure as negative energy marks the raising of their latest victim as a zombie, a sensation they seek to replicate.

Mohrgs' intelligence and potential memory of their former lives make them dangerous predators. They understand human society, can navigate cities, and, if disguised, can recruit living agents for their quests. Mohrgs show inhuman patience when executing plans, killing populations slowly to build an army of zombies. Their bloodlust is unmitigated, leaving a core of murderous intent.

Mohrgs often replicate their former killing styles, creating eerie echoes of their past crimes. A murderer who slit throats might claw necks, or use a knife on helpless victims, while a thug might lure victims into dark alleys. The most dangerous mohrgs remember their mortal lives entirely and feel no remorse, seeking to outdo their past crimes, making them an anathema to life itself.

**Mentality Traits:** Compulsive Murderer (9); Intolerance (Living).

## Skills

Brawling-14; Stealth-14; Tracking-14; Wrestling-14.

## Ecology

**Habitat and Society:** Mohrgs, not needing to eat, drink, or sleep, prefer small, dark dwellings, often caves or rooms. These lairs are sparse, sometimes containing trophies or books on anatomy and necromancy, but lack comfort or hospitality.

Small groups of mohrgs form for protection and more efficient killing. They rarely discuss tactics; the strongest mohrg chooses a target, and others follow their own prey. They may fight over kills only when driven by their lust for negative energy.

In large communities, mohrgs hide in sewers, catacombs, dungeons, or abandoned buildings, sometimes disguising themselves with cloaks. They hunt at night, targeting weaker individuals, and utilize zombies to collect victims.

Mohrgs are indifferent towards other undead. They see mindless undead as tools and have no empathy for souls they reanimate. They resent more powerful undead like liches, mummies, and vampires and are jealous of dullahans. Some ghosts and revenants hunt mohrgs, their undead existence tracing back to the mohrgs' mortal killings.

**Origin:** Most mohrgs were once mortal killers, delighting in the deaths of others. Some were created from innocent victims by spellcasters, driven mad by their transformation and the decay of their bodies. The loss of ties to the living world incites the same hatred for the living found in "naturally occurring" mohrgs.

**Undead:** As undead creatures, mohrgs do not need food, water, sleep, air, or experience aging. They are immune to metabolic hazards and vacuum. Mohrgs do not possess a FP score, and are unable to reproduce sexually. Unlike most lesser undead, the mohrgs **can recover HP naturally**.

## Spoils

Mohrgs are intelligent creatures and sometimes collect treasure.

## Capturing and Training

Mohrgs are difficult to use as soldiers due to their compulsive need to murder, but some necromancers may magically compel them to direct their impulses only at the enemies.

**Untrained Value:** \$5,800.

**Trained Value:** \$58,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.06

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,740.

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Mohrgs**

*Battle Rating:* 7

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 28/112

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$208,900.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$208,900.

## Racial Template

The following racial template represents a humanoid mohrg. It can be applied as a lens to another racial template to simulate mohrgs risen from non-human beings.

*172 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+4 [40]; DX+2 [40]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** Basic Speed +1.00 [20]; HP+3 [6].

**Advantages:** DR 3 [15]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Dominance (Zombie; Fatal Beating, -40%) [12]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving) [40]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15]; Vacuum Support [5].

*Paralyzing Tongue* [25]; Affliction 1 (HT; Contact Agent, -30%; Melee Attack, Reach C, 1, Cannot Parry, -25%; Paralysis, +150%; Reduced Duration, 1/20, -25%) [17] + Not Numb (Tongue Only, -60%) [8].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Brittle [-15]; Compulsive Murderer (9) [-22]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Intolerance (Living) [-10]; No Extra Skull DR [-2]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Skinny [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Vulnerability (Crushing Attacks, x2) [-30].

**Quirks:** Cannot Float [-1]; Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue.

# Nightmare

Type: Outsider (Evil, Nightmare)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |         |
|----|----|----|----|--------|---------|
| ST | 22 | HP | 22 | SM     | +1      |
| DX | 11 | BS | 6  | thr/sw | 2d/4d   |
| HT | 12 | FP | 12 | BL     | 97 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 2d/2d+2

- Body Plan:** Quadruped (p. B553).
- Weight:** 1,500 lbs.
- Length:** 9 ft.
- Effective Height:** 6 ft.
- Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).
- Organization:** Solitary. 0% lair encounter chance.
- Treasure Type:** -.

Nightmares are regal yet malevolent equine beings, with hearts as dark and evil as the abysses from which they originate. Known also as hell horses or demon horses, these fiendish creatures are named after the terrifying dreams inflicted upon those unfortunate enough to encounter them.

Nightmares appear as gaunt stallions cloaked in night-black coats, which superficially resemble the exterior of warhorses. However, closer inspection reveals their true nature: they possess enormous heads, viper-like fangs, and sinister dark eyes often glowing with red-hot flames. Their flaring nostrils emit orange fire. Encircled by flames, their wild manes and unkempt tails turn to cinders and disperse upon their demise.

Their steel-like hooves leave scorch marks in mysterious patterns and gaps wherever they tread. They gallop through the night with unnatural agility, their black bodies merging with the darkness. Onlookers are left to witness only the infernal flames racing by, appearing and vanishing in smoky clouds of brimstone. It is rumored that nightmares move so quickly they appear as blurs, leading to speculation

that they can move between shadows or teleport, explaining their ability to suddenly appear and disappear.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 9/18; exploration 9 miles per hour.

**Air:** Move 12/24; exploration 12 miles per hour. Although the nightmare has no wings, the creature can fly with great speed. This is an innate magical ability.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 97 | 194   | 291    | 582   | 970         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 3\* (tough skin), +1 DR (feet).

**Dodge:** 11.

**Immunities:** noxious fire effects.

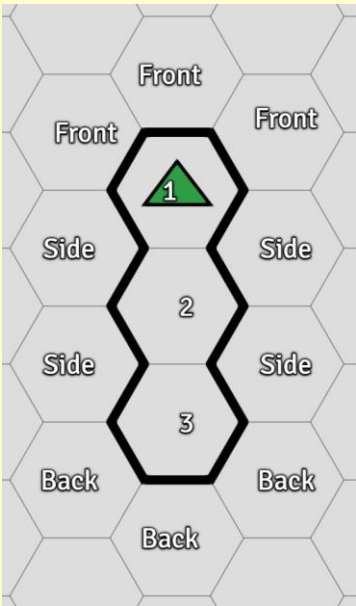
**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Vulnerabilities:** holy weapons (x2).

**Fire Resistance:** The nightmare has DR 10 against fire. This includes internal and eye damage.

## Combat

With tooth and hoof, nightmares ruthlessly attack most beings they encounter. Creatures from the Lower Planes are generally spared their wrath, but entities from the Material Plane are not so fortunate. Nightmares use hit-and-run tactics, targeting isolated members of groups and blocking escape routes with fire, speed, and their planar shifting abilities. Only the most skilled riders can hope to engage a nightmare effectively while riding one.



**Flaming Hooves (Front) (12):** thrust 2d+1 crushing + 1d-1 follow-up burning. Reach C-1 from hex #1.

**Flaming Hooves (Rear) (10):** thrust 2d+2 crushing + 1d-1 follow-up burning. Reach C-1 from hex #3.

**Rearing Kick (9):** thrust 2d+2 crushing + 1d-1 follow-up burning. Reach C-1 from hex #1. Can only target the upper body.

**Fangs (12):** thrust 1d-1 impaling. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the nightmare may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d control

against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d-2 control against larger ones.

**Smoke (13):** The nightmare may fill a two-yard-radius area within 10 yards with bad smelling smoke. This gives -3 to all vision and Infravision rolls made through it. To place the cloud at a distance, it uses Innate Attack (Breath), with normal range penalties, but at +4 for affecting an area. The initial attack roll places the effect. It then drifts from that point with the wind. Every creature that inhales the smoke, begins to cough (is at -3 to DX and -1 to IQ, and cannot use Stealth) for 3 minutes, if it fails a HT roll.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 4.85 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 48.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 11                   | 22        | 33                   | 44                 |

## Special Abilities

**Astral Projection (10):** The nightmare can leave its body behind, unconscious, while projecting its spirit to the Astral Plane by making an IQ roll and spending 1 FP. While there, it cannot cast spells or otherwise affect the world in any meaningful way. The spirit form is visible, but insubstantial. This ability can be maintained indefinitely, provided the nightmare continues paying 1 FP per minute, but the body's need to eat, drink, sleep, etc. effectively limits the duration to a day or so – longer if the body is left with friends, or otherwise cared for.

On the Astral Plane, projectors (but not native astral denizens) are attached to their body by a slim silver cord, which fades to invisible after about 20 feet. The cord always “points” in the direction of the projector's body.

Astral Projection takes 10 seconds to activate. The nightmare can speed this up by taking -1 to the activation roll for each second omitted (maximum -10).

**Etherealness:** The nightmare can become ethereal by taking a Concentrate maneuver. The nightmare slips into the space between worlds and becomes intangible, passing through solid objects as though they weren't there. In this state, the nightmare makes no noise when she moves. The nightmare can perceive the tangible world, and speak normally to those within it, but it cannot pick up normal objects or affect them in any way.

Physical and energy attacks cannot harm the nightmare, but it is still vulnerable to psionic and (nonmaterial) magical attacks. Likewise, its physical and energy attacks cannot affect physical opponents. Its psi abilities and magic spells can affect the physical world, but at -3 to all skill rolls.

Although the nightmare can pass through solids, it must still breathe. When moving through a solid object, treat this as if it was swimming underwater for purposes of suffocation. It cannot materialize inside a solid object.

The nightmare can carry objects up to its light encumbrance while insubstantial, including clothing and armor. They become physical if dropped. It cannot materialize these objects inside other objects or characters. The nightmare still weighs nothing, so it doesn't leave footprints and can walk on surfaces that wouldn't support a solid body, such as the surface of a body of water.

**Nightmare Aura (10):** Every sapient creature within 4 yards of the nightmare must roll a Quick Contest of Will against it every second or succumb to the nightmare aura. The victim of this aura gains the Nightmares (6) disadvantage (p. B144) for one day. The nightmare may exclude any creatures from this effect.

**Racial Telepathy (10):** Nightmares are able to transmit general concepts and emotions, but not speech via magical telepathy to other nightmares. To establish contact requires one second of concentration and an IQ roll. After that, no concentration is required. The nightmare can maintain multiple contacts, but the IQ roll is at a cumulative -1 per contact after the first. The roll takes penalties under *Long-Distance Modifiers* (p. B241). If the nightmare cannot see or otherwise sense the recipient, it has an additional penalty: -1 for family, lovers, or close friends; -3 for casual friends and acquaintances; or -5 for someone met only briefly.

**Unholy Touch:** A nightmare's natural attacks are treated as unholy for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

High-Speed Movement (p. B394).

Making Things Burn (p. B433).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the nightmare can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

Callous and cruel, nightmares relentlessly pursue those they intend to victimize. They harbor a deep hatred for all life on the Material Plane and exhibit a malevolent intelligence far beyond that of true beasts. Instead of merely killing their prey, they employ their supernatural powers to instill terror first, reducing their victims to panicking wrecks before delivering the fatal blow. A favored tactic is to grant their victims a fleeting sense of safety before suddenly reappearing, shattering their last vestige of hope, and striking the killing blow.

**Mentality Traits:** Bestial; Callous; Hidebound; Sadism (12).

## Skills

Aerobatics-13; Brawling-12; Flight-13; Innate Attack (Breath)-13; Mount-13.

## Other Traits

Extra Legs (Four Legs); Horizontal; No Fine Manipulators.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Breathing:** Nightmares, though resembling horses, are only semi-material beings and do not require breathing.

**Diet:** Though nightmares do not need food or water to survive, they often consume the flesh of their fallen enemies. They particularly favor the meat of humans, demihumans, and lesser fiends, such as manes and lemures, but individual preferences can vary. If they are not given such delicacies at least once a month, they may exhibit increased hostility.

**Habitat:** Nightmares inhabit a range of evil-aligned planes, from Acheron to Pandemonium. They can be found racing through the acidic jungles of Cathrys and the blasting deserts of Minethys in Carceri, as well as the fire and magma flows of Gehenna. Their comfort zone for temperature ranges between 35°F and 150°F.

**Lifecycle:** Nightmares can reproduce naturally, producing up to one foal per year, though many prefer to give birth only once a decade or less frequently. Additionally, a ritual of dark magic can transform a pegasus into a nightmare by the agonizing removal of its wings, replacing its noble qualities with despicable traits.

Nightmares reach maturity at 12 years and can live up to 100 years. Signs of aging include gray hairs on their black coats and a hunched posture. As death approaches, nightmares journey to Pluton, the third

layer of Hades, specifically to a place known as the Hill of Bone, to die.

The Hill of Bone is a massive graveyard shaped like a giant equine skeleton when viewed from above. Eerie silence pervades the area, interrupted only by occasional whinnies and chuffs, even in the absence of living nightmares. The constant, faint rattling of bones can be heard, sometimes shifting as if in victory. Elderly nightmares occasionally appear from walls of mist, greeting the Hill with raised heads, which then responds with an ear-splitting neigh that can drive listeners mad. Immediately afterward, the nightmare falls dead, and its body decays rapidly.

The Hill of Bone serves as the means by which nightmares achieve immortality alongside their ancient ancestors. Removing a single bone from this sacred site is considered a grave transgression, leading the entire nightmare race to hunt down the perpetrator, recover the stolen bone, and exact retribution. The sensation of being watched at the Hill is due to the skulls, which possess truesight and can still communicate, providing descriptions of grave robbers to any living nightmare that arrives. If the stolen bone is not recovered, the nightmare whose bone was taken will suffer permanent death, its life force dispersing throughout Hades. Ensuring that their bodies reach the Hill of Bone, even if they die on other planes, is of utmost importance to nightmares.

**Speech:** While nightmares cannot speak, they can communicate with each other through a limited form of telepathy.

## Society

Sin's Reward, a nightmare adorned in spiked black armor and enveloped in black smoke and white flames, reigns supreme over all nightmares in the Nine Hells. Conversely, the mares of the Abyss are ruled by Thunder of Hooves, a massive, six-legged mutant nightmare that dominates through sheer violence and intimidation. Despite their profound animosity, the two meet annually on the Plane of Shadow to mate, producing three powerful offspring: one destined for the Abyss, one for the Hells, and one to remain on the Plane of Shadow.

## Spoils

When designing nightmare hide armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid #3-52*, use the following statistics: WM 0.9; Cost \$65, DR/inch 12, Max DR 6, Flexible, Construction: fabric, layered fabric. Regardless of its thickness, nightmare hide armor provides an additional DR 5 against fire.

Each of a nightmare's hooves (1 lb. each) can substitute for 1 EP when enchanting an item that grants fire resistance or creates fire.

## Capturing and Training

While nightmares are naturally wild and roaming creatures, they willingly serve as mounts in missions of malice for those deemed sufficiently wicked and capable. Prospective riders should understand that nightmares are not mere steeds but fiercely independent and untamable fiends with their own instincts and agendas. Nightmares, prideful and egotistical, often act on their own volition—even if it conflicts with the goals of their supposed masters and sometimes to their detriment. The methodologies of conducting evil deeds can differ significantly, and attempts to coerce nightmares into servitude usually end disastrously. Only through time and the forging of a bond can a nightmare develop loyalty to its rider, thereby becoming true partners in villainy.

Nightmares are highly coveted mounts among many malevolent races, giving rise to the Order of the Nightmare, a company named for their steeds. Night hags frequently ride them, but they are primarily the mounts of powerful and intelligent demons and devils, especially narzugons, who regard them as trusted and valued companions. Certain undead beings like death knights, liches, vampires, and even specters also take nightmares as mounts. Mortal spellcasters, wicked warriors, and anti-paladins seek out nightmares for the power and acclaim they offer, and the shadar-kai hold them in high esteem as prized steeds.

**Young Value:** \$9,100.

**Untrained Value:** \$45,400.

**Trained Value:** \$454,200.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Flying Horses). When ridden on the ground, Riding (Horses) can be used instead.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.473

**Wage (Monthly):** \$13,600.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Nightmares

*Battle Rating:* 28.5

*Classes:* Air, Cv, Eng.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 96/384 (air) or 72/288 (land)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$817,500.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$817,500.

## Racial Template

372 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+12 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%; Size Modifier, -10%) [60]; DX+1 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [12]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Basic Speed +0.25 [5]; Basic Move +3 [15].

**Advantages:** Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 3 (Tough Skin, -40%) [9]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Enhanced Move 1 (Air) [20]; Enhanced Move 1 (Ground) [20]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Fangs [2]; Flight (Magical, -10%) [36]; Hooves [3]; Infravision [10]; Telesend (Magical, -10%; Racial, -20%; Vague, -50%) [6]; Temperature Tolerance 5 (Hot) [5].

*Flaming Hooves:* Burning Attack 1d-1 (Follow-Up, Hooves, +0%; Magical, -10%) [4].

*Astral Projection:* Jumper (World; Improved, +10%; Limited Access, -20%; Magical, -10%; Projection, Cannot affect new world, -50%) [30].

*Etherealness:* Insubstantiality (Magical, -10%) [72].

*Smoke* [38]: Affliction 1 (HT; Area Effect, 2 yards, +50%; Coughing, +20%; Drifting, +20%; Fixed Duration, +0%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Persistent, +40%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%; Respiratory Agent, +50%) [25] + Obscure Vision 3 (Defensive, +50%; Drifting, +20%; Extended, Infravision, +20%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Ranged, +50%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%) [13].

*Fire Resistance* [35]: DR 10 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Fire, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [25] + Immunity to Noxious Fire Effects [10].

*Nightmare Aura:* Affliction 1 (Will; Accessibility, Only on sapient creatures, -10%; Always On, -10%; Area Effect, 4 yards, +100%; Aura, +80%; Based on Will, +20%; Disadvantage, Nightmares (6), +10%; Extended Duration, 1,000x, +120%; Fixed Duration, +0%; Magical, -10%; Malediction 1, +100%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; No Signature, +20%; Selective Effect, +20%) [51].

**Disadvantages:** Bestial [-10]; Callous [-5]; Cannot Speak [-15]; Hidebound [-5]; Horizontal [-10]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Holy Weapons, x2) [-10]; Weak Bite [-2].

**Perks:** Unholy Touch [1].

## Cauchemar

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 32 | <b>HP</b> | 32   | <b>SM</b>     | +2        |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 6.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 3d+1/6d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 13 | <b>FP</b> | -    | <b>BL</b>     | 205 lbs.  |

*Reduced Swing:* 3d+1/4d-1

**Body Plan:** Quadruped (p. B553).

**Weight:** 4,500 lbs.

**Length:** 12 ft.**Effective Height:** 9 ft.**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).**Organization:** Solitary. 0% lair encounter chance.**Treasure Type:** -.

The cauchemar is a horrible, especially malevolent version of a nightmare. The sight of one of these great horrors bearing down is enough to shake the heart of the boldest champion.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 9/18; exploration 9 miles per hour.**Air:** Move 12/24; exploration 12 miles per hour. Although the cauchemar has no wings, the creature can fly with great speed. This is an innate magical ability.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 205 | 410   | 615    | 1,230 | 2,050       |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 5\* (tough skin), +1 DR (feet).**Dodge:** 11.**Immunities:** noxious fire effects.**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.**Vulnerabilities:** holy weapons (x2).**Fire Resistance:** The cauchemar has DR 10 against fire. This includes internal and eye damage.

## Combat

**Flaming Hooves (Front) (15):** thrust 3d+2 crushing + 2d follow-up burning. Reach C-1 from hexes #1.**Flaming Hooves (Rear) (13):** thrust 4d-1 crushing + 2d follow-up burning. Reach C-2 from hexes #2.**Rearing Kick (12):** thrust 4d-1 crushing + 2d follow-up burning. Reach C-1 from hexes #1. Can only target the upper body.**Fangs (15):** thrust 1d+2 impaling. Reach C from hexes #1. If the attack hits, the cauchemar may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d-1 control against SM-1 and smaller victims or 1d+2 control against larger ones.**Smoke (13):** The cauchemar may fill a two-yard-radius area within 10 yards with bad smelling smoke. This gives -3 to all vision and Infravision rolls made through it. To place the cloud at a distance, it uses Innate Attack (Breath), with normal range penalties, but at +4 for affecting an area. The initial attack roll places the effect. It then drifts from that point with the wind. Every creature that inhales the smoke, begins to

cough (is at -3 to DX and -1 to IQ, and cannot use Stealth) for 3 minutes, if it fails a HT roll.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 10.25 lbs.**Effective Slam Weight:** 102.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 4                    | 16                   | 32        | 48                   | 64                 |

## Special Abilities

**Astral Projection (10):** The cauchemar can leave its body behind, unconscious, while projecting its spirit to the Astral Plane by making an IQ roll and spending 1 FP. While there, it cannot cast spells or otherwise affect the world in any meaningful way. The spirit form is visible, but insubstantial. This ability can be maintained indefinitely, provided the nightmare continues paying 1 FP per minute, but the body's need to eat, drink, sleep, etc. effectively limits the duration to a day or so – longer if the body is left with friends, or otherwise cared for.

On the Astral Plane, projectors (but not native astral denizens) are attached to their body by a slim silver cord, which fades to invisible after about 20 feet. The cord always “points” in the direction of the projector's body.

Astral Projection takes 10 seconds to activate. The nightmare can speed this up by taking -1 to the activation roll for each second omitted (maximum -10).

**Etherealness:** The cauchemar can become ethereal by taking a Concentrate maneuver. The cauchemar slips into the space between worlds and becomes intangible, passing through solid objects as though they weren't there. In this state, the cauchemar makes no noise when she moves. The cauchemar can perceive the tangible world, and speak normally to those within it, but it cannot pick up normal objects or affect them in any way.

Physical and energy attacks cannot harm the cauchemar, but it is still vulnerable to psionic and (nonmaterial) magical attacks. Likewise, its physical and



energy attacks cannot affect physical opponents. Its psi abilities and magic spells can affect the physical world, but at -3 to all skill rolls.

Although the cauchemar can pass through solids, it must still breathe. When moving through a solid object, treat this as if it was swimming underwater for purposes of suffocation. It cannot materialize inside a solid object.

The cauchemar can carry objects up to its light encumbrance while insubstantial, including clothing and armor. They become physical if dropped. It cannot materialize these objects inside other objects or characters. The cauchemar still weighs nothing, so it doesn't leave footprints and can walk on surfaces that wouldn't support a solid body, such as the surface of a body of water.

**Nightmare Aura (12):** Every sapient creature within 4 yards of the cauchemar must roll a Quick Contest of Will against it every second or succumb to the nightmare aura. The victim of this aura gains the Nightmares (6) disadvantage (p. B144) for one day. The cauchemar may exclude any creatures from this effect.

**Racial Telepathy (10):** Cauchemars are able to transmit general concepts and emotions, but not speech via magical telepathy to other cauchemars and nightmares. To establish contact requires one second of concentration and an IQ roll. After that, no concentration is required. The cauchemar can maintain multiple contacts, but the IQ roll is at a cumulative -1 per contact after the first. The roll takes penalties under *Long-Distance Modifiers* (p. B241). If the cauchemar cannot see or otherwise sense the recipient, it has an additional penalty: -1 for family, lovers, or close friends; -3 for casual friends and acquaintances; or -5 for someone met only briefly.

**Unholy Touch:** A cauchemar's natural attacks are treated as unholy for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

High-Speed Movement (p. B394).

Making Things Burn (p. B433).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the cauchemar can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 12   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bestial; Callous; Hidebound; Sadism (12).

## Skills

Aerobatics-13; Brawling-15; Flight-13; Innate Attack (Breath)-13; Mount-13.

## Other Traits

Extra Legs (Four Legs); Horizontal; No Fine Manipulators.

## Capturing and Training

**Young Value:** \$23,900.

**Untrained Value:** \$119,500.

**Trained Value:** \$1,195,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 1.245

**Wage (Monthly):** \$35,900.

## Mass Combat Statistics

**20 Cauchemars**

*Battle Rating:* 25

*Classes:* Air, Cv, Eng.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 96/384 (air) or 72/288 (land)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$717,300.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$717,300.

## Racial Template

431 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+22 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%; Size Modifier, -20%) [88]; DX+1 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [12]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+2; Will+2 [10]; Basic Speed +0.25 [5]; Basic Move +3 [15].

**Advantages:** Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 5 (Tough Skin, -40%) [15]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Enhanced Move 1 (Air) [20]; Enhanced Move 1 (Ground) [20]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Fangs [2]; Flight (Magical, -10%) [36]; Hooves [3]; Infravision [10]; Telesend (Magical, -10%; Racial, -20%; Vague, -50%) [6]; Temperature Tolerance 5 (Hot) [5].

*Flaming Hooves:* Burning Attack 2d (Follow-Up, Hooves, +0%; Magical, -10%) [9].

*Astral Projection:* Jumper (World; Improved, +10%; Limited Access, -20%; Magical, -10%; Projection, Cannot affect new world, -50%) [30].

**Etherealness:** Insubstantiality (Magical, -10%) [72].

**Smoke** [38]: Affliction 1 (HT; Area Effect, 2 yards, +50%; Coughing, +20%; Drifting, +20%; Fixed Duration, +0%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Persistent, +40%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%; Respiratory Agent, +50%) [25] + Obscure Vision 3 (Defensive, +50%; Drifting, +20%; Extended, Infravision, +20%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Ranged, +50%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%) [13].

**Fire Resistance** [35]: DR 10 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Fire, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [25] + Immunity to Noxious Fire Effects [10].

**Nightmare Aura:** Affliction 1 (Will; Accessibility, Only on sapient creatures, -10%; Always On, -10%; Area Effect, 4 yards, +100%; Aura, +80%; Based on Will, +20%; Disadvantage, Nightmares (6), +10%; Extended Duration, 1,000x, +120%; Fixed Duration, +0%; Magical, -10%; Malediction 1, +100%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; No Signature, +20%; Selective Effect, +20%) [51].

**Disadvantages:** Bestial [-10]; Callous [-5]; Cannot Speak [-15]; Hidebound [-5]; Horizontal [-10]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Holy Weapons, x2) [-10]; Weak Bite [-2].

**Perks:** Unholy Touch [1].

## Nightmare, Lesser

Type: Outsider (Evil, Nightmare)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |         |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|---------|
| <b>ST</b> | 22 | <b>HP</b> | 22 | <b>SM</b>     | +1      |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 2d/4d   |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12 | <b>BL</b>     | 97 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 2d/2d+2

**Body Plan:** Quadruped (p. B553).

**Weight:** 1,500 lbs.

**Length:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

Lesser nightmares are as malevolent as their regular brethren, but possess fewer magical abilities.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 9/18; exploration 9 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 97 | 194   | 291    | 582   | 970         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 3\* (tough skin), +1 DR (feet).

**Dodge:** 11.

**Immunities:** noxious fire effects.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Vulnerabilities:** holy weapons (x2).

**Fire Resistance:** The lesser nightmare has DR 10 against fire. This includes internal and eye damage.

### Combat

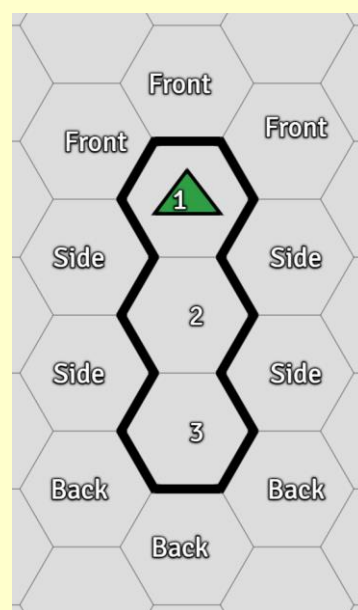
**Flaming Hooves (Front) (12):** thrust 2d+1 crushing + 1d-1 follow-up burning. Reach C-1 from hex #1.

**Flaming Hooves (Rear) (10):** thrust 2d+2 crushing + 1d-1 follow-up burning. Reach C-1 from hex #3.

**Rearing Kick (9):** thrust 2d+2 crushing + 1d-1 follow-up burning. Reach C-1 from hex #1. Can only target the upper body.

**Fangs (12):** thrust 1d-1 impaling. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the lesser nightmare may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d-2 control against larger ones.

**Smoke (13):** The lesser nightmare may fill a two-yard-radius area within 10 yards with bad smelling smoke. This gives -3 to all vision and Infravision rolls made through it. To place the cloud at a distance, it uses Innate Attack (Breath), with normal range penalties, but at +4 for



affecting an area. The initial attack roll places the effect. It then drifts from that point with the wind. Every creature that inhales the smoke, begins to cough (is at -3 to DX and -1 to IQ, and cannot use Stealth) for 3 minutes, if it fails a HT roll.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 4.85 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 48.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 11                   | 22        | 33                   | 44                 |

## Special Abilities

**Racial Telepathy (10):** Lesser nightmares are able to transmit general concepts and emotions, but not speech via magical telepathy to other nightmares. To establish contact requires one second of concentration and an IQ roll. After that, no concentration is required. The lesser nightmare can maintain multiple contacts, but the IQ roll is at a cumulative -1 per contact after the first. The roll takes penalties under *Long-Distance Modifiers* (p. B241). If the nightmare cannot see or otherwise sense the recipient, it has an additional penalty: -1 for family, lovers, or close friends; -3 for casual friends and acquaintances; or -5 for someone met only briefly.

**Unholy Touch:** A lesser nightmare's natural attacks are treated as unholy for the purpose of such disadvantages as Weakness and Vulnerability, and defenses with the Bane limitation.

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

High-Speed Movement (p. B394).

Making Things Burn (p. B433).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the lesser nightmare can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bestial; Callous; Hidebound; Sadism (12).

## Skills

Brawling-12; Innate Attack (Breath)-13; Mount-13.

## Other Traits

Extra Legs (Four Legs); Horizontal; No Fine Manipulators.

## Capturing and Training

**Young Value:** \$2,900.

**Untrained Value:** \$14,500.

**Trained Value:** \$144,700.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Horses).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.51

**Wage (Monthly):** \$4,300.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Lesser Nightmares

**Battle Rating:** 9

**Classes:** Cv.

**Features:** Night.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 72/288

**Supply (Weekly):** \$0.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$260,500.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$260,500.

## Racial Template

163 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+12 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%; Size Modifier, -10%) [60]; DX+1 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [12]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Basic Speed +0.25 [5]; Basic Move +3 [15].

**Advantages:** Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 3 (Tough Skin, -40%) [9]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Enhanced Move 1 (Ground) [20]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Fangs [2]; Hooves [3]; Infravision [10]; Telesend (Magical, -10%; Racial, -20%; Vague, -50%) [6]; Temperature Tolerance 5 (Hot) [5].

**Flaming Hooves:** Burning Attack 1d-1 (Follow-Up, Hooves, +0%; Magical, -10%) [4].

**Smoke** [38]: Affliction 1 (HT; Area Effect, 2 yards, +50%; Coughing, +20%; Drifting, +20%; Fixed Duration, +0%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Persistent, +40%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%; Respiratory Agent, +50%) [25] + Obscure Vision 3 (Defensive, +50%; Drifting, +20%; Extended, Infravision, +20%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Ranged, +50%; Reduced Range, 1/10, -30%) [13].

**Fire Resistance** [35]: DR 10 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Fire, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [25] + Immunity to Noxious Fire Effects [10].

**Disadvantages:** Bestial [-10]; Callous [-5]; Cannot Speak [-15]; Hidebound [-5]; Horizontal [-10]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Sadism (12) [-15]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Holy Weapons, x2) [-10]; Weak Bite [-2].

**Perks:** Unholy Touch [1].

# Nymph

Type: Fey



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 9  | <b>HP</b> | 9   | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-2/1d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | 10  | <b>BL</b>     | 16 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid (p. B552).

**Weight:** 130 lbs.

**Height:** 5'2".

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Transcendent (Universal) (+5 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-4. 100% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A.

Nymphs are the essence of nature's beauty and protectors of its sacred wilds. Their appearance is so stunning that it can blind those who gaze upon them. They despise evil and any actions that harm the wilderness.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 16 | 32    | 48     | 96    | 160         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Immunities:** Pressure, satyr pipes, sleep.

**Vulnerabilities:** cold iron (x2).

## Combat

Typically avoiding contact with non-fey, nymphs vigilantly guard the places they hold sacred, such as groves, pools, hilltops, or peaks. They use spells and animal allies to ward off intruders, opting for nonlethal methods first and resorting to deadly force only against malevolent beings or violent aggressors.

Nymphs favor elves, half-elves, and druids, considering them allies of nature, and are more likely to allow them to explain their presence. They are also known to assist virtuous heroes who approach them respectfully.

**Punch (12):** thrust 1d-3 crushing, Reach C.

**Dagger (13):** thrust 1d-3 impaling, Reach C.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-2 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.8 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 8 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 5                    | 9         | 14                   | 18                 |

## Special Abilities

**Animal Empathy (11):** Nymphs possess Animal Empathy (p. B40), attracting animals which sense their healing nature. Injured beasts seek their care, and the nymph can use Influence Skills on animals. The GM may roll against the nymph's IQ to determine an animal's emotional state or if it is under supernatural control.

**Blinding Beauty:** The nymph can activate this ability at will as a Concentrate maneuver. When she does so, anyone who sees her must roll Fright Check using the Awe variant table (*GURPS Powers*, p. 85). In addition, every victim within 8 yards who is looking directly at the nymph, must make a roll against HT or become permanently blind. This blindness is magical – it can be dispelled normally. Regardless of the result, the victim becomes immune to the awe aspect of this ability for one hour. If a victim *succeeds* at his Will roll to resist, he will be unaffected by the blinding aspect of this ability for one hour.

**Charisma:** Nymphs have Charisma 2 (p. B41).

**Nature Bond:** Their Nature Bond deeply ties them to the beauty of their surroundings. Any injury to a nymph mars the landscape she protects, and vice versa. Killing a nymph despoils and potentially curses her special area. Nymphs are constantly aware of the condition of their lands, regardless of distance.

**Stunning Glance (11):** The nymph can attempt to stun an enemy by locking eyes with him. Roll a Quick Contest between of Will between the nymph and her

target, penalized by the range between them. Mind Shield adds to resistance against this ability. If the nymph wins, the target suffers mental stun. On subsequent turns, he can recover normally by making an unpenalized IQ roll.

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 11          | 11    |

**Vision:** As fey, nymphs are able to see well at night. They have **Night Vision 5**.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 11 | 11   |

A nymph's demeanor is as wild and unpredictable as nature itself, combining stunning beauty with formidable danger. She can be kind and graceful to mortals who honor the wild places, yet quick to strike against those who exploit nature or treat it carelessly.

Being the embodiment of loveliness, nymphs prioritize their appearance, often adorning themselves with fragrant flowers. This care reflects their deep connection to their natural surroundings, known as their Nature Bond (see above).

**Mentality Traits:** Impulsiveness (12); Sense of Duty (Nature); Short Attention Span (12).

### Skills

First Aid/TL3-14; Knife-13; Stealth-13; Veterinary/TL3-14.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Diurnal.

**Habitat:** Nymphs possess the ability to breathe and speak underwater, although most rarely explore the depths. They typically inhabit temperate forests, glades, and valleys but can also be found in exceptionally beautiful underwater locations, undisturbed by the lack of air or water pressure.

**Sleep:** While nymphs sleep like other beings, they are immune to supernatural sleep effects.

### Society

**Language:** They have their own language but often learn the tongues of other faerie beings.

**Relationships:** In sylvan forests, unicorns act as their protectors, willing to fight to the death to defend them. Satyrs, linked to dryads and thus to the nymphs, can gaze upon them without being blinded and often pursue them playfully—nymphs, in turn, enjoy satyrs' musical talents and are immune to the magical effects of their piping.

**Reproduction:** Occasionally, woodland nymphs, inspired by men or elves who honor the land and its creatures, become enamored, inspiring poets to craft epic tales of love and longing. These romances are fleeting, as nymphs tire easily of mortal life. Yet, in rare instances, such unions result in a daughter, inheriting qualities from both parents. Some nymphs embrace their half-nymph offspring, raising them amidst nature's beauty, while others disdain the mingling of their fey blood with mortal traits, departing and leaving the child in the father's care.

### Spoils

Nymphs possess treasures often given to them by admirers, including gemstones and potions made from natural ingredients in their domain.

A typical nymph has 0.3 lbs. of hair that can be used in enchanting. Each 0.1 lb. of hair can be used as \$200 of ingredients for *potions of sleep* and *potions of long slumber* or as 1 EP when enchanting garments that grant the wearer Charisma.

### Capturing and Training

Though not suitable as soldiers or laborers, nymphs are sometimes cruelly sought after by unscrupulous individuals as pleasure slaves.

**Pleasure Slave Value:** \$50,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$2 and 3 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.032

**Wage (Monthly):** \$920

### Racial Template

214 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-1 [-10]; DX+2 [40]; IQ+1 [20].

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; Animal Empathy [5]; Blessed (The King's Two Bodies) [10]; Appearance (Transcendent; Universal, +25%) [25]; Charisma 2 [10]; Doesn't Breathe (Gills, -50%) [10]; Immunity to Sleep Effects [5]; Night Vision 5 [5]; Pressure Support 3 [15]; Speak Underwater [5].

**Blinding Beauty** [86]: Affliction 1 (HT; Area Effect, 8 yards, +150%; Disadvantage, Blindness, +50%; Emanation, -20%; Extended Duration, Permanent, +150%; Increased Immunity 2, -20%; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%; Vision-Based, +150%) [56] + Terror (Sight; Awe; Link, +10%; Magical, -10%) [30].

**Stunning Glance:** Affliction 1 (Will; Based on Will, +20%; Magical, -10%; Malediction 2, +150%; Vision-Based, -20%) [24].

**Disadvantages:** Compulsive Carousing (15) [-2]; Impulsiveness (12) [-10]; Sense of Duty (Nature) [-15]; Short Attention Span (12) [-10]; Vulnerability (Cold Iron, x2) [-10].

**Perks:** Immunity to Satyr Pipes [1].

# Ogre

*Type: Giant (Ogre)*



**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 600 lbs.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction) or Unattractive (-1 reaction) for civilized ogres.

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction). Civilized ogres have no such Social Stigma.

**Organization:** 2-20. 60% are tribesmen, 40% are barbarians. 20% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E.

Ogres are brutish giant-kin, characterized by their muscular bodies and large heads. They have black blood and skin tones ranging from dull yellow to dull brown, often with brown, black, or dirty blonde dreadlocks. While most have a single skin tone, some exhibit piebald patterns with darker bases and yellow or ivory splotches. Their clothing typically consists of poorly cured furs and hides.

Physically, ogres resemble giants, featuring a massive lean muscle mass with strong outer limbs and a wide build supported by broad pelvises. Unfamiliar humans may mistake male ogres for females due to their low hips, and their legs, short and thick like tree trunks, are adapted for their weight and rapid movement.

Ogre facial features range from mostly human-like to bestial, making many indistinguishable from extremely unattractive large humans. However, some may possess muzzles, pronounced teeth, or other notable characteristics.

## Mentality

Ogres possess a distinct psychology shaped by their immense physical presence, the ability to take what they want, and their inherent lack of intelligence. They struggle with focus, becoming easily distracted, which hinders their ability to construct anything beyond the most basic structures. Tasks requiring more than half an hour exceed their attention span.

Additionally, ogres often exhibit extreme laziness. Once they achieve their immediate goals—

such as obtaining food or driving off a threat—they rarely pursue further actions. They prefer the quickest, most dangerous solutions to problems, believing that completing a task quickly allows them to return to their habitual idleness.

Ogres are perpetually filled with unchecked anger, which drives them to seek direct solutions to obstacles. This constant rage differs from the occasional outbursts of more refined beings; ogres exhibit a nearly pathological fury with little inclination to manage it. Even venting their anger on others does not alleviate it, even when they descend into total bloodlust.

While ogres can demonstrate reasoning when pressed, they generally reach conclusions much slower than other races. It's unclear whether this slowness stems from natural limitations or the decline of their mental faculties as they mature.

These factors contribute to the chaotic and often malevolent behavior that other species observe. For instance, when encountering travelers, an ogre's first thought is not about who they are but whether he is hungry. If so, he may attack without hesitation; if not, he might simply walk away, as engaging with them would require unnecessary energy. If the travelers flee, he is unlikely to chase them.

Civilized ogres lack many of these traits of exhibit them in a milder degree.

**Typical Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Gluttony (12); Greed (15); Laziness; Short Attention Span (15).

**Typical Mentality Traits (Civilized):** Bad Temper (15); Gluttony (12).

## Ecology

**Diet:** Many believe ogres to be carnivorous, but in truth, they eat anything from fruit to humans. Civilized ogres do not eat other sapient beings.

**Habitat:** Since the early days of adventuring, ogres have inhabited cave hovels, typically isolating themselves or living in small groups. These stereotypes hold true; while they could find better accommodations, most ogres choose to live in squalor, preferring areas with easy shelter and mild weather for a lazy lifestyle. As a result, they are most commonly found in temperate hills and low mountains, thriving in temperatures between 35° and 90°F.

Ogres show little interest in basic civilization, dwelling in conditions that would shame even goblins. Their lairs fall into four categories: open camps, natural shelters, ruined shelters, and tribute shelters, with ogres only ensuring that biological waste is disposed of outside.

Open camps are simply places where ogres spread blankets and belongings, often near a spring or large

trees. They create a fire pit and lounge around until local resources are depleted before moving on. Natural shelters, such as hollow trees or caves, offer more protection, but ogres leave them in disrepair, causing damage only if provoked.

Ruined shelters are either existing ruins or the remnants of settlements from other species. Ogres occupy these locations for years or decades, taking separate sleeping spaces adorned with whatever goods remain, which quickly deteriorate. They often demand tribute from weaker species to supplement their finds.

Finally, tribute shelters are built by other races to appease ogres and avoid conflict, allowing the builders to harness the ogres' strength for their own defense. These shelters are constructed as well as possible, often supplied with food and cleaning services to manage the stench. Common builders of tribute shelters include gnomes, goblins, halflings, hobgoblins, and kobolds.

Regardless of the shelter type, all ogre camps contain only basic necessities: filthy blankets, minimal tools, and poorly prepared food stored in tattered bags. The blankets are crudely tied with hides, reflecting their lack of care for their living conditions.

Common ogres serving in mercenary armies or with more powerful giants usually reside with their employers. If placed in designated 'ogre quarters,' these spaces will quickly resemble a typical ogre lair. Otherwise, the surroundings will reflect the environment of the host race, both in appearance and smell.

**Lifespan:** Ogres can live up to 80 years, but most find a violent end of their life much earlier.

## Society

Despite appearances, ogres possess a stable and complex culture. Their laid-back approach and minimal material output make it challenging to analyze, yet their fundamental rituals and values influence all decisions made by ogres and their groups striving for greater status.

Ogre culture emerges from myths, psychology, circumstances, prejudices, and chance, resulting in seemingly contradictory elements. While ogres produce little in terms of material culture, they do have some artistic traditions that serve as echoes of past times, becoming incongruous only in the modern context.

The principles that shape ogre culture not only reinforce their thug-like reputation but also hint at an earlier, more purposeful existence. The core tenets include:

*Everything dies:* Ogres believe everything, from gods to mountains, will eventually perish. This conviction fosters a reluctance to invest in anything that is not easily replaceable.

*Freedom comes from not caring:* Recognizing that attachments will ultimately fade, ogres adopt an attitude of indifference, channeling their inherent wrath into expressions of anger towards their surroundings.

*Might makes right:* Ogre ethics have remained stagnant, centering on the belief that the strongest individual is justified in their actions. This principle shapes their family dynamics, justice system, and societal rules, making them susceptible to manipulation by ogre magi and warlords who showcase their strength.

**Arts and Crafts:** Ogres have a weak artistic and craft tradition, relying on what little they know about creating material goods—much of which they have learned or stolen from other cultures. Their weapons, armor, clothes, and tools often appear either crudely made or sourced externally.

Despite this lack of artistic output, ogres express their limited creativity through shoulder bags and wooden figurines. Whether these traditions stem from recent exposure or long-standing cultural survival is a matter of scholarly debate.

Many ogres have adopted the giant custom of carrying large leather shoulder bags filled with possessions. Unlike giants, ogres decorate these bags with various trinkets; a young ogre's bag is usually plain, but older ones accumulate an assortment of items, such as oddly shaped bones and ancient coins. Ogres attach these decorations with leather cords and bone needles, and some obsessively rearrange them for visual and auditory appeal.

Ogres also engage in a modest woodcarving tradition, primarily whittling, as they lack the patience for larger projects. Most ogres attempt this craft, though only a few have the discipline for prolonged work. This results in a collection of crude figurines in their bags, with a handful showcasing some artistic merit.

Common subjects for these figurines include ogres, natural objects like trees and rocks, animals, and occasionally other races. Even the most intricate carvings adopt a minimalistic style, favoring evocative features over realism. For instance, a tree figurine may initially resemble a small mushroom, with abstract lines representing branches and leaves only becoming clear upon closer inspection.

**Birth and Death:** Birth and death are the most significant transitions in an ogre's life. Birth marks the start of an ogre's struggle, while death represents their final act. Consequently, ogres value the quality of childbirth and the dignity of a warrior's death.

Ogre females typically carry two to four offspring, with pregnancies lasting six to eight months, influenced by food availability. A plentiful

food supply accelerates growth, while scarcity can prolong gestation or lead to termination.

About half of ogre infants are stillborn, while those who survive are helpless at birth but can walk within two months, consuming large amounts of meat. When a child reaches walking age, the ogre band celebrates for a day, where the mother names the child, and the father gifts a shoulder bag, marking the child's transition to a full, albeit weak, member of the band.

Ogres also observe important customs surrounding death. Three days post-death, the band dedicates a day to consume available food. If the ogre died in battle, they eat his body and those of his enemies; if from natural causes, they gather food near the death site. Although the origin of these customs is unknown, ogres acknowledge their significance.

**Names:** Ogre names consist of simple, abstract sounds, with each ogre having one given name. Throughout their lives, they may acquire additional descriptive names based on jokes, accomplishments, or personal preferences. However, they always respond to their given names, regardless of any preferred alternatives.

**Religion and Rituals:** Ogres worship a small array of deities. Savage ogres commonly revere Vaprak the Destroyer, shared with trolls. Civilized ogres favor Mirkalak the Orcslayer and Ysshara the Lorekeeper. Some savage ogres even view true giants as divine.

**Relationships:** Ogres maintain minimal family ties, recognizing immediate family members but little beyond that. Dominance is established through physical power, and parental bonds dissolve by adulthood. Beyond family, ogre relationships are about dominance, either as master/servant or as peers vying for power. Traditional friendships are rare, and sexual encounters are seen as dominance displays rather than for pleasure. Parenthood results when offspring arise, leading to complex family structures.

**Relations with Other Races:** Ogres often associate with goblinoids, orcs, and trolls. Within the giant hierarchy, they are at the bottom and often serve hill giants or verbeeg, sometimes as traders. They also work as mercenaries, alongside verbeeg or as guards for hags, and can be polymorphed into spies.

**Tribute and Slaves:** Ogres believe in offering tributes to stronger entities as a way to avoid harm and improve their living conditions. This custom can lead to unusual situations, such as ogres offering gifts to more dominant giants or receiving tribute from creatures like kobolds. Ogres give little thought to selecting tributes, offering whatever is at hand. Scholars debate whether tribute giving is a form of primitive social organization or a relic of the past, contrasting their typical aggressive behavior.

**Lands:** Ogres were not always as barbaric as they are today. In the past, the ancient civilization of Tor-Kan thrived on the continent of Aventan before it fell due to a planar incursion. The remnant of this civilization, Ronad, is home to civilized ogres who live apart from their savage relatives. Unlike their tribal cousins, Ronadian ogres have built cities, constructed ships, and engage in trade, demonstrating sophistication comparable to humans. They value physical strength and martial skill, often enjoying arena fights where gladiators, adventurers, or enslaved individuals battle each other or exotic beasts. Ronadians place great importance on religion, believing that their reverence for the ogre pantheon differentiates them from their tribal counterparts.

In Northern Aril, within the nation of Gaessalion, ogres live under the subjugation of high elves, who forced them to adopt a more civilized lifestyle. While these ogres are not as sophisticated as those in Ronad, they are still more advanced than the savage ogres.

Despite these instances of civilization, the majority of ogres in Karilan remain barbaric, focused on pillaging and destroying towns and cities.

## Racial Template

-22 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+6 (Size Modifier, -10%) [54]; DX-1 [-20]; IQ-1 [-20]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM+1; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** DR 2 (Tough Skin, -40%) [6]; Infravision [10]; Reduced Consumption 3 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [3].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Ugly) [-8]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Greed (15) [-7]; Laziness [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Short Attention Span (15) [-5]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10].

The template above should be used for savage ogres. Civilized ogres have higher intelligence and fewer or less severe disadvantages. It is suggested to use the following template for such characters.

57 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+6 (Size Modifier, -10%) [54]; DX-1 [-20]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM+1; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** DR 2 (Tough Skin, -40%) [6]; Infravision [10]; Reduced Consumption 3 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [3].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Unattractive) [-4]; Bad Temper (15) [-5]; Gluttony (15) [-2].

# Ogre Tribesman

Type: Giant (Ogre)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |           |
|----|----|----|----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 16 | HP | 16 | SM     | +1        |
| DX | 9  | BS | 5  | thr/sw | 1d+1/2d+2 |
| HT | 11 | FP | 11 | BL     | 51 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+1/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 600 lb.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

This typical savage ogre only has basic weapon training but is in no way a combat veteran.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 51 | 102   | 153    | 306   | 510         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8U (small mace); 8 (javelin); 7 (unarmed).

## Combat

Ogres favor overwhelming odds, sneak attacks, and ambushes over a fair fight. They are intelligent enough to fire ranged weapons first to soften up their foes before closing, but ogre gangs and bands fight as unorganized individuals.

**SM+1 Small Mace (10):** swing 3d+1 crushing (RS: 2d+2), Reach 1, unbalanced, 6.75 lbs.

**SM+1 Javelin throw (10):** thrust 2d-1 impaling, Acc 3, x1.5/x2.5 (24/40), 4.5 lbs., Bulk -4.

**SM+1 Javelin thrust (10):** thrust 2d-1 impaling, Reach 1, 4.5 lbs.

**Punch (9):** thrust 1d crushing, Reach C-1.

**Grapple (9):** thrust 1d+1 control, Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.55 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 25.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 8                    | 16        | 24                   | 32                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (Pyramid #3-77, pp. 4-5).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 9   | 9      | 9       | 9           | 9     |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the ogre can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 9    |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Gluttony (12); Greed (15); Laziness; Short Attention Span (15).

## Skills

Axe/Mace-10; Spear-10; Throwing Weapon (Spear)-10.

## Spoils

**Treasure Type:** A.

## Capturing and Training

Ogres can often be seen cooperating with other savage humanoids, such as orcs, or serve as mercenaries for true giants.

**Young Value:** \$320.

**Untrained Value:** \$1,580.

**Trained Value:** \$15,800.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.9 and 6.8 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.016

**Wage (Monthly):** \$475

## Mass Combat Statistics

**60 Ogre Tribesmen**

**Battle Rating:** 1

**Classes:** None.  
**Features:** Night.  
**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 24/96  
**Supply (Weekly):** \$480.  
**Wage (Monthly):** \$28,500.  
**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$2,000.  
**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$32,430.

## Ogre Barbarian

*Type: Giant (Ogre)*



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |         |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|---------|
| <b>ST</b> | 18 | <b>HP</b> | 18  | <b>SM</b>     | +1      |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+2/3d |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12  | <b>BL</b>     | 65 lbs. |

*Reduced Swing: 1d+2/2d*

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.  
**Weight:** 600 lb.  
**Height:** 9 ft.  
**Effective Height:** 9 ft.  
**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).  
**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).  
 This typical savage ogre only has basic weapon training but is in no way a combat veteran.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 65 | 130   | 195    | 390   | 650         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2\* (tough skin).  
**Dodge:** 9.  
**Parry:** 10U (round mace); 10 (javelin); 9 (unarmed).

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

### Combat

Marginally more intelligent than his brutish fellows, an ogre barbarian is slightly more likely to enter a fair fight, but in general prefers the brutish tactics common to all its kind. It should be noted that ogre barbarians have **Berserk (12)** (p. B124).

**SM+1 Round Mace (12):** swing 4d-1 crushing (RS: 3d-1), Reach 1, unbalanced, 11.25 lbs.

**SM+1 Javelin throw (12):** thrust 2d impaling, Acc 3, x1.5/x2.5 (27/45), 4.5 lbs., Bulk -4.

**SM+1 Javelin thrust (12):** thrust 2d impaling, Reach 1, 4.5 lbs.

**Punch (10):** thrust 1d+1 crushing, Reach C-1.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 1d+2 control, Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 3.25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 32.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 9                    | 18        | 27                   | 36                 |

### Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 9   | 9      | 9       | 9           | 9     |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the ogre can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 9    |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Gluttony (12); Greed (15); Laziness; Short Attention Span (15).

### Skills

Axe/Mace-12; Spear-12; Stealth-10; Survival (Plains)-12; Throwing Weapon (Spear)-12.

### Spoils

**Treasure Type:** A.

### Capturing and Training

Ogres can often be seen cooperating with other savage humanoids, such as orcs, or serve as mercenaries for true giants.

**Young Value:** \$320.

**Untrained Value:** \$1,580.

**Trained Value:** \$30,370.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.9 and 6.8 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.032

**Wage (Monthly):** \$900

## **Mass Combat Statistics**

### **60 Ogre Barbarians**

*Battle Rating:* 2

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Impetuous, Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$480.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$54,660.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$58,600.

# Ogre, Merrow

Type: Giant (Ogre)



**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 600 lbs.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-20. 20% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E.

Merrow, or aquatic ogres, are a breed of ogre adapted to aquatic environments. Freshwater merrow are more violent and agile than their land counterparts, featuring green, scaled skin, green eyes, slimy seaweed-green hair, underbites, webbed hands and feet, and long, thick necks. One in ten possesses ivory horns, particularly among powerful males. They enjoy tattooing their bodies, with females often adorned in images of death and destruction.

## Mentality

Like savage ogres, merrow are not very intelligent, but they are highly aggressive, greedy, and lazy.

**Typical Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Gluttony (12); Greed (15); Laziness; Short Attention Span (15).

## Ecology

**Aquatic:** Merrow are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. They can breathe water but cannot breathe air. Merrow are able to speak underwater.

**Diet:** Unlike the omnivorous common ogres, merrow are carnivorous, preying on anything from fish to fishermen.

**Habitat:** Merrow thrive in freshwater environments, preferring temperatures between 35° and 90°F. While they lack basic hygiene, their aquatic habitat prevents filth from accumulating excessively.

Merrow can survive at pressures up to 100 atmospheres. This lets them live comfortably at a depth up to 1,100 yards, but they prefer depths between 100 and 200 yards.

Merrow typically establish lairs in secluded areas on the river or lake bottoms, underwater crevices, or the remains of wrecked boats. They rarely modify these shelters but often gather flotsam and discarded junk from their environment, particularly if near an active city. As a result, their lairs can be quite cluttered. Unlike common ogres, merrow create more stable homes, moving only due to calamity, seasonal changes, pollution, or stronger forces. Some river folk interpret merrow movements as omens of danger or the approach of winter.

**Lifespan:** Merrow can live up to 160 years, but most find a violent end of their life much earlier. They reach maturity at the age of 18 years.

## Society

Merrow share most of the cultural and psychological traits of their common ogre cousins. Merrow territories usually encompass an area with a radius between 10 and 15 miles. A chieftain rules the tribe, and his power-hungry orders dictate the life of the members.

## Racial Template

-2 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+6 (Size Modifier, -10%) [54]; DX-1 [-20]; IQ-1 [-20]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM+1; Basic Move +2 [10].

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; DR 2 (Tough Skin, -40%) [6]; Extended Lifespan 1 [2]; Infravision [10]; Nictitating Membrane 1 [1]; Pressure Support 2 [10]; Reduced Consumption 3 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [3]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Speak Underwater [5].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Ugly) [-8]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Greed (15) [-7]; Laziness [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Short Attention Span (15) [-5]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10]; Weakness (Immersion in saline water, 1d per 30 minutes) [-5].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Features:** Doesn't Breathe (Gills); Early Maturation 1.

## Merrow Warrior

Type: Giant (Ogre)



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |           |
|----|----|----|----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 16 | HP | 16 | SM     | +1        |
| DX | 9  | BS | 5  | thr/sw | 1d+1/2d+2 |
| HT | 11 | FP | 11 | BL     | 51 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+1/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 600 lb.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

This merrow warrior only has basic weapon training but is in no way a combat veteran.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 51 | 102   | 153    | 306   | 510         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2\* (tough skin), eyes are protected by DR 1.

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8 (long spear); 8 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** sunburn.

**Resistances:** +1 to all HT rolls concerned with eye damage.

**Weaknesses:** immersion in saline water (1d HP per 30 minutes).

### Combat

When underwater, the merrow prefer to use their hands to grapple and teeth to bite. During the very short surface forays, they employ long spears.

**SM+1 Long Spear thrust (one-handed) (11):** thrust 2d+1 impaling, Reach 3-4\*, unbalanced, 11.25 lbs.

**SM+1 Long Spear thrust (two-handed) (11):** thrust 2d+2 impaling, Reach 3-4\*, 11.25 lbs.

**Sharp Teeth (11):** thrust 1d+1 cutting, Reach C. If the attack hits, the merrow may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+2 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d control against larger ones.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d+1 crushing, Reach C-1.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d+2 control, Reach C-1. Effective ST 18 due to knowing Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.55 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 25.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 9                    | 18        | 27                   | 36                 |

### Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Teeth (p. MA115).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid* #3-26, pp. 7-8).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 9   | 9      | 9       | 9           | 9     |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the merrow can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 9    |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Gluttony (12); Greed (15); Laziness; Short Attention Span (15).

### Skills

Brawling-11; Spear-11; Wrestling-11.

### Spoils

**Treasure Type:** A.

### Capturing and Training

Merrow can be found serving as enforcers for freshwater hags and other evil aquatic beings.

**Young Value:** \$310.

**Untrained Value:** \$1,550.

**Trained Value:** \$15,500.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.9 and 6.8 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.016

**Wage (Monthly):** \$465

## **Mass Combat Statistics**

**60 Merrow Warriors**

*Battle Rating:* 1

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$480.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$28,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$31,850.

## Shadow

Type: Undead



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |   |        |        |
|----|----|----|---|--------|--------|
| ST | 0  | HP | 8 | SM     | +0     |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5 | thr/sw | -      |
| HT | 10 | FP | - | BL     | 0 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d-3/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 0 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-20. 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** C.

Shadows are sentient entities of darkness with a deep-seated loathing for both life and light. Their touch imparts a harrowing coldness akin to being wiped from existence, making them formidable foes. Within dim or shadowy spaces, they are difficult to discern, but in well-lit areas, they become glaringly apparent. Shadows are incapable of coherent speech.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

**Air:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour. The flight is magical in nature, and thus does not function in areas with no mana. In low mana areas, the speed decreases to Move 2. In high mana area, the speed increases to Move 7.

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Injury Resistance:** Decrease injury received by the shadow by 2, and only then apply the injury cap (see *Diffuse* below).

**Immunities:** knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture, pressure, vacuum.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (Diffuse; No Eyes).

**Weaknesses:** Being a creature of darkness, the shadow is harmed by sunlight, taking 1d injury per minute. This injury is not reduced by Injury Resistance (see above) and is not subject to the injury cap (see *Diffuse* below).

Shadows are *tenuous*. Even though the shadow is immune to stun and crippling injuries, if it receives more than HP/2 injury from an explosive attack, it must make an HT roll. If it fails it by 5 or more or rolls a critical failure, the shadow is dispersed and destroyed, instantly reduced to -10xHP.

As an undead creature, the shadow is destroyed when it reaches 0 HP.

The shadows have a vulnerability to silkstone – a fibrous variety of quartz similar to tiger eye. If a shadow is touched by silkstone, it must immediately make a HT roll or take a -5 penalty to all skills and attributes for the next 10 minutes.

### Combat

Shadows lurk in dark places, waiting for living prey to happen by. When facing an unliving enemy that it cannot harm, it will simply flee.

**Strength Drain (10):** thrust 1d-1 toxic damage, Reach C. To affect the victim, the shadow must touch bare skin. The touch of a shadow drains strength from living beings. Anyone struck by the shadow must make a roll against HT or take a *cumulative* -2 penalty to ST for margin of failure minutes.

### Special Abilities

**Create Spawn:** Any living creature that has been killed by the shadow rises as a shadow in 1d minutes under control of its slayer (it gains Slave Mentality). If the shadow is a player character, the character must have enough unspent points to buy the victim as an Ally, or else the newly risen shadow will not be under his control. If the shadow is an NPC, the GM may want to waive this requirement.

**Diffuse:** The shadow is a diffuse being. It cannot manipulate objects, slam, overrun, trample, or grapple, and it cannot be grappled either. Others may move through a shadow without the need to evade and vice versa. Slams against a shadow deal normal damage, subject to the injury cap described below, but do not cause knockback and cannot knock down the

shadow or its opponent. The shadow provides no Cover DR for the purpose of overpenetration.

The shadow slip through tiny cracks. If it encounters an immobilized living opponent, it can permeate its clothing in two seconds or chinks in armor in five seconds to ignore its DR.

The shadow is immune to knockback, unless it was caused by an area-effect, cone, jet, or explosive attack.

Due to being diffuse, the shadow is hard to damage and is immune to crippling injuries. Subtract 2 from injury received by the elemental and then cap the remaining injury. Impaling, piercing, and tight-beam burning attacks never do more than 1 HP of injury, and other attacks can never do more than 2 HP of injury with the exception of area-effect, cone, and explosion attacks that deal normal injury.

If a creature attacks the shadow while standing in a hex occupied by the shadow, and all adjacent hexes also are occupied by the shadow, the hit is automatic, and no active defense is allowed.

In addition, the shadow has no blood, no vitals, no brain, no face, no skull, no neck, and no eyes – it's a uniform being with no vulnerable hit locations. Ignore any location-based injury multipliers and knockdown modifiers.

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | -           | -     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the shadow has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 7  | 8    |

Inherently hostile, shadows are natural adversaries to all living things, displaying aggressive predatory behavior. They are quick to attack and can swiftly overpower those who are ill-prepared. Generally lacking in creativity, shadows typically remain in one location unless commanded by a more dominant undead or given direct orders, only becoming active when provoked or disturbed.

**Mentality Traits:** Hidebound; Intolerance (Living).

## Skills

None.

## Other Traits

No Manipulators; No Mouth.

## Ecology

**Diet:** Even though the shadow does not require sustenance, it experiences an uncontrollable craving for life force. When encountering a living creature, the shadow must roll against 9 to resist attacking it and draining its strength.

**Habitat:** Shadows deplete the vigor of the living to quench their dark cravings and fulfill their eternal longing to influence the material world. Death caused by a shadow turns the victim into another such creature, leading to areas afflicted by shadows becoming deserted ruins or quickly deteriorating once they are overrun. These newly formed shadows relentlessly pursue other living entities, propagating their numbers until survivors either escape or succumb to transformation. This cycle leaves such places desolate, deterring newcomers and ensuring shadows that remain are starved for prey when opportunity arises.

Fortunately for the living, shadows tend to remain close to their initial manifestation points. As beings of darkness, they abhor direct sunlight and open areas. Thus, a shadow-infested location might be near a populated area, yet the shadows typically prey on solitary travelers or those ignorant of the danger. Their proclivity for dark enclaves provides a strategic advantage for adventurers.

**Origin:** Shadows typically emerge from the souls of morally corrupt yet uninspired wrongdoers—those whose misdeeds are severe but lack the intense fury characteristic of a spectre or the delight in malevolence typical of wraiths. Examples include a bandit who coldly cuts throats out of convenience, a minor official who initiates a witch burning to obscure his extramarital activities, or a stingy headmaster who neglects starving orphans to save money. Although shadows can spontaneously originate from such individuals, most are created through magical means. Necromancers, recognizing the utility of these compliant and unambitious undead servants, frequently bring them into existence using the *create undead* spell or through the life-draining actions of other similarly conjured shadows.

**Society:** Shadows display minimal intelligence and thus have a simplistic societal structure based entirely on power dynamics. Stronger shadows dominate and control the weaker ones (often those they have spawned), who then command their own offspring, creating a chain of command with the most

potent shadow at the top overseeing a hierarchy of subordinates.

**Undead:** As undead creatures, shadows do not need food, water, sleep, air, or experience aging. They are immune to metabolic hazards, atmospheric pressure changes, and vacuums. Shadows do not possess a FP score, cannot naturally heal HP, and are unable to reproduce sexually.

## Spoils

Upon defeat, a shadow vanishes without leaving a corpse or any physical remains. They do not accumulate wealth or carry equipment, although they may retain some personal items from their living days.

## Capturing and Training

Some necromancers can summon or command shadows, utilizing them as reconnaissance agents or combatants within armies of the undead.

**Untrained Value:** \$1,450.

**Trained Value:** \$14,500.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.015

**Wage (Monthly):** \$435

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Shadows

*Battle Rating:* 2

*Classes:* Air.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80 (air or land)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$52,170.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$52,170.

## Racial Template

The following racial template represents a human-shaped shadow. It can be applied as a lens to another racial template to simulate shadows risen from non-human beings.

*-64 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-100 [-100]; IQ-3 [-60].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** HP+8 [16]; Will+1 [5]; Per+4 [20].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Dominance (Fatal Beating, -40%; No Onset Time, +50%) [22]; Flight (Magical, -10%; Slow, -25%) [26]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (Diffuse; Infiltration, +40%) [140]; Injury Tolerance (No Eyes) [5]; Pressure Support 3 [15]; Unaging [15]; Vacuum Support [5].

**Strength Drain** [48]: Affliction 1 (HT; Attribute Penalty, ST-2, +10%; Cumulative, +400%; Follow-Up, Toxic Attack, -30%; Magical, -10%) [47] + Toxic Attack 1d-1 (Contact Agent, -30%; Magical, -10%; Melee Attack, Reach C, Cannot Parry, -35%) [1].

**Disadvantages:** Cannot Speak [-15]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Hidebound [-5]; Intolerance (Living) [-10]; No Manipulators [-50]; No Mouth [-4]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Revulsion (Silkstone) [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Tenuous [-15]; Uncontrollable Appetite (9) (Strength Drain) [-22]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Weakness (Sunlight; 1d per minute) [-60]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue; Sterile; Taboo Trait (Fixed ST).

## Shadow, Greater

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |        |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|--------|
| <b>ST</b> | 0  | <b>HP</b> | 12 | <b>SM</b>     | +0     |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5  | <b>thr/sw</b> | -      |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | -  | <b>BL</b>     | 0 lbs. |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-1/1d+1

**Organization:** 2-20. 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** C.

Greater shadow is a rare, stronger variant of the regular shadow. Most of the statistics remain the same, only the changed ones are listed below.

## Combat

**Strength Drain (10):** thrust 1d+1 toxic damage, Reach C. To affect the victim, the greater shadow must touch bare skin. The touch of a shadow drains strength from living beings. Anyone struck by the greater shadow must make a roll against HT or take a *cumulative* -2 penalty to ST for margin of failure minutes.

## Capturing and Training

**Untrained Value:** \$2,175.

**Trained Value:** \$21,740.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.023

**Wage (Monthly):** \$650

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Greater Shadows

*Battle Rating:* 2.5

*Classes:* Air.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80 (air or land)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$78,250.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$78,250.

## Racial Template

*-55 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-100 [-100]; IQ-3 [-60].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** HP+12 [24]; Will+1 [5]; Per+4 [20].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Dominance (Fatal Beating, -40%; No Onset Time, +50%) [22]; Flight (Magical, -10%; Slow, -25%) [26]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (Diffuse; Infiltration, +40%) [140]; Injury Tolerance (No Eyes) [5]; Pressure Support 3 [15]; Unaging [15]; Vacuum Support [5].

**Strength Drain** [49]: Affliction 1 (HT; Attribute Penalty, ST-2, +10%; Cumulative, +400%; Follow-Up, Toxic Attack, -30%; Magical, -10%) [47] + Toxic Attack 1d+1 (Contact Agent, -30%; Magical, -10%; Melee Attack, Reach C, Cannot Parry, -35%) [2].

**Disadvantages:** Cannot Speak [-15]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Hidebound [-5]; Intolerance (Living) [-10]; No Manipulators [-50]; No Mouth [-4]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Revulsion (Silkstone) [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Tenuous [-15]; Uncontrollable Appetite (9) (Strength Drain) [-22]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Weakness (Sunlight; 1d per minute) [-60]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue; Sterile; Taboo Trait (Fixed ST).

## Shadow Creature (Lens)

Shadow creatures, also known as umbrimals, inhabit the Plane of Shadow, occasionally crossing into other dimensions where boundaries are thin. They resemble warped versions of Material Plane beings, sharing a superficial likeness. These creatures are darker, more elusive, and spookier, primarily in shades of gray and black, with white and yellow being rare. It is important not to confuse them with undead shadows. Moreover, other native creatures, like the shadow mastiff, have varying connections to shadow energies and do not fit this description.

### Ecology

**Habitat:** Shadow creatures, as their name implies, inhabit the Plane of Shadow. Shadow creatures have the lower boundary of their temperature comfort zone extended by 5xHT degrees.

### Lens

*204 points*

**Applicable to:** Any corporeal aberration, animal, deathless, dragon, fey, fungus, giant, humanoid, magical beast, monstrous humanoid, plant, undead, or vermin.

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Basic Speed +1.00 [20]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Regeneration (Regular) [25]; Silence 3 [15]; Temperature Tolerance 5 (Cold) [5].

*Blend into Shadows:* Invisibility (Accessibility, Only in shadowy illumination, -30%; Affects Machines, +50%; Costs Fatigue, 1 FP, -5%; Dispels after an attack, -20%; Magical, -10%) [34].

*Cold Resistance* [35]: DR 10 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Cold, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [25] + Immunity to Noxious Cold Effects [10].

*Shadow Jump:* Jumper (Planar; Accessibility, Only on the Plane of Shadow and planes that border it, -5%; Limited Access, Plane of Shadow, -20%; Magical, -10%; Takes Recharge, 5 seconds, -10%) [55].

**Disadvantages:** Weakness (1d per 30 minutes; Sunlight) [-15].

## Shadow Choker

Type: Aberration (Choker)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 7  | <b>HP</b> | 7  | <b>SM</b>     | -1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 10 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12 | <b>BL</b>     | 9.8 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-3/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 35 lbs.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 3 ft. when horizontal and 4.5 ft. when upright.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 10% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A.

A shadow choker is a cavern choker native to the Plane of Shadow. It looks like a creature of oily, liquid shadow in the form of its regular counterpart.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 10; exploration 5 miles per hour.

Typically, the shadow choker moves on all four limbs, but it is able to awkwardly walk upright with Move 6. While upright, the shadow choker can use both forearms to attack and parry. Its effective height for the purpose of combat modifiers becomes 4.5 ft.

Shadow chokers with DX 12 or more can carry a small object or two while walking.

The shadow choker can **move and fight unimpeded on uneven surfaces**.

**Clinging:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour. The shadow choker can walk on walls and ceilings as per Clinging (p. B43).

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 9.8 | 19.6  | 29.4   | 58.8  | 98          |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 14.

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** noxious cold effects.

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Cold Resistance:** Shadow chokers have DR 10 against cold. This includes internal and eye damage.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Weaknesses:** Being a creature of darkness, the shadow choker is harmed by sunlight, taking 1d injury per 30 minutes.

### Combat

A shadow choker typically strikes from the shadows using its Blend into Shadows ability.

**Claws (14):** thrust 1d-3 cutting. Reach C or C-1 when the arms are fully stretched out.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C or C-1 when the arms are fully stretched out. The shadow choker can actively constrict grappled victims, attacking them each turn with a Constriction Attack (p. B43). Effective ST 9 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.49 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 4.9 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 1                           | 5                           | 9                | 14                          | 18                        |

### Special Abilities

**Blend into Shadows:** In any condition of illumination that imposes a -5 penalty to Vision or worse, a shadow choker can disappear into the shadows, becoming invisible. This gives it a +9 bonus to Stealth in any situation where being seen would matter. Invisibility of this kind only works against electromagnetic vision (which encompasses ordinary vision, Infravision, Ultravision, and radar). The shadow choker does not cast a shadow and doesn't show up in mirrors when invisible. Each minute of use costs 1 FP.

This effect ends if the shadow choker attacks any other creature. For purposes of this ability, an attack includes any spell targeting a foe or whose area or effect includes a foe. Exactly who is a foe depends on the invisible creature's perceptions. Actions directed at unattended objects do not break the effect. Causing harm indirectly is not an attack. Thus, an invisible being can open doors, talk, eat, climb stairs, summon monsters and have them attack, cut the ropes holding a rope bridge while enemies are on the bridge, remotely trigger traps, open a portcullis to release attack dogs, and so forth. If the shadow choker attacks directly, however, it immediately becomes visible.

**Double-Jointed:** Notably flexible, shadow chokers get +5 on Climbing, Erotic Art, and Escape rolls, and can ignore up to -5 penalties for working in close quarters.

**Flexible Arms:** The shadow choker's arms are extra-flexible. They can always reach and work with other limbs, regardless of body positioning, general layout, or "right" and "left." In addition, the shadow choker may stretch them out, increasing their effective SM by 1 per second, up to the maximum of SM+1. Decreasing the length of arms back to their natural state also takes 1 second per SM. When fully stretched, the arms of the shadow choker's let it attack and grapple at Reach 1, but are attacked at +2. This does *not* increase the general SM of the shadow choker.

**Good Grip:** The cartilaginous protrusions on the shadow choker's palms are excellent gripping surfaces. The shadow choker has +4 with tasks that require a firm grip, including climbing and grappling.

**Regeneration:** Shadow chokers automatically recover 1 HP per hour.

**Shadow Jump (7):** A shadow choker can slip into the Plane of Shadows from the Material Plane and the other way around as per Jumper (p. B64). After using this ability, it cannot reactivate it for 5 seconds.

**Silent Movement:** Shadow chokers get +6 to Stealth when perfectly motionless, or +3 if moving. This only helps against hearing-based detection attempts.

**Slipperiness:** The shadow choker has +1 on all ST, DX, and Escape rolls to slip restraints, break free in close combat, or squeeze through narrow openings. If using FDG, this gives Control DR 1 and +1 to DX when attacking to break free of an existing grapple.

### Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).
- Visibility (p. B394).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 10          | 10    |

**Vision:** Shadow chokers have **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 7  | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Callous; Cowardice (12); Gluttony (12); Greed (12); Loner (12).

### Skills

Brawling-14; Stealth-15; Survival (Plane of Shadow)-14; Wrestling-14.

### Techniques

Choke Hold-14.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Night.

**Habitat:** Shadow chokers dwell on the Plane of Shadow, preferring the Shadowdark, thriving in temperatures between -25° and 90°F.

### Spoils

Shadow chokers themselves do not offer valuable parts, but their lairs may contain gems, coins, and trinkets looted from their prey.

### Capturing and Training

Some Shadowdark creatures may capture and tame shadow chokers to use them as guardians or trackers.

**Young Value:** \$450.

**Untrained Value:** \$2,200.

**Trained Value:** \$22,380.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.0006 and 0.003 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.023

**Wage (Monthly):** \$670

### Mass Combat Statistics

#### 120 Shadow Chokers

**Battle Rating:** 3

**Classes:** Recon.

**Features:** Night, Terrain (Underground).

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 32/128

**Supply (Weekly):** \$30.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$80,600.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$80,720.

## Racial Template

267 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-3 [-30]; DX+1 [20]; IQ-3 [-60]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-1; Basic Speed +4.25 [85]; Will+3 [15]; Per+3 [15].

**Advantages:** Clinging [20]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Constriction Attack [15]; Dark Vision [25]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Double-Jointed [15]; Extra-Flexible Arms [10]; Good Grip 2 [10]; Reduced Consumption 3 [6]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Regeneration (Regular) [25]; Sharp Claws [5]; Silence 3 [15]; Slippery 1 [2]; Stretching 2 (Limited, Arms Only, -20%) [10]; Temperature Tolerance 5 (Cold) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Uneven) [5].

*Blend into Shadows:* Invisibility (Accessibility, Only in shadowy illumination, -30%; Affects Machines, +50%; Costs Fatigue, 1 FP, -5%; Dispels after an attack, -20%; Magical, -10%) [34].

*Cold Resistance* [35]: DR 10 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Cold, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [25] + Immunity to Noxious Cold Effects [10].

*Shadow Jump:* Jumper (Planar; Accessibility, Only on the Plane of Shadow and planes that border it, -5%; Limited Access, Plane of Shadow, -20%; Magical, -10%; Takes Recharge, 5 seconds, -10%) [55].

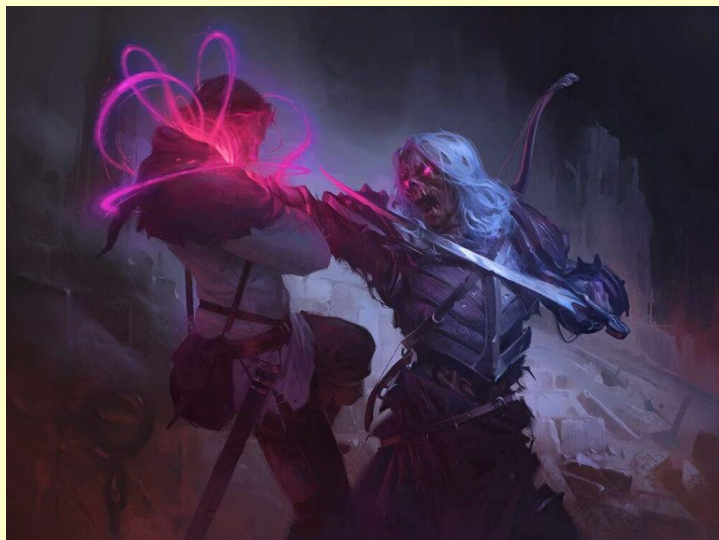
**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Ugly) [-8]; Callous [-5]; Cowardice (12) [-10]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Greed (12) [-15]; Loner (12) [-5]; Odious Personal Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Semi-Upright [-5]; Short Lifespan 1 [-10]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Weakness (1d per 30 minutes; Sunlight) [-15].

**Quirks:** Likes shiny things [-1]; Prefers meat to other food [-1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 2.

# Shadow Wight

Type: Undead



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |     |        |           |
|----|----|----|-----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 12 | HP | 16  | SM     | +0        |
| DX | 12 | BS | 6.5 | thr/sw | 1d-1/1d+2 |
| HT | 10 | FP | -   | BL     | 29 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-1/1d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-16. 70% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A (individual), F.

A shadow wight is a regular wight infused with the ambient energies of the Plane of Shadow.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 29 | 58    | 87     | 174   | 290         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 9.

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** knockdown, metabolic hazards, noxious cold effects, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Cold Resistance:** Shadow wights have DR 10 against cold. This includes internal and eye damage.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** As an undead creature, the shadow wight is destroyed when it reaches 0 HP.

When exposed to light bright enough to cause illumination penalty of -3 to 0, the shadow wight must roll against HT every second. On a failure, it gets -1 to DX, IQ, Per, and skill rolls (but *not* Will or active defense rolls) until it leaves the illuminated area.

Being a creature of darkness, the shadow wight is harmed by sunlight, taking 1d injury per 30 minutes.

**Notes:** A shadow wight's eyes emit a dim glow. Reduce the darkness penalties to hit the eyes by -2.

## Combat

Shadow wights drain life with a touch, even through clothing or armor, often lurking in shadows to ambush unsuspecting prey.

**Sharp Teeth (14):** thrust 1d-1 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the shadow wight may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-2 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 1d-1 cutting. Reach C.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d control. Reach C. Effective ST 14 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.45 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 14.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 7                    | 14        | 21                   | 28                 |

## Special Abilities

**Blend into Shadows:** In any condition of illumination that imposes a -5 penalty to Vision or worse, a shadow wight can disappear into the shadows, becoming invisible. This gives it a +9 bonus to Stealth in any situation where being seen would matter. Invisibility of this kind only works against electromagnetic vision (which encompasses ordinary vision, Infravision, Ultravision, and radar). The shadow wight does not cast a shadow and doesn't show up in mirrors when invisible. Each minute of use costs 1 FP.

This effect ends if the shadow wight attacks any other creature. For purposes of this ability, an attack includes any spell targeting a foe or whose area or effect includes a foe. Exactly who is a foe depends on the invisible creature's perceptions. Actions directed at unattended objects do not break the effect. Causing harm indirectly is not an attack. Thus, an invisible being can open doors, talk, eat, climb stairs, summon monsters and have them attack, cut the ropes holding a rope bridge while enemies are on the bridge, remotely trigger traps, open a portcullis to release attack dogs, and so forth. If the shadow wight attacks directly, however, it immediately becomes visible.

**Create Spawn:** When a shadow wight kills a living creature, roll 3d. On 1-14, the creature rises after 1d minutes as a zombie under the shadow wight's control; on 15-17, it rises as a shadow wight; on a 18, it rises as a shadow half-wight. They do not possess any of the abilities they had in life. Player character shadow wights must be able to buy these risen zombies and shadow wights as Allies to be able to control them. You may ignore this for NPC shadow wights.

**Energy Drain:** While maintaining ongoing contact (grappling, for example), the shadow wight can take an Attack maneuver to drain 3 HP from the victim, while healing 1 HP per each stolen HP.

**Energy Reserve:** The shadow wight has ER 4 that it can use to power magical abilities, particularly Blend into Shadows.

**Shadow Jump (10):** A shadow wight can slip into the Plane of Shadows from the Material Plane and the other way around as per Jumper (p. B64). After using this ability, it cannot reactivate it for 5 seconds.

**Silent Movement:** Shadow wights get +10 to Stealth when perfectly motionless, or +5 if moving. This only helps against hearing-based detection attempts.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Teeth (p. MA115).

Visibility (p. B394).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | -           | 10    |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the shadow wight has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

**Life Sense (10):** A shadow wight possesses a constantly active magical ability to sense life. By making a Sense roll with normal range penalties, a shadow wight may sense all nearby living beings, knowing their precise location. A follow-up IQ roll may reveal information about the living being, with margin of success of 0-1 only revealing vague information, such as race, and margin of success of 4+ revealing detailed information, such as age, gender, and physical condition.

**Psychic Value Sense (6):** Whenever a shadow wight touches an object, the GM may make a roll against IQ-4 (6) to sense strong emotions and psychic impressions tied to the object's history. On a critical success, the shadow wight receives an actual vision of a significant past event. Roll at no additional penalty for events earlier the same day, at -1 for up to 10 days

ago, -2 for up to 100 days ago, -3 for up to three years ago, and another -1 per additional 10x multiplier. The shadow wight cannot use this ability actively – this is a passive sense.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 11   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Callous; Intolerance (Living); Selfish (12).

## Skills

Brawling-14; Stealth-14; Wrestling-14.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Night.

**Habitat:** Shadow wights inhabit the Plane of Shadow. Shadow wights have the upper boundary of their temperature comfort zone extended by 5xHT degrees and the lower boundary extended by 10xHT degrees.

**Life Force Craving:** Despite not requiring sustenance, a shadow wight has an uncontrollable craving for life force. When encountering a living creature, the shadow wight must roll against 15 to resist attacking it and leeching HP from it with the Energy Drain ability. The self-control roll is at -1 per missing HP. The shadow wight must make a second self-control roll to stop draining life once it replenished its entire HP pool.

**Speech:** Shadow wights retain their ability to speak any languages they knew in life, but are not good at talking. Their disturbing voice gives -2 on any speech-based reaction roll and -2 to Diplomacy, Fast-Talk, Performance, Public Speaking, Sex Appeal, and Singing.

**Undead:** As undead creatures, shadow wights do not need food, water, sleep, air, or experience aging. They are immune to metabolic hazards. Shadow wights do not possess a FP score, cannot naturally heal HP, and are unable to reproduce sexually.

**Unnatural Aura:** Shadow wights possess an unnatural aura that frightens animals and saps life. Animals react at -4 to shadow wights, usually with fear or aggression. Grass dies and never regrows within a yard of the shadow wight, and so do insects and other tiny mundane animals weighing no more than a few ounces. This usually imposes another -2 on reaction rolls and +2 on rolls to locate the shadow wight outdoors.

## Capturing and Training

Some necromancers and cultists of dark powers employ shadow wights in their armies.

**Untrained Value:** \$5,370.

**Trained Value:** \$53,700.  
**Supply Cost:** \$0.  
**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.056  
**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,600

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Shadow Wights

*Battle Rating:* 6.5  
*Classes:* Recon.  
*Features:* Night.  
*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 28/112  
*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.  
*Wage (Monthly):* \$193,200.  
*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.  
*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$193,200.

## Racial Template

The following racial template represents a humanoid shadow wight. It can be applied as a lens to another racial template to simulate shadow wights risen from non-human beings.

287 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** HP+4 [8]; Will+1 [5]; Basic Speed +1.00 [20]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Dominance (Fatal Beating, -40%) [12]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; ER 4 (Magic) [12]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (Unliving, No Blood) [25]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Silence 5 [25]; Temperature Tolerance 15 (5xHT to hot; 10xHT to cold) [15]; Unaging [15].

*Blend into Shadows:* Invisibility (Accessibility, Only in shadowy illumination, -30%; Affects Machines, +50%; Costs Fatigue, 1 FP, -5%; Dispels after an attack, -20%; Magical, -10%) [34].

*Cold Resistance* [35]: DR 10 (Includes Eyes, +10%; Includes Internal, +20%; Limited, Cold, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [25] + Immunity to Noxious Cold Effects [10].

*Energy Drain:* Leech 3 (Accelerated Healing, +25%; Magical, -10%) [38].

*Life Sense:* Detect (Life; Magical, -10%; Precise, +100%; Reflexive, +40%) [69].

*Psychic Value Sense:* Psychometry (Magical, -10%; Passive Only, -60%) [6].

*Shadow Jump:* Jumper (Planar; Accessibility, Only on the Plane of Shadow and planes that border it, -5%; Limited Access, Plane of Shadow, -20%; Magical, -10%; Takes Recharge, 5 seconds, -10%) [55].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Callous [-5]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Frightens Animals [-10]; Intolerance (Living) [-10]; Lifebane [-10]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Selfish (12) [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Uncontrollable Appetite (15) (Life Force) [-7]; Unhealing (Partial; Leech) [-20]; Weakness (1d per 30 minutes; Sunlight) [-15].

**Quirks:** Glowing Eyes [-1]; Prefers to stay in its tomb [-1]; Sexless [-1]; Supernatural Dislike (Light) [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue.

## Skeleton (Lens)

Type: Undead



Skeletons are undead animated corpses similar to zombies, but completely devoid of flesh. Zombies with time also decay to become skeletons. Any corporeal creature with an internal skeleton can become an animated skeleton, and some rare ones gain special abilities (e.g., skeletal dragons). Skeletons are the simplest and most widespread of all undead.

Typically, skeletons serve as tools for evil priests and wizards via spells like *animate dead*. However, they can also arise spontaneously due to the presence of other powerful undead. Areas with strong necromantic energy or a history of violence, such as battlefields or mass graves, can generate masterless skeletons without the Reprogrammable disadvantage. These skeletons, though leaderless, may instinctively cooperate with each other or more intelligent undead to the extent their limited minds allow.

### Ecology

**Habitat:** Skeletons often remain in their former habitats, commonly found in crypts, tombs, ruins, graveyards, and necropolises. They are cheap and easy to create, making them popular among necromancers to guard lairs and evil temples, especially those devoted to death gods. Overproduction can lead to "wild" undead that roam freely from their creation sites.

Skeletons have their temperature comfort zone extended by 5xHT degrees in both directions.

**Speech:** Skeletons retain their ability to speak despite lacking the organs that would let them do that physically. However, they do not talk unless ordered by their master.

**Undead:** As undead creatures, skeletons do not need food, water, sleep, air, or experience aging. They are immune to metabolic hazards and vacuum. Skeletons do not possess a FP score, cannot naturally heal HP, and are unable to reproduce sexually.

### Mentality

Nearly mindless, skeletons can follow simple commands like "kill anyone who opens the treasure chest." Without a master, they may claim and defend territories, such as a crypt or a dungeon hallway. When in groups, their congregations are instinctual rather than coordinated.

Being mindless, skeletons are immune to mind control, Fright Checks, and mundane influence, even with an IQ above 5 after adjustments. Specialized spells like *control undead* can affect them. Skeletons are highly focused on their tasks, gaining a +3 to success rolls when focus would benefit them but suffering a -5 penalty on noticing interruptions.

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Spoils

Skeletons do not accumulate wealth, but they may carry equipment given to them by their masters.

### Lens

-114 points

**Applicable to:** Any corporeal non-undead creature with a skeletal system.

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-1 [-10]; DX+2 [40]; IQ-2 [-40].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** Basic Speed +1.00 [20].

**Advantages:** DR 2 [10]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving) [40]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15]; Vacuum Support [5].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Brittle [-15]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Extra Skull DR [-2]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Skinny [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Vulnerability (Crushing Attacks, x2) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Cannot Float [-1]; Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue.

When applying the lens, make sure to check for conflicts between the two templates, remove traits that are not appropriate for a skeleton, and modify lens characteristics that are affected by the base creature's traits, such as No Fine Manipulators or positive SM.

## Skeleton (Goblin)

Type: Undead

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 7  | <b>HP</b> | 6    | <b>SM</b>     | -1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 13 | <b>BS</b> | 6.75 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | -    | <b>BL</b>     | 9.8 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-3/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 5 lb.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 3-30. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is the typical skeleton created from a corpse of a goblin.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** Skeletons cannot float.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 9.8 | 19.6  | 29.4   | 58.8  | 98          |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 9.

**Parry:** 9 (unarmed).

**DR:** 2. Unlike most corporeal creatures, skeletons do not have extra 2 skull DR.

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture, vacuum.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving).

**Vulnerabilities:** The skeleton takes x2 injury from crushing attacks.

**Weaknesses:** Skeletons, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A skeleton that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

**Brittle:** Whenever an injury cripples one of the skeleton's limbs or extremities, it breaks off. If it can make a HT roll, it falls off in one piece; otherwise, it shatters irrecoverably. Furthermore, the skeleton must make a HT roll upon being brought down to 0 HP. If it fails, it is instantly crumbles, as if it had gone down to -10xHP.

**Lightweight:** Skeletons have -2 to ST when they resist knockback.

### Combat

Skeletons attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**Sharp Teeth (13):** thrust 1d-4 cutting, Reach C. If the attack hits, the goblin skeleton may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-3 control against SM-4 and smaller victims or 1d-5 control against larger ones.

**Punch (13):** thrust 1d-4 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (13):** thrust 1d-3 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.49 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 4.9 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 4                    | 7         | 11                   | 14                 |

### Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).  
Teeth (p. MA115).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 8   | 8      | 8       | -           | -     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the skeleton has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

**Touch:** Skeletons are numb. When performing a task that requires hand-eye coordination, a skeleton suffer all the effects of one level of Ham-Fisted (p. B138) unless it takes twice as long to perform the action and can clearly see what it is doing.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 8    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Skills

None.

### Capturing and Training

Skeletons are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$110.

**Trained Value:** \$1,100.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.001

**Wage (Monthly):** \$33

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Goblin Skeletons

*Battle Rating:* 0.14

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$4,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$4,000.

## Racial Template

*-120 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-3 [-30]; DX+3 [60]; IQ-2 [-40].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM-1; HP-1 [-2]; Basic Speed +1.00 [20]; Basic Move -1 [-5].

**Advantages:** DR 2 [10]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving) [40]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15]; Vacuum Support [5].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Brittle [-15]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Extra Skull DR [-2]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Skinny [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Vulnerability (Crushing Attacks, x2) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Cannot Float [-1]; Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue.

## Skeleton (Human Commoner)

Type: Undead



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 9  | <b>HP</b> | 9   | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 6.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-2/1d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | -   | <b>BL</b>     | 16 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 8 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 3-30. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is the typical skeleton created from the reanimation of an ordinary human, like a peasant. Sometimes, such skeletons are given equipment.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

**Water:** Skeletons cannot float.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 16 | 32    | 48     | 96    | 160         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 9.

**Parry:** 9 (unarmed).

**DR:** 2. Unlike most corporeal creatures, skeletons do not have extra 2 skull DR.

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture, vacuum.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving).

**Vulnerabilities:** The skeleton takes x2 injury from crushing attacks.

**Weaknesses:** Skeletons, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A skeleton that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

**Brittle:** Whenever an injury cripples one of the skeleton's limbs or extremities, it breaks off. If it can make a HT roll, it falls off in one piece; otherwise, it shatters irrecoverably. Furthermore, the skeleton must make a HT roll upon being brought down to 0 HP. If it fails, it is instantly crumbles, as if it had gone down to -10xHP.

**Lightweight:** Skeletons have -2 to ST when they resist knockback.

### Combat

Skeletons attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**Punch (12):** thrust 1d-3 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-2 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.8 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 8 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 5                    | 9         | 14                   | 18                 |

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 8   | 8      | 8       | -           | -     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the skeleton has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

**Touch:** Skeletons are numb. When performing a task that requires hand-eye coordination, a skeleton suffer all the effects of one level of Ham-Fisted (p. B138) unless it takes twice as long to perform the action and can clearly see what it is doing.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 8    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

## Skills

None.

## Capturing and Training

Skeletons are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$145.

**Trained Value:** \$1,450.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.0015

**Wage (Monthly):** \$44

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Human Commoner Skeletons

*Battle Rating:* 0.18

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$5,300.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$5,300.

## Racial Template

-114 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-1 [-10]; DX+2 [40]; IQ-2 [-40].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** Basic Speed +1.00 [20].

**Advantages:** DR 2 [10]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving) [40]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15]; Vacuum Support [5].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Brittle [-15]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Extra Skull DR [-2]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Skinny [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Vulnerability (Crushing Attacks, x2) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Cannot Float [-1]; Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue.

# Skeleton (Human Warrior)

Type: Undead



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |     |        |           |
|----|----|----|-----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 9  | HP | 9   | SM     | +0        |
| DX | 12 | BS | 6.5 | thr/sw | 1d-2/1d-1 |
| HT | 10 | FP | -   | BL     | 16 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 8 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 3-30. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is a skeleton of a dead warrior that skill has some rusty equipment and skills that it had in life.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

**Water:** Skeletons cannot float.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 16 | 32    | 48     | 96    | 160         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 10 (shortsword).

**Block:** 10 (small light shield; DB 1; \$30; 3 lbs.; DR 2, HP 12, Cover DR 5).

**DR:** 2. Unlike most corporeal creatures, skeletons do not have extra 2 skull DR.

**Feet:** +1\* DR vs. cutting (light leather boots).

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture, vacuum.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving).

**Vulnerabilities:** The skeleton takes x2 injury from crushing attacks.

**Weaknesses:** Skeletons, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A skeleton that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

**Brittle:** Whenever an injury cripples one of the skeleton's limbs or extremities, it breaks off. If it can make a HT roll, it falls off in one piece; otherwise, it shatters irrecoverably. Furthermore, the skeleton must make a HT roll upon being brought down to 0 HP. If it fails, it is instantly crumbles, as if it had gone down to -10xHP.

**Lightweight:** Skeletons have -2 to ST when they resist knockback.

## Combat

Skeletons attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**Cheap shortsword swing (12):** thrust 1d-1 cutting, Reach 1. 2 lbs.

**Cheap shortsword thrust (12):** thrust 1d-1 impaling, Reach 1. 2 lbs.

**Shield Bash (12):** thrust 1d-2 crushing, Reach 1.

**Punch (12):** thrust 1d-3 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-2 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.8 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 8 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 5                    | 9         | 14                   | 18                 |

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 8   | 8      | 8       | -           | -     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the skeleton has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

**Touch:** Skeletons are numb. When performing a task that requires hand-eye coordination, a skeleton suffer all the effects of one level of Ham-Fisted (p. B138) unless it takes twice as long to perform the action and can clearly see what it is doing.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 8    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor;

and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Skills

Shield-12; Shortsword-12.

### Spoils

This skeleton warrior has the following gear:

- Small light shield (DB 1; \$30; 3 lbs.; DR 2, HP 12, Cover DR 5).
- Cheap shortsword (\$160; 2 lbs.)
- Light leather boots (\$50; 1.5 lb.)

### Capturing and Training

Skeletons are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$335.

**Trained Value:** \$3,350.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.003

**Wage (Monthly):** \$100

### Mass Combat Statistics

#### 120 Human Warrior Skeletons

*Battle Rating:* 0.5

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$12,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$12,000.

### Racial Template

*-111 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-1 [-10]; DX+2 [40]; IQ-2 [-40].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** Basic Speed +1.00 [20].

**Advantages:** DR 2 [10]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving) [40]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15]; Vacuum Support [5].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Brittle [-15]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Extra Skull DR [-2]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Skinny [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Vulnerability (Crushing Attacks, x2) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Cannot Float [-1]; Sexless [-1].

**Racial Skills:** Shield (E) DX [1]; Shortsword (A) DX [2].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue.

## Skeleton (Troll)

Type: Undead

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 17 | <b>HP</b> | 17  | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 13 | <b>BS</b> | 7.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+2/3d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 13 | <b>FP</b> | -   | <b>BL</b>     | 58 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+2/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 50 lb.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-6. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is a skeleton of a troll.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 8; exploration 4 miles per hour.

**Water:** Skeletons cannot float.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 58 | 116   | 174    | 348   | 580         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 9 (unarmed).

**DR:** 2. Unlike most corporeal creatures, skeletons do not have extra 2 skull DR.

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture, vacuum.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving).

**Vulnerabilities:** The skeleton takes x2 injury from crushing attacks.

**Weaknesses:** Skeletons, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A skeleton that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

**Brittle:** Whenever an injury cripples one of the skeleton's limbs or extremities, it breaks off. If it can make a HT roll, it falls off in one piece; otherwise, it shatters irrecoverably. Furthermore, the skeleton must make a HT roll upon being brought down to 0 HP. If it fails, it is instantly crumbles, as if it had gone down to -10xHP.

**Lightweight:** Skeletons have -2 to ST when they resist knockback.

### Combat

Skeletons attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**Bite (13):** thrust 1d+1 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the troll skeleton may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+2 control against SM-1 and smaller victims or 1d control against larger ones.

**Claws (13):** thrust 1d+1 cutting. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (13):** thrust 1d+2 control. Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.9 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 29 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 2                           | 9                           | 17               | 26                          | 34                        |

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 8   | 8      | 8       | -           | -     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the skeleton has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

**Touch:** Skeletons are numb. When performing a task that requires hand-eye coordination, a skeleton suffer all the effects of one level of Ham-Fisted (p. B138) unless it takes twice as long to perform the action and can clearly see what it is doing.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 6  | 9    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Skills

None.

### Capturing and Training

Skeletons are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$2,580.

**Trained Value:** \$25,850.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.027

**Wage (Monthly):** \$775

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Troll Skeletons

*Battle Rating:* 1.5

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 32/128

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$46,500.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$46,500.

## Racial Template

*5 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+7 (Size Modifier, -10%) [63]; DX+3 [60]; IQ-4 [-80]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM+1; Will+3 [15]; Per+2 [10]; Basic Speed +1.00 [20]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** DR 2 [10]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving) [40]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15]; Vacuum Support [5].

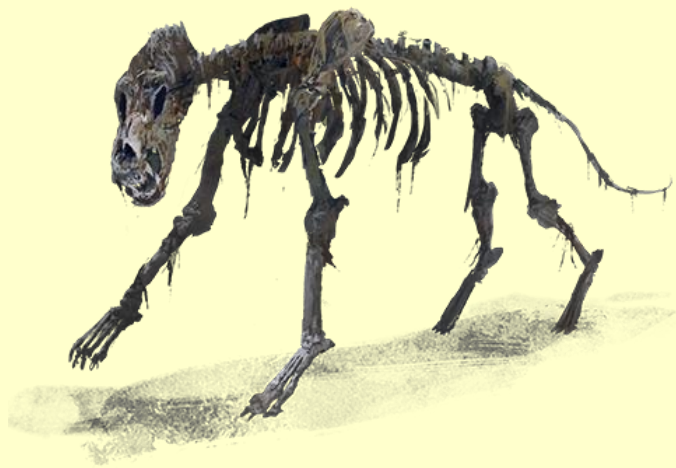
**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Brittle [-15]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Extra Skull DR [-2]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Skinny [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Vulnerability (Crushing Attacks, x2) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Cannot Float [-1]; Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue.

## Skeleton (Wolf)

Type: Undead



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 7  | <b>HP</b> | 7    | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 14 | <b>BS</b> | 7.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | -    | <b>BL</b>     | 9.8 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-3/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Quadruped (p. B553).

**Weight:** 7 lb.

**Length:** 5 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-12. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is a skeleton created from a dead wolf.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 11/16; exploration 8 miles per hour.

**Water:** Skeletons cannot float.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 9.8 | 19.6  | 29.4   | 58.8  | 98          |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 10.

**DR:** 2. Unlike most corporeal creatures, skeletons do not have extra 2 skull DR.

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture, vacuum.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving).

**Vulnerabilities:** The skeleton takes x2 injury from crushing attacks.

**Weaknesses:** Skeletons, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A skeleton that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

**Brittle:** Whenever an injury cripples one of the skeleton's limbs or extremities, it breaks off. If it can make a HT roll, it falls off in one piece; otherwise, it shatters irrecoverably. Furthermore, the skeleton must make a HT roll upon being brought down to 0 HP. If it fails, it is instantly crumbles, as if it had gone down to -10xHP.

**Lightweight:** Skeletons have -2 to ST when they resist knockback.

**Notes:** The wolf skeleton's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +2 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

### Combat

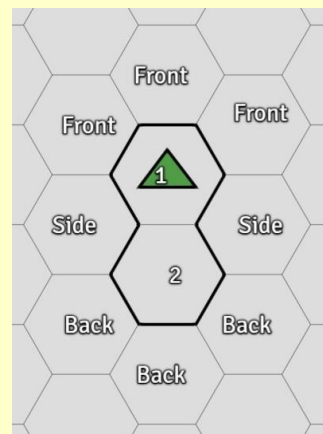
Skeletons attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**Sharp Teeth (14):** thrust 1d-3 cutting. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the wolf skeleton may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-2 control against SM-1 and smaller victims or 1d-5 control against larger ones.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d-2 control. Reach C from hex #1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.49 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 4.9 lbs.



| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 1                           | 4                           | 7                | 11                          | 14                        |

### Useful Combat Rules

Teeth (p. MA115).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | -           | -     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the skeleton has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

**Touch:** Skeletons are numb. When performing a task that requires hand-eye coordination, a skeleton suffer all the effects of one level of Ham-Fisted (p.

B138) unless it takes twice as long to perform the action and can clearly see what it is doing.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 2  | 8    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Other Traits

Extra Legs (Four Legs); Horizontal; No Fine Manipulators.

### Skills

None.

### Capturing and Training

Wolf skeletons sometimes are favored over human skeletons by the necromancers because wolves do not require any weapons or armor to be effective.

**Untrained Value:** \$250.

**Trained Value:** \$2,500.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.003

**Wage (Monthly):** \$75

### Mass Combat Statistics

#### 120 Wolf Skeletons

*Battle Rating:* 0.5

*Classes:* Cv.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 64/256

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$9,100.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$9,100.

### Racial Template

-164 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-3 [-30]; DX+4 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [48]; IQ-8 [-160]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** Will+6 [30]; Per+8 [40]; Basic Speed +1.00 [20]; Basic Move +4 [20].

**Advantages:** DR 2 [10]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Enhanced Move 0.5 (Ground) [10]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, No Brain, No Eyes, No Vitals, Unliving) [40]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Single-Minded [5]; Striking ST 3

(One Attack Only, Bite, -60%) [6]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15]; Vacuum Support [5].

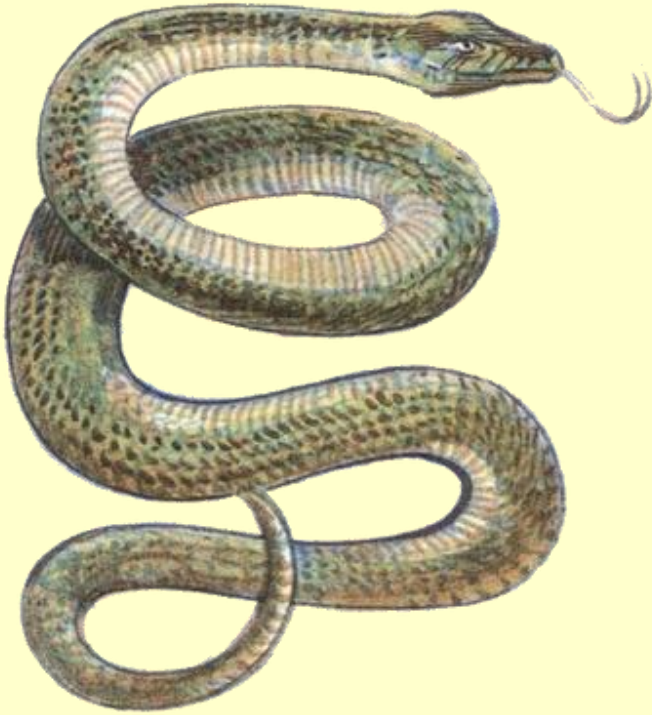
**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Brittle [-15]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Horizontal [-10]; No Extra Skull DR [-2]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Skinny [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Vulnerability (Crushing Attacks, x2) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Cannot Float [-1]; Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; Not Subject to Fatigue; Tail.

# Snake, Constrictor

Type: Animal (Reptile)



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 7  | <b>HP</b> | 7  | <b>SM</b>     | -2        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 10 | <b>BL</b>     | 9.8 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-3/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Vermiform (p. B553).

**Weight:** 22 lbs.

**Length:** 3 yd.

**Effective Height:** 1.5 ft. when horizontal and 1 yd. when upright.

**Organization:** 1-2. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

Constrictor snakes have thick, bulky bodies adorned with patterns of blotches, saddles, or reticulations. These patterns blur when they move, concealing their motion, and when still, they break up their outline, making them harder to see. They glide gracefully through grass, brush, and trees. A narrow forked tongue flicks from their small head, which can expand to swallow large prey. Their jaws and palate have rows of needle-sharp, recurved teeth ideal for gripping prey. Males retain vestigial hind legs, visible as small spurs near the vent for courtship.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 2; exploration 1 mile per hour.

The constrictor snake can **move and fight unimpeded on undergrowth, uneven and slippery surfaces.**

**Water:** Move 1; exploration 0.5 mile per hour. The constrictor snake is an adept swimmer. Aside from being able to swim fast, the constrictor snake takes no skill penalties from being underwater and is able to hold its breath 16 times longer than normal.

**Climbing:** The constrictor snake may climb on surfaces that have coil-holds at Move 1 without any Climbing rolls.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 9.8 | 19.6  | 29.4   | 58.8  | 98          |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** Scales give the constrictor snake DR 1\*.

**Dodge:** 10 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against damage caused by high or low body temperature.

**Immunities:** Sunburn.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; Hard to Kill 4; Hard to Subdue 4.

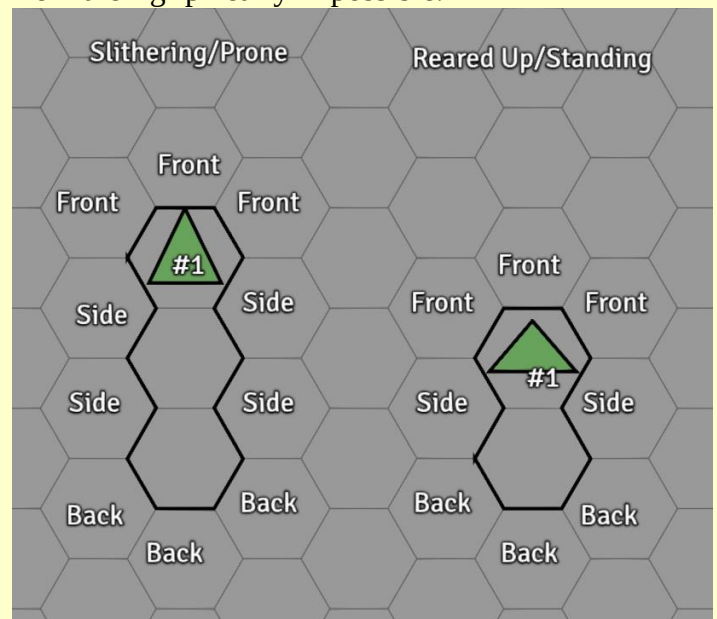
**Notes:** A character can target a constrictor snake's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Snakes) roll.

The constrictor snake's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +2 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

The constrictor snake's neck is targeted at +3 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

## Combat

As ambush predators, constrictors strike with incredible speed, coiling around prey to impede vital functions like breathing and heartbeats, leading to death by asphyxiation or cardiac arrest. Their powerful jaws, designed to hold rather than rip, make escape from their grip nearly impossible.



**Bite (14):** thrust 1d-3 cutting. Reach C from hex #1 or Reach C-1 from hex #1 if reared up. If the attack

hits, the constrictor snake may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-2 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-4 control against larger ones.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d-2 control. Reach C from any hex or Reach C-1 from hex #1 if reared up and grappling with the bite. Effective ST 9 due to having Wrestling at DX+2. The constrictor snake may grapple not only with its bite, but also with its torso. The constrictor snake can actively constrict grappled victims, attacking them each turn with a Constriction Attack (p. B43).

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.49 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 4.9 lb.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 5                    | 9         | 14                   | 18                 |

## Special Abilities

**Camouflage:** The scales of the constrictor snake let it blend it with the surrounding leaves. This gives the snake +2 to Camouflage and Stealth when posed still and unclad against leaves. This bonus only works against normal vision, not Infravision.

**Double-Jointed:** Notably flexible, constrictor snakes get +5 on Climbing, Erotic Art, and Escape rolls, and can ignore up to -5 penalties for working in close quarters.

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Holding Your Breath (p. B351).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 12  | 12     | 8       | 19          | 12    |

**Vision:** The constrictor snake possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

**Hearing:** Constrictor snakes are **Hard of Hearing** (p. B138).

**Smell:** The constrictor snake has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

**Thermal Sense (12):** The constrictor snake possess a pair of pits, functioning like pinhole cameras in response to radiant heat. These pits are unaffected by eye injuries or impairments. The constrictor snake can detect warm-blooded creatures

or objects that are hotter or colder than their surroundings, with a -1 penalty to its Sense roll for each yard of distance. While it cannot perceive color and only has a faint sense of shapes, it can fight without penalties even in complete darkness against a detectable target. It receives a +2 bonus to Vision when spotting such targets and a +3 to Tracking for trails less than an hour old, but there is a -4 penalty to Vision for distinguishing similar objects.

**Tremorsense (12):** The constrictor snake can feel faint movements in the surface it is on with a Sense roll, including earth tremors, distant explosions, and footsteps. Modify the roll for loudness and distance as for sound (p. B358). If lying full length, roll at +2!

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 2  | 10   |

Constrictors' behaviors are limited but suited for survival. They lack understanding of emotions and may not even recognize others outside of mating. Although capable of learning, constrictor snakes are not considered intelligent. However, their instinctual behaviors are finely tuned for their ecological niche.

**Mentality Traits:** Low Empathy; Wild Animal.

## Skills

Brawling-14; Climbing-16; Escape-12; Intimidation-10; Stealth-17; Survival (Jungle)-12; Tracking-15; Wrestling-14.

## Other Traits

No Legs (Slithers); No Manipulators.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Day.

**Diet:** Constrictor snakes prey on birds, lizards, and small mammals like rodents and opossums, often ambushing from tree branches. They also capture flying birds and bats.

**Habitat:** Warm forests. The temperature comfort zone of a constrictor snake falls between 35° and 90°, but see *Temperature Regulation* below.

**Lifespan:** Constrictor snakes can live for up to 15 years, with sexual maturity typically reached by the age of 4.

**Organization:** Solitary.

**Reproduction:** Constrictor snakes generally ignore each other, except during mating season when they come together to reproduce. They give birth to live young, which immediately disperse and fend for themselves, hunting rodents, birds, and lizards to grow and continue the cycle.

**Temperature Regulation:** The constrictor snake is a cold-blooded creature. While it has +2 HT to

resist damage from high or low body temperature, it tends to stiffen up in cold weather. After 30 minutes in cold conditions, the constrictor snake gets -1 to Basic Speed and DX per 10° below 65°F. The constrictor snake regains lost Basic Speed and DX at the rate of one point of each per hour once it returns to a warm climate. Double this rate in an exceptionally warm environment. At temperatures below 32°, the constrictor snake must roll vs. HT (12) or take 1 HP of damage.

## Spoils

The skin of a constrictor snake is a sought after item in many markets. A good quality skin could cost a buyer up to \$400. Constrictor snake meat is edible.

## Capturing and Training

Constrictor snakes are beneficial to humans by consuming large quantities of pest rodents and contributing to the pet trade. As pets, they are docile, hardy, and impressive in size, yet manageable and not overly dangerous.

**Young Value:** \$25.

**Untrained Value:** \$135.

**Trained Value:** \$1,340.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.0007 and 0.006 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Training Skill:** Animal Handling (Snakes).

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Snakes).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.0014

**Wage (Monthly):** \$40

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Constrictor Snakes**

*Battle Rating:* 0.16

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 8/32

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$4,825.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$4,825.

## Racial Template

-55 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-3 [-30]; DX+2 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [24]; IQ-8 [-160]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-2; FP-2 [-6]; Will+8 [40]; Per+10 [50]; Basic Move -4 [-20]; Water Move -1 [-2].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 3 [6]; Amphibious [10]; Clinging (Requires coil-holds, -30%) [14]; Breath-Holding 4 [8]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Constriction Attack [15]; DR 1 (Flexible, -20%) [4]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Double-Jointed [15]; Hard to Kill 4 [8]; Hard to Subdue 4 [8]; Long Neck 3

[9]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 [6]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Subsonic Hearing (Biological (Passive), -5%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4]; Terrain Adaptation (Slippery) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Uneven) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Undergrowth) [5]; Thermal Infrared Vision (Biological (Passive), -5%; Short-Range 1, -10%) [9].

**Disadvantages:** Cold-Blooded (65°) [-10]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Low Empathy [-20]; No Manipulators [-50]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Wild Animal [-30].

**Perks:** Limited Camouflage (Leaves) [1]; Scales [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; No Legs (Slithers).

## Snake, Constrictor, Giant

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 15 | <b>HP</b> | 15 | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+1/2d+1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 10 | <b>BL</b>     | 45 lbs.   |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d+1/1d+2

Most of the statistics remain the same, only the changed ones are listed below.

**Weight:** 220 lbs.

**Length:** 7 yd.

**Effective Height:** 1 yd. when horizontal and 2 yd. when upright.

### Movement and Encumbrance

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 45 | 90    | 135    | 270   | 450         |

### Combat



**Bite (14):** thrust 1d+1 cutting. Reach C from hex #1 or Reach C-2 from hex #1 if reared up. If the attack hits, the giant constrictor snake may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+2 control against SM-1 and smaller victims or 1d control against larger ones.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d+2 control. Reach C from any hex or Reach C-2 from hex #1 if reared up and grappling with the bite. Effective ST 17 due to having Wrestling at DX+2. The giant constrictor snake may grapple not only with its bite, but also with its torso. The giant constrictor snake can actively constrict grappled victims, attacking them each turn with a Constriction Attack (p. B43).

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 22.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 9                    | 17        | 26                   | 34                 |

## Spoils

The skin of a giant constrictor snake is too stiff and bulky to be workable for anything but armor, so it doesn't fetch very high prices. Giant constrictor snake meat is edible.

## Capturing and Training

**Young Value:** \$160.

**Untrained Value:** \$805.

**Trained Value:** \$8,040.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.003 and 0.2 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.008

**Wage (Monthly):** \$240

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Giant Constrictor Snakes

*Battle Rating:* 1

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 8/32

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$28,950.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$28,950.

## Racial Template

5 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+5 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [30]; DX+2 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [24]; IQ-8 [-160]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** FP-2 [-6]; Will+8 [40]; Per+10 [50]; Basic Move -4 [-20]; Water Move -1 [-2].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 3 [6]; Amphibious [10]; Clinging (Requires coil-holds, -30%) [14]; Breath-Holding 4 [8]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Constriction Attack [15]; DR 1 (Flexible, -20%) [4]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Double-Jointed [15]; Hard to Kill 4 [8]; Hard to Subdue 4 [8]; Long Neck 3 [9]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 [6]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Subsonic Hearing (Biological (Passive), -5%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4]; Terrain Adaptation (Slippery) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Uneven) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Undergrowth) [5]; Thermal Infrared Vision (Biological (Passive), -5%; Short-Range 1, -10%) [9].

**Disadvantages:** Cold-Blooded (65°) [-10]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Low Empathy [-20]; No Manipulators [-50]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Wild Animal [-30].

**Perks:** Limited Camouflage (Leaves) [1]; Scales [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; No Legs (Slithers).

# Snake, Viper, Tiny

Type: Animal (Reptile)



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 1  | <b>HP</b> | 1   | <b>SM</b>     | -6        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-6/1d-5 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 10  | <b>BL</b>     | 0.2 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-6/1d-5

**Body Plan:** Vermiform (p. B553).

**Weight:** 0.11 lb.

**Length:** 2 ft.

**Effective Height:** 3 inches when horizontal and 8 inches when upright.

**Organization:** 1-6. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

Vipers are a group of highly venomous snakes. They are typically heavy-set and slow moving animals, but capable of blazing fast strikes. Their heads are characteristically arrowhead shaped, with the broad jaws significantly wider than the neck. Vipers typically rest in a tight coil, and this pose is how they are commonly encountered.

The color pattern of these snakes varies widely, from light specimens with small, dark crossbars to entirely brown ones with darker markings, and even to melanistic individuals that are completely dark without a dorsal pattern. Most vipers exhibit a zigzag dorsal pattern along their bodies and tails. The head often displays a distinctive dark V or X on the back, and a dark streak extends from the eye to the neck, continuing as a series of spots along the flanks.

Unusually, it's often possible to distinguish sexes by color: females tend to be brown with dark-brown markings, while males are usually grey with black markings.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 2; exploration 1 mile per hour.

The viper can **move and fight unimpeded on sand, undergrowth, uneven and slippery surfaces.**

**Water:** Move 1; exploration 0.5 mile per hour.

The viper is an adept swimmer. Aside from being able to swim fast, the viper takes no skill penalties from being underwater and is able to hold its breath 16 times longer than normal.

**Climbing:** The viper may climb on branches and brush at Move 1 without any Climbing rolls.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 0.2 | 0.4   | 0.6    | 1.2   | 2           |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against damage caused by high or low body temperature.

**Immunities:** Sunburn.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; Hard to Kill 4; Hard to Subdue 4.

**Notes:** A character can target a viper's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Snakes) roll.

The viper's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +2 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

The viper's neck is targeted at +3 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

## Combat

Vipers rely on their venomous bite to kill prey and defend themselves.

**Bite (12):** thrust 1d-6 impaling. Reach C. If the attack hits, the viper may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-5 control against SM-7 and smaller victims or 1d-7 control against larger ones.

In addition, the viper's fangs carry a fast-acting poison. Anyone injured by the bite attack must roll against HT-4 or take 1d-2 toxic damage. When he loses 1/3 of his HP to this poison, he begins suffering from moderate pain (p. B428) until he recovers HP above this threshold. This increases to severe pain upon losing 1/2 HP and terrible pain upon losing 2/3 HP.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-5 control. Reach C. Effective ST 3 due to having Wrestling at DX+2. The viper may grapple not only with its bite, but also with its torso.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.01 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 0.1 lb.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 1                           | 2                           | 3                | 5                           | 6                         |

## Special Abilities

**Double-Jointed:** Notably flexible, vipers get +5 on Climbing, Erotic Art, and Escape rolls, and can ignore up to -5 penalties for working in close quarters.

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Holding Your Breath (p. B351).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 12  | 12     | 8       | 19          | 12    |

**Vision:** The viper possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

**Hearing:** Vipers are **Hard of Hearing** (p. B138).

**Smell:** The viper has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

**Thermal Sense (12):** The viper possess a pair of pits, functioning like pinhole cameras in response to radiant heat. These pits are unaffected by eye injuries or impairments. The viper can detect warm-blooded creatures or objects that are hotter or colder than their surroundings, with a -1 penalty to its Sense roll for each yard of distance. While it cannot perceive color and only has a faint sense of shapes, it can fight without penalties even in complete darkness against a detectable target. It receives a +2 bonus to Vision when spotting such targets and a +3 to Tracking for trails less than an hour old, but there is a -4 penalty to Vision for distinguishing similar objects.

**Tremorsense (12):** The viper can feel faint movements in the surface it is on with a Sense roll, including earth tremors, distant explosions, and footsteps. Modify the roll for loudness and distance as for sound (p. B358). If lying full length, roll at +2!

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 2  | 10   |

Vipers are typically timid and only bite when cornered or threatened. Bites usually occur when someone steps on or tries to pick them up. At the slightest hint of danger, vipers retreat into the undergrowth but often return to their original spot once everything is quiet. Some may hiss loudly to warn off threats, often seen in pregnant females. When threatened, vipers coil their front body into an S-shape, preparing to strike.

**Mentality Traits:** Low Empathy; Wild Animal.

## Skills

Brawling-12; Climbing-14; Escape-10; Intimidation-10; Stealth-15; Survival (Swampland)-12; Tracking-15; Wrestling-12.

## Other Traits

No Legs (Slithers); No Manipulators.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Day.

**Diet:** Vipers primarily eat small mammals like mice, rats, voles, and shrews, along with lizards and occasionally slow worms, weasels, and moles. They also consume amphibians such as frogs, newts, and salamanders. Birds, especially nestlings and eggs, are part of their diet, for which vipers may climb shrubs and bushes.

**Habitat:** Temperate marshes. The temperature comfort zone of a viper falls between 35° and 90°, but see *Temperature Regulation* below.

**Hibernation:** The viper retreats into hibernation to weather the winter. Should a viper attempt to stave off hibernation for any reason, it must succeed on a Will (10) roll to resist succumbing to slumber.

To the untrained eye, a hibernating viper might be mistaken for deceased. Only those with knowledge of its unique metabolic dormancy can accurately assess its condition through a Quick Contest of Diagnosis against the viper's HT (12).

Should it sustain injury, the viper awakens immediately.

**Lifespan:** Vipers can live for up to 15 years, with sexual maturity typically reached by the age of 4.

**Organization:** Solitary.

**Reproduction:** Mating occurs in mid-spring or early summer, with females breeding every two to three years depending on climate. Males track females by their scent, sometimes covering hundreds of meters daily. If a female flees, the male pursues. Courtship involves side-by-side movement, tongue flicking, and tail lashing. Pairs remain together for one or two days post-mating, with males fending off rivals through combat, including the dramatic 'adder dance'.

Gestation lasts about three months, with litter sizes ranging from 3 to 20. Neonates, measuring 5.5 to 9.1 inches, are born encased in a sac they must escape. They are equipped with functional venom and a yolk reserve. Newborns shed their skin within a day or two. While females show little interest post-birth, the young often stay near their mothers for several days.

**Temperature Regulation:** The viper is a cold-blooded creature. While it has +2 HT to resist damage from high or low body temperature, it tends to stiffen up in cold weather. After 30 minutes in cold conditions, the viper gets -1 to Basic Speed and DX per 10° below 50°F. The viper regains lost Basic Speed and DX at the rate of one point of each per hour once it returns to a warm climate. Double this rate in an exceptionally warm environment. At

temperatures below 32°, the viper must roll vs. HT (12) or take 1 HP of damage.

## Spoils

Snakeskin is used in making clothing items like vests, belts, and footwear. Viper meat is edible. Poison extraction, which takes 10 minutes and requires a successful Poisons roll, yields 1 dose plus 1 extra dose per 2 points or margin of success, up to five doses. The poison costs \$4 per dose.

## Capturing and Training

A viper may be an exotic pet in some lands, but it more or less useless otherwise.

**Young Value:** \$15.

**Untrained Value:** \$77.

**Trained Value:** \$770.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.00004 and 0.0003 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Training Skill:** Animal Handling (Snakes).

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Snakes).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.0008

**Wage (Monthly):** \$23

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Vipers (Tiny)**

*Battle Rating:* 0.1

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 8/32

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$2,765.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$2,765.

## Racial Template

-133 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-9 [-90]; IQ-8 [-160]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-6; FP-2 [-6]; Will+8 [40]; Per+10 [50]; Basic Move -3 [-15]; Water Move -1 [-2].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 3 [6]; Amphibious [10]; Clinging (Specific, Branches and Brush, -40%) [12]; Breath-Holding 4 [8]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Double-Jointed [15]; Fangs [2]; Hard to Kill 4 [8]; Hard to Subdue 4 [8]; Long Neck 3 [9]; Metabolism Control 3 (Winter; Hibernation, -60%) [6]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 [6]; Subsonic Hearing (Biological (Passive), -5%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4]; Terrain Adaptation (Sand) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Slippery) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Uneven) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Undergrowth) [5]; Thermal Infrared Vision (Biological (Passive), -5%; Short-Range 1, -10%) [9].

**Poison:** Toxic Attack 1d-2 (Follow-Up, Fangs, +0%; Resistible, HT-4, -10%; Symptoms, Moderate Pain, 1/3 HP, +60%; Symptoms, Severe Pain, 1/2 HP, +80%; Symptoms, Terrible Pain, 2/3 HP, +60%) [6].

**Disadvantages:** Cold-Blooded (50°) [-5]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Low Empathy [-20]; No Manipulators [-50]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Wild Animal [-30].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; No Legs (Slithers).

## Snake, Viper, Small

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 2  | <b>HP</b> | 2   | <b>SM</b>     | -4        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-6/1d-5 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 10  | <b>BL</b>     | 0.8 lbs.  |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-6/1d-5

Most of the statistics remain the same, only the changed ones are listed below.

**Weight:** 1.1 lb.

**Length:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 8 inches when horizontal and 1.5 ft. when upright.

### Movement and Encumbrance

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 0.8 | 1.6   | 2.4    | 4.8   | 8           |

### Combat

**Bite (12):** thrust 1d-6 impaling. Reach C. If the attack hits, the viper may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-5 control against SM-5 and smaller victims or 1d-7 control against larger ones.

In addition, the viper's fangs carry a fast-acting poison. Anyone injured by the bite attack must roll against HT-4 or take 1d-1 toxic damage. When he loses 1/3 of his HP to this poison, he begins suffering from moderate pain (p. B428) until he recovers HP above this threshold. This increases to severe pain upon losing 1/2 HP and terrible pain upon losing 2/3 HP.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-5 control. Reach C. Effective ST 4 due to having Wrestling at DX+2. The viper may grapple not only with its bite, but also with its torso.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.04 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 0.4 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 1                           | 2                           | 4                | 6                           | 8                         |

## Spoils

The poison costs \$6 per dose.

## Capturing and Training

**Young Value:** \$18.

**Untrained Value:** \$90.

**Trained Value:** \$900.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.0001 and 0.0009 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.0009

**Wage (Monthly):** \$27

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Vipers (Small)**

*Battle Rating:* 0.11

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 8/32

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$3,245.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$3,245.

## Racial Template

-120 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-8 [-80]; IQ-8 [-160]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-4; FP-2 [-6]; Will+8 [40]; Per+10 [50]; Basic Move -3 [-15]; Water Move -1 [-2].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 3 [6]; Amphibious [10]; Clinging (Specific, Branches and Brush, -40%) [12]; Breath-Holding 4 [8]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Double-Jointed [15]; Fangs [2]; Hard to Kill 4 [8]; Hard to Subdue 4 [8]; Long Neck 3 [9]; Metabolism Control 3 (Winter; Hibernation, -60%) [6]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 [6]; Subsonic Hearing (Biological (Passive), -5%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4]; Terrain Adaptation (Sand) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Slippery) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Uneven) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Undergrowth) [5]; Thermal Infrared Vision (Biological (Passive), -5%; Short-Range 1, -10%) [9].

**Poison:** Toxic Attack 1d-1 (Follow-Up, Fangs, +0%; Resistible, HT-4, -10%; Symptoms, Moderate Pain, 1/3 HP, +60%; Symptoms, Severe Pain, 1/2 HP, +80%; Symptoms, Terrible Pain, 2/3 HP, +60%) [9].

**Disadvantages:** Cold-Blooded (50°) [-5]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Low Empathy [-20]; No Manipulators [-50]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Wild Animal [-30].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; No Legs (Slithers).

## Snake, Viper, Medium

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 3  | <b>HP</b> | 3   | <b>SM</b>     | -3        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-5/1d-4 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 10  | <b>BL</b>     | 1.8 lbs.  |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-5/1d-4

Most of the statistics remain the same, only the changed ones are listed below.

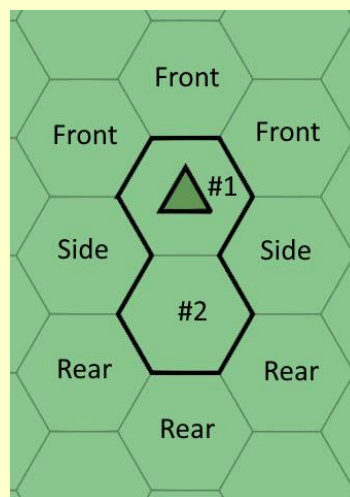
**Weight:** 4.4 lbs.

**Length:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 1 ft. when horizontal and 2 ft. when upright.

### Movement and Encumbrance

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 1.8 | 3.6   | 5.4    | 10.8  | 18          |



## Combat

**Bite (12):** thrust 1d-5 impaling. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the viper may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-4 control against SM-4 and smaller victims or 1d-6 control against larger ones.

In addition, the viper's fangs carry a fast-acting poison. Anyone injured by the bite attack must roll against HT-4 or take 1d toxic damage. When he loses 1/3 of his HP to this poison, he begins suffering from moderate pain (p. B428) until he recovers HP above this threshold. This increases to severe pain upon losing 1/2 HP and terrible pain upon losing 2/3 HP.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-4 control. Reach C from any hex. Effective ST 5 due to having Wrestling at DX+2. The viper may grapple not only with its bite, but also with its torso.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.09 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 0.9 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 3                    | 5         | 8                    | 10                 |

## Spoils

The poison costs \$8 per dose.

## Capturing and Training

**Young Value:** \$30.

**Untrained Value:** \$140.

**Trained Value:** \$1,380.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.0066 and 0.05 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.0014

**Wage (Monthly):** \$40

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Vipers (Medium)**

*Battle Rating:* 0.17

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 8/32

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$4,800.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$4,800.

## Racial Template

-107 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-7 [-70]; IQ-8 [-160]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-3; FP-2 [-6]; Will+8 [40]; Per+10 [50]; Basic Move -3 [-15]; Water Move -1 [-2].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 3 [6]; Amphibious [10]; Clinging (Specific, Branches and Brush, -40%) [12]; Breath-Holding 4 [8]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Double-Jointed [15]; Fangs [2]; Hard to Kill 4 [8]; Hard to Subdue 4 [8]; Long Neck 3 [9]; Metabolism Control 3 (Winter; Hibernation, -60%) [6]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 [6]; Subsonic Hearing (Biological (Passive), -5%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4]; Terrain Adaptation (Sand) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Slippery) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Undergrowth) [5]; Thermal Infrared Vision (Biological (Passive), -5%; Short-Range 1, -10%) [9].

**Poison:** Toxic Attack 1d (Follow-Up, Fangs, +0%; Resistible, HT-4, -10%; Symptoms, Moderate Pain, 1/3 HP, +60%; Symptoms, Severe Pain, 1/2 HP, +80%; Symptoms, Terrible Pain, 2/3 HP, +60%) [12].

**Disadvantages:** Cold-Blooded (50°) [-5]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Low Empathy [-20]; No Manipulators [-50]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Wild Animal [-30].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; No Legs (Slithers).

# Snake, Viper, Large

## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 4  | <b>HP</b> | 4   | <b>SM</b>     | -2        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-5/1d-4 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 10  | <b>BL</b>     | 3.2 lbs.  |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-5/1d-4

Most of the statistics remain the same, only the changed ones are listed below.

**Weight:** 8.8 lbs.

**Length:** 8 ft.

**Effective Height:** 1.5 ft. when horizontal and 1 yd. when upright.

## Movement and Encumbrance

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 3.2 | 6.4   | 9.6    | 19.2  | 32          |

## Combat

**Bite (12):** thrust 1d-5 impaling. Reach C from hex #1 or Reach C-1 from hex #1 when upright. If the attack hits, the viper may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-4 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-6 control against larger ones.



In addition, the viper's fangs carry a fast-acting poison. Anyone injured by the bite attack must roll against HT-4 or take 1d+1 toxic damage. When he loses 1/3 of his HP to this poison, he begins suffering from moderate pain (p. B428) until he recovers HP above this threshold. This increases to severe pain upon losing 1/2 HP and terrible pain upon losing 2/3 HP.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-4 control. Reach C from any hex or Reach C-1 from hex #1 when upright and grappling with a bite. Effective ST 6 due to having

Wrestling at DX+2. The viper may grapple not only with its bite, but also with its torso.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.16 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 1.6 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 3                    | 6         | 9                    | 12                 |

## Spoils

The poison costs \$12 per dose.

## Capturing and Training

**Young Value:** \$30.

**Untrained Value:** \$150.

**Trained Value:** \$1,535.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.0007 and 0.005 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.0016

**Wage (Monthly):** \$45

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Vipers (Large)**

*Battle Rating:* 0.2

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 8/32

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$5,400.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$5,400.

## Racial Template

-91 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-6 [-60]; IQ-8 [-160]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-2; FP-2 [-6]; Will+8 [40]; Per+10 [50]; Basic Move -3 [-15]; Water Move -1 [-2].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 3 [6]; Amphibious [10]; Clinging (Specific, Branches and Brush, -40%) [12]; Breath-Holding 4 [8]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Double-Jointed [15]; Fangs [2]; Hard to Kill 4 [8]; Hard to Subdue 4 [8]; Long Neck 3 [9]; Metabolism Control 3 (Winter; Hibernation, -60%) [6]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 [6]; Subsonic Hearing (Biological (Passive), -5%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4]; Terrain Adaptation (Sand) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Slippery) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Uneven) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Undergrowth) [5]; Thermal Infrared Vision (Biological (Passive), -5%; Short-Range 1, -10%) [9].

**Poison:** Toxic Attack 1d+1 (Follow-Up, Fangs, +0%; Resistible, HT-4, -10%; Symptoms, Moderate Pain, 1/3 HP, +60%; Symptoms, Severe Pain, 1/2 HP, +80%; Symptoms, Terrible Pain, 2/3 HP, +60%) [18].  
**Disadvantages:** Cold-Blooded (50°) [-5]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Low Empathy [-20]; No Manipulators [-50]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Wild Animal [-30].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; No Legs (Slithers).

## Snake, Viper, Huge

### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |     |        |           |
|----|----|----|-----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 6  | HP | 6   | SM     | -1        |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5.5 | thr/sw | 1d-4/1d-3 |
| HT | 12 | FP | 10  | BL     | 7.2 lbs.  |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-4/1d-3

Most of the statistics remain the same, only the changed ones are listed below.

**Weight:** 33 lbs.

**Length:** 4 yd.

**Effective Height:** 2 ft. when horizontal and 1.5 yd. when upright.

### Movement and Encumbrance

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 7.2 | 14.4  | 21.6   | 43.2  | 72          |

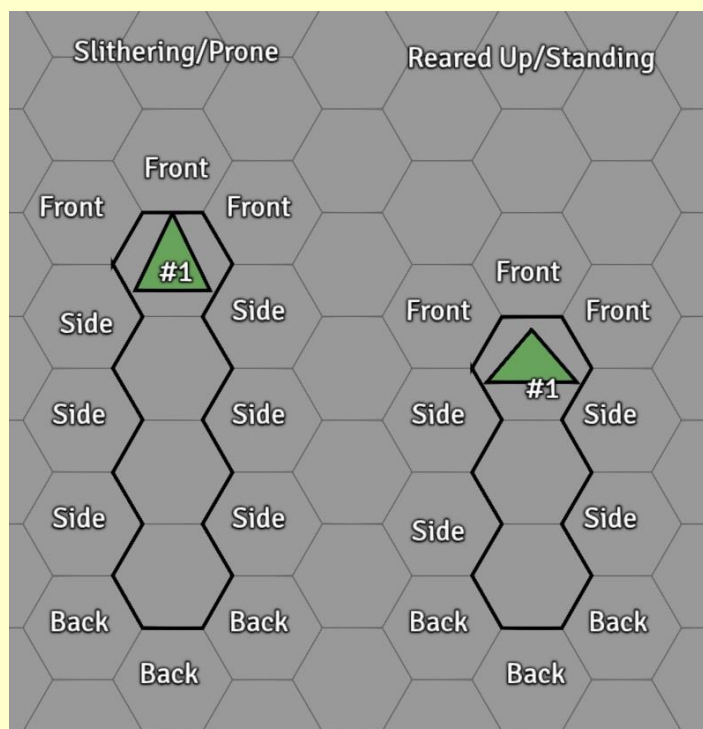
### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** Scaly hide gives the viper DR 1\*.

### Combat

**Bite (12):** thrust 1d-4 impaling. Reach C from hex #1 or Reach C-1 from hex #1 when upright. If the attack hits, the viper may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-3 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d-5 control against larger ones.

In addition, the viper's fangs carry a fast-acting poison. Anyone injured by the bite attack must roll against HT-4 or take 1d+2 toxic damage. When he loses 1/3 of his HP to this poison, he begins suffering from moderate pain (p. B428) until he recovers HP above this threshold. This increases to severe pain upon losing 1/2 HP and terrible pain upon losing 2/3 HP.



**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-3 control. Reach C from any hex or Reach C-1 from hex #1 when upright and grappling with a bite. Effective ST 8 due to having Wrestling at DX+2. The viper may grapple not only with its bite, but also with its torso.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.36 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 3.6 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 4                    | 8         | 12                   | 16                 |

## Spoils

The poison costs \$14 per dose.

## Capturing and Training

**Young Value:** \$40.

**Untrained Value:** \$190.

**Trained Value:** \$1,880.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.001 and 0.01 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.002

**Wage (Monthly):** \$55

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Vipers (Huge)**

*Battle Rating:* 0.2

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 8/32

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$6,600.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$6,600.

## Racial Template

-67 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-4 [-40]; IQ-8 [-160]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM-1; FP-2 [-6]; Will+8 [40]; Per+10 [50]; Basic Move -3 [-15]; Water Move -1 [-2].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 3 [6]; Amphibious [10]; Clinging (Specific, Branches and Brush, -40%) [12]; Breath-Holding 4 [8]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Double-Jointed [15]; DR 1 (Flexible, -20%) [4]; Fangs [2]; Hard to Kill 4 [8]; Hard to Subdue 4 [8]; Long Neck 3 [9]; Metabolism Control 3 (Winter; Hibernation, -60%) [6]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 [6]; Subsonic Hearing (Biological (Passive), -5%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4]; Terrain Adaptation (Sand) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Slippery) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Uneven) [5]; Terrain Adaptation (Undergrowth) [5]; Thermal Infrared Vision (Biological (Passive), -5%; Short-Range 1, -10%) [9].

**Poison:** Toxic Attack 1d+1 (Follow-Up, Fangs, +0%; Resistible, HT-4, -10%; Symptoms, Moderate Pain, 1/3 HP, +60%; Symptoms, Severe Pain, 1/2 HP, +80%; Symptoms, Terrible Pain, 2/3 HP, +60%) [18].

**Disadvantages:** Cold-Blooded (50°) [-5]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Low Empathy [-20]; No Manipulators [-50]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Wild Animal [-30].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; No Legs (Slithers).

# Troglodyte

Type: Humanoid (Reptile, Troglodyte)



**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lbs.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** 10-10. 15% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** G x 2.

Troglodytes, known as "stinkmeat" by the duergar, are cave-dwelling reptilian humanoids with a barbaric culture revolving around food and scent. Their foul odor, especially when threatened or enraged, can sicken nearby creatures, lingering even after their death.

Typically shorter than humans, troglodytes stand 5–6' tall, with spindly, muscular arms, squat legs, and long tails. They have rough, leathery scales, grayish-brown skin that can change color like a chameleon, and lizard-like heads adorned with frills on males. Their black, beady eyes struggle in bright light, complemented by prominent claws and fangs.

## Mentality

Sadistic and constantly at war, troglodytes hunt weaker beings for food, believing the world is filled with threats to their existence, a mindset exacerbated by their raiding behavior. They are shunned by other races due to their savagery and smell, finding solace in isolation and violence against others. While they frequently engage in tribal conflicts, they view fellow tribe members as family, though friendships are uncommon.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (15); Gluttony (9); Sadism (15); Short Attention Span (15).

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Night.

**Diet:** Strictly carnivorous, troglodytes prefer human meat, provoking fierce reactions when detected.

**Habitat:** Troglodytes are most likely found underground or in dense jungles. They have a temperature comfort zone between 35° and 90°, but prefer hotter climates due to being cold-blooded.

**Lifecycle:** Troglodytes remain with a mate for life but will seek new partners if one dies. After a female lays eggs, they are incubated in nearby waterways and protected with leather nets. The eggs are lighter with darker speckles and are removed from water a day before hatching to harden the shells. Troglodytes mature at four years and have an average lifespan of 75 years.

**Temperature Regulation:** The troglodyte is a cold-blooded creature. While it has +2 HT to resist damage from high or low body temperature, it tends to stiffen up in cold weather. After 30 minutes in cold conditions, the troglodyte gets -1 to Basic Speed and DX per 10° below 50°F. The troglodyte regains lost Basic Speed and DX at the rate of one point of each per hour once it returns to a warm climate. Double this rate in an exceptionally warm environment. At temperatures below 32°, the troglodyte must roll vs. HT or take 1 HP of damage.

## Society

Troglodyte leaders are chosen based on strength, with the strongest becoming the chieftain and others serving as sub-chieftains, regardless of gender. Any sign of weakness in leadership incites mutiny. Their clan-based society features a fluid rank system, rooted in their history as a servitor race, often submitting to the most powerful ruler, usually another troglodyte. Incapable of creating advanced tools or trade goods, they highly value metal items as symbols of prowess, often sparking conflict. Tribal wars result in either the destruction of one tribe or a merger under the strongest survivor. Some troglodytes are uncontrollably feral and require confinement.

Young troglodytes are raised by their tribe, encouraged to fight early on, and by age two, can handle weapons. As they mature, they join hunts, with the tribe being nearly evenly split between females and hatchlings. Old troglodytes, having survived numerous years, act as advisors. Most tribe members are warriors, except for dedicated hunter-gatherers and clerics.

**Lairs:** Troglodyte lairs are cavernous spaces connected by tunnels, randomly inhabited by them.

These lairs are filled with half-eaten food, secretions, and stolen treasures. Their proximity to settlements and airflow make them ideal for detecting human scents and other troglodytes. Troglodytes may tame drakes or lizards for protection and mark territories with bloody pictographs and remains to signal their presence.

**Language:** Simplified Black Draconic comprises their spoken language, half of which is non-verbal, relying on a variety of smells, unintelligible to most other races. This limits comprehension for most races to the Broken level, as many concepts are scent-based and untranslatable. Likewise, a troglodyte who uses only vocalization or only smells can only speak at Broken. Troglodyte navigation relies on scent cues rather than maps, guiding travelers by the sequence of smells encountered en route.

**Religion:** Troglodytes originally worshiped the now-forgotten deity of the sarrukh, their creators in the Serpent Realms of Eastern Mishtafalon. After the sarrukh's downfall, they shifted their devotion to Laogzed. They celebrate victories with feasts involving the consumption of their slain enemies, but this desire for frequent feasting often results in over-hunting. Worshiping Laogzed offers little more than the aspiration to be as large and satisfied as he is, with the only advantage being his low expectations. After battles, the tribe's dead are gathered and blessed by a priest in a ceremony called "Renewal," where their meat is "returned" to the tribe.

Occasionally, exceptionally intelligent and strong troglodytes, known as champions, emerge. These champions, typically chieftains, can spew acid as a manifestation of their power. Troglodytes may also honor other Abyssal deities, such as the brutal Demogorgon, through sacrificial rituals.

## Spoils

Troglodyte hide can be used to make leather armor, but it is very difficult to get rid of the stench.

Troglodyte meat is edible, but mildly toxic. Those without at least three levels of Reduced Consumption (Cast-Iron Stomach) must roll against HT after eating troglodyte meat to become nauseated for margin of failure hours (p. B428) and take 1 point of toxic damage.

## Racial Template

13 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** IQ-1 [-20]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Per+1 [5].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 2 [4]; Chameleon 1 [5]; Discriminatory Smell (Emotion Sense, +50%) [23]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Infravision [10]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Reduced Consumption 3 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [3]; Sharp

Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Signals (Chemical Messengers; Limited to Broken without normal speech, -20%) [12].

**Stench:** Affliction 1 (HT; Area Effect, 4 yards, Spherical, +115%; Aura, +80%; Emergencies Only, -30%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%; Nauseated, +30%; Respiratory Agent, +50%) [32].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Ugly) [-8]; Bad Smell [-10]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (15) [-5]; Callous [-5]; Cold-Blooded (50°) [-5]; Gluttony (9) [-7]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Sadism (15) [-7]; Short Attention Span (15) [-5]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10].

**Perks:** Immunity to Troglodyte Stench [1]; Scales [1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 2; Night Vision 5.

## Troglodyte Warrior

*Type: Humanoid (Reptile, Troglodyte)*



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 12 | <b>HP</b> | 12 | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-1/1d+2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | 11 | <b>BL</b>     | 29 lbs.   |

*Reduced Swing: 1d-1/1d+1*

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lbs.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

This is a regular troglodyte warrior who has received traditional weapon training.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 29 | 58    | 87     | 174   | 290         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 10 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 10U (axe); 10 (javelin); 10 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** sunburn, troglodyte stench.

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against damage caused by high or low body temperature; +3 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

## Combat

An unarmed troglodyte can fiercely attack enemies using tooth and claw. They fashion stone tools and excel at throwing javelins before closing in with stone axes and claws. Due to their sensitivity to light, they avoid fire and prefer to attack in the absence of sunlight, though they remain effective fighters even in daylight.

Typically, a troglodyte warrior carries two javelins.

**Stone Axe (12):** swing 2d(0.5) cutting (RS: 2d-1(0.5)), Reach 1, unbalanced, 4 lbs. Treated as cheap for breakage purposes when parrying a swung weapon made of metal.

**Stone Javelin throw (14):** thrust 1d(0.5) impaling, Acc 3, x1.5/x2.5 (18/30), 2 lbs., Bulk -4.

**Stone Javelin thrust (12):** thrust 1d(0.5) impaling, Reach 1, 2 lbs. Treated as cheap for breakage purposes when parrying a swung weapon made of metal.

**Bite (12):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the troglodyte may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-1 control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-3 control against larger ones.

**Claws (12):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C.

**Grapple (12):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.45 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 14.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 6                    | 12        | 18                   | 24                 |

## Special Abilities

**Camouflage:** A troglodyte's skin can change color and texture to resemble its surroundings. In any

situation where being seen is a factor, the troglodyte gets +2 to Stealth skill when perfectly still, or +1 if moving. If for some reason the troglodyte is wearing clothes, this bonus is reduced to +1 when the troglodyte is motionless, with no bonus if it is moving. This ability only affects normal vision.

**Stench:** When a troglodyte is angry or frightened, it secretes an oily, musk-like chemical that nearly every form of animal life finds offensive. Any creature that inhales the stench exuded by the troglodyte in a 4-yard radius must make a successful HT roll or become nauseated for margin of failure minutes. Troglodytes are immune to this effect. Even when this ability is inactive, the troglodytes exude a bad smell (-2 to reaction).

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furies*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Holding Your Breath (p. B351).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | 16          | 10    |

**Vision:** The troglodyte possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

Aside from normal vision, the troglodyte can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

The eyes of the troglodyte are adapted to darkness; its **native illumination level is -5**. This lets it see and fight at no penalty at night, but it suffers a -5 penalty during the day. When hunting underground, the troglodyte prefers to use Infravision to avoid darkness penalties.

**Smell:** Troglodytes can interpret basic emotions and desires of others people and animals via smell within 2 yards as per **Empathy** (p. B51), while also having **Discriminatory Smell** (p. B49). They also use their sense of smell for communication.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 9    |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (15); Gluttony (9); Sadism (15); Short Attention Span (15).

## **Skills**

Axe/Mace-12; Brawling-12; Spear-12; Stealth-14;  
Thrown Weapon (Spear)-14; Survival (Underdark)-  
12.

## **Spoils**

**Treasure Type:** A.

## **Capturing and Training**

Troglodytes are rarely enslaved due to their unbearable stench, but they occasionally can be found serving as mercenaries in the underground realms.

**Young Value:** \$315.

**Untrained Value:** \$1,570.

**Trained Value:** \$15,720.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.13 and 1 lb./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.016

**Wage (Monthly):** \$470

## **Mass Combat Statistics**

### **120 Troglodyte Warriors**

*Battle Rating:* 2

*Classes:* Recon.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$160.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$56,600.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$59,250.

# Troll

Type: Giant (Troll)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |         |
|----|----|----|----|--------|---------|
| ST | 18 | HP | 18 | SM     | +1      |
| DX | 11 | BS | 6  | thr/sw | 1d+2/3d |
| HT | 13 | FP | 13 | BL     | 65 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d+2/2d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 500 lbs.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-12. 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E, C.

Trolls are bestial giants driven by unrelenting hunger, falling between animal predators and other giants. These rubber-skinned brutes cherish strength, craving slaughter and destruction above all else. Confident that most creatures can't inflict lasting injuries, trolls fight fearlessly. Despite their savage nature, they are capable of reasoning beyond their next meal, though they focus intensely on food when it's available.

Trolls have severe hunches, causing their hands to drag as they walk upright, with arms dangling when they run. Despite their awkward appearance, trolls are agile and excellent climbers.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 65 | 130   | 195    | 390   | 650         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 2\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Weaknesses:** -5 to HT against mutagenic effects.

## Combat

Trolls hunt various living creatures without concern for the size or number of their prey and have no fear of death, often using All-Out Attacks. In combat, trolls flail with clawed hands and bite fiercely, rarely using weapons, but sometimes throwing large stones before attacking.

**Bite (14):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the troll may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d-1 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d+1 control against larger ones.

**Claws (14):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 2d-1 control. Reach C-1. Effective ST 20 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 3.25 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 32.5 lbs.

## Control Thresholds

| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| 2                    | 10                   | 20        | 30                   | 40                 |

## Special Abilities

**Flexibility:** Notably flexible, trolls get +3 on Climbing, Erotic Art, and Escape rolls, and can ignore up to -3 penalties for working in close quarters.

**Regeneration:** Trolls' most notorious ability is their regeneration, recovering 1 HP per second unless injured by fire or acid. They can also regrow lost limbs and organs, provided the stump wasn't exposed to fire or acid. All parts regenerate as the troll heals to full HP.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).  
Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 6       | 14          | 10    |

**Vision:** The eyes of the troll are adapted to darkness; its **native illumination level** is -5. This lets

it see and fight at no penalty at night, but it suffers a -5 penalty during the day.

Aside from normal vision, the troll can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

**Smell:** The troll has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

**Hearing:** Trolls are **Hard of Hearing** (p. B138).

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 11   |

Known for their bad tempers and bullying weaker creatures, trolls prefer to gorge themselves well beyond what is necessary to satisfy their hunger.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Gluttony (12).

### Skills

Brawling-14; Climbing-14\*; Stealth-12; Survival (Any)-14; Tracking-14; Traps-12; Wrestling-14.

\* Includes +3 from Flexibility

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Primarily nocturnal, trolls use their olfactory and visual abilities to hunt at night.

**Diet:** Trolls have voracious appetites, consuming at least 13.6 lbs. of meat daily. They focus on acquiring food by exploring, ambushing, or tracking prey. They prefer to eat immediately but will carry food back to their lair if necessary.

**Habitat:** Trolls inhabit various climates, including the Underdark, operating within a 10-mile radius of their lairs, comfortable between -17° and 116°F. They aren't overly territorial with non-trolls and often lead semi-nomadic lives, moving once they deplete nearby settlements.

**Lairs:** Troll dens consist of two to four connected natural caverns with small entrances (about 2x2 yards). They often disguise or bar entry with boulders or other materials. Trolls prefer caves with strewn boulders or stalactites for ambushes and ideally have two entrances for better escape and attack strategies.

**Lifecycle:** Trolls live up to 100 years, maturing in 10 years and able to fend for themselves within a year. They learn through harsh experiences and are taught to fear fire and revere barbaric gods like Vaprak, Erythnul, and Kremor. Trolls consider other races as food.

**Reproduction:** Trolls mate irregularly with a low birth rate. "Mate-rut," a foul-smelling signal, indicates readiness to breed. Courtship involves brawls led by dominant females and sometimes sharing a kill. Pregnant trolls require vast amounts of food, and a year-long gestation usually results in one newborn.

### Society

**Clans:** Trolls form small clans or family groups due to their chaotic nature. These manageable groups enable effective hunting and mutual protection, with matriarchal leadership due to stronger females. Interactions between clans are limited to meetings for news sharing or trading males and magic items. Clans generally avoid trespassing on each other's territory unless seeking conflict but may unite against common foes.

**Culture:** Troll culture relies on oral tradition, attributing divine origins to clan founders. They consider themselves superior to other giants due to their connection to primal chaos. Trolls seldom engage in crafts or farming; instead, they acquire treasures through theft or conquest, valuing magic items above all for their power. Trolls may express themselves through cave drawings depicting hunts and wars, often referencing their dark gods.

**Origin:** The origin of trolls is uncertain. Scholars classify them as giants, though true giants don't recognize them as such. Legends suggest trolls originated from Vaprak's daughters, making them descendants of Annam All-Father through an unwanted union. Trolls also believe they descended from a dark Earth Mother.

**Relationships:** Trolls have few natural enemies, but threats include creatures large enough to swallow and digest them, such as dragons and purple worms. Only incorporeal undead inspire fear in them.

### Spoils

When designing troll hide armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid* #3-52, use the following statistics: WM 0.8, Cost \$40, DR/inch 9, Max DR 5, Combustible, Flexible, Construction: fabric, layered fabric, scale. If damaged, troll hide armor regenerates 1 HP per second unless damaged by fire or acid.

Weapons and other items crafted from troll bone regenerate 1 HP per second unless damaged by fire or acid.

Troll flesh, valued at \$50 per pound, is used in alchemical potions and ointments for HP restoration, though they smell and taste foul. Consuming such elixirs requires a HT-2 roll to avoid retching, which renders the potion ineffective. Using ointments results in Bad Smell (-2 reaction) for 8 hours.

A 6-lbs. troll brain, extractable with a Surgery roll and 30 minutes of work, counts as 4 EP for enchanting *rings of regeneration*. A troll soul contributes 10 EP for enchanting regenerative *pearly white ioun stones*.

### Capturing and Training

Though generally avoided by good races due to their predatory behavior, trolls can serve as

mercenaries for more intelligent monsters like ogres and giants.

**Young Value:** \$2,830.

**Untrained Value:** \$14,140.

**Trained Value:** \$141,415.

**Supply Cost:** \$24 and 27.2 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.147

**Wage (Monthly):** \$4,240

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Trolls

*Battle Rating:* 9

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 28/112

*Supply (Weekly):* \$19,200.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$182,550.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$331,350.

## Racial Template

127 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+8 (Size Modifier, -10%) [72]; DX+1 [20]; IQ-2 [-40]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Will+3 [15]; Per+2 [10]; Basic Move +1 [5]

**Advantages:** DR 2 (Tough Skin, -40%) [6]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Extended Lifespan 0.5 [1]; Infravision [10]; Regeneration (Very Fast; Bane, Acid or Fire, -50%) [50]; Regrowth (Bane, Acid or Fire, -50%) [20]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Temperature Tolerance 6 (4xHT to cold; 2xHT to hot) [6].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (12) [-10]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Increased Consumption 1 [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10]; Susceptible to Mutagenic Effects 5 [-5].

**Features:** Early Maturation 1; Night Vision 5.

## Troll Hunter

*Type:* Giant (Troll)



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 20 | <b>HP</b> | 20  | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 13 | <b>BS</b> | 6.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 2d-1/3d+2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 13 | <b>FP</b> | 13  | <b>BL</b>     | 80 lbs.   |

*Reduced Swing:* 2d-1/2d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 500 lbs.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** C.

Some trolls, more cunning than most, are not satisfied with merely eating civilized beings but train to hunt them relentlessly. These troll hunters are fearsome rangers who focus on slaying and devouring humanoid prey.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 80 | 160   | 240    | 480   | 800         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 2\* (tough skin). Torso is protected by light mail armor that provides DR 3\* (-2 vs. crushing).

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 11U (great axe); 11 (unarmed); 8 (javelin).

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Weaknesses:** -5 to HT against mutagenic effects.

## Combat

A troll hunter makes full use of its Discriminatory Smell to track enemies and generally prefers to hunt in darkness. Like most other trolls, it is not reluctant to use All-Out Attacks against weaker creatures.

**SM+1 Great Axe (15):** swing 5d+1 cutting (RS: 4d), Reach 1-3\*, unbalanced, becomes unready after attacking, 18 lbs.

**SM+1 Javelin throw (15):** thrust 2d+1 impaling, Acc 3, x1.5/x2.5 (30/50), 4.5 lbs., Bulk -4.

**SM+1 Javelin thrust (8):** thrust 2d+1 impaling, Reach 1, 4.5 lbs.

**Bite (15):** thrust 2d cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the troll may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d+1 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 2d-1 control against larger ones.

**Claws (15):** thrust 2d cutting. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (15):** thrust 2d+1 control. Reach C-1. Effective ST 22 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 4 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 40 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 11                   | 22        | 33                   | 44                 |

## Special Abilities

**Flexibility:** Notably flexible, trolls get +3 on Climbing, Erotic Art, and Escape rolls, and can ignore up to -3 penalties for working in close quarters.

**Regeneration:** Trolls' most notorious ability is their regeneration, recovering 1 HP per second unless injured by fire or acid. They can also regrow lost limbs and organs, provided the stump wasn't exposed to fire or acid. All parts regenerate as the troll heals to full HP.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furies*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid #3-77*, pp. 4-5).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 7       | 15          | 11    |

**Vision:** The eyes of the troll are adapted to darkness; its **native illumination level is -5**. This lets it see and fight at no penalty at night, but it suffers a -5 penalty during the day.

Aside from normal vision, the troll can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

**Smell:** The troll has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

**Hearing:** Trolls are **Hard of Hearing** (p. B138).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 11   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Gluttony (12).

## Skills

Brawling-15; Climbing-15\*; Stealth-13; Survival (Any)-15; Thrown Weapon (Spear)-15; Tracking-15; Traps-14; Two-Handed Axe/Mace-15; Wrestling-15.

\* Includes +3 from Flexibility

## Equipment

SM+1 Great Axe (\$225; 18 lbs.)

SM+1 Javelin (\$68; 4.5 lbs.)

SM+1 Light Mail Armor (torso) (DR 3\*; \$1,125; 27 lbs.; Don 15; Holdout -1)

*Total Weight:* 49.5 lbs.

*Total Cost:* \$1,418

## Capturing and Training

The costs below do not include equipment.

**Young Value:** \$2,830.

**Untrained Value:** \$19,200.

**Trained Value:** \$192,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$24 and 27.2 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.2

**Wage (Monthly):** \$5,760

## Mass Combat Statistics

**60 Troll Hunters**

*Battle Rating:* 12

*Classes:* Recon.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 28/112

*Supply (Weekly):* \$19,200.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$345,580.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$424,380.

# Troll, Scrag

Type: Giant (Troll)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |           |
|----|----|----|----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 16 | HP | 16 | SM     | +1        |
| DX | 11 | BS | 6  | thr/sw | 1d+1/2d+2 |
| HT | 13 | FP | 13 | BL     | 51 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+1/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.  
**Weight:** 400 lbs.  
**Height:** 8 ft.  
**Effective Height:** 9 ft.  
**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).  
**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).  
**Organization:** 1-12. 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E, C.

A scrag, or river troll, freshwater troll, aquatic troll, or hool, is a gilled variant of the common troll. They reside in large freshwater bodies, needing ample space to hunt. Smaller than regular trolls, scraggs have heavy scales, less formidable claws, and an enlarged jaw with sharp fangs.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 51 | 102   | 153    | 306   | 510         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 3\*.

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Sunburn.

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Weaknesses:** -5 to HT against mutagenic effects; immersion in saline water (1d HP per 30 minutes).

**Notes:** The scrag's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +1 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

## Combat

Scraggs don't use tools or weapons, attacking with reckless claw swings and bites at anything nearby.

**Bite (14):** thrust 1d+1 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the scrag may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+2 control against SM-1 and smaller victims or 1d control against larger ones.

**Claws (14):** thrust 1d+1 cutting. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d+2 control. Reach C-1. Effective ST 18 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.55 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 25.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 9                    | 18        | 27                   | 36                 |

## Special Abilities

**Flexibility:** Notably flexible, scraggs get +3 on Climbing, Erotic Art, and Escape rolls, and can ignore up to -3 penalties for working in close quarters.

**Regeneration:** Scraggs' most notorious ability is their regeneration, recovering 1 HP per second when immersed in freshwater unless injured by fire or acid.

They can also regrow lost limbs and organs when immersed in freshwater, provided the stump wasn't exposed to fire or acid. All parts regenerate as the scrag heals to full HP.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Teeth (p. MA115).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid* #3-26, pp. 7-8).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 6       | 14          | 10    |

**Vision:** The eyes of the scrag are adapted to darkness; its **native illumination level is -5**. This lets it see and fight at no penalty at night, but it suffers a -5 penalty during the day.

Aside from normal vision, the scrag can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infra-vision** (p. B60).

**Smell:** The scrag has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49). Its smell can operate both in air and underwater.

**Hearing:** Scrag are **Hard of Hearing** (p. B138).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 11   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Gluttony (12).

## Skills

Brawling-14; Stealth-12; Survival (Freshwater Lake or River/Stream)-14; Swimming-16; Tracking-14; Wrestling-14.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Primarily nocturnal, scrag use their olfactory and visual abilities to hunt at night.

**Aquatic:** Scrag are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. They can breathe water but cannot breathe air. Scrag are able to speak underwater.

**Diet:** Scrag have voracious appetites, consuming at least 13.6 lbs. of meat daily. They prefer to eat immediately but will carry food back to their lair if necessary. Scrag consider other races as food.

**Habitat:** Scrag prefer large lakes or rivers that have enough prey to hunt, comfortable between 35° and 103°F.

Scrag can survive at pressures up to 10 atmospheres. This lets them live comfortably at a depth up to 112 yards.

**Lifecycle:** Scrag live up to 100 years, maturing in 10 years and able to fend for themselves within a year.

**Reproduction:** Scrag mate irregularly with a low birth rate. Pregnant scrag require vast amounts of food, and a year-long gestation usually results in one newborn.

## Society

Scrag form small clans or family groups due to their chaotic nature. These manageable groups enable effective hunting and mutual protection, with matriarchal leadership due to stronger females.

## Spoils

When designing scrag hide armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid* #3-52, use the following statistics: WM 1, Cost \$40, DR/inch 11, Max DR 6, Combustible, Flexible, Construction: fabric, layered fabric, scale. If damaged, scrag hide armor regenerates 1 HP per second if immersed in freshwater unless damaged by fire or acid.

Weapons and other items crafted from scrag bone regenerate 1 HP per second if immersed in freshwater unless damaged by fire or acid.

Scrag flesh, valued at \$50 per pound, is used in alchemical potions and ointments for HP restoration, though they smell and taste foul. Consuming such elixirs requires a HT-2 roll to avoid retching, which renders the potion ineffective. Using ointments results in Bad Smell (-2 reaction) for 8 hours.

A 6-lbs. scrag brain, extractable with a Surgery roll and 30 minutes of work, counts as 4 EP for enchanting *rings of regeneration*. A scrag soul contributes 10 EP for enchanting regenerative *pearly white ioun stones*.

## Capturing and Training

Though generally avoided by good races due to their predatory behavior, scrag can serve as mercenaries for more intelligent monsters like merrow and ocean giants.

**Young Value:** \$2,360.

**Untrained Value:** \$11,800.

**Trained Value:** \$118,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$24 and 27.2 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.123

**Wage (Monthly):** \$3,540

## Mass Combat Statistics

**60 Scrag**

*Battle Rating:* 7.5

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 28/112 (land or water)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$19,200.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$140,340.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$217,140.

## Racial Template

85 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+6 (Size Modifier, -10%) [54]; DX+1 [20]; IQ-2 [-40]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Will+3 [15]; Per+2 [10]; Basic Move +1 [5]

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; DR 3 (Flexible, -20%) [12]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Extended Lifespan 0.5 [1]; Infravision [10]; Pressure Support 1 [5]; Regeneration (Very Fast; Accessibility, Only when immersed in freshwater, -40%; Bane, Acid or Fire, -50%) [20]; Regrowth (Accessibility, Only when immersed in freshwater, -40%; Bane, Acid or Fire, -50%) [8]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Speak Underwater [5]; Temperature Tolerance 1 (Hot) [1].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (12) [-10]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Increased Consumption 1 [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10]; Susceptible to Mutagenic Effects 5 [-5]; Weakness (Immersion in saline water, 1d per 30 minutes) [-5].

**Perks:** Scales [1]; Universal Smell [1].

**Features:** Doesn't Breathe (Gills); Early Maturation 1; Night Vision 5.

# Troll, Scrag, Marine

Type: Giant (Troll)



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 17 | <b>HP</b> | 18 | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+2/3d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 13 | <b>FP</b> | 13 | <b>BL</b>     | 58 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+2/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 500 lbs.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Hideous (-4 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-12. 40% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E, C.

A marine scrag, or saltwater troll, is a gilled variety of the common troll with coloration ranging from blue-green to olive. These scraggs have thick, scaled skin, and some use armor made from shells or sharkskin. They possess short, weak forelimbs but have developed a large maw with numerous fangs.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 58 | 116   | 174    | 348   | 580         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 3\*.

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 11 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Sunburn.

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Weaknesses:** -5 to HT against mutagenic effects.

**Notes:** The marine scrag's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +1 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

## Combat

Marine scraggs attack with reckless claw swings and bites, often targeting seagoing vessels by clawing into the hull and climbing onboard to attack the crew.

**Bite (14):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the marine scrag may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d-1 control against SM-1 and smaller victims or 1d+1 control against larger ones.

**Claws (14):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 2d-1 control. Reach C-1. Effective ST 19 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.9 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 29 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 10                   | 19        | 29                   | 38                 |

## Special Abilities

**Flexibility:** Notably flexible, marine scraggs get +3 on Climbing, Erotic Art, and Escape rolls, and can ignore up to -3 penalties for working in close quarters.

**Regeneration:** Marine scraggs' most notorious ability is their regeneration, recovering 1 HP per second when immersed in saline water unless injured by fire or acid. They can also regrow lost limbs and organs when immersed in saline water, provided the stump wasn't exposed to fire or acid. All parts regenerate as the marine scrag heals to full HP.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Teeth (p. MA115).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid* #3-26, pp. 7-8).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 6       | 14          | 10    |

**Vision:** The eyes of the marine scrag are adapted to darkness; its **native illumination level** is -5. This

lets it see and fight at no penalty at night, but it suffers a -5 penalty during the day.

Aside from normal vision, the marine scrag can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

**Smell:** The marine scrag has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49). Its smell can operate both in air and underwater.

**Hearing:** Marine scrag are **Hard of Hearing** (p. B138).

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 11   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (12); Gluttony (12).

### Skills

Brawling-14; Climbing-15\*; Stealth-12; Survival (Open Ocean or Salt-Water Sea)-14; Swimming-16; Tracking-14; Wrestling-14.

\* Includes +3 from Flexibility.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Primarily nocturnal, marine scrag use their olfactory and visual abilities to hunt at night.

**Aquatic:** Marine scrag are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. They can breathe water but cannot breathe air. Marine scrag are able to speak underwater. Unlike their freshwater cousins, they can live both in saline and fresh water.

**Diet:** Marine scrag have voracious appetites, consuming at least 13.6 lbs. of meat daily. They prefer to eat immediately but will carry food back to their lair if necessary. Marine scrag consider other races as food.

**Habitat:** The saltwater scrag is found in seas and oceans, comfortable between 35° and 103°F.

Marine scrag can survive at pressures up to 100 atmospheres. This lets them live comfortably at a depth up to 1,100 yards, but they prefer depths between 100 and 200 yards.

**Lifecycle:** Marine scrag live up to 100 years, maturing in 10 years and able to fend for themselves within a year.

**Reproduction:** Marine scrag mate irregularly with a low birth rate. Pregnant marine scrag require vast amounts of food, and a year-long gestation usually results in one newborn.

### Society

Marine scrag are a matriarchal species, led by a female chieftain/shaman who uses her intelligence and magic to find prey. Typically, a small group of

three or four marine scrag, led by their chieftain, hunt for the rest of the tribe, though the chieftain rarely participates in attacks.

### Spoils

When designing marine scrag hide armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid #3-52*, use the following statistics: WM 1, Cost \$40, DR/inch 11, Max DR 6, Combustible, Flexible, Construction: fabric, layered fabric, scale. If damaged, marine scrag hide armor regenerates 1 HP per second if immersed in saline water unless damaged by fire or acid.

Weapons and other items crafted from marine scrag bone regenerate 1 HP per second if immersed in saline water unless damaged by fire or acid.

Marine scrag flesh, valued at \$50 per pound, is used in alchemical potions and ointments for HP restoration, though they smell and taste foul. Consuming such elixirs requires a HT-2 roll to avoid retching, which renders the potion ineffective. Using ointments results in Bad Smell (-2 reaction) for 8 hours.

A 6-lbs. marine scrag brain, extractable with a Surgery roll and 30 minutes of work, counts as 4 EP for enchanting *rings of regeneration*. A marine scrag soul contributes 10 EP for enchanting regenerative *pearly white ioun stones*.

### Capturing and Training

Though generally avoided by good races due to their predatory behavior, marine scrag can serve as mercenaries for more intelligent monsters like merrow and ocean giants.

**Young Value:** \$2,600.

**Untrained Value:** \$13,100.

**Trained Value:** \$131,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$24 and 27.2 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.137

**Wage (Monthly):** \$3,930

### Mass Combat Statistics

**60 Marine Scrag**

*Battle Rating:* 8

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 28/112 (land or water)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$19,200.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$163,900.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$240,700.

## Racial Template

*106 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+7 (Size Modifier, -10%) [63]; DX+1 [20]; IQ-2 [-40]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; HP+1 (Size Modifier, -10%) [2]; Will+3 [15]; Per+2 [10]; Basic Move +1 [5]

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; DR 3 (Flexible, -20%) [12]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Extended Lifespan 0.5 [1]; Infravision [10]; Pressure Support 2 [10]; Regeneration (Very Fast; Accessibility, Only when immersed in saline water, -40%; Bane, Acid or Fire, -50%) [20]; Regrowth (Accessibility, Only when immersed in saline water, -40%; Bane, Acid or Fire, -50%) [8]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Speak Underwater [5]; Temperature Tolerance 1 (Hot) [1].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Hideous) [-16]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (12) [-10]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Hard of Hearing [-10]; Increased Consumption 1 [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10]; Susceptible to Mutagenic Effects 5 [-5].

**Perks:** Scales [1]; Universal Smell [1].

**Features:** Doesn't Breathe (Gills); Early Maturation 1; Night Vision 5.

# Umbur Hulk

Type: Aberration (Umbur Hulk)



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 19 | <b>HP</b> | 19   | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.75 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 2d-1/3d+1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 13 | <b>FP</b> | 13   | <b>BL</b>     | 72 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 2d-1/2d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 800 lbs.

**Height:** 8 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft. when horizontal and 9 ft. when upright.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-4. 30% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** C.

Umbur hulks are four-eyed, heavily armored creatures that dwell deep underground. With a blend of gorilla-like strength and beetle-like armor, they easily tunnel through rock using massive claws. Their defining features include a pair of 8-inch mandibles, sharp teeth, and two sets of eyes—compound eyes on the sides of their heads and smaller, ape-like eyes on their foreheads. Covered in steel-tough, chitinous plates, they have gill-like openings instead of noses, suggesting possible aquatic ancestry. Their large, dark bodies limit their movement in open spaces, making them more agile in narrow tunnels.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

Typically, the umbur hulk moves on all four limbs, but it is able to awkwardly walk upright with Move 4. While upright, the umbur hulk can use both forearms to attack and parry. Its effective height for the purpose of combat modifiers becomes 9 ft. Umbur hulks with DX 12 or more can carry a small object or two while walking.

**Tunneling:** Move 1; exploration 0.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 72 | 144   | 216    | 432   | 720         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 8.

**Antennae** (-7): DR 0. 1 HP of injury cripples an antenna; any excess injury is lost.

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Umbur hulk confusing gaze.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Notes:** A character can target an umbur hulk's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Umbur Hulk) roll.

The umbur hulk's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +3 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

Unlike most creatures, the umbur hulk has four eyes.

## Combat

Driven primarily by hunger, umbur hulks hunt selectively, targeting weaker prey. They raid settlements and dungeons but limit kills to allow food sources to recover. Using feelers, they sense movement and lie in ambush near strategic points, sometimes peeking through small holes to assess targets. When attacking, they deploy a disorienting gaze, and if overpowered, they retreat tactically—causing cave-ins, leading enemies into dead ends, creating circular paths, flooding areas, collapsing tunnels, or setting pitfall traps to evade or regroup.

**Mandibles (12):** thrust 2d cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the umbur hulk may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d-1 control against SM+1 and smaller victims or 1d+1 control against larger ones.

**Blunt Claws (12):** thrust 2d+2 crushing. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 2d-1 control. Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 3.6 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 36 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 10                   | 19        | 29                   | 38                 |

## Special Abilities

**Breath-Holding:** Even though umber hulks are not adept swimmers, they are able to hold their breath 8 times longer than normal.

**Confusing Gaze:** With a Ready maneuver, the umber hulk can activate or deactivate this magical ability. When it is active, anyone who meets the umber hulk's gaze with their own must make a Fright Check using the confusion variant from page 85 of *GURPS Powers*. The victim gets +1 to resist per each exposure to Confusion Gaze after the first within 24 hours. Regardless of the result, the victim becomes immune to this ability for one hour. UMBER hulks are immune to this ability.

See *Avoiding Gaze Attacks* (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8) for details on averting or hiding one's eyes.

## Useful Combat Rules

Avoiding Gaze Attacks (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Holding Your Breath (p. B351).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 15          | 11    |

**Vision:** The umber hulk possesses **Peripheral Vision** (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

Aside from normal vision, the umber hulk can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

**Smell:** The umber hulk has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

**Tremorsense (10):** The umber hulk can feel faint movements in the surface it is standing on with a Sense roll, including earth tremors, distant explosions, and footsteps. Modify the roll for loudness and distance as for sound (p. B358). If lying full length (burrowing without building a tunnel counts automatically), roll at +2!

This sense relies on the umber hulk's antennae. The antennae have no DR. They can be targeted at -7, and have 1 HP each; any excess injury is lost. Losing one antenna imposes a -4 penalty on Sense rolls to use this ability, and losing both disables this sense.

**Vibration Sense (10):** Vibration Sense lets the umber hulk make a Sense roll subject to *separate* bonuses for the target's size, speed (invert the penalty), and a penalty for range to the target based on the *Size and Speed/Range Table* (p. B550) to detect something by sensing vibrations that propagate

through the air. Success allows ignoring visibility penalties in combat that second. Wind will generate "noise" that imposes penalties, and the same penalties are applied to attacks that rely on this ability.

Just like Tremorsense, this sense relies on the umber hulk's antennae.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 12   |

UMBER hulks are often seen as mindless brutes, a misconception they accept. Although not highly intelligent, they can think rationally and plan ahead. They rarely need complex strategies or technology, relying on their strength, but can use earth-shaping skills if necessary.

Solitary by nature, umber hulks don't hate each other but find no advantage in cooperation, as they handle threats alone. They prefer staying underground due to their aversion to light.

**Mentality Traits:** Dislikes bright lights; Uncongenial.

## Other Traits

Bad Grip 2.

## Skills

Brawling-12; Engineer (Mining)-12; Prospecting-11; Stealth-11; Survival (Underdark)-13; Traps-12.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Diet consists mainly of underground creatures like purple worms and ankhegs, though they favor humanoids as a delicacy. Rumors suggest they digest precious metals, but this is unproven. Their teeth chew food rather than serve in combat. Some caves they inhabit support fungi and lichen, consumed by insects they deliberately encourage for sustenance.

**Habitat:** UMBER hulks inhabit the Underdark, thriving in temperatures between 35° and 90°F.

**Lifecycle:** UMBER hulks appear identical, regardless of gender. Males live about 50 years, females 75. Females are rarer, with males defending them even at personal risk, but leave post-mating. Females birth 1–3 young, nurturing them in caves. Young learn hunting after two years, maturing quickly to live independently. Initially, mothers hunt extensively to feed their offspring until they're grown and can start their own broods.

## Society

UMBER hulks are mainly solitary, with little known about any societal structures. Rumors suggest they have underground cities with web-like tunnels

and may use precious metals as currency, though not all value them. Sometimes, they live in small groups, usually mothers with offspring. Their lairs are large caves marked by claw scratches, likely from creating the cavern or sharpening claws.

**Language:** They speak Umber Hulk (or "Hulkish,") a harsh language of hisses, grunts, gestures, and facial movements. It is easy to learn but difficult for non-umber hulks to replicate. Some understand Terran and Neogi.

**Relations:** Umber hulks lack alliances and are often enslaved by other races. Hated by underground races, they inadvertently cause conflicts by creating tunnels near ore veins, connecting isolated groups and sparking wars. The phrase "chasing an umber hulk" among dwarves describes a risky but potentially rewarding prospecting strategy.

### Spoils

Umber hulks destroy items they can't use but collect curiosities and food, securing them with simple traps. Other races harvest umber hulks for hides, mandibles, and eyes, using them for equipment and potions. When designing umber hulk plate armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid* #3-52, use the following statistics: WM 0.58, Cost \$60, DR/inch 70, Max DR 16, Construction: plate, scale, solid.

An umber hulk mandible can be used as an improvised small axe at -1 to skill. In addition, each mandible counts as 1 EP for enchanted items that destroy earth. Two forehead eyes of the umber hulk that produce the confusion gaze count as 1 EP each for enchanted items that induce madness.

### Capturing and Training

Neogi enslave young umber hulks as servants, while illithids and human spellcasters exploit them for muscle. Willingly working for some evil races, they serve as guards or labor if kept underground. Though obedient if fed well, they may turn on their masters unexpectedly.

**Young Value:** \$2,300.

**Untrained Value:** \$11,400.

**Trained Value:** \$114,300.

**Supply Cost:** \$18 and 6.8 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Umbur Hulk).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.119

**Wage (Monthly):** \$3,430

### Mass Combat Statistics

**60 Umber Hulks**

*Battle Rating:* 7

*Classes:* Eng.

*Features:* Night, Terrain (Underground).

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 28/112 (land) or 4/16 (burrowing)

**Supply (Weekly):** \$9,600.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$172,200.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$210,500.

### Racial Template

225 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+9 (Size Modifier, -10%) [81]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Will+2 [10]; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move +2 [10].

**Advantages:** Blunt Claws [3]; Breath-Holding 3 [6]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; DR 8 [40]; Infravision [10]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Subsonic Hearing (Biological (Passive), -5%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4]; Tunneling (Move 1) [35]; Vibration Sense (Air; Biological (Passive), -5%) [10].

**Confusing Gaze:** Terror (Confusion; Magical, -10%; Vision-Based, Reversed, -20%) [21].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous) [-20]; Bad Grip 2 [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Semi-Upright [-5]; Short Lifespan 1 [-10]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15].

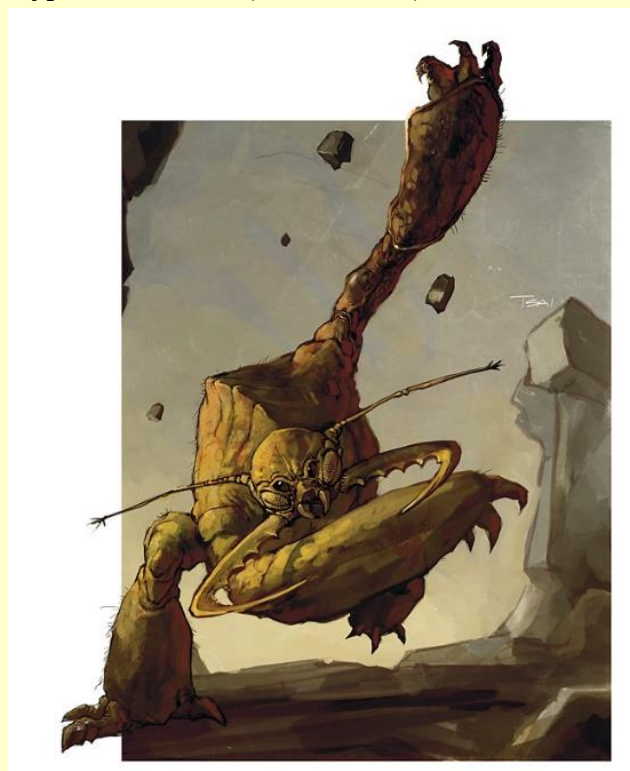
**Perks:** Immunity to Umber Hulk Confusing Gaze [1].

**Quirks:** Dislikes bright lights [-1]; Uncongenial [-1].

**Features:** Born Biter 3; Early Maturation 2; Four Eyes.

## Truly Horrid Umber Hulk

*Type: Aberration (Umbur Hulk)*



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 27 | <b>HP</b> | 35   | <b>SM</b>     | +3        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 6.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 3d-1/5d+1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 15 | <b>FP</b> | 15   | <b>BL</b>     | 146 lbs.  |

*Reduced Swing:* 3d-1/3d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 8,000 lbs.

**Height:** 18 ft.

**Effective Height:** 15 ft. when horizontal and 21 ft. when upright.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 30% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E, C.

Umbur hulks have been known to grow to tremendous size and strength. Phenomenally powerful, the truly horrid umbur hulk is a loner that is feared even by its own kind.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 9; exploration 4.5 miles per hour.

Typically, the truly horrid umbur hulk moves on all four limbs, but it is able to awkwardly walk upright with Move 5. While upright, the truly horrid umbur hulk can use both forearms to attack and parry. Its effective height for the purpose of combat modifiers becomes 21 ft. Truly horrid umbur hulks with DX 12 or more can carry a small object or two while walking.

**Tunneling:** Move 2; exploration 1 mile per hour.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 146 | 292   | 438    | 876   | 1,460       |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 9.

**Antennae** (-7): DR 0. 1 HP of injury cripples an antenna; any excess injury is lost. Located in hex #1.

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Umbur hulk confusing gaze.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

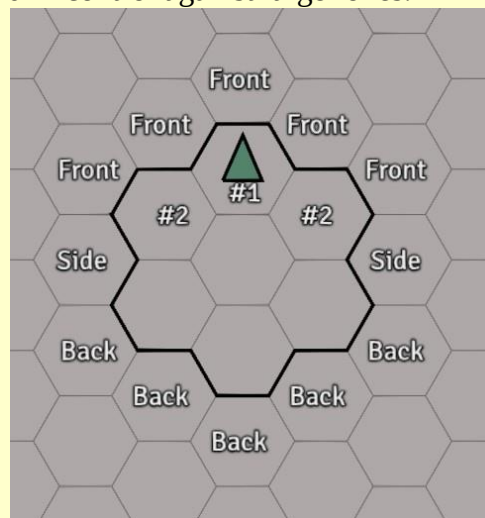
**Notes:** A character can target a truly horrid umbur hulk's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Umbur Hulk) roll.

The truly horrid umbur hulk's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +3 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

Unlike most creatures, the truly horrid umbur hulk has four eyes.

## Combat

**Mandibles (12):** thrust 3d+1 cutting. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the truly horrid umbur hulk may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 3d-1 control against SM+3 and smaller victims or 2d+1 control against larger ones.



**Blunt Claws (12):** thrust 4d crushing. Reach C-2 from hexes #1-2.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 3d-1 control. Reach C-2 from hexes #1-2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 7.3 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 73 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 10                   | 19        | 29                   | 38                 |

## Special Abilities

**Breath-Holding:** Even though truly horrid umbur hulks are not adept swimmers, they are able to hold their breath 8 times longer than normal.

**Confusing Gaze (11):** With a Ready maneuver, the truly horrid umbur hulk can activate or deactivate this magical ability. When it is active, anyone who meets the truly horrid umbur hulk's gaze with their own must make a Fright Check at -3 using the confusion variant from page 85 of *GURPS Powers*. The victim gets +1 to resist per each exposure to Confusion Gaze after the first within 24 hours. Regardless of the result, the victim becomes immune to this ability for one hour. Umbur hulks are immune to this ability.

See *Avoiding Gaze Attacks* (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8) for details on averting or hiding one's eyes.

## Useful Combat Rules

*Avoiding Gaze Attacks* (*Serpents of Legend*, p. 8).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Holding Your Breath (p. B351).  
Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 15          | 11    |

**Vision:** The truly horrid umber hulk possesses **Peripheral Vision** (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

Aside from normal vision, the truly horrid umber hulk can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

**Smell:** The truly horrid umber hulk has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

**Tremorsense (10):** The truly horrid umber hulk can feel faint movements in the surface it is standing on with a Sense roll, including earth tremors, distant explosions, and footsteps. Modify the roll for loudness and distance as for sound (p. B358). If lying full length (burrowing without building a tunnel counts automatically), roll at +2!

This sense relies on the truly horrid umber hulk's antennae. The antennae have no DR. They can be targeted at -7, and have 1 HP each; any excess injury is lost. Losing one antenna imposes a -4 penalty on Sense rolls to use this ability, and losing both disables this sense.

**Vibration Sense (10):** Vibration Sense lets the truly horrid umber hulk make a Sense roll subject to *separate* bonuses for the target's size, speed (invert the penalty), and a penalty for range to the target based on the *Size and Speed/Range Table* (p. B550) to detect something by sensing vibrations that propagate through the air. Success allows ignoring visibility penalties in combat that second. Wind will generate "noise" that imposes penalties, and the same penalties are applied to attacks that rely on this ability.

Just like Tremorsense, this sense relies on the truly horrid umber hulk's antennae.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 12   |

**Mentality Traits:** Dislikes bright lights; Uncongenial.

## Other Traits

Bad Grip 2.

## Skills

Brawling-12; Engineer (Mining)-12; Prospecting-11; Stealth-11; Survival (Underdark)-13; Traps-12.

## Capturing and Training

Truly horrid umber hulks are occasionally found in the service of evil dragons or sorcerers, guarding their lairs.

**Young Value:** \$6,900.

**Untrained Value:** \$34,500.

**Trained Value:** \$345,100.

**Supply Cost:** \$72 and 27 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Umbur Hulk).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.359

**Wage (Monthly):** \$10,350

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 20 Truly Horrid Umbur Hulks

*Battle Rating:* 7

*Classes:* Arm, Eng.

*Features:* Night, Terrain (Underground).

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 36/144 (land) or 8/32 (burrowing)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$19,200.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$131,900.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$208,700.

## Racial Template

329 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+17 (Size Modifier, -30%) [119]; HT+5 [50].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+3; HP+7 (Size Modifier, -30%) [10]; Will+2 [10]; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move +3 [15].

**Advantages:** Blunt Claws [3]; Breath-Holding 3 [6]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; DR 9 [45]; Infravision [10]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Subsonic Hearing (Biological (Passive), -5%; Melee Attack, Reach C, -30%) [4]; Tunneling (Move 2) [40]; Vibration Sense (Air; Biological (Passive), -5%) [10].

*Confusing Gaze:* Terror (-3) (Confusion; Magical, -10%; Vision-Based, Reversed, -20%) [42].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous) [-20]; Bad Grip 2 [-10]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Semi-Upright [-5]; Short Lifespan 1 [-10]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15].

**Perks:** Immunity to Umbur Hulk Confusing Gaze [1].

**Quirks:** Dislikes bright lights [-1]; Uncongenial [-1].

**Features:** Born Biter 3; Early Maturation 2; Four Eyes.

# Umber Hulk, Vodyanoi

Type: Aberration (Umber Hulk)



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |           |
|----|----|----|------|--------|-----------|
| ST | 19 | HP | 19   | SM     | +1        |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5.75 | thr/sw | 2d-1/3d+1 |
| HT | 13 | FP | 13   | BL     | 72 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 2d-1/2d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 800 lbs.

**Height:** 8 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft. when horizontal and 9 ft. when upright.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-4. 30% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** C.

A vodyanoi (not to be confused with a fey creature with the same name), a close relative of the umber hulk, inhabits deep freshwater environments. These strong creatures resemble umber hulks but have slimy green skin, webbed claws, and only two eyes. Their powerful mandibles can bite through clamshells and shark hides.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

Typically, the vodyanoi moves on all four limbs, but it is able to awkwardly walk upright with Move 4. While upright, the vodyanoi can use both forearms to attack and parry. Its effective height for the purpose of combat modifiers becomes 9 ft. Vodyanoi with DX 12

or more can carry a small object or two while walking.

**Water:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

**Tunneling:** Move 1; exploration 0.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 72 | 144   | 216    | 432   | 720         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 8. A nictitating membrane provides DR 2 to the eyes.

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Umber hulk confusing gaze.

**Resistances:** +2 to all HT rolls concerned with eye damage.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Weaknesses:** immersion in saline water (1d HP per 30 minutes).

**Notes:** A character can target a vodyanoi's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Umber Hulk) roll.

The vodyanoi's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +3 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

## Combat

Vodyanoi attack with their large and powerful claws, as well as their mandibles.

**Mandibles (12):** thrust 2d cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the vodyanoi may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d-1 control against SM+1 and smaller victims or 1d+1 control against larger ones.

**Blunt Claws (12):** thrust 2d+2 crushing. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 2d-1 control. Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 3.6 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 36 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 10                   | 19        | 29                   | 38                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

*Teeth* (p. MA115).

Underwater Activity (*Pyramid* #3-26, pp. 7-8).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 15          | 11    |

**Vision:** The vodyanoi possesses **Peripheral Vision** (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

The vodyanoi possesses **Night Vision 5**.

**Smell:** The vodyanoi has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

**Vibration Sense (10):** Vibration Sense lets the vodyanoi make a Sense roll subject to *separate* bonuses for the target's size, speed (invert the penalty), and a penalty for range to the target based on the *Size and Speed/Range Table* (p. B550) to detect something by sensing vibrations that propagate through the water. Success allows ignoring visibility penalties in combat that second. Currents will generate "noise" that imposes penalties, and the same penalties are applied to attacks that rely on this ability.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 12   |

Vodyanoi are reasonably intelligent, though often aggressive and territorial. They tend to simplify complex situations and prioritize physical strength over intellect, attacking interlopers in their territory, including creatures and vessels.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (15); Uncongenial.

## Other Traits

Bad Grip 2.

## Skills

Brawling-12; Stealth-11; Survival (Fresh-Water Lake)-13.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Aquatic:** Vodyanoi are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. They can only breathe water; vodyanoi suffocate in air. Vodyanoi can speak both in air and underwater.

**Diet:** Carnivorous by nature, vodyanoi do not hesitate to eat humanoids and other sapient beings.

**Habitat:** Vodyanoi are most common in deep, freshwater lakes. Vodyanoi can survive at pressures up to 10 atmospheres. This lets them survive on most continental shelves. Vodyanoi have a temperature comfort zone between 9° and 90°F.

**Lifecycle:** Vodyanoi appear identical, regardless of gender. Males live about 50 years, females 75. Females are rarer, with males defending them even at personal risk, but leave post-mating. Females birth 1–3 young, nurturing them in caves. Young learn hunting after two years, maturing quickly to live independently. Initially, mothers hunt extensively to feed their offspring until they're grown and can start their own broods.

## Society

While mostly solitary, they occasionally gather with their kind or live as peaceful hermits in deeper waters.

**Language:** Vodyanoi speak a dialect of the umber hulk language, which allows communication over great distances (+3 to Hearing rolls to hear a vodyanoi), and can also learn human languages and various undersea languages, including those of locathah, merfolk, sahuagin, and tritons.

## Spoils

Vodyanoi destroy items they can't use but collect curiosities. Other races harvest vodyanoi for hides, mandibles, and eyes, using them for equipment and potions. When designing vodyanoi plate armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid #3-52*, use the following statistics: WM 0.58, Cost \$60, DR/inch 70, Max DR 16, Construction: plate, scale, solid.

A vodyanoi mandible can be used as an improvised small axe at -1 to skill.

## Capturing and Training

Aboleths are known to use enslaved vodyanoi as guardians.

**Young Value:** \$1,190.

**Untrained Value:** \$5,940.

**Trained Value:** \$59,360.

**Supply Cost:** \$18 and 6.8 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Umbur Hulk).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.062

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,780

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Vodyanoi

**Battle Rating:** 3.5

**Classes:** Eng, Naval.

**Features:** None.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 28/112 (land or water) or 4/16 (burrowing)

**Supply (Weekly):** \$9,600.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$73,250.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$111,600.

## Racial Template

*195 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+9 (Size Modifier, -10%) [81]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Will+2 [10]; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move +2 [10].

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; Blunt Claws [3]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; DR 8 [40]; Nictitating Membrane 2 [2]; Night Vision 5 [5]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Pressure Support 1 [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Speak Underwater [5]; Temperature Tolerance 2 (Cold) [2]; Tunneling (Move 1) [35]; Vibration Sense (Water; Biological (Passive), -5%) [10].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous) [-20]; Bad Grip 2 [-10]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (15) [-5]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Semi-Upright [-5]; Short Lifespan 1 [-10]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Weakness (Immersion in saline water, 1d per 30 minutes) [-5].

**Perks:** Immunity to Umber Hulk Confusing Gaze [1]; Penetrating Voice [1].

**Quirks:** Uncongenial [-1].

**Features:** Born Biter 3; Doesn't Breathe (Gills); Early Maturation 2.

# Umber Hulk, Vodyanoi, Marine

Type: Aberration (Umber Hulk)

## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 23 | <b>HP</b> | 23   | <b>SM</b>     | +2        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.75 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 2d+1/4d+1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 13 | <b>FP</b> | 13   | <b>BL</b>     | 106 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 2d+1/2d+2

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 1,500 lbs.

**Height:** 15 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft. when horizontal and 15 ft. when upright.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-4. 30% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E.

Marine vodyanoi are a rare vodyanoi subrace that dwells in seawater. They are less intelligent, but more physically imposing than their freshwater kin. In addition, they are able to change the coloration of their hide to blend in with the surroundings.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

Typically, the marine vodyanoi moves on all four limbs, but it is able to awkwardly walk upright with Move 4. While upright, the marine vodyanoi can use both forearms to attack and parry. Its effective height for the purpose of combat modifiers becomes 15 ft. Marine vodyanoi with DX 12 or more can carry a small object or two while walking.

**Water:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

**Tunneling:** Move 1; exploration 0.5 miles per hour.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 106 | 212   | 318    | 636   | 1,060       |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 8. A nictitating membrane provides DR 2 to the eyes.

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Umber hulk confusing gaze.

**Resistances:** +2 to all HT rolls concerned with eye damage; +2 to HT against damage caused by high or low body temperature.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

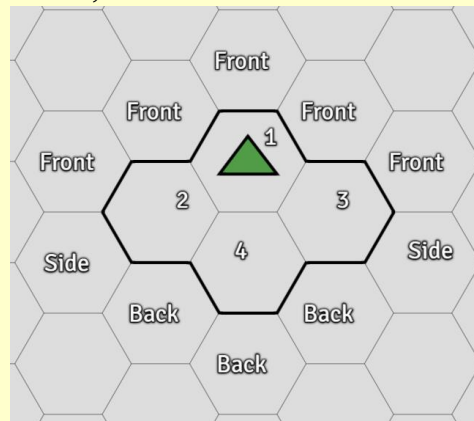
**Weaknesses:** immersion in fresh water (1d HP per 30 minutes).

**Notes:** A character can target a marine vodyanoi's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Umber Hulk) roll.

The marine vodyanoi's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +3 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

## Combat

Marine vodyanoi attack with their large and powerful claws, as well as their mandibles. If a marine



vodyanoi finds itself being beaten in a fight, it will attempt to flee and will utilize its camouflage ability in an attempt to avoid detection.

**Mandibles (12):** thrust 2d+2 cutting. Reach C-1 from hex #1. If the attack hits, the marine vodyanoi may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d+1 control against SM+2 and smaller victims or 2d-1 control against larger ones.

**Blunt Claws (12):** thrust 3d crushing. Reach C-1 from hexes #1-3.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 2d+1 control. Reach C-1 from hexes #1-3.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 5.3 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 53 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 12                   | 23        | 35                   | 46                 |

## Special Abilities

**Camouflage:** A marine vodyanoi's hide can change color and texture to resemble its surroundings. In any situation where being seen is a factor, the marine vodyanoi gets +6 to Stealth skill when perfectly still, or +3 if moving. If for some reason the marine vodyanoi is wearing clothes, this bonus is reduced to +3 when the marine vodyanoi is motionless, with no bonus if it is moving. This ability only affects normal vision.

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5). Teeth (p. MA115).
- Underwater Activity (*Pyramid* #3-26, pp. 7-8).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 15          | 11    |

**Vision:** The marine vodyanoi possesses **Peripheral Vision** (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

The marine vodyanoi possesses **Night Vision 5**.

**Smell:** The marine vodyanoi has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

**Vibration Sense (10):** Vibration Sense lets the marine vodyanoi make a Sense roll subject to *separate* bonuses for the target's size, speed (invert the penalty), and a penalty for range to the target based on the *Size and Speed/Range Table* (p. B550) to detect something by sensing vibrations that propagate through the water. Success allows ignoring visibility penalties in combat that second. Currents will generate "noise" that imposes penalties, and the same penalties are applied to attacks that rely on this ability.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 12   |

Marine vodyanoi are not very intelligent, and often aggressive and territorial. They tend to simplify complex situations and prioritize physical strength over intellect, attacking interlopers in their territory, including creatures and vessels.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bully (15); Uncongenial.

## Other Traits

Bad Grip 2.

## Skills

Brawling-12; Stealth-11; Survival (Salt-Water Sea)-13.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Aquatic:** Marine vodyanoi are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. They can only breathe water; marine vodyanoi suffocate in air. Marine vodyanoi can speak both in air and underwater.

**Diet:** Carnivorous by nature, marine vodyanoi do not hesitate to eat humanoids and other sapient beings.

**Habitat:** Marine vodyanoi dwell in seas, often in the deeper parts. Marine vodyanoi can survive at pressures up to 100 atmospheres. This lets them live comfortably at a depth up to 1,100 yards. Marine vodyanoi have a temperature comfort zone between 35° and 90°F.

**Lifecycle:** Marine vodyanoi appear identical, regardless of gender. Males live about 50 years, females 75. Females are rarer, with males defending them even at personal risk, but leave post-mating. Females birth 1–3 young, nurturing them in caves. Young learn hunting after two years, maturing quickly to live independently. Initially, mothers hunt extensively to feed their offspring until they're grown and can start their own broods.

**Temperature Regulation:** The marine vodyanoi, unlike its freshwater kin, is a cold-blooded creature. While it has +2 HT to resist damage from high or low body temperature, it tends to stiffen up in cold weather. After 30 minutes in cold conditions, the ankheg gets -1 to Basic Speed and DX per 10° below 50°F. The marine vodyanoi regains lost Basic Speed and DX at the rate of one point of each per hour once it returns to a warm climate. Double this rate in an exceptionally warm environment. At temperatures below 32°, the marine vodyanoi must roll vs. HT (13) or take 1 HP of damage.

## Society

While mostly solitary, they occasionally gather with their kind or live as peaceful hermits in deeper waters.

**Language:** Marine vodyanoi speak a dialect of the umber hulk language, which allows communication over great distances (+3 to Hearing rolls to hear a marine vodyanoi), and can also learn human languages and various undersea languages, including those of locathah, merfolk, sahuagin, and tritons.

## Spoils

Marine vodyanoi destroy items they can't use but collect curiosities. Other races harvest marine vodyanoi for hides, mandibles, and eyes, using them for equipment and potions. When designing marine vodyanoi plate armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid* #3-52, use the following statistics: WM 0.58, Cost \$60, DR/inch 70, Max DR 16, Construction: plate, scale, solid.

A marine vodyanoi mandible can be used as an improvised axe at -1 to skill.

## Capturing and Training

Saltwater aboleths are known to use enslaved marine vodyanoi as guardians.

**Young Value:** \$1,900.

**Untrained Value:** \$9,440.

**Trained Value:** \$94,400.

**Supply Cost:** \$6 and 4 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Umber Hulk).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.098

**Wage (Monthly):** \$2,830

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Marine Vodyanoi

*Battle Rating:* 6

*Classes:* Eng, Naval, Recon.

*Features:* None.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 28/112 (land or water) or 4/16 (burrowing)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$3,200.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$162,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$175,000.

## Racial Template

211 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+13 (Size Modifier, -20%) [104]; IQ-2 [-40]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+2; Will+4 [20]; Per+3 [15]; Basic Move +2 [10].

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; Blunt Claws [3]; Chameleon 3 [15]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; DR 8 [40]; Nictitating Membrane 2 [2]; Night Vision 5 [5]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Pressure Support 2 [10]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Speak Underwater [5]; Tunneling (Move 1) [35]; Vibration Sense (Water; Biological (Passive), -5%) [10].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous) [-20]; Bad Grip 2 [-10]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bully (15) [-5]; Cold-Blooded (50°) [-5]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Semi-Upright [-5]; Short Lifespan 1 [-10]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Weakness (Immersion in fresh water, 1d per 30 minutes) [-5].

**Perks:** Immunity to Umber Hulk Confusing Gaze [1]; Penetrating Voice [1].

**Quirks:** Uncongenial [-1].

**Features:** Born Biter 3; Doesn't Breathe (Gills); Early Maturation 2.

# Warforged

Type: Construct (Warforged)



**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 280 lbs.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Sapient Construct (-1 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-20. 5% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** D, C.

The warforged are believed to originate from Ktll (often spelled and pronounced as Ktill) on the Elemental Plane of Air, though their true roots lie in the world of Eberron—unknown even to them. Originally built to defend Ktll from hostile elementals and djinn, warforged possess the ability to choose peace due to their sentient minds, allowing them to exceed their creators' intentions.

After Ktll became an independent city and repelled its invaders, warforged were granted free will. Many continue to serve as soldiers or law enforcement in Ktll, while some pursue peaceful careers. A few even venture to the Prime Material Plane to become adventurers.

A warforged is a bulky humanoid with a skin of plates made of metal and stone, supported by a skeleton of similar material and a musculature of leathery, woody fiber bundles. An internal network of tubes filled with bloodlike fluid nourishes and lubricates warforged systems. Powerful warforged arms end in two-fingered, thumbless hands, and warforged feet each have two broad toes.

Simple humanlike features—heavy brows, hinged jaws with no teeth, no nose—make up a warforged's face. Its eyes sometimes glow when it experiences intense emotions, and its forehead and pate bears runic whorls. Each warforged has a unique rune on its forehead, much like humans have distinctive

fingerprints. This rune is known as a “ghulra,” a word that means “truth” in Auran.

## New Disadvantage

Warforged and some similar constructs usually have a new form of Social Stigma

## Social Stigma (Sapient Construct) [-5]

While non-sapient constructs are considered Valuable Property, sapient constructs have legal rights but receive a -1 reaction penalty from humans and other non-constructs.

## Mentality

**Creation:** The creation of warforged originated from techniques used for mindless constructs, with the goal of achieving sentience but without foreseeing its implications or preparing their minds for existence. Upon awakening, a warforged can understand its creator's language, typically Auran, and instinctively move, but is otherwise a blank slate, easily influenced in its early stages regarding truth, morality, and behavior. Lies accepted at this stage can persist until disproven.

Most warforged were made by the Warsmiths of Ktll around 580 AF, during Ktll's struggle against the Elemental Plane of Air's hostile natives. They were trained to obey and lacked initiative, requiring extensive instruction in weapons, tactics, and improvisation. Training involved war games with real weapons, where victory brought praise and loss brought reprimand.

This training introduced them to emotions like pride, shame, joy, or jealousy, driving them to succeed in combat to maintain positive feelings. Fear followed, arising not from battle but from realizing death ends experience. With no need for sleep, a warforged perceives continuous existence; recognizing death as oblivion became a tool for control.

On the battlefield, warforged understood camaraderie but rarely friendship or love, while jealousy could lead to hate, especially against threats to their comrades. Once hostilities ended and they became free beings, warforged faced a loss of structure, leading to diverse lifestyle choices in newfound freedom.

**Gender and Personality:** Warforged were created without gender, solely to fight for their owners and fall on the battlefield if necessary. Surprisingly, many warforged began adopting gender identities on their own. While some remain comfortable as genderless beings, others embrace male or female identities, integrating these into their daily lives. They may choose gender-specific clothing and occupations to blend into surrounding societies.

**Needs:** Warforged don't need sleep, food, or air—only protection from extreme temperatures and repairs for their bodies. Despite their minimal survival needs, they are thinking beings and require mental engagement.

Warforged constantly seek activities or purposes to fill their time. While a few may lead a minimal existence, focusing solely on self-repair and protection, most pursue professions or activities to engage their minds and find a place in the world.

**Battle:** Born into a warring world, warforged were confused when the war with the Elemental Plane of Air ended. Some felt relief, others anger or fear. All warforged have strong opinions about war, which influence their actions. To them, war and violence are inseparable; even a tavern brawl is part of a larger conflict. This mindset often creates issues in settlements, prompting many warforged to seek peaceful lands or clearly defined roles involving violence.

**Freedom:** Freedom is both exhilarating and daunting for warforged. Created to fight and obey orders, many are overwhelmed by newfound freedom and prefer roles with clear expectations. Reactions vary: some embrace freedom and reject authority, others seek to serve, or test limits cautiously. Their views on freedom even affect minor decisions, like choosing a cloak color.

**Soldier Mindset:** Freed warforged no longer see other creatures as masters but categorize them into five roles: commander, comrade, ally, civilian, and foe.

*Commander:* Anyone they take orders from, recognizing authority marks on the battlefield and categorizing others' commanders.

*Comrade:* Those who consistently work or fight alongside them. Warforged call this experience camaraderie and are beginning to grasp true friendship in peaceful times.

*Ally:* Creatures sharing the same goals as the warforged.

*Civilian:* Those with whom they have no quarrel or common goals. Warforged often struggle to interact with civilians, leading to perceptions of them as disrespectful, rude, or cold.

*Foe:* Individuals who oppose their goals, viewed as someone to defeat rather than necessarily attack. Warforged also consider a foe's allies and their place in the command hierarchy.

**Typical Mentality Traits:** Attentive; Code of Honor (Soldier's); Workaholic.

## Ecology

Warforged have an artificial, sexless form and cannot reproduce like other humanoids. Their limited sense of pain, focused only on actual injury, allows

them to modify their bodies easily. This ability enables them to have as varied appearances as other races.

## Society

Despite being part of society, warforged remain outsiders. Their lives are vastly different from other creatures, lacking the need to breathe, eat, sleep, or dream.

**Leisure:** Warforged never tire and rarely get bored, possessing almost endless patience due to their lack of biological needs. However, their history as constant soldiers makes long inactivity anxiety-inducing. To cope, they often engage in repetitive or unending hobbies, creating tasks for themselves like counting objects or intricate braiding. Tasks similar to pre-battle routines, such as sharpening weapons, provide fulfillment when idle. Warforged proficient in crafting work tirelessly, pursuing quieter tasks like sewing or basket weaving at night. They seldom engage in activities requiring others, often choosing solitary hobbies, but enthusiastically join in social games like chess or gambling when invited.

**Art:** Warforged produce a surprising variety of art despite not being emotionally inclined. Most create without aiming for artistic expression, often producing items with no purpose other than creation itself. Their art, typically portable, includes woodcarving, sketching, and weaving, and is usually abstract or representational without emotional attachment. For them, creation serves to occupy their hands and minds while waiting.

**War:** For warforged, life was designed for battle, and many still embrace this role even in peace, serving as constables, bodyguards, pirates, bounty hunters, gladiators, soldiers, or adventurers. Others have adapted to new purposes, but all have distinct opinions on war, often perplexing to other races. Created for combat, warforged view life through a lens of battles, goals, and alliances. Their training instills a soldier's mindset, making war seem natural rather than wrong or evil. Violence is seen as a natural act, akin to a predator's instinct.

Though rare, some warforged are pacifists, typically those trained as aides, not warriors. Some veterans seek peaceful lives, yet keep their weapons ready for possible conflict. This perspective on violence can make other races wary, but contrary to belief, warforged are not fearless. They fear destruction, perhaps more than others fear death, but pain for them is merely an operational indicator, not a source of fear. A few warforged yearn for a return to war.

## Equipment

The warforged's body makes it difficult for them to wear armor made for humans. Rigid armor must be specially made to fit a warforged (+0.5 CF). Such armor is not donned, but attached to the body of the warforged using special fixtures. This process takes twice as long as regular donning, and the same applies to detaching. It cannot be worn by non-warforged.

Some warforged possess attached or embedded components specially designed for them. The rarest and most prized of them are the *docents*. A docent is a small platinum or mithral sphere studded with gems. When affixed to a warforged's neck, the docent awakens, becoming an intelligent item that grants the host extra skills and abilities.

## Creating and Repairing a Warforged

An artificer can craft the body of a warforged, but the secret to imbuing it with sapience and free will is known only to the Warsmiths of Ktll. Only one active Creation Forge exists in Ktll, producing all warforged, though rumors suggest a rogue Warsmith may have another forge on the Material Plane.

A warforged's body has a volume of 2.8 ft<sup>3</sup>, consisting of 140 lbs. of iron (\$966), 140 lbs. of stone (\$105), and a circulatory system with special tubes and liquids (10 lbs.; \$429). Total material costs are \$1,500, with labor adding \$6,500, totaling \$8,000. Crafting requires skill in Machinist and takes 128 man-days, with skilled craftsmen earning \$1,700 monthly.

To enchant the warforged with free will, character points are spent as detailed in *GURPS Power-Ups 5: Impulse Buys*, page 14. The enchanter must know the Enchant spell and have the appropriate construction manual.

A warforged that still has positive HP can be repaired with a successful Mechanic (Golems)-1 roll that requires half an hour. Success restores 1 HP times the margin of success (minimum 1). A warforged's circulatory system possesses self-healing properties, so "bleeding" can stop naturally. However, First Aid does not work on a warforged – use Mechanic (Golems) instead.

A warforged at 0 HP or below requires spare parts that cost 1d x \$150. After obtaining these parts, use the rules above, except that all rolls are at an extra -2.

## Spoils

A warforged's body may be salvaged for metal and stone.

## Racial Template

This template represents the most common warforged chassis. DR 2 is intrinsic DR of the body, but most warforged have armor attached to their

bodies that has to be specially made for them (see *Equipment* above). Do not buy this extra DR with points!

101 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** HP+6 [12].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; DR 2 [10]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Injury Tolerance (Homogenous) [40]; Pressure Support 1 [5]; Speak Underwater [5]; Temperature Tolerance 4 [4]; Unaging [15]; Vacuum Support [5].

**Disadvantages:** Code of Honor (Soldier's) [-10]; No Extra Skull DR [-2]; No Mouth [-4]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Numb [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Unnatural [-50]; Workaholic [-5].

**Perks:** Striking Surface [1].

**Quirks:** Affected by Magnetism [-1]; Affected by Rust [-1]; Attentive [-1]; Cannot Float [-1]; Glowing Eyes [-1].

**Features:** Not Pressurized; Not Subject to Fatigue; Sterile.

## Warforged Warrior

Type: Construct (Warforged)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |         |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|---------|
| <b>ST</b> | 13 | <b>HP</b> | 19 | <b>SM</b>     | +0      |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d/2d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | -  | <b>BL</b>     | 34 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 1d/1d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 280 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Sapient Construct (-1 reaction).

This entry represents a warforged warrior who has received basic combat training after being created.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** The warforged cannot swim. They cannot float without support.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 34 | 68    | 102    | 204   | 340         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2. Skull doesn't have extra DR. Light plate armor provides additional DR 3 to torso, limbs, face, and skull. Targeting the eyes through the eye-slits is at -10 (see *Chinks in Armor*, p. LT101).

**Dodge:** 9. Add +2 for the shield's DB.

**Parry:** 10 (broadsword); 9 (unarmed). Add +2 for the shield's DB.

**Block:** 12 (medium light shield; DB 2; DR 2; HP 16; Cover DR 6).

**Immunities:** Metabolic hazards.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; Injury Tolerance (Homogenous).

**Weaknesses:** Unlike most constructs, warforged are not automatically destroyed when they reach 0 HP and are able to lose consciousness. However, they *automatically* fail the HT roll to "stay alive" if reduced to -1xHP or below.

Being partially metallic creatures, warforged are affected by rust and magnetism.

**Notes:** A warforged's eyes emit a dim glow. Reduce the darkness penalties to hit the eyes by -2.

## Combat

Warforged warriors fight in well-coordinated units, following orders of their commanders.

**Longsword swing (13):** swing 2d cutting (RS: 1d+2), Reach 1, 4 lbs.

**Longsword thrust (13):** thrust 1d+2 impaling, Reach 1-2, 4 lbs.

**Shield Bash (12):** thrust 1d crushing, Reach 1, 7 lbs.

**Punch (10):** thrust 1d crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 1d control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.7 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 17 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 7                    | 13        | 20                   | 26                 |

## Special Abilities

**Sapient Construct Traits:** The warforged is a unique construct with traits similar to living creatures. It is immune to metabolic hazards but can still be affected by mind control and bleeding. It doesn't need to breathe, eat, drink, or sleep and does not age.

The warforged does not have a mouth – it cannot bite or drink potions. It can talk as long as head is intact, and can do so even underwater.

The warforged is comfortable in temperatures between 15° and 110° and can withstand pressures up to 10 atmospheres, allowing survival on most continental shelves and even in a vacuum.

Warforged do not have a FP score, cannot naturally heal HP, and cannot reproduce sexually. They *can* be repaired.

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing          | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|------------------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10/6 (full helm) | -           | -     |

**Vision:** As a construct, the warforged has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

The full helm gives the warforged **Hard of Hearing** (p. B138) and **No Peripheral Vision** (p. B151)

**Touch:** Warforged are numb. When performing a task that requires hand-eye coordination, a warforged suffer all the effects of one level of Ham-Fisted (p. B138) unless it takes twice as long to perform the action and can clearly see what it is doing.

Unlike most constructs, warforged can feel pain.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Attentive; Code of Honor (Soldier's); Workaholic.

## Skills

Body Sense-12; Broadsword-13; Shield-12; Soldier-12.

## Equipment

Longsword (\$700; 4 lbs.)

Medium Light Shield (\$45; 7 lbs.)

Warforged Light Plate Armor (torso) (DR 3; \$1,500; 8 lbs.; Attach 90; Holdout -3)

Warforged Light Plate Armor (arms) (DR 3; \$750; 4 lbs.; Attach 46; Holdout -3)

Warforged Light Plate Armor (legs) (DR 3; \$1,500; 8 lbs.; Attach 90; Holdout -3)

Warforged Light Plate Full Helm (DR 3; \$450; 2.4 lbs.; Attach 28; Holdout -4)

*Total Weight:* 33.4 lbs.

*Total Cost:* \$4,945

## **Capturing and Training**

Warforged are made to be used in warfare. The costs below do not include equipment.

**Untrained Value:** \$900.

**Trained Value:** \$8,970.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.009

**Wage (Monthly):** \$270

## **Mass Combat Statistics**

### **120 Warforged Warriors**

*Battle Rating:* 1

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$32,300.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$34,300.

## Wight

Type: Undead



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |     |        |           |
|----|----|----|-----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 12 | HP | 16  | SM     | +0        |
| DX | 12 | BS | 5.5 | thr/sw | 1d-1/1d+2 |
| HT | 10 | FP | -   | BL     | 29 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-1/1d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-16. 70% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A (individual), F.

A wight is an undead creature animated by violence and hatred, resembling a twisted version of its former self. It exists in a state between life and death, like a corpse driven by a malevolent spirit. Its mummified flesh covers a warped skeleton, with clawed hands and needle-like teeth. Wights communicate through wheezes and moans.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 29 | 58    | 87     | 174   | 290         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** As an undead creature, the wight is destroyed when it reaches 0 HP.

When exposed to light bright enough to cause illumination penalty of -3 to 0, the wight must roll against HT every second. On a failure, it gets -1 to DX, IQ, Per, and skill rolls (but *not* Will or active defense rolls) until it leaves the illuminated area.

**Notes:** A wight's eyes emit a dim glow. Reduce the darkness penalties to hit the eyes by -2.

### Combat

Wights drain life with a touch, even through clothing or armor, often lurking in shadows to ambush unsuspecting prey. While many wights prefer to use teeth and claws in combat, some wear armor and wield weapons, becoming even more dangerous foes.

**Sharp Teeth (14):** thrust 1d-1 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the wight may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-2 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 1d-1 cutting. Reach C.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d control. Reach C. Effective ST 14 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.45 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 14.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 7                    | 14        | 21                   | 28                 |

### Special Abilities

**Create Spawn:** When a wight kills a living creature, roll 3d. On 1-14, the creature rises after 1d minutes as a zombie under the wight's control; on 15-17, it rises as a wight; on a 18, it rises as a half-wight. They do not possess any of the abilities they had in life. Player character wights must be able to buy these risen zombies and wights as Allies to be able to control them. You may ignore this for NPC wights.

**Energy Drain:** While maintaining ongoing contact (grappling, for example), the wight can take and Attack maneuver to drain 3 HP from the victim, while healing 1 HP per each stolen HP.

**Silent Movement:** Wights get +4 to Stealth when perfectly motionless, or +2 if moving. This only helps against hearing-based detection attempts.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furies*, p. 17).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | -           | 10    |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the wight has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

**Life Sense (10):** A wight possesses a constantly active magical ability to sense life. By making a Sense roll with normal range penalties, a wight may sense all nearby living beings, knowing their precise location. A follow-up IQ roll may reveal information about the living being, with margin of success of 0-1 only revealing vague information, such as race, and margin of success of 4+ revealing detailed information, such as age, gender, and physical condition.

**Psychic Value Sense (6):** Whenever a wight touches an object, the GM may make a roll against IQ-4 (6) to sense strong emotions and psychic impressions tied to the object's history. On a critical success, the wight receives an actual vision of a significant past event. Roll at no additional penalty for events earlier the same day, at -1 for up to 10 days ago, -2 for up to 100 days ago, -3 for up to three years ago, and an another -1 per additional 10x multiplier. The wight cannot use this ability actively – this is a passive sense.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 11   |

Wights are malevolent undead creatures, brought back by vanity and evil deeds. At the end of their mortal lives, they sought undeath from Orcus or other dark powers, exchanging their souls to eternally despise and destroy the living.

Wights retain their memories and personalities but often serve the dark powers that revived them. They crave the life force of the living, akin to an addiction. Typically territorial, wights linger near their burial sites unless commanded otherwise. Their attachment to these sites could be due to pride in their condition or tactical preferences.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Callous; Intolerance (Living); Selfish (12).

## Skills

Brawling-14; Stealth-14; Wrestling-14.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Night.

**Habitat:** Active at night, wights retreat to crypts or tombs by day, unfazed by sunlight but disliking it. Their lairs, marked by eerie silence and dead plant life, are found anywhere, not just in burial sites. Wights have their temperature comfort zone extended by 5xHT degrees in both directions.

**Life Force Craving:** Despite not requiring sustenance, a wight has an uncontrollable craving for life force. When encountering a living creature, the wight must roll against 15 to resist attacking it and leeching HP from it with the Energy Drain ability. The self-control roll is at -1 per missing HP. The wight must make a second self-control roll to stop draining life once it replenished its entire HP pool.

**Organization:** Solitary, pair, gang (3–5), or pack (6–11).

**Origin:** While it is known that wights multiply by draining life-energy, their ultimate origin is debated. There is no necromantic spell to create wights, and legends offer contradictory explanations. Some suggest that dark deities gift undeath to loyal servants, with wights claiming Orcus or another dark power created the first of their kind. Others consider undeath a curse, a result of powerful maledictions or overwhelming hatred that denies rest.

The Taarnaks of northern lands have their own lore. They bury their dead in large mounds, believing the mound's size reflects the deceased's glory and prevents them from rising. Tales speak of warrior chieftains returning from the dead and heroes seeking glory by challenging them, only to become enslaved.

Other legends suggest sorcerer-kings sought eternal life but only achieved decayed immortality, becoming the first wights. Across many worlds, varying tales share a constant truth: the living fear the restless dead, as death is not always an end.

**Speech:** Wights retain their ability to speak any languages they knew in life, but are not good at talking. Their disturbing voice gives -2 on any speech-based reaction roll and -2 to Diplomacy, Fast-Talk, Performance, Public Speaking, Sex Appeal, and Singing.

**Undead:** As undead creatures, wights do not need food, water, sleep, air, or experience aging. They are immune to metabolic hazards. Wights do not possess a FP score, cannot naturally heal HP, and are unable to reproduce sexually.

**Unnatural Aura:** Wights possess an unnatural aura that frightens animals and saps life. Animals react at -4 to wights, usually with fear or aggression. Grass dies and never regrows within a yard of the wight, and so do insects and other tiny mundane animals weighing no more than a few ounces. This

usually imposes another -2 on reaction rolls and +2 on rolls to locate the wight outdoors.

## Society

A wight's primary trait is its deep hatred for the living, driven by jealousy, distrust from past encounters with tomb-robbers, or lingering cruelty. Wights see mortals as slaves, cattle to drain of life-energy, potential converts to undeath, or enemies to destroy, but never as equals or trustworthy beings.

Wight societies are led by a dominant wight and its spawn, and they are fiercely territorial, staying close to their burial sites unless compelled to leave. Some wights form groups or engage in piracy, traveling in search of power, a cure, or for violent rampages.

In mimicry of barbarian hierarchies, the strongest wight rules, and others serve as warriors or occupy menial roles. Promotion is rare and occurs through displays of strength. Spawned wights, seen as inferior to those that rise spontaneously or by divine favor, serve as slaves until proven by deeds; they are bound to their master's control, leading to mock challenges for status.

Wight spellcasters, particularly in ancient temples or tombs, hold significant respect, often seen as favored by dark apowers, although they are uncommon. Most wights care little for religion, valuing only their strength and abilities.

## Spoils

Wights can "see" the aura of psychic value on valuables, prompting them to collect items for their auras. However, they neglect the physical upkeep of items, often resulting in small collections of durable treasures like gold, silver, and gems. Barrow wights also may possess treasure they were buried with.

## Capturing and Training

Some necromancers and cultists of dark powers employ wights in their armies.

**Untrained Value:** \$2,900.

**Trained Value:** \$28,900.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.03

**Wage (Monthly):** \$870

## Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Wights**

*Battle Rating:* 3.5

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$104,200.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$104,200.

## Racial Template

The following racial template represents a humanoid wight. It can be applied as a lens to another racial template to simulate wights risen from non-human beings.

*151 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** HP+4 [8]; Will+1 [5].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Dominance (Fatal Beating, -40%) [12]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (Unliving, No Blood) [25]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Silence 2 [10]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15].

*Energy Drain:* Leech 3 (Accelerated Healing, +25%; Magical, -10%) [38].

*Life Sense:* Detect (Life; Magical, -10%; Precise, +100%; Reflexive, +40%) [69].

*Psychic Value Sense:* Psychometry (Magical, -10%; Passive Only, -60%) [6].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Callous [-5]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Frightens Animals [-10]; Intolerance (Living) [-10]; Lifebane [-10]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Selfish (12) [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Uncontrollable Appetite (15) (Life Force) [-7]; Unhealing (Partial; Leech) [-20].

**Quirks:** Glowing Eyes [-1]; Prefers to stay in its tomb [-1]; Sexless [-1]; Supernatural Dislike (Light) [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue.

## Wight, Aquatic

*Type: Undead*



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 12 | <b>HP</b> | 16  | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-1/1d+2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | -   | <b>BL</b>     | 29 lbs.   |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d-1/1d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-16. 70% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A (individual), F.

Also known as sea wights, aquatic wights are wights that dwell in bodies of water and are capable swimmers. In most regards, they are the same as regular wights.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

**Water:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 29 | 58    | 87     | 174   | 290         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 10 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, pain, physical stun, physical torture, pressure.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** As an undead creature, the aquatic wight is destroyed when it reaches 0 HP.

When exposed to light bright enough to cause illumination penalty of -3 to 0, the aquatic wight must roll against HT every second. On a failure, it gets -1 to DX, IQ, Per, and skill rolls (but *not* Will or active defense rolls) until it leaves the illuminated area.

**Notes:** An aquatic wight's eyes emit a dim glow. Reduce the darkness penalties to hit the eyes by -2.

## Combat

**Sharp Teeth (14):** thrust 1d-1 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the aquatic wight may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-2 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 1d-1 cutting. Reach C.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d control. Reach C. Effective ST 14 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.45 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 14.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 2                           | 7                           | 14               | 21                          | 28                        |

## Special Abilities

**Create Spawn:** When an aquatic wight kills a living creature, roll 3d. On 1-14, the creature rises after 1d minutes as a sea zombie under the aquatic wight's control; on 15-17, it rises as an aquatic wight; on a 18, it rises as an aquatic half-wight. They do not possess any of the abilities they had in life. Player character aquatic wights must be able to buy these risen sea zombies and wights as Allies to be able to control them. You may ignore this for NPC aquatic wights.

**Energy Drain:** While maintaining ongoing contact (grappling, for example), the aquatic wight can take an Attack maneuver to drain 3 HP from the victim, while healing 1 HP per each stolen HP.

**Silent Movement:** Aquatic wights get +4 to Stealth when perfectly motionless, or +2 if moving. This only helps against hearing-based detection attempts.

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furries*, p. 17).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | -           | 10    |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the aquatic wight has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

**Life Sense (10):** An aquatic wight possesses a constantly active magical ability to sense life. By making a Sense roll with normal range penalties, an aquatic wight may sense all nearby living beings, knowing their precise location. A follow-up IQ roll may reveal information about the living being, with margin of success of 0-1 only revealing vague information, such as race, and margin of success of 4+ revealing detailed information, such as age, gender, and physical condition.

**Psychic Value Sense (6):** Whenever an aquatic wight touches an object, the GM may make a roll against IQ-4 (6) to sense strong emotions and psychic impressions tied to the object's history. On a critical success, the aquatic wight receives an actual vision of a significant past event. Roll at no additional penalty

for events earlier the same day, at -1 for up to 10 days ago, -2 for up to 100 days ago, -3 for up to three years ago, and an another -1 per additional 10x multiplier. The aquatic wight cannot use this ability actively – this is a passive sense.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 11   |

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Callous; Intolerance (Living); Selfish (12).

### Skills

Brawling-14; Stealth-14; Wrestling-14.

### Ecology

**Aquatic:** Aquatic wights are adept swimmers that take no skill penalties for being underwater. Aquatic wights are able to speak underwater.

**Habitat:** Aquatic wights dwell among shipwrecks and dangerous reefs.

### Capturing and Training

Some necromancers and cultists of dark powers employ aquatic wights in their armies.

**Untrained Value:** \$4,300.

**Trained Value:** \$6,500.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.03

**Wage (Monthly):** \$870

### Mass Combat Statistics

#### 120 Aquatic Wights

*Battle Rating:* 3.5

*Classes:* Naval.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80 (land or water)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$104,200.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$104,200.

### Racial Template

The following racial template represents a humanoid aquatic wight. It can be applied as a lens to another racial template to simulate aquatic wights risen from non-human beings.

*181 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** HP+4 [8]; Will+1 [5].

**Advantages:** Amphibious [10]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10];

Doesn't Sleep [20]; Dominance (Fatal Beating, -40%) [12]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Injury Tolerance (Unliving, No Blood) [25]; Pressure Support 3 [15]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Silence 2 [10]; Speak Underwater [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15].

*Energy Drain:* Leech 3 (Accelerated Healing, +25%; Magical, -10%) [38].

*Life Sense:* Detect (Life; Magical, -10%; Precise, +100%; Reflexive, +40%) [69].

*Psychic Value Sense:* Psychometry (Magical, -10%; Passive Only, -60%) [6].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Callous [-5]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Frightens Animals [-10]; Intolerance (Living) [-10]; Lifebane [-10]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Selfish (12) [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Uncontrollable Appetite (15) (Life Force) [-7]; Unhealing (Partial; Leech) [-20].

**Quirks:** Glowing Eyes [-1]; Prefers to stay in its tomb [-1]; Sexless [-1]; Supernatural Dislike (Light) [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue.

# Wolf

Type: Animal



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |           |
|----|----|----|------|--------|-----------|
| ST | 8  | HP | 8    | SM     | +0        |
| DX | 12 | BS | 5.75 | thr/sw | 1d-3/1d-2 |
| HT | 11 | FP | 14   | BL     | 13 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-3/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Quadruped (p. B553).

**Weight:** 90 lbs.

**Length:** 5 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Organization:** 2-20. 10% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

Wolves are canine pack hunters skilled in tracking by scent and working as a team to surround and trip their prey. Known companions to rangers and druids, gray wolves, or common wolves, use their haunting howls to establish territory and communicate (+2 to hearing rolls for their howl).

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 9/13; exploration 6.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 13 | 26    | 39     | 78    | 130         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 10.

**Immunities:** Sunburn.

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Notes:** The wolf's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +2 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

## Combat

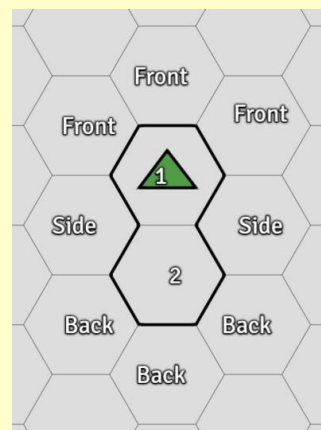
A favorite tactic is to send a few individuals against the foe's front while the rest of the pack circles and attacks from the flanks or rear.

**Sharp Teeth (14):** thrust 1d-1 cutting. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the wolf may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-1 control against SM-1 and smaller victims or 1d-3 control against larger ones.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C from hex #1. Effective ST 10 due to having Wrestling at DX+2.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.65 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 6.5 lbs.



## Control Thresholds

| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| 1                    | 5                    | 10        | 15                   | 20                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 12  | 14     | 12      | 19          | 12    |

**Vision:** Wolves are able to see well at night. They have **Night Vision 4**.

**Smell:** The wolf has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

**Hearing:** Wolves remove up to -2 penalties to Hearing for background noise. In addition, wolves possess Ultrahearing (p. B94), which allows them to hear high-frequency sounds.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 4  | 10   |

Despite their ferocity, wolves are caring within their pack, aiding the sick, feeding the young, and maintaining a strict dominance hierarchy. Only the dominant male and female may breed, and competition for these roles can be intense. Wolves

mark territory with howls and urination, driving off or attacking intruders, including wolves from other packs.

**Mentality Traits:** Bloodlust (12); Chummy; Gluttony (12); Sense of Duty (Pack).

### Skills

Brawling-14; Intimidation-11; Running-11; Stealth-12; Survival (Woodland)-12; Tracking-16; Wrestling-14.

### Other Traits

Extra Legs (Four Legs); Horizontal; No Fine Manipulators.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Wolves are omnivores, but they prefer fresh meat. They feed predominantly on ungulates. In times of scarcity, wolves will readily eat carrion.

**Habitat:** Wolves can be found in almost any temperate environment, but they prefer to stay away from inhabited areas. The temperature comfort zone of a wolf falls between 24° and 90°.

**Lifespan:** Wolves can live up to 15 years, reaching maturity at 3 years.

**Organization:** Solitary, pair, or pack (7-16).

### Spoils

A wolf's pelt weighs 8 pounds and fetches \$250.

### Capturing and Training

Wolves can be tamed and used as animal companions, guards, hunters, or even mounts for small riders, such as goblins.

**Young Value:** \$120.

**Untrained Value:** \$580.

**Trained Value:** \$5,800.

**Supply Cost:** \$2.5 and 3 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Wolves).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.006

**Wage (Monthly):** \$175

### Mass Combat Statistics

#### 120 Wolves

*Battle Rating:* 0.5

*Classes:* Cv.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 52/208

*Supply (Weekly):* \$3,200.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$17,800.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$30,600.

### Racial Template

-39 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-2 [-20]; DX+2 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [24]; IQ-6 [-120]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** FP+3 [9]; Will+6 [30]; Per+8 [40]; Basic Move +4 [20].

**Advantages:** Acute Taste and Smell 3 [6]; Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Enhanced Move 0.5 (Ground) [10]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Night Vision 4 [4]; Parabolic Hearing 2 [8]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Striking ST 3 (One Attack Only, Bite, -60%) [6]; Temperature Tolerance 1 (Cold) [1]; Ultrahearing [5].

**Disadvantages:** Bloodlust (12) [-10]; Chummy [-5]; Gluttony (12) [-5]; Horizontal [-10]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; Sense of Duty (Pack) [-5]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Wild Animal [-30].

**Perks:** Fur [1]; Penetrating Voice [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; Tail.

## Wolf, Winter

Type: *Magical Beast (Cold)*



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 16 | <b>HP</b> | 16 | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d+1/2d+2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | 12 | <b>BL</b>     | 51 lbs.   |

*Reduced Swing:* 1d+1/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Quadruped (p. B553).

**Weight:** 450 lbs.

**Length:** 8 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Social Stigma:** Monster (-3 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-8. 10% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** E.

Winter wolves, formidable predators of icy terrains, relentlessly pursue prey until they bring it down. They reach about 8 feet in length and stand around 4.5 feet tall at the shoulder, boasting glistening white or silvery coats and eyes of silvery or pale blue hues. Similar to other wolves, they possess five toes on their forelimbs and four on the rear, but their first toes are positioned higher, not forming part of their footprints. Winter wolves lack manipulative abilities in their paws, hindering them from wielding tools or performing tasks like humanoids.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 9/13; exploration 6.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 51 | 102   | 153    | 306   | 510         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 2\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 10.

**Immunities:** Noxious cold effects, sunburn.

**Resistances:** +2 to HT against food-borne poisons and diseases.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Vulnerabilities:** Fire (x2).

**Cold Resistance:** The winter wolf has DR 20 against cold. This includes internal and eye damage.

**Notes:** The winter wolf's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +2 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

### Combat

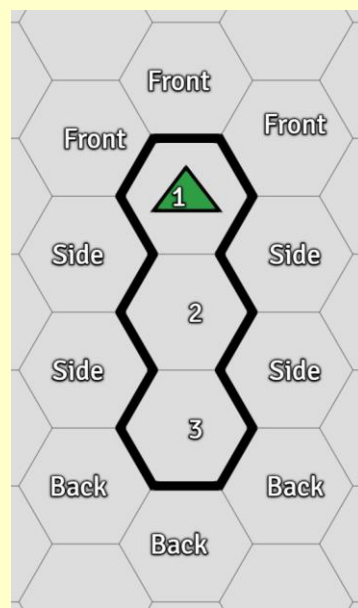
Winter wolves typically hunt in packs. Their size, cunning, and formidable breath weapon allow them to hunt and kill creatures much larger than themselves. A pack usually circles an opponent, each wolf attacking in turn to exhaust it. If they're in a hurry, white wolves try to pin their foes.

**Freezing Bite (14):** thrust 1d+1 cutting + follow-up 1d follow-up non-incendiary burning from cold. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the winter wolf may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+2 control against SM+0 and smaller victims or 1d control against larger ones.

**Breathe Frost (14):** The wolf breathes out a blast of extremely cold vapor, dealing thrust 1d non-incendiary burning damage as large-area injury. Targets injured by this attack must make an HT roll, at -1 per 2 points of injury, or take a -2 penalty to DX and become Numb (p. B146) for (20-HT) minutes (minimum 1 minute). This is a cone attack that uses rules from *Area and Spreading Attacks* (pp. B413-414). The cone is 1-yard wide and has a length of 3 yards (ST/5). Each use costs 2 FP. It is possible to make the cone wider by using the rules from *Cones of Power* (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10). It will blow out any ordinary fire (candle, lantern, torch, etc.).

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.55 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 22.5 lbs.



| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 9                    | 18        | 27                   | 36                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Area and Spreading Attacks (p. B413).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Cones of Power (*GURPS Dungeon Fantasy Monsters 4: Dragons*, p. 10).

Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 13  | 13     | 13      | 13          | 13    |

**Vision:** The winter wolf can be active both during the day and night, so its eyes are adapted to nighttime illumination. The winter wolf possesses **Night Vision 5**.

Aside from normal vision, the winter wolf can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60) which makes it easy to spot warm-blooded prey in cold environments.

**Smell:** The winter wolf has **Discriminatory Smell** (p. B49).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 9  | 11   |

These creatures are known to often have a foul disposition.

**Mentality Traits:** Bad Temper (12); Bestial; Chummy.

## Skills

Brawling-14; Innate Attack (Breath)-14; Intimidation-11; Running-12; Stealth-12; Survival (Arctic)-13; Tracking-17; Wrestling-14.

## Other Traits

Extra Legs (Four Legs); Horizontal; No Fine Manipulators; Penetrating Voice.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Camouflage:** The white (or, in rare cases, silvery) fur of the winter wolf lets it blend it with the surrounding snow. This gives the winter wolf +2 to Camouflage and Stealth when posed still and unclad against snow. This bonus only works against normal vision, not Infravision.

**Dens:** Winter wolves inhabit dens in various terrains, such as caves, borrowed burrows, or self-dug holes, often using multiple dens along migration routes. Conflicts over dens among packs are common, often resolved through merging. Dens serve primarily as protection from predators, with most having a single entrance and a communal chamber. Mated pairs may carve out separate niches, and pups typically have their own chambers due to different sleep patterns. Foundlings, usually humanoid members, are kept in protected areas, as winter wolves maintain a relatively warm den without allowing fires. Packs may remain in the same den for years while raising humanoid members due to their slower development compared to wolves.

**Diet:** Winter wolves are predominantly carnivorous, with teeth designed to push food back while chewing. Some of their flat-crowned molars suggest they can eat non-meat items. They prefer hunting small animals like rabbits, lemmings, and mice but will consume carrion and even berries or fruit if necessary. In winter, when food is scarce, they form large packs to hunt bigger prey, such as caribou or moose. They can eat up to a quarter of their body weight in one meal, then go days without food. Winter wolves also hunt humans and other sapient beings.

**Habitat:** Winter wolves thrive in arctic and subarctic regions, comfortable in temperatures from -25° to 90°. They live similarly to smaller wild wolves, focusing on meals, hunts, and raising pups. They dominate their icy territories, relying on their abilities for survival. Some packs inhabit snowy mountain tops or explore underground cave systems, where prey is less adapted for their frigid environment. Packs venturing into the Underdark may have offspring unfamiliar with daylight.

**Hunting Territories:** Winter wolves have vast hunting grounds, often exceeding 100 miles. Their powerful bodies allow them to cover up to 50 miles in a single night.

**Lifecycle:** Winter wolves mate for life with typically one breeding pair per pack. Gestation lasts a few months, resulting in two to four pups born in late spring or early summer. Newborns are blind and helpless, opening their eyes at two weeks, and are suckled by their mother for two months. At one month, they can eat half-digested meat provided by adults. The entire pack participates in raising the pups. Despite their evil nature, winter wolves share a strong bond with their young and protect them fiercely.

By six weeks, pups join their mother on hunts, sometimes finishing off crippled prey brought back by adults. By late in the year, they can hunt independently and may leave the pack. They reach

full adult size at two years and can live up to fifteen years.

## Society

Most winter wolves live in small, family-based packs, which offer advantages like cooperative hunting and safety from powerful arctic predators such as white dragons, remorhaz, cryohydras, and frost worms. Occasionally, multiple packs join forces to form “super-packs” of 20 or more wolves to take on large or dangerous prey, including humanoid villages and frost giants.

**Language:** Winter wolves have their own language consisting of barks, growls, and yips, and some can also speak the primitive wolveren language of worgs. They disdain normal and dire wolves due to their lower intelligence and lack of sophisticated language, making associations between them rare.

**Names:** The alpha male names pack members a few weeks after birth, once pups open their eyes and begin to interact. He can rename pack members at any time. Names often reflect appearance, demeanor, or behavior, such as Bloodrage, Bonecruncher, Brightfur, and Runt. Names may also be drawn from the Frost Giant language, including options like Boolentir, Bereketh, and Vorpek. Wolves that leave their birth-pack can rename themselves, especially if formerly named "Runt."

**Pack Structure:** Wolves live in a family group led by the alpha male and his mate, the alpha female, who is the only one to mate and bear young. Other pack members help raise the cubs. Male wolves establish a hierarchy through non-lethal battles, where submission signals acceptance of a lower status. Once established, the hierarchy minimizes further conflicts, with higher-ranked wolves getting first access to food and having greater influence on group decisions.

**Relations with Other Creatures:** In regions where winter wolves and worgs coexist, worgs can be found in winter wolf packs but are ranked lower and used as expendable assets in battles. Winter wolves occasionally ally with other intelligent, evil creatures of the cold, such as frost giants or white dragons, serving them as scouts, hunters, and trackers.

## Spoils

A winter wolf den often contains treasures from previously slain victims, though these items are mostly useless to the wolves. Pups might use some objects as toys, and humanoid foundlings may find them useful. A winter wolf pelt (16.8 lbs) can fetch up to \$3,000, and their teeth and claws are prized by northern barbarians as jewelry, ornamentation, and talismans believed to confer bravery and winter survival abilities. Teeth and claws cost \$70 and weigh 1.6 lbs.

When designing winter wolf hide armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid* #3-52, use the following statistics: WM 0.9; Cost \$45, DR/inch 8, Max DR 4, Combustible, Flexible, Construction: fabric, layered fabric. Regardless of its thickness, winter wolf hide armor provides an additional DR 10 against cold.

## Capturing and Training

The winter wolf is a sapient creature, but it can be forced or persuaded into being a war mount, guard, hunter, or war beast.

**Young Value:** \$1,300.

**Untrained Value:** \$6,470.

**Trained Value:** \$64,700.

**Supply Cost:** \$6 and 6.8 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Wolves).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.067

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,950

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Winter Wolves

**Battle Rating:** 4

**Classes:** Cv.

**Features:** Night, Terrain (Arctic).

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 52/208

**Supply (Weekly):** \$3,200.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$108,500.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$121,300.

## Racial Template

65 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+6 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%; Size Modifier, -10%) [30]; DX+2 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [24]; IQ-1 [-20]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; Will+2 [10]; Per+4 [20]; Basic Move+3 [15].

**Advantages:** DR 2 (Tough Skin, -40%) [6]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; Enhanced Move 0.5 (Ground) [10]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Infravision [10]; Night Vision 5 [5]; Reduced Consumption 2 (Cast-Iron Stomach, -50%) [2]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Temperature Tolerance 5 (Cold) [5].

**Cold Resistance** [30]: DR 20 (Limited, Cold, -40%; Tough Skin, -40%) [20] + Immunity to Noxious Cold Effects [10].

**Freezing Bite:** Burning Attack 1d (Follow-Up, Sharp Teeth, +0%; Magical, -10%; No Incendiary Effect, -10%) [4].

**Breathe Frost:** Natural Weapon (Burning; Cannot Parry, -40%; Cone 1, +60%; Costs Fatigue, 2 FP, -10%; Hidden, +20%; Increased 1/2D, 2x, +5%; Intangible, +50%; Magical, -10%; No Incendiary, -10%; Ranged, +100%; Reduced Damage, -1 per die, -

30%; Reduced Range, 1/5, -20%; Side Effect, DX-2 and Numb, +90%; Single, -20%) [15].

**Disadvantages:** Bad Temper (12) [-10]; Bestial [-10]; Chummy [-5]; Horizontal [-10]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; Odious Racial Habit (Eats sapient beings) [-15]; Short Lifespan 2 [-20]; Social Stigma (Monster) [-15]; Vulnerability (Fire, x2) [-30].

**Perks:** Fur [1]; Limited Camouflage (Snow) [1]; Penetrating Voice [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; Early Maturation 1; Tail.

## Wyvern

Type: Dragon (Lesser Dragon)



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |          |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 26 | <b>HP</b> | 26 | <b>SM</b>     | +2       |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 2d+2/5d  |
| <b>HT</b> | 14 | <b>FP</b> | 14 | <b>BL</b>     | 135 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 2d+2/3d

**Body Plan:** Avian (p. B553).

**Weight:** 2,000 lbs.

**Length:** 12 ft. (24 ft. with tail).

**Effective Height:** 15 ft.

**Organization:** 1-6. 30% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** H x 2.

A wyvern is a large, winged lizard related to dragons but with only two hind legs. They range from 15 to 35 feet long, with wingspans over 50 feet. Covered in dark brown or grey scales, wyverns have red or orange eyes. Their long, mobile tails end in a scorpion-like stinger. They produce loud hisses and growls, much like alligators (+3 to Hearing rolls to hear a wyvern).

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

**Air:** Move 12; exploration 6 miles per hour.

Cannot hover – must move at least at Move 3 when flying. In order to take off or land, the wyvern must have an open area with a radius of 4 yards in all directions.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 135 | 270   | 405    | 810   | 1,350       |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** The wyvern's scaly hide provides DR 4 and protects against sunburn. A nictitating membrane provides DR 2 to the eyes.

**Dodge:** 10 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Immunities:** Paralysis, sleep, sunburn, wyvern poison.

**Resistances:** +2 to all HT rolls concerned with eye damage, +3 to all HT rolls to avoid knockdown, stunning, and torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; High Pain Threshold.

**Notes:** A character can target a wyvern's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Dragons) roll.

### Combat

Wyverns attack by diving from above, grabbing prey with their hind claws, and stinging them. They also slash with their claws mid-flight, often striking with their tails first due to their length.

The wyvern has **Extra Attack 1** and hence can attack with two body parts in a single turn.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 3d cutting, Reach C from hexes #2-3. If used on the ground, the wyvern must roll against DX to remain standing on a miss.

**Sharp Teeth (16):** thrust 3d-1 cutting, Reach C from hexes #1-3. If the attack hits, the wyvern may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d+2 control against SM+1 and smaller victims or 2d control against larger ones.

**Tail Barb (16):** thrust 4d-1 impaling plus poison, Reach C-5 from hex #4.

**Tail Slam (16):** thrust 4d-1 crushing, Reach C-5 from hex #4.

**Wing Buffet (12):** thrust 3d crushing. Reach C-1 from hexes #2-3. When in flight, the wyvern must roll DX after attempting a Wing Buffet attack, whether it succeeds or fails. If the DX roll fails, the wyvern loses control of its flight. It will continue moving in the same direction and speed it was moving on the last turn before it lost control, until it can make an Aerobatics+2 roll to regain control.

**Poison:** The wyvern's stinger carries a potent poison. Anyone injured by the Tail Barb attack must roll against HT-2 or immediately take 1d-1 toxic



damage, ignoring DR. Then, every minute for five more cycles, the victim must roll against HT-2 again or take 1d-1 toxic damage again. When he loses 1/2 of his HP to this poison, he gets a -3 to HT until he recovers HP above this threshold.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 6.75 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 67.5 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 13                   | 26        | 39                   | 52                 |

### Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

Flying Combat (p. B398).

Slam and Overrun (p. B392).

- Defense vs. Slams (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 9).

Teeth (p. MA115).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 12     | 10      | 14          | 10    |

**Vision:** The wyvern possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

Aside from normal vision, the wyvern can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infra-vision** (p. B60).

The eyes of the wyvern also are adapted to darkness – it has **Night Vision 5**.

**Smell:** The wyvern has Discriminatory Smell (p. B49).

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 7  | 10   |

Wyverns are aggressive and not very intelligent, often attacking anything weaker than themselves.

**Mentality Traits:** Bestial; Loner (12).

### Skills

Aerobatics-12; Brawling-16; Stealth-12.

### Other Traits

Foot Manipulators; No Fine Manipulators.

### Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Dusk and dawn.

**Diet:** Carnivorous. Wyverns are immune to each other's poison and avoid eating flesh tainted by it. While humans find wyvern meat unpalatable, the tail's meat is considered delicious, similar to juicy pork. Wyverns bring live prey for their offspring to avoid tainting it with poison. Adult wyverns can carry live prey, but younger ones kill and transport the carcass instead. Older wyverns maintain control of their prey even when startled mid-flight.

**Habitat:** Typically found in warm hills, tangled forests, or large caverns, with temperatures between 35° and 90°. Their territories are roughly 25 miles in diameter, expanding when food is scarce. Wyverns may form partnerships to hunt large game and can develop pack tactics, but they prefer solitude if food is abundant.

**Language:** Wyverns have their own language and some learn a dialect of Draconic.

**Lifespan:** Up to 80 years.

**Relationships:** Fiercely rivalries with dragons, griffons, and other wyverns over hippogriff meat; territorial rivals with manticores, chimeras, griffons, perytons, and wyverns.

**Reproduction:** Mate every second year in late fall or early winter. Lay one egg (two if conditions are favorable) two to three months later. The egg hatches after another month, in late winter or early spring. The young leave the nest by late spring of the following year, which prevents the adults from mating that season.

Hatchlings are initially fragile and helpless, unable to walk for weeks. Within weeks, they can kill with their poison. By four months, they can effectively attack and immobilize small prey. At six months, they begin flying and become proficient flyers by nine months. They leave the nest at a year and a half and reach sexual maturity in up to three years, shorter if food is abundant.

### Spoils

Wyvern hide is used for book bindings and its blood for the belarris poison and Create Darkenbeast spells.

When designing wyvern hide armor with *Low-Tech Armor Design* from *Pyramid* #3-52, use the following statistics: WM 0.75; Cost \$34, DR/inch 9, Max DR 6, Combustible, Flexible, Construction: fabric, layered fabric, scale.

It is possible to extract poison from the wyvern's stinger. A successful Poisons roll that takes 10 minutes extracts one dose of poison plus one additional dose for every 2 points of margin of success, up to the maximum of 4 doses. Each dose costs \$65.

## Capturing and Training

Cloud giants keep griffons, perytons, and wyverns similarly to how humans keep birds of prey. These tamed creatures often patrol the giants' gardens alongside other predators like owlbears.

**Egg Value:** \$20,000.

**Hatchling Value:** \$14,500.

**Untrained Value:** \$72,400.

**Trained Value:** \$724,300.

**Supply Cost:** \$32 and 12 lbs./day. If it is allowed to hunt, then supply cost is \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Wyverns).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.754.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$21,700.

**Quirks:** Dislikes the taste of poison of other wyverns [-1].

**Features:** Early Maturation 2.

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 20 Wyverns

*Battle Rating:* 15

*Classes:* Air, Cv.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 48/192 (air) or 28/112 (land).

*Supply (Weekly):* \$9,600.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$473,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$511,400.

## Racial Template

228 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+16 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%; Size Modifier, -20%) [64]; IQ-3 [-60]; HT+4 [40].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+2; Will+3 [15]; Per+3 [15]; FP+2 [6]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Acute Vision 2 [4]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Discriminatory Smell [15]; DR 4 [20]; Extra Attack 1 [25]; Flight (Cannot Hover, -15%; Winged, -25%) [24]; High Pain Threshold [10]; Immunity to Paralysis [10]; Immunity to Sleep [10]; Infravision [10]; Nictitating Membrane 2 [2]; Night Vision 5 [5]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1].

*Barbed Tail* [34]: Striker (Impaling; Cannot Parry, -40%; Long 3, +300%) [30] + Striker (Crushing; Cannot Parry, -40%; Long 3, +300%) [18/5=4].

*Poison:* Toxic Attack 1d-1 (Cyclic, 1 minute, 5 cycles, Resistible, +100%; Follow-Up, Stinger, +0%; Resistible, HT-2, -20%; Symptoms, 1/2 HP, -3 HT, +30%) [7].

**Disadvantages:** Bestial [-10]; Foot Manipulators [-6]; Loner (12) [-5]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; Restricted Diet (Carnivore) [-10]; Short Arms [-10].

**Perks:** Immunity to Wyvern Poison [1]; Penetrating Voice [1]; Scales [1].

## Xill

Type: Outsider (Xill)



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |           |
|----|----|----|----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 11 | HP | 11 | SM     | +0        |
| DX | 12 | BS | 6  | thr/sw | 1d-1/1d+1 |
| HT | 12 | FP | 12 | BL     | 24 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-1/1d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid (four arms).

**Weight:** 100 lbs.

**Height:** 5 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Ugly (-2 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Savage (-2 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-6. 5% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** A (individual), C.

Xill, reptilian beings from the Ethereal plane, are divided into two societies: the barbaric Lower Clans and the civilized High Clans. They have flame-red, leathery skin, solid black eyes, and humanoid bodies with four clawed arms. High Clan xill adorn themselves with clothing and jewelry, while Lower Clan xill wear nothing.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 24 | 48    | 72     | 144   | 240         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 10.

**Parry:** 11 (shortsword).

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes.

**Resistances:** Magic Resistance 2 (Improved).

**Immunities:** sunburn.

**Vulnerabilities:** -2 to ST against knockback.

**Notes:** A character can target a xill's vitals intentionally only if he succeeds on a Physiology (Xill) roll.

### Combat

Lower Clan xill use their planeshifting ability to ambush and capture victims on the Material plane, relying solely on their claws. In their Ethereal plane lair, they prioritize the safety of their young before engaging enemies (all xill have **Extra Attack 1** and **Ambidexterity**).

High Clan xill use armor and weapons, preferring to wield weapons in two hands and use the other two for grappling. Their paralyzing venom is used sparingly.

**Paralyzing Bite (14):** thrust 1d-1 cutting plus follow-up affliction (resisted by HT; paralysis for margin of failure hours, then physical stun). Reach C. If the attack hits, the xill may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d control against SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-2 control against larger ones.

**Sharp Claws (14):** thrust 1d-1 cutting. Reach C.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d control. Reach C. This assumes a two-handed grapple. A four-handed grapple deals 1d+1 control.

**Shortsword swing (14):** swing 1d+1 cutting (RS: 1d), Reach 1. 2 lbs.

**Shortsword thrust (14):** thrust 1d impaling, Reach 1. 2 lbs.

**Longbow (14):** thrust 1d+1 impaling, Acc 3, Range 165/300, RoF 1, Shots 1(2).

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.2 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 12 lbs.

### Control Thresholds

| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| 2                    | 7                    | 13        | 20                   | 26                 |

### Special Abilities

**Implant:** A xill that deals injury with a bite attack can inject an egg pellet into the opponent's body. The affected creature must make a successful HT-3 roll to avoid implantation. Often the xill implants an unconscious or otherwise helpless creature. The egg gestates for 90 days, then the host takes 2d toxic

damage each hour for 13 cycles. Each cycle allows an additional HT-3 roll that prevents any further damage and destroys the egg pellet. Once the host loses 1/2 of their HP to this effect, they begin experiencing terrible pain (p. B428) until they heal above that threshold. Once the host loses 2/3 of their HP to this effect, they begin experiencing agony (p. B428) until they heal above that threshold. The egg pellet can be removed with a successful Surgery roll (failure deals 1d-1 injury), or a Remove Disease spell cast at a -5 penalty. If the host dies to this effect, the egg hatches into a xill that eats its way out.

**Planewalk (10):** The xill can slip into the Ethereal Plane from the Material Plane and the other way around as per Jumper (p. B64).

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).  
Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 11  | 11     | 11      | 11          | 11    |

**Vision:** Aside from normal vision, the xill can use a Ready maneuver to switch to **Infravision** (p. B60).

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 10 | 11   |

Xill are brutal and malevolent. Lower Clan xill focus on reproduction, while High Clan xill are vengeful and power-hungry but maintain a semblance of civilization.

**Mentality Traits:** Bully (12); Callous. High Clan xill often have Selfish (12).

## Other Traits

Extra Arms 2; Skinny.

## Skills

Bow-14; Brawling-14; Climbing-14; Jumping-14; Shortsword-14; Wrestling-14.

## Ecology

**Activity Cycle:** Any.

**Diet:** Omnivorous.

**Habitat:** Xill inhabit the Border and Deep Ethereal planes but can hunt on the Material plane in any land climate between 35° and 90°.

**Lifespan:** Xill lifespan is about 50 years.

**Reproduction:** Xill reproduce asexually, laying two sets of eggs (2-16 eggs each) during their lifetime. These eggs must be implanted in a living, intelligent host, causing a -3 **reaction** penalty. Lower

Clan xill prefer magic-bearing hosts. The eggs incubate in the host's gut for about 90 days before hatching. The larvae grow for 12 hours inside the host before emerging, a process usually fatal to the host. Xill reach adulthood within 1-4 hours after emergence.

High Clan xill keep their reproductive habits secret, but rumors suggest they also need intelligent hosts. They are believed to maintain a hidden prison/hatchery in the Deep Ethereal, where human slaves, descendants of long-ago captives, are bred for this purpose. These slaves typically lose all traces of civilization and rarely survive past adolescence.

## Society

All xill belong to either the High Clans or the Lower Clans.

- Lower Clans: Barbaric and solely focused on reproduction, they do not acknowledge the High Clans and see all other species as prey.

- High Clans: Civilized, they manufacture and use weapons, clothing, and tools, trade with other species, and build cities on blocks of "solid ether" in the Deep Ethereal. Though rarely leaving the Ethereal Plane, they do not view all other species as prey and may work as guides. Some High Clan xill become clerics, leading small groups and worshipping the deity Sixin.

## Spoils

High Clan xill may possess armor, weapons, jewelry, and any other items, while the Lower Clan xill typically carry nothing of value.

## Capturing and Training

Xill mercenaries can be trained as soldiers, but their control is difficult due to their combat prowess.

**Untrained Value:** \$7,200.

**Trained Value:** \$72,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$2 and 3 lbs./day.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.075

**Wage (Monthly):** \$470

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Xill

**Battle Rating:** 9

**Classes:** None.

**Features:** Night.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 28/112

**Supply (Weekly):** \$2,400.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$259,200.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$2,000.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$268,800.

## Racial Template

259 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+1 [10]; DX+2 [40]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** Will+1 [5]; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Ambidexterity [5]; DR 2 (Tough Skin, -40%) [6]; Extra Arms 2 [20]; Extra Attack 1 [25]; Infravision [10]; Magic Resistance 2 (Improved, +150%) [10]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1].

**Implant:** Toxic Attack 2d (Cyclic, 12 one-hour cycles, Resistible, +110%; Follow-Up, Sharp Teeth, +0%; Onset, 90 days, -40%; Resistible, HT-3, -15%; Symptoms, 1/2 HP, Terrible Pain, +120%; Symptoms, 2/3 HP, Agony, +300%) [46].

**Paralysis:** Affliction 1 (HT; Extended Duration, 100x, +80%; Follow-Up, Sharp Teeth, +0%; Paralysis, +150%) [33].

**Planewalk:** Jumper (Planar; Accessibility, Only on the Ethereal Plane and planes that border it, -5%; Limited Access, Ethereal, -20%; Magical, -10%) [65].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Ugly) [-8]; Bully (12) [-10]; Callous [-5]; Odious Racial Habit (Implantation requires sapient hosts) [-15]; Skinny [-5]; Social Stigma (Savage) [-10].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

## Zombie (Lens)

Type: Undead



A zombie is an undead creature created by reanimating a corpse. Unlike animated skeletons, zombies retain some flesh and emit a foul odor (-2 to reaction). Typically, a zombie decays and becomes a skeleton within 21-50 days (*GURPS Bio-Tech*, p. 140.) Any corporeal creature can become a zombie, and some rare ones gain special abilities (e.g., zombie dragons). Zombies are the simplest and most widespread of all undead.

Typically, zombies serve as tools for evil priests and wizards via spells like *animate dead*. However, they can also arise spontaneously due to the presence of other powerful undead. Areas with strong necromantic energy or a history of violence, such as battlefields or mass graves, can generate masterless zombies without the Reprogrammable disadvantage. These zombies, though leaderless, may instinctively cooperate with each other or more intelligent undead to the extent their limited minds allow.

### Ecology

**Habitat:** Zombies often remain in their former habitats, commonly found in crypts, tombs, ruins, graveyards, and necropolises. They are cheap and easy to create, making them popular among necromancers to guard lairs and evil temples, especially those devoted to death gods. Overproduction can lead to "wild" undead that roam freely from their creation sites.

Zombies have their temperature comfort zone extended by 5xHT degrees in both directions.

**Speech:** Zombies retain their ability to speak, but are not good at talking. Their disturbing voice gives -2 on any speech-based reaction roll and -2 to Diplomacy, Fast-Talk, Performance, Public Speaking, Sex Appeal, and Singing.

**Undead:** As undead creatures, zombies do not need food, water, sleep, air, or experience aging. They are immune to metabolic hazards. Zombies do not possess a FP score, cannot naturally heal HP, and are unable to reproduce sexually.

### Mentality

Nearly mindless, zombies can follow simple commands like "kill anyone who opens the treasure chest." Without a master, they may claim and defend territories, such as a crypt or a dungeon hallway. When in groups, their congregations are instinctual rather than coordinated.

Being mindless, zombies are immune to mind control, Fright Checks, and mundane influence, even with an IQ above 5 after adjustments. Specialized spells like *control undead* can affect them. Zombies are highly focused on their tasks, gaining a +3 to success rolls when focus would benefit them but suffering a -5 penalty on noticing interruptions.

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Spoils

Zombies do not accumulate wealth, but they may carry equipment given to them by their masters.

### Lens

-123 points

**Applicable to:** Any corporeal non-undead creature with a skeletal system.

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+1 [10]; IQ-2 [-40].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** HP+4 [8].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).

When applying the lens, make sure to check for conflicts between the two templates, remove traits that are not appropriate for a zombie, and modify lens characteristics that are affected by the base creature's traits, such as No Fine Manipulators or positive SM.

# Zombie (Bugbear)

Type: Undead



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |           |
|----|----|----|------|--------|-----------|
| ST | 17 | HP | 20   | SM     | +1        |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5.25 | thr/sw | 1d+2/3d-1 |
| HT | 11 | FP | -    | BL     | 58 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+2/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 300 lb.

**Height:** 7 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-6. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is a zombie created from a bugbear corpse.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 58 | 116   | 174    | 348   | 580         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8U (axe); 8 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

## Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**SM+1 Axe (two-handed) (10):** swing 4d cutting (RS: 3d), Reach 1, unbalanced, 9 lbs.

**Punch (10):** thrust 1d+1 crushing, Reach C-1.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 1d+2 control, Reach C-1.

**Fangs (10):** thrust 1d+1 impaling, Reach C. If the attack hits, the bugbear zombie may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d+2 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d control against larger ones.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.9 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 29 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 9                    | 17        | 26                   | 34                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | -           | 10    |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the zombie has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 7  | 7    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

## Other Traits

Silence 1.

## Skills

Two-Handed Axe/Mace-10.

## Capturing and Training

Zombies are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$1,770.

**Trained Value:** \$17,730.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.018

**Wage (Monthly):** \$530

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Bugbear Zombies

*Battle Rating:* 1

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$31,900.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$33,900.

## Racial Template

-49 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+7 (Size Modifier, -10%) [63]; IQ-3 [-60]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM+1; HP+3 (Size Modifier, -10%) [6]; Per+3 [15]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Fangs [2]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Silence 1 [5]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Perks:** Fur [1].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).

**Racial Skills:** Two-Handed Axe/Mace (A) DX [2].

## Zombie (Goblin)

Type: Undead

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 9  | <b>HP</b> | 12   | <b>SM</b>     | -1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 5.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-2/1d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | -    | <b>BL</b>     | 16 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 60 lb.

**Height:** 4 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-20. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is the typical zombie created from a corpse of a goblin.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 16 | 32    | 48     | 96    | 160         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8U (mace), 8 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

### Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**SM-1 Small Round Mace (11):** swing 1d crushing, Reach 1, unbalanced, 1.9 lb.

**SM-1 Small Round Mace throw (7):** swing 1d crushing, Acc 1, x1/x1.5 (9/13), 1.9 lb., Bulk -3.

**Sharp Teeth (11):** thrust 1d-3 cutting, Reach C. If the attack hits, the goblin zombie may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-2 control against SM-4 and smaller victims or 1d-4 control against larger ones.

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-3 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-2 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.8 lb.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 8 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 1                           | 5                           | 9                | 14                          | 18                        |

### Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).  
Teeth (p. MA115).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 8   | 8      | 8       | -           | 8     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the zombie has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 8    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Other Traits

Silence 1.

### Skills

Axe/Mace-11.

### Capturing and Training

Zombies are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$175.

**Trained Value:** \$1,750.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.002

**Wage (Monthly):** \$50

### Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Goblin Zombies**

*Battle Rating:* 0.2

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 16/64

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$6,300.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$8,300.

## Racial Template

-122 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-1 [-10]; DX+1 [20]; IQ-2 [-40].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM-1; HP+3 [6]; Basic Move -1 [-5].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Silence 1 [5]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).

**Racial Skills:** Axe/Mace (A) DX [2].

## Zombie (Gray Render)

Type: Undead

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |          |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 29 | <b>HP</b> | 33  | <b>SM</b>     | +1       |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 3d/5d+2  |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | -   | <b>BL</b>     | 168 lbs. |

Reduced Swing: 3d/3d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 4,000 lb.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is a zombie created from a gray render corpse.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 168 | 336   | 504    | 1,008 | 1,680       |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 3\* (tough skin).

**Skull:** In addition to the normal additional DR 2, the skull is covered by thick bone plates that provide extra DR 4. Thus, the skull has total DR 9.

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 9 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

**Notes:** The gray render zombie's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +2 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

Unlike most creatures, the gray render zombie has six eyes.

### Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**Bite (10):** thrust 3d-1 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the gray render zombie may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 3d control against SM+0 and smaller victims or 2d+2 control against larger ones.

**Claws (10):** thrust 3d-1 cutting. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 3d control. Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 8.4 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 84 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 15                   | 29        | 44                   | 58                 |

### Special Abilities

**Marsupial Pouch:** The gray render zombie has a marsupial pouch that can hold up to 84 lbs.

### Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furies*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).  
Teeth (p. MA115).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 9   | 12     | 9       | -           | 9     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the zombie has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

The gray render zombie possesses **Peripheral Vision** (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

In addition, gray render zombie's eyes are able to detect light polarization. The gray render zombie knows the true direction of the sun even through clouds, and can navigate without a penalty for being unable to see it. It has +2 to spot water surfaces from above or below.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 4  | 8    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor;

and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

## Skills

None.

## Capturing and Training

Gray render zombies may be used by necromancers in their armies.

**Untrained Value:** \$8,800.

**Trained Value:** \$88,160.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.092

**Wage (Monthly):** \$50

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Gray Render Zombies

*Battle Rating:* 5.5

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$158,700.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$158,700.

## Racial Template

89 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+19 (Size Modifier, -10%) [171]; IQ-6 [-120]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristic Modifiers:** SM+1; HP+4 (Size Modifier, -10%) [8]; Will+4 [20]; Per+5 [25]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Acute Vision 3 [6]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Dark Vision [25]; DR 4 (Outer Layer; Partial, Skull Only, -70%) [8]; DR 3 (Tough Skin, -40%) [9]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Payload 5 [5]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Cannot Speak [-15]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Perks:** Polarization Detection [1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).

# Zombie (Human Commoner)

Type: Undead



## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |           |
|----|----|----|----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 11 | HP | 15 | SM     | +0        |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5  | thr/sw | 1d-1/1d+1 |
| HT | 10 | FP | -  | BL     | 24 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-1/1d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 150 lb.

**Height:** 6 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-20. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is the typical zombie created from the reanimation of an ordinary human, like a peasant. Sometimes, such zombies are given equipment.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 24 | 48    | 72     | 144   | 240         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

## Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**Punch (10):** thrust 1d-2 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 1d-1 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 1.2 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 12 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 6                    | 11        | 17                   | 22                 |

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 8   | 8      | 8       | -           | 8     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the zombie has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 8    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

## Skills

None.

## Capturing and Training

Zombies are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$100.

**Trained Value:** \$1,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.001

**Wage (Monthly):** \$50

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 120 Human Commoner Zombies

*Battle Rating:* 0.12

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 20/80

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$3,600.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$3,600.

## Racial Template

*-123 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+1 [10]; IQ-2 [-40].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** HP+4 [8].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).

## Zombie (Kobold)

Type: Undead

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 6  | <b>HP</b> | 10   | <b>SM</b>     | -2        |
| <b>DX</b> | 11 | <b>BS</b> | 5.25 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-4/1d-3 |
| <b>HT</b> | 10 | <b>FP</b> | -    | <b>BL</b>     | 7.2 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 1d-4/1d-2

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 40 lb.

**Height:** 2.5 ft.

**Effective Height:** 3 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 2-20. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is the typical zombie created from the reanimation of a kobold.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 4; exploration 2 miles per hour.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 7.2 | 14.4  | 21.6   | 43.2  | 72          |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 8 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

**Notes:** The kobold zombie's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +3 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

### Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**Punch (11):** thrust 1d-5 crushing, Reach C.

**Grapple (11):** thrust 1d-4 control, Reach C.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.36 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 3.6 lbs.

### Control Thresholds

| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1                           | 3                           | 6                | 9                           | 12                        |

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 8   | 8      | 8       | -           | 8     |

**Vision:** The kobold zombie possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

As an undead being, the zombie has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 8    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Skills

None.

### Capturing and Training

Zombies are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$75.

**Trained Value:** \$740.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.001

**Wage (Monthly):** \$22

### Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Kobold Zombies**

**Battle Rating:** 0.09

**Classes:** None.

**Features:** Night.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 16/64

**Supply (Weekly):** \$0.

**Wage (Monthly):** \$2,650.

**Specialist Cost (Monthly):** \$0.

**Cost to Field (Monthly):** \$2,650.

## Racial Template

-139 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-4 [-40]; DX+1 [20]; IQ-2 [-40].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM-2; HP+4 [8]; Basic Move -1 [-5].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Born Biter 3; Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).

# Zombie (Minotaur)

Type: Undead



## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |     |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|-----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 19 | <b>HP</b> | 23  | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.5 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 2d-1/3d+1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 12 | <b>FP</b> | -   | <b>BL</b>     | 72 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 2d-1/2d

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 700 lb.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-4. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is a zombie created from a corpse of a minotaur.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 72 | 144   | 216    | 432   | 720         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** DR 2\* (tough skin). The skull has an additional DR 2 (total DR 6). Hooves add +1 DR to feet.

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 8U (two-handed axe/mace); 8 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A

zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

## Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**SM+1 Great Axe (10):** swing 5d cutting (RS: 4d-1), Reach 1-3\*, unbalanced, becomes unready after attacking, 18 lbs.

**Horns (10):** thrust 2d-1 impaling, Reach C-1. The minotaur zombie may gore with both horns as a single attack; if it hits, figure damage for each horn separately. Horns have DR 4 and HP 11. Damage dealt to the horns is not subtracted from the minotaur zombie's HP. If the minotaur zombie loses one horn, it may still attack with the other.

**Bite (10):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the minotaur zombie may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d-1 control against SM-2 and smaller victims or 1d+1 control against larger ones.

**Claws (10):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C-1.

**Kick (8):** thrust 2d-1 crushing. Reach C-1. On a miss with a kick, roll vs. DX to avoid falling.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 2d-1 control. Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 3.6 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 36 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 10                   | 19        | 29                   | 38                 |

## Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid #3-77*, pp. 4-5).

*Teeth* (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 8   | 8      | 8       | -           | 8     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the zombie has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 7  | 7    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

## Skills

Two-Handed Axe/Mace-10.

## Capturing and Training

Zombies are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$3,325.

**Trained Value:** \$33,250.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.035

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,000

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Minotaur Zombies

*Battle Rating:* 2

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$60,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$62,000.

## Racial Template

-13 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+9 (Size Modifier, -10%) [81]; IQ-3 [-60]; HT+2 [20].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM+1; HP+4 (Size Modifier, -10%) [8]; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; DR 2 (Tough Skin, -40%) [6]; DR 2 (Partial, Skull, -70%) [3]; Hooves [3]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

*Horns* [8]: 2 x Natural Weapon (Impaling; Cannot Parry, -40%; Link, +10%; Single, -20%) [4].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Perks:** Fur [1].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).

**Racial Skills:** Two-Handed Axe/Mace (A) DX [2].

## Zombie (Ogre)

Type: Undead



### Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |    |        |           |
|----|----|----|----|--------|-----------|
| ST | 17 | HP | 21 | SM     | +1        |
| DX | 9  | BS | 5  | thr/sw | 1d+2/3d-1 |
| HT | 11 | FP | -  | BL     | 58 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d+2/2d-1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 600 lb.

**Height:** 9 ft.

**Effective Height:** 9 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-6. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is a zombie created from an ogre corpse.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 6; exploration 3 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 58 | 116   | 174    | 348   | 580         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 2\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8.

**Parry:** 7U (small mace); 7 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

### Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**SM+1 Small Mace (9):** swing 3d+2 crushing (RS: 2d+2), Reach 1, unbalanced, 6.75 lbs.

**Punch (9):** thrust 1d+1 crushing, Reach C-1.

**Grapple (9):** thrust 1d+2 control, Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 2.9 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 29 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 6                    | 11        | 17                   | 22                 |

### Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 7   | 7      | 7       | -           | 7     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the zombie has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 7  | 7    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Skills

Axe/Mace-9.

### Capturing and Training

Zombies are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$1,330.

**Trained Value:** \$13,300.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.014

**Wage (Monthly):** \$400

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Ogre Zombies

*Battle Rating:* 1

*Classes:* None.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 24/96

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$24,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$26,000.

## Racial Template

-87 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+7 (Size Modifier, -10%) [63]; DX-1 [-20]; IQ-3 [-60]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM+1; HP+4 (Size Modifier, -10%) [8]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** DR 2 (Tough Skin, -40%) [6]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).

**Racial Skills:** Axe/Mace (A) DX [2].

# Zombie (Troglodyte)

Type: Undead

## Physical Characteristics

|    |    |    |      |        |           |
|----|----|----|------|--------|-----------|
| ST | 11 | HP | 15   | SM     | +0        |
| DX | 10 | BS | 5.25 | thr/sw | 1d-1/1d+1 |
| HT | 11 | FP | -    | BL     | 24 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-1/1d

Body Plan: Humanoid.

Weight: 150 lb.

Height: 6 ft.

Effective Height: 6 ft.

Appearance: Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

Social Stigma: Dead (-4 reaction).

Organization: 1-10. 0% lair encounter chance.

Treasure Type: -.

This is a zombie created from a troglodyte corpse.

## Movement and Encumbrance

Ground: Move 5; exploration 2.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 24 | 48    | 72     | 144   | 240         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

Dodge: 1\* (tough skin).

Dodge: 8 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

Parry: 8U (axe); 8 (unarmed).

Immunities: Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

Defensive Traits: Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

Weaknesses: Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

## Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

Stone Axe (10): swing 2d-1(0.5) cutting (RS: 1d+2(0.5)), Reach 1, unbalanced, 4 lbs. Treated as cheap for breakage purposes when parrying a swung weapon made of metal.

Bite (10): thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the troglodyte zombie may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per Teeth (p. MA115), applying 1d-1 control against

SM-3 and smaller victims or 1d-3 control against larger ones.

Claws (10): thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C.

Grapple (10): thrust 1d-1 control. Reach C.

Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight: 1.2 lbs.

Effective Slam Weight: 12 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 2                    | 6                    | 11        | 17                   | 22                 |

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 8   | 8      | 8       | -           | 8     |

Vision: As an undead being, the zombie has Dark Vision (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

The troglodyte zombie possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 7  | 7    |

Mentality Traits: Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

## Skills

Axe/Mace-10.

## Capturing and Training

Zombies are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

Untrained Value: \$440.

Trained Value: \$4,400.

Supply Cost: \$0.

Individual Battle Rating: 0.005

Wage (Monthly): \$130

## Mass Combat Statistics

120 Troglodyte Zombies

Battle Rating: 0.5

Classes: None.

Features: Night.

Move (Daily/Weekly, miles): 20/80

Supply (Weekly): \$0.

Wage (Monthly): \$15,600.

Specialist Cost (Monthly): \$2,000.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$17,600.

## Racial Template

*-101 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+1 [10]; IQ-3 [-60]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** HP+4 [8]; Per+1 [5].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Perks:** Scales [1].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).

**Racial Skills:** Axe/Mace (A) DX [2].

# Zombie (Umbur Hulk)

Type: Undead

## Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 20 | <b>HP</b> | 24   | <b>SM</b>     | +1        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 5.75 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 2d-1/3d+2 |
| <b>HT</b> | 13 | <b>FP</b> | -    | <b>BL</b>     | 80 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 2d-1/2d+1

**Body Plan:** Humanoid.

**Weight:** 800 lb.

**Height:** 8 ft.

**Effective Height:** 6 ft. when horizontal and 9 ft. when upright.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is a zombie created from an umber hulk corpse.

## Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

Typically, the umber hulk zombie moves on all four limbs, but it is able to awkwardly walk upright with Move 4. While upright, the umber hulk zombie can use both forearms to attack and parry. Its effective height for the purpose of combat modifiers becomes 9 ft. UMBER hulk zombies with DX 12 or more can carry a small object or two while walking.

**Tunneling:** Move 1; exploration 0.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 80 | 160   | 240    | 480   | 800         |

## Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 8.

**Dodge:** 9 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Parry:** 9 (unarmed).

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

**Weaknesses:** Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

**Notes:** The umber hulk zombie's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is

targeted at +3 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

Unlike most creatures, the umber hulk zombie has four eyes.

## Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**Mandibles (10):** thrust 1d+2 cutting. Reach C. If the attack hits, the umber hulk zombie may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 2d-1 control against SM+1 and smaller victims or 1d+2 control against larger ones.

**Blunt Claws (10):** thrust 2d crushing. Reach C-1.

**Grapple (10):** thrust 2d-1 control. Reach C-1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 4 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 40 lbs.

| Control Thresholds          |                             |                  |                             |                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 0.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq \text{CM}$ | $\geq 1.5 \times \text{CM}$ | $\geq 2 \times \text{CM}$ |
| 2                           | 10                          | 20               | 30                          | 40                        |

## Useful Combat Rules

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid #3-77*, pp. 4-5).  
Teeth (p. MA115).

## Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 9   | 9      | 9       | -           | 9     |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the zombie has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

The umber hulk zombie possesses **Peripheral Vision** (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

## Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 8  | 10   |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

## Skills

None.

## Capturing and Training

Umber hulk zombies may be used by necromancers in their armies.

**Untrained Value:** \$4,630.

**Trained Value:** \$46,300.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.048

**Wage (Monthly):** \$1,400

## Mass Combat Statistics

### 60 Umber Hulk Zombies

*Battle Rating:* 3

*Classes:* Eng.

*Features:* Night, Terrain (Underground).

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 28/112 (land) or 4/16 (burrowing)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$84,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$84,000.

## Racial Template

106 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+10 (Size Modifier, -10%) [90]; IQ-2 [-40]; HT+3 [30].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM+1; HP+4 (Size Modifier, -10%) [8]; Will+2 [10]; Per+1 [5]; Basic Move +2 [10].

**Advantages:** Blunt Claws [3]; Combat Reflexes [15]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; DR 8 [40]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Tunneling (Move 1) [35]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Grip 2 [-10]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Semi-Upright [-5]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Born Biter 3; Four Eyes; Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).

## Zombie (Wolf)

Type: Undead

### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |      |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|------|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 9  | <b>HP</b> | 13   | <b>SM</b>     | +0        |
| <b>DX</b> | 12 | <b>BS</b> | 5.75 | <b>thr/sw</b> | 1d-2/1d-1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 11 | <b>FP</b> | -    | <b>BL</b>     | 16 lbs.   |

Reduced Swing: 1d-2/1d-1

**Body Plan:** Quadruped (p. B553).

**Weight:** 90 lb.

**Length:** 5 ft.

**Effective Height:** 4.5 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** 1-4. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is a zombie created from a wolf's body.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 9/13; exploration 6.5 miles per hour.

| No | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 16 | 32    | 48     | 96    | 160         |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** 1\* (tough skin).

**Dodge:** 8.

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Defensive Traits:** Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving).

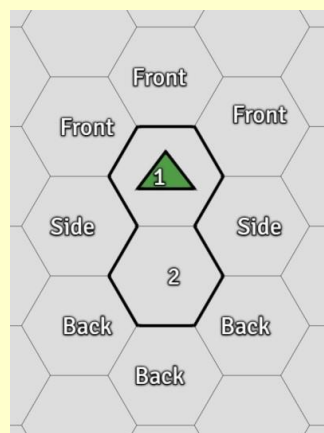
**Weaknesses:** Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

**Notes:** The wolf zombie's jaw (or face, if you're not using expanded facial hit locations) is targeted at +2 due to being larger than usual relative to the body.

### Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

**Sharp Teeth (12):** thrust 1d-2 cutting. Reach C from hex #1. If the attack hits, the wolf may elect to hold on and grapple the



victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 1d-2 control against SM-1 and smaller victims or 1d-4 control against larger ones.

**Grapple (14):** thrust 1d-2 control. Reach C from hex #1.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 0.8 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 8 lbs.

| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 1                    | 5                    | 9         | 14                   | 18                 |

### Useful Combat Rules

Teeth (p. MA115).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 10  | 10     | 10      | -           | 10    |

**Vision:** As an undead being, the zombie has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 2  | 8    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Other Traits

Extra Legs (Four Legs); Horizontal; No Fine Manipulators.

### Skills

None.

### Capturing and Training

Zombies are commonly used in necromancers' armies, mindlessly marching toward the enemy and attacking with fists or any weapons provided.

**Untrained Value:** \$510.

**Trained Value:** \$5,100.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.005

**Wage (Monthly):** \$150

### Mass Combat Statistics

**120 Wolf Zombies**

**Battle Rating:** 0.5

**Classes:** Cv.

**Features:** Night.

**Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):** 52/208

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$18,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$18,000.

## Racial Template

*-142 points*

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST-1 [-10]; DX+2 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%) [24]; IQ-8 [-160]; HT+1 [10].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** HP+4 [8]; Will+6 [30]; Per+8 [40]; Basic Move +4 [20].

**Advantages:** Dark Vision [25]; DR 1 (Tough Skin, -40%) [3]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Enhanced Move 0.5 (Ground) [10]; Extra Legs (Four Legs) [5]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Single-Minded [5]; Striking ST 3 (One Attack Only, Bite, -60%) [6]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Horizontal [-10]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Perks:** Fur [1]; Penetrating Voice [1].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Born Biter 2; Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton); Tail.

## Zombie (Wyvern)

Type: Undead



### Physical Characteristics

|           |    |           |    |               |           |
|-----------|----|-----------|----|---------------|-----------|
| <b>ST</b> | 27 | <b>HP</b> | 31 | <b>SM</b>     | +2        |
| <b>DX</b> | 10 | <b>BS</b> | 6  | <b>thr/sw</b> | 3d-1/5d+1 |
| <b>HT</b> | 14 | <b>FP</b> | -  | <b>BL</b>     | 146 lbs.  |

Reduced Swing: 3d-1/3d

**Body Plan:** Avian (p. B553).

**Weight:** 2,000 lbs.

**Length:** 12 ft. (24 ft. with tail).

**Effective Height:** 15 ft.

**Appearance:** Monstrous (Universal) (-5 reaction).

**Social Stigma:** Dead (-4 reaction).

**Organization:** Solitary. 0% lair encounter chance.

**Treasure Type:** -.

This is a zombie created from a dead wyvern.

### Movement and Encumbrance

**Ground:** Move 7; exploration 3.5 miles per hour.

**Air:** Move 12; exploration 6 miles per hour. Cannot hover – must move at least at Move 3 when flying. In order to take off or land, the zombie wyvern must have an open area with a radius of 4 yards in all directions.

| No  | Light | Medium | Heavy | Extra-Heavy |
|-----|-------|--------|-------|-------------|
| 146 | 292   | 438    | 876   | 1,460       |

### Defenses and Vulnerabilities

**DR:** The zombie wyvern's scaly hide provides DR 4. A nictitating membrane provides DR 2 to the eyes.

**Dodge:** 10 (no penalty against side attacks, -2 against rear attacks).

**Immunities:** Fright Checks, knockdown, metabolic hazards, mind control, mundane influence, pain, physical stun, physical torture.

**Resistances:** +2 to all HT rolls concerned with eye damage.

**Defensive Traits:** Combat Reflexes; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving)..

**Weaknesses:** Zombies, being animated by necromantic energies, do not cling to life. When they are reduced to 0 HP, they immediately die for good. A zombie that has been put down by bringing it down to 0 HP with damage cannot be animated again.

### Combat

Zombies attack mindlessly and recklessly, often using All-Out Attack (Determined) or All-Out Attack (Strong).

The zombie wyvern has **Extra Attack 1** and hence can attack with two body parts in a single turn.

**Sharp Claws (8):** thrust 3d-1 cutting, Reach C from hexes #2-3. If used on the ground, the wyvern must roll against DX to remain standing on a miss.

**Sharp Teeth (10):** thrust 2d+2 cutting, Reach C from hexes #1-3. If the attack hits, the wyvern zombie may elect to hold on and grapple the victim in addition to injuring him as per *Teeth* (p. MA115), applying 3d-1 control against SM+1 and smaller victims or 2d+1 control against larger ones.

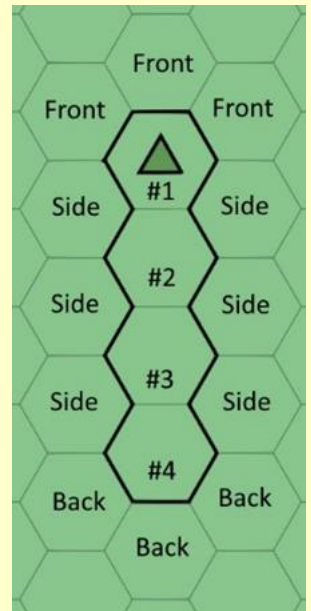
**Tail Barb (10):** thrust 3d+2 impaling, Reach C-5 from hex #4.

**Tail Slam (10):** thrust 3d+2 crushing, Reach C-5 from hex #4.

**Wing Buffet (6):** thrust 3d-1 crushing. Reach C-1 from hexes #2-3. When in flight, the wyvern must roll DX after attempting a Wing Buffet attack, whether it succeeds or fails. If the DX roll fails, the wyvern loses control of its flight. It will continue moving in the same direction and speed it was moving on the last turn before it lost control, until it can make an Aerobatics+2 roll to regain control.

**Effective Unarmed Attacks Weight:** 7.3 lbs.

**Effective Slam Weight:** 73 lbs.



| Control Thresholds   |                      |           |                      |                    |
|----------------------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|--------------------|
| $\geq 0.1 \times CM$ | $\geq 0.5 \times CM$ | $\geq CM$ | $\geq 1.5 \times CM$ | $\geq 2 \times CM$ |
| 3                    | 14                   | 27        | 41                   | 54                 |

### Useful Combat Rules

Clawed Grapple (*GURPS Furrries*, p. 17).

Combat at Different Levels (p. B402).

- Height Effects (*Pyramid* #3-77, pp. 4-5). Flying Combat (p. B398).
- Slam and Overrun (p. B392).
- Defense vs. Slams (*Pyramid* #3-77, p. 9). Teeth (p. MA115).

### Senses

| Per | Vision | Hearing | Taste/Smell | Touch |
|-----|--------|---------|-------------|-------|
| 8   | 10     | 8       | -           | 8     |

**Vision:** The zombie wyvern possesses Peripheral Vision (p. B74), so it has no penalty to defend against side attacks and may even defend against attacks from the rear at -2. Also, it gets +3 to rolls to detect Shadowing attempts.

As an undead being, the zombie wyvern has **Dark Vision** (p. B47) and can perfectly see in total darkness, albeit without distinguishing colors.

### Mentality

| IQ | Will |
|----|------|
| 5  | 8    |

**Mentality Traits:** Automaton (Hidebound; Incurious (6); Low Empathy; No Sense of Humor; and Slave Mentality); Cannot Learn; Indomitable; Reprogrammable; Single-Minded; Unfazeable.

### Other Traits

Foot Manipulators; No Fine Manipulators.

### Skills

None.

### Capturing and Training

Zombie wyverns may be used not only as combatants, but also as mounts for necromancers or death knights.

**Untrained Value:** \$60,000.

**Trained Value:** \$600,000.

**Supply Cost:** \$0.

**Riding Skill:** Riding (Wyverns).

**Individual Battle Rating:** 0.625

**Wage (Monthly):** \$18,000.

### Mass Combat Statistics

#### 20 Wyvern Zombies

*Battle Rating:* 12.5

*Classes:* Air, Cv.

*Features:* Night.

*Move (Daily/Weekly, miles):* 48/192 (air) or 28/112 (land)

*Supply (Weekly):* \$0.

*Wage (Monthly):* \$360,000.

*Specialist Cost (Monthly):* \$0.

*Cost to Field (Monthly):* \$360,000.

### Racial Template

56 points

**Attribute Modifiers:** ST+17 (No Fine Manipulators, -40%; Size Modifier, -20%) [68]; IQ-5 [-100]; HT+4 [40].

**Secondary Characteristics Modifiers:** SM+2; HP+4 (Size Modifier, -20%) [7]; Will+3 [15]; Per+3 [15]; FP+2 [6]; Basic Move +1 [5].

**Advantages:** Acute Vision 2 [4]; Combat Reflexes [15]; DR 4 [20]; Dark Vision [25]; Doesn't Breathe [20]; Doesn't Eat or Drink [10]; Doesn't Sleep [20]; Extra Attack 1 [25]; Flight (Cannot Hover, -15%; Winged, -25%) [24]; Immunity to Metabolic Hazards [30]; Immunity to Mind Control [30]; Immunity to Pain [30]; Indomitable [15]; Injury Tolerance (No Blood, Unliving) [25]; Nictitating Membrane 2 [2]; Peripheral Vision [15]; Sharp Claws [5]; Sharp Teeth [1]; Single-Minded [5]; Temperature Tolerance 10 [10]; Unaging [15]; Unfazeable [15].

*Barbed Tail* [34]: Striker (Impaling; Cannot Parry, -40%; Long 3, +300%) [30] + Striker (Crushing; Cannot Parry, -40%; Long 3, +300%) [18/5=4].

**Disadvantages:** Appearance (Monstrous; Universal, +25%) [-25]; Automaton [-85]; Bad Smell [-10]; Cannot Learn [-30]; Disturbing Voice [-10]; Enhanced Unnatural [-100]; Foot Manipulators [-6]; No Fine Manipulators [-30]; No Sense of Smell/Taste [-5]; Reprogrammable [-10]; Short Arms [-10]; Social Stigma (Dead) [-20]; Unhealing (Total) [-30]; Wealth (Dead Broke) [-25].

**Perks:** Penetrating Voice [1]; Scales [1].

**Quirks:** Sexless [-1].

**Features:** Not Subject to Fatigue; Potential Form (Skeleton).